THE CERTAINTY OF CHRISTIANITY WITHOUT POPERY

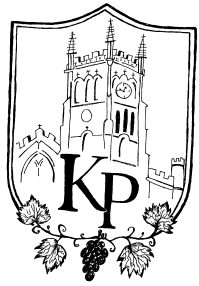
NAKED POPERY

ROMAN TRADITION EXAMINED

Richard Baxter

Modernized spelling edition

Edited by Jackson Harper



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THE CERTAINTY OF CHRISTIANITY Without POPERY:

OR,

Whether the Catholic-Protestant,
or the Papist have
the Surer Faith.

Being an Answer to one of the oft canted Questions and Challenges of the Papists, sent to one who desired this.

Published to direct the unskilful, how to defend their faith against Papists and Infidels, but especially against the Temptations of the Devil; that by saving their Faith, they may save their Holiness, their Comfort and their Souls.

By *Richard Baxter.*

2 Cor. 4. 1, 2.

Seeing we have this Ministry, as we have received mercy we faint not: But have renounced the Hidden *things of dishonesty, not walking in craftiness, nor handling the word of God deceitfully, But by manifestation of the truth, commending ourselves to every man's Conscience in the sight of God.*

LONDON, Printed for *Nevil Simons* at the Sign of the *Prince's Arms* in St. *Paul's* Church-Yard. 1672.

TO THE Protestant Reader.

IT is for your Reading, and not for the Papists chiefly that I publish this short and hasty writing. For I may probably prognosticate of them, 1. That the lay men will not, must not read it; 2. That the Priests, will not read it with any impartiality, as Lovers of Truth; 3. That what they cannot answer they will silently dissemble, or if any meddle with it, they will either take some scrap and leave the rest; or they will spend paper in cavilling at my 40. Reasons against them, because, lest I be tedious, I have not improved them by Syllogistical form and full confirmation, and they will put off the full answers already given them in the former Books to which I refer them, without a Reply: And they will pass by the strength of what they meddle with. 4. And when I am dead, they will patch up some confident answer to some of my Books (as vain as Mr. *Johnson, alias Terret,* hath done to one,) and will borrow some lies, from the writings of some against me that are of the same spirit with them, wherewith to reproach my Name, which shall be instead of an answer to my Books.

The Answer to their present Question I have already fuller given them, 1. In my *Reasons* of the *Christian Religion;* 2. And in my *More Reasons,* 3. In my *Life of Faith,* Part 2. 4. In my *Safe Religion* throughout, especially Disp. 3. 5. In my *Key for Catholics.* 6. In my Preface to the 2. Part of the *Saints' Rest.* And none of them that I know of are answered; But they cant over and over the same thing, and tempt or necessitate us thereby to write over and over the same thing, to the wearying of the Readers, while they silently dissemble all.

But the end of this writing is, to tell young unstudied persons, on what terms, and in what order they must deal with this great Question, and defend the foundations of their faith, against *Infidels, Papists,* and the *Devil* himself, who will here assault us with greater craft and force, than Papists or Infidels can do. Reader, study it well, till thy soul is clear and well confirmed; For the *Keeping* or *Losing* of this *Fort,* is the Keeping or Losing of thy Religion, thy Comfort, and thy soul.

This following Paper was sent me from an unknown person in a Letter, which had these words.

SIR,

THe business of this Paper is to beg a favour of you, of a public nature—an Answer to the enclosed Paper, which was sent me from a friend of mine who is a Papist, with an earnest desire that I would procure it to be answered. The resolution of which would be of use to us both in the things in Controversy between us—I cannot but wonder at the confidence of this deluded people, who though they are so often again and again Learnedly and Religiously writ against, yet they can with as great confidence and boasting challenge and dare the Ministers of Truth to encounter and answer them, in such kind of Papers, as if their tenets had never been refuted at all: And though I have referred my friend to your Books, that will not satisfy; but he doth as it were Goliath-*like bid defiance to our Ministers, telling me that if any be so hardy, let them answer his Papers.*

The Paper followeth.

ALL who call themselves Christians are agreed in this principle.

That every Revelation of God, or whatsoever God says is most certainly true in the sense wherein he intends it.

And this is a matter of right on God's part, to have this granted.

But all Christians do not agree; and it is the sole point wherein Christians differ:

Whether God hath Revealed or said what is proposed to us as his Revelation: Or as the sense intended by him by that which they all agree to be his Revelation.

And this is purely matter of Fact, (*viz.*) 1. Whether several Books affirmed and proposed to us as the Revelations of God be truly so. For Instance, the Old Testament affirmed by some to be, and proposed as the Revelations of God, are denied by the *Valentinians* and the *Manichees.* The Gospels of St. *Mark,* St. *Luke,* St. *John*, and all St. *Paul's* Epistles, proposed by some

Christians as the Revelations of God, are denied by others, namely by the *Ebionites.* So likewise several parties agreeing several Books to be Scripture and the Revelation of God, do notwithstanding differ touching the Copies, and touching the Translations; Some affirming one Copy to be true, and one Translation to be true, whilst others expressly say, that Copy is false, and that Translation false. And Lastly, several parties agreeing the Books to be Scripture, the Copies true, and the Translations true, and to be the Revelation of God, do nevertheless differ touching the sense, each party delivering a particular sense of such a Text, and proposing such sense, as the sense, and the only sense Revealed by God, to be intended by God by that Text, and each proposed sense being contrary to the other.

It is clear in any difference arising touching matter of Fact, there can only be one party which can have the true Faith touching that matter, for it is impossible one thing can be a Revelation of God and no Revelation of God: That one Copy, or one Translation, or one Sense can be true and not true.

It is now enquired whether Christ hath settled any principle or medium in the world: And what principle or medium it is which Christ hath settled in the world, for the determining of matters of Fact of this nature. By which Unity in Faith may be conserved, and Christians may with certainty know what is a true Revelation of God, which a true Copy of such true Revelation, which a true Translation of such true Copy, and what the true sense thereof, that Christians may not be carried about with every wind of Doctrine.

The solution of this is desired to be by fixed and solid principles, and not by tedious discourses; for the Nature of the thing requires that there be a firm Principle settled among Men, for the final determining of matters of Fact.

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CHAP. I.

Of the Quality of this Question.

SIR,

§. 1. YOU may see by this Paper, with the ordinary disputing of this sort of men, that it is not without cause that we have suspected the hand of the Papists in many of the defences of the Infidel cause, and questionings of the foundations of the Christian faith, which this age is troubled with. They have so long played the Infidels in jest, till they have made such a swarm of serious Infidels, as will prove neither the honour nor comfort of such seducers in the end. I know that this Paper itself hath a more modest aspect, but the tendency of it is the same as of the rest. But I hope God will turn all their endeavours to our advantage, and teach Christians better to consider the foundations of their faith; that they may not only be able to defend it against an Infidel or Papist; but, which is of more universal and frequent necessity, to defend it against the inward suggestions of Satan, the enemy of Christ and us.

§. 2. Therefore I think it most profitable to answer this Question in such a manner as shall tend not only to silence the Caviller, but as may best satisfy such as doubt, and establish men about the cause itself; and therefore to be larger, than this Imposer desireth, that I may be plain.

§. 3. The fraud which this Querist is guilty of is manifold, and manifest to any discerning Reader. 1. In the choice of his subject: For he knoweth (for it's easily known,) that it hath not pleased God to make the mysteries of our faith so evident, as things sensible are; and that the difficulties which are in and about the Christian cause, are such, as give advantage to carnal unbelievers, to find many words to say against it; and that maketh it the hardest work of Preachers, to convince unbelievers: or else the Gospel had been received by more than

the sixth part of the world, before this day. Now these jugglers would lay all the difficulties which are in the Christian cause as such, upon the *Reformers* cause alone, as if all this were nothing to them, but the cause of Popery were wholly free from them; or at least, they could answer such questions better than we can do. And so when such a fellow as *Hobbs,* or *Benedictus Spinosa* in his *Tractatus Theologico-politicus,* shall stretch their wits to disgrace the Scripture and the Christian cause, all this shall seem only to fall upon the Protestants; whereas if we could not better defend Christianity than the present principles of Popery enable them to do, we must confess that the Infidel were far harder answered than any Sectary that we have to deal with.

§. 4. 2. And his next fraud lieth in casting all the positive defence and proof on us, that he may have nothing to do but assault Religion, and manage the Infidels' objections against us. He offereth not to tell you himself, what their uniting certainty of Divine Revelations is, and to make it good, but to put *you* upon the *proving task.*

§. 5. 3. And his fraud is evident in the *multitude of Questions* which he thrusteth *together* into *one;* which any man of wit knoweth cannot have *one answer;* but must have *many* as the Questions are *many.* §. 6. 4. And yet he will oblige the Answerer to avoid [*tedious discourses*] that so if his many questions have not *one short answer,* he may have the evading pretence, that *It is a tedious discourse.*

§. 7. 5. And there is evident fraud in his ambiguous terms; As his opposing *matter of fact* only to *matter* of *right,* and so making many heterogeneals to fall under matter of fact; His confused and unexplained use of the terms [*Principle, Medium, determining, Certainty, Unity in faith,* &c.]

§. 8. 6. Lastly, There is much fraud in his many insinuated suppositions; As, 1. That the Truth of this proposition that *Whatsoever God saith* is *true,* &c. is a *matter* of mere *right,* as distinct from the rest mentioned as matters of fact: 2. That the *sense of the words* is a *matter of fact* as the *truth* of them is not. 3. That Papists agree with us that every Revelation of God is

most certainly true. 4. That the *Ebionites, Valentinians,* &c. who questioned the Scripture books were Christians; 5. That these matters have here a *final* determination. 6. That this is necessary to Certainty and Unity in the faith. By all which it appeareth that this Question is intended, or used at least, as a *Soul-trap,* and a *Fool-trap.*

CHAP. II.

The Explication of some Terms.

§. 1. THat he may be satisfactorily answered, these Terms must be necessarily explained, and distinguished of, 1. Revelation, 2. *Matter of fact,* 3. Certainty, 4. Principle, 5. Medium, 6. Determining, 7. Unity in faith.

§. 2. I. Either he taketh *Revelation generally,* as containing *natural* and *supernatural Revelation,* 2. Or *specially* for *supernatural Revelation* only: Because he distinguisheth not, we must suppose him to take it *Generally:* But you will understand the matter the better if I distinguish of Revelation.

Revelation is either

I. *Objective,* or the bare proposal of the Object.
II. *Effective Illumination* of the mind: The first only is here spoken of.

In Objective Revelation we have to consider,

I. The Efficient cause, *viz.*
1. Principal which is God.
1, As the Author or first Cause of Nature,
2. As the Cause of Gracious extraordinary Light.
II. Subservient.
I. Persons.
1. Christ as man; the Teacher of the Church and Messenger of God.
2. His Ministers.
1. Angels.
2. Men.
1. Public.
1. Parents Economical.
2. Ecclesiastical.
1. Inspired.
2. Instructed.
3. Magistrates.
2. Private: Neighbours and Friends.
II. Things: Considered
I. Singly.
1. In the *matter,* and so they are
1. Signs Natural, *viz.* All God's works.
2. Signs Artificial, *viz.* Writings, *&c.*
3. Signs Mixed, *viz.* Vocal Words.
2. In the *manner* of causing them
1. Naturally, as the works and Law of Nature.
2. Supernaturally, and extraordinarily.
II. Conjunct and duly ordered; as they make up just evidence. *Viz.*
1. Things in their notifying conditions.
2. Words; 1. Simple Terms, 2. Propositions, 3. Discourses

II. The *Matter* of Divine Revelations *signified* (for the *Matter signifying* is before spoken of) is,

I. Beings substantial

1. Created,
2. The Creator.

II. The Modes or Accidents of Beings substantial, which are,

1. Physical and Hyperphysical.
2. Moral: Especially, 1. Truth, 2. Right or Dueness, 3. Goodness.

And reductively and by accident, All their contraries.

III. The form of Revelation, is Evidence, or the *Notifying Aptitude* which includeth, 1. The Sense or *Meaning* as *True:* 2. As *Perceptible.*

IV. The Terminus and Ends of Revelation (to join them for brevity) are,

1. The sense and its Perception, 1. External, 2. Internal; the Imagination.
2. The higher faculties
   1. The Intellect and its perception.
   2. The Will and its Complacency or Displicence.

All this goeth to make up Divine Revelation. And *do* you think we can give you one only Medium of it in a word?

§. 3. II. *Matter of fact,* is a phrase sometime used so largely as to signify the Reality of any Being, that is existent as such. But ordinarily it signifieth something *practised* or *done* as such: If he here take it in the first sense, then the *verity* of this proposition [*Whatsoever God saith is True*] is as much *matter of fact* as the *sense* of that *Proposition.* But if he mean the later, neither of them is matter of fact. And yet he saith that the said Proposition is matter of *Right;* As if the *Truth* of a Proposition, and God's Right to be believed, were formally the same. And yet he saith that the *sense* is matter of fact.

§. 4. III. The word *Certainty* is very ambiguous: Lest he complain of needless distinction, I will only remember you, 1. That as *Certainty* is *Objective* and *Subjective,* so it is the *Objective Certainty* that we have here to enquire of: But so as it is the *means* of *Subjective Certainty.* But withal to remember that to Subjective Certainty (that we ourselves may be sure) there is need of much more than Objective Certainty, *viz.* that the soul and faculties be, 1. Rightly disposed: 2. And duly excited and applied, *&c.*

2. Of Objective Certainty you must note, that the word is sometimes taken for mere *Verity* and *Reality;* And so the word [Infallible] is used, for that which *verily* is, and whosoever apprehendeth it so to be, is not deceived. And so all Truth is *Certain* and *Infallible Truth.* But usually besides *Truth,* the word *Certainty,* (and infallibility,) denoteth the *evidence* of that Truth, by which it is (not always actually, but) aptitudinally *notified* to us.

This *evidence* is either *sensible,* or *Intelligible,* as the sense or the *intellect* is to be the perceiver of it.

Where you must distinguish the Physical Evidence of the Thing or Incomplex Object, from the Logical Evidence of Complex Objects. And here between the Evidence of self-evident Principles, and of Conclusions whose Evidence is derivative.

But especially you must note wherein it is that certainty of Intelligible evidence *formally consisteth;* which is in a certain *degree* of *evidence:* And 1. It is not every low degree: For though all Truth be equally Truth, and infallible, so that no man is deceived that receiveth it: yet we use not to call that *Certainty* of *evidence* which is apt only to give them some dark probability, and leave the mind in hesitant doubtfulness. 2. And yet it is not only that degree of evidence (which must help us to a *perfect apprehension,* which is to be called *Certainty:* For then no man should be certain in this world. For no man hath such a degree of apprehension, but more may be added to the *clearness* of it. 3. Therefore certainty must be denominated from a middle degree; which is, when the evidence is not only True (for the confidentest apprehension of a falsehood is no certainty,) but also so Clear as is apt to give a *satisfying, quieting, resolving apprehension* to the mind, yea though it should be sometimes molested with some doubts. 4. And therefore seeing such or none is our *certainty* here, it followeth that *Certainty* hath divers degrees, as the *satisfaction* of the *mind* is *more* or *less:* And that we are not equally certain of all that we are certain of. You will find necessary use of these distinctions about this controversy.

§. 5. IV. And what he meaneth by [*Principle*] I know not. 1. There is a Physical or Hyperphysical *Principle* of *Being,* and there is a *natural* principle of *notification,* and there is a *Logical principle* of *notification.* 1. Our *intellective faculties* are the *natural apprehending principle.* 2. The *spirit of God* is the supreme *moving principle* of Influx. 3. The intrinsic and adherent *evidence* of the thing in itself, is the *natural notifying* principle: which is as various as things are. 4. The *Premises* as inferring the conclusion are the *Logical Principles* of *derivative* certainty.

§. 6. V. And I scarce know what he meaneth by [*Medium*] he seemeth to take it for the same with [*Principle*]. There are *media essendi* which I suppose he meaneth not (means to make us Articles of faith, or to make them True); but rather the *media cognoscendi:* But these are necessarily more than one. 1. There are the *media* by which we *hear* the *word* and receive

the Bible as it is. 2. There are the *media* by which we come to understand—the *sense* of the words. 3. There are the *media* by which we know the difference between the several parts of the Book, the more certain and the more doubtful, and the different copies and readings, and the different translations. 4. There are the *media* by which we know that these Doctrines and these Books are the same which were delivered to the Churches by the Apostles, *&c.* 5. There are the *media* by which we know that Miracles were wrought by Christ and his Apostles and other Christians in confirmation of the Gospel. 6. And there are the *media* by which we know that this Gospel and these Books are true. And all these are not to be confounded, by the simple pretence of calling for a fixed *medium or principle.*

§. 7. VI. [*Determining*] signifieth either the *private* decision or determining of doubts in the *minds* of particular persons; or else the *public* decision of doubts as they are managed in the Church, by a public Judge. And this either as binding men's Consciences or Minds what to believe, or only as ruling their tongues, and actions, in teaching and conversation.

§. 8. VII. By [*Unity in faith*] is meant either unity in a *general faith* (which they call *Implicit,*) or in a *particular* (*explicit*) faith: And that is either a unity in all the essentials of Christianity, or also in all the Integrals, or also in all the accidentals which are revealed by God. And it is either a secret unity of *minds,* or a public *unity* for communion that is meant.

If he think any of these distinctions needless, let him prove it and then cast them by. I am sure confusion is fit to deceive, but not to edify.

CHAP. III.

The rude and summary answer to the confused Question.

§. 1. LEst the Querist should pretend that by distinguishing I avoid a plain and direct answer to his Question, I will here first suppose him to be as rude and confused as his Question would imply, and give him such an answer as it will bear. But so as that it cannot be satisfactory to a distinguishing understanding, for whom therefore I shall afterward answer more distinctly.

§. 2. I cannot answer with common sense in a narrower compass than by distinguishing these Questions: 1. How know I the *words* and *Bible?* 2. How know I that this Doctrine and Book is the same, which was delivered by the Apostles to the Churches? 3. How know I the meaning of the words? 4. How know I that this Doctrine and these words are of God, (or a Divine Revelation)? 5. How know I that they are true?

§. 3. I. To the first Question I answer, that I know that I hear and read the words, and that this Bible containeth in it all its visible contents, by my sense (my sight and hearing) and my intellective perception of things sensible. And though this be a principle in which the Papists agree not with us, I am never the more in doubt, whether I see and hear the words.

§. 4. II. To the second, I know that this Doctrine and Book is the same which by the Apostles were delivered to the Churches, by Infallible History; not such as dependeth on the *honesty* of the speakers only, and so begetteth but a human faith; much less such as depends on the bare Authority of the King of *Rome* and his narrow selfish sect or party and Kingdom; but by such History as hath a certainty in it from *natural principles,* by which we prove it impossible that there should be deceit; there being so full a concurrence of all sorts of Christians, and enemies also, and infallible circumstantial

evidence. Even as I know that there was such a man at *Rome* as *Gregory* 1. and *Gregory* 7. and such persons in *England,* as *Henry* 8. King *Edward* 6. Queen *Mary.* Queen *Elizabeth,* &c. And as I know that our Statute Books are not counterfeit: And as your Doctors know that the Acts and Decrees of Councils, the Works of *Bellarmine, Baronius,* &c. are not counterfeit: which is not because the Pope or a General Council saith so, but by *rational evidence* of *certain History,* which leaveth not men's minds in doubt.

§. 5. But I am not *equally certain* of some questioned Books, or Readings, (no nor of the sense of some difficult words) as I am *of all the rest,* which being more evident are more past controversy.

§. 6. III. I know the meaning of the words (spoken or written) as you know the meaning of a man that talketh with you, or of any other writings; as of your Councils, Decretals, Massbook, *Bellarmine,* &c. that is, by the significance of such words by human usage from those days till now, which Lexicons, Books, and successive practice fully prove.

§. 7. But there are plain passages in Scripture which I understand certainly, (not because the Pope saith This is the meaning:) Such are all the essentials of Christianity and abundance more. And there are difficult passages which I am not certain of the sense of.

§. 8. IV. I know that this *Doctrine* and the *Bible* containing it as such, are of God, (or are his word,) by the *spirit attesting* and sealing it; not in the fanatic sense, as they think they have an inward impulse persuading them that so it is; (as some Papists think the Pope and Councils know that to be of God which they decree, by Prophetical Inspiration:) But, 1. As to the Gospel, the spirit attested it by antecedent Prophecy. 2. The image of God's *Power, Wisdom* and *Goodness* imprinted on the Scripture, is its essential constitutive evidence, being inimitable by mere man, and that which is its intrinsic self evidencing light: so that a spiritual well disposed soul, may from a sensibleness, taste that it is God's word; if a Bible had come to them by chance and they had never heard of it before.

I say that they *may* do so, if you can suppose them spiritually disposed before: But if not, yet they may strongly suspect that it is God's word, when they read that it affirmeth itself to be so, and that the image of God upon it is so clear. 3. But the *Concomitant Evidence* of the *spirit* maketh up the proof; in the miracles of Christ's Life, Resurrection and ascension; and in the miracles of Apostles and primitive Christians, abroad the world by which the Gospel was fully sealed, 4. And the effected subsequent evidence of the spirit completeth all the evidence; which is the spirit of holiness given by the means of this same word to all true serious Believers in the world in all ages and nations: which Holiness is the Image of God himself, and is such a gift as none but God can give, and as God would not give by a Doctrine, which he abhorreth as a lie. Therefore, 1. It witnesseth objectively as an evidence; 2. And it witnesseth *effectively,* by inclining the heart to taste and close with and receive the τὸν λόγον ἔμφυτον the innaturalized word; as life and health cause a man to know suitable food, by a gust which proceedeth from a suitable nature; so is it in the new nature and the sincere milk of the word. And indeed though the intellect be the proper apprehender of Truth as such *suo modo,* yet the will is *quaedam natura,* and hath a natural propensity to *Good* as *Good,* which is natural to it, and is the *pondus motuum* in the rational soul: And it is not an *universal notion,* or *nothing* under the name of *good* which it thus inclineth to; but *existent good,* in some *being* that is, *Unum, Verum, Bonum,* as *Rada* and other Scotists well prove. And therefore it hath *necessary volitions* (as of its own felicity, *&c.*) which yet are free, and not merely *per modum naturae,* though natural as being *ex sua natura.*

And this three or fourfold witness or attestation of the spirit, (sometime *Antecedent,* always *Constitutive, Concomitant,* and *subsequent*) though a holy soul that is suited to it, and hath the witness in itself may most fully and certainly discern, yet another also may discern; The Miracles being Intelligible attestations to them, and the beauty of *Wisdom* and *Holiness* in

the *Scripture* and in the *Saints* being refulgent and discernible by a stander by, though not as by a possessor.

§. 9. But I have not an *equal Certainty* of all the parts of it, that they are the word of God, because, 1. All the Books, Texts and Readings are not brought to me with equal historical Evidence. 2. And there are abundance of passages in it which are but Accidental to the Christian Religion which have not the same self-evidencing luster in them as the Essentials have. And there is no Necessity of an equal knowledge of the parts.

§. 10. The parts which I am fully *Certain* of in the Scripture are, 1. All the Essentials of the Christian Religion; Because, 1. They are delivered in Scripture *frequently, plainly, past all Controversy* of which I will cite your testimonies anon. 2. Because they were as certainly delivered to all Christians and Churches in the whole world distinctly by themselves, (twelve years before any of the New Testament was written, and above threescore and ten years before all of it was written,) even in the Covenant of Baptism, renewed in the Lord's Supper, and in the Creed, Lord's Prayer and Decalogue, which are the exposition of the Covenants, professed by all Christians, in all Christian Churches at every sacred meeting. And these two ways of Tradition (in Scripture and by themselves) are fuller than one.

2. And all the rest of the holy Scriptures in which the full concord of Copies, and the plainness of the words doth leave no room for rational doubting.

§. 11. V. I know that all this word is True, because God is True, (*verax,*) and it is impossible for him to lie. For whoever lieth, must want either *Wisdom,* to know what to say, or *Goodness* to Love Truth, or *Power* to make good his word, and attain his will by better means. But God is perfect in all these. Which you seem to grant us.

§. 12. That all things necessary to Salvation have been delivered by the Apostles to the Churches two ways, as by two hands, *viz.* Distinctly by word of mouth, and in the *Bible,* is our Doctrine. That more than all in the Bible hath been delivered by word of mouth, and this as necessary to the Salva-

tion of some men (I know not whom, who have no more wit than to create necessity to themselves,) is your Doctrine. But yet your famousest contentious Doctors confess that all things commonly necessary to Salvation are plainly expressed in the holy Scriptures.

Concil. Basil, Orat. Ragus. Bin. pag. 299. [*The holy Scripture in the literal sense, soundly and well understood, is the Infallible, and most sufficient Rule of faith.*]

Bellarm. *de verbo Dei*, lib. 4. c. 11. [*In the Christian Doctrine both of faith and manners, some things are simply necessary to the salvation of all, as the knowledge of the articles of the Apostles' Creed, of the ten Commandments and of the Sacraments. The rest are not so necessary that a man cannot be saved without the explicit knowledge, belief and profession of them—These things which are simply necessary and profitable to all, the Apostles preached to all—All things are written by the Apostles which are necessary to all, and which they openly preached to all.*]

Costerus in Enchirid. cap. 1. p. 49. [*We do not deny that those chief heads of faith which to all Christians are necessary to be known to Salvation, are plainly enough comprehended in the writings of the Apostles.*]

§. 13. By the way, hence judge of the juggling of your praters, when they call to us for a Catalogue of Essentials, or Fundamentals, as if no such distinction were to be made.

§. 14. But the ancient Fathers talked at a higher rate; even as *Theophil. Alexandr.* Epist. Paschal. 2. Cont. Orig. Biblioth. Patr. To. 3. pag. 96. [*Ignorans quod daemoniaci spiritus esset instinctus sophismata humanarum mentium sequi, & aliquid extra Scripturarum authoritatem putare divinum.* i. e. *not knowing that it is the instinct of a devilish spirit, to follow the sophisms of men's minds, and to think that anything is Divine, without* (or besides) *the authority of the Scriptures.*]

CHAP. IV.

The distinct Questions all Implied or Confounded in his one.

Quest 1. *What are the Revelations in Controversy.*

§. 1. I Must now for the satisfaction of him if he be judicious, answer his Question more distinctly, and therefore divide it into all these Questions.

Quest. 1. What are the Revelations of God, about which our Controversies lie. 2. Whether it be true that the Papists grant us that all Divine Revelations are true. 3. What Certainty have we what is a real Revelation of God. 4. What Certainty have we of the true Copies and Readings. 5. What Certainty of the Canonical or Divine books. 6. What Certainty of the Truth of Translations. 7. What Certainty have we of the true sense of the words. 8. What unity of faith may be expected to be conserved, by such certainties. 9. What Determination is necessary to this Certainty and Unity. And the Questions, what *Principle,* and what *Medium* is established, will be Answered in these.

§. 2. Quest. I. *What are the Revelations of God about which our Controversies lie?*

Answ. To mention no more, than I needs must, there are three sorts of Revelation which we assert and rest in: 1. Of Natural Production and Evidence; such as is the Light and Law of Nature, in the *Nature* of all things, especially of man himself, as revealing God's will *per modum signi.*

2. Infallible, Oral and Historical, Tradition: And so, 1. All the Covenant of Grace in the Sacraments of Baptism and the Lord's Supper, with the Catechistical explanation in the Creed, Lord's-prayer and Decalogue, have been particularly delivered by themselves. 2. And so the Bible hath been delivered to us in the bulk. 3. Written Revelation, in the sacred Records of the Spirit, which is the holy Scriptures themselves.

§. 3. Of the first, more anon. The second they grant us so far as to confess, 1. That the said Covenant and Catechistical Principles have had that way of delivery by themselves, as well as in the Scripture: But they tell of much more (I know not what) delivered the same way, than is in them, and the Scripture itself. 2. Yet (as you see) they confess that none of that addition is commonly necessary to Salvation.

The third they grant us (that all those books which we receive are the Certain word of God) But, 1. They say that there are more; 2. And that we must receive them as such, because the Pope and his Council, as the only Judges, say they are such. Of which more anon.

CHAP. V.

Quest. II. *Whether it be true that the Papists grant us, that all Divine Revelations are true?*

§. 1. *Answ.* YES, if you will first take their bare word what are Divine Revelations, 2. And will take in this word [*in the sense that God intends them*] 3. And will allow them to speak contradictions. For thus, 1. They can tell you when they have a mind, that God's plainest Revelations, are none of his Revelations. 2. And that whatever *Evidence* of *truth* or *sense* there is in the *signs revealing,* God *intendeth* something contrary: 3. And that that is his revelation which is contrary to his Revelation.

§. 2. For instance: The first fundamental Revelation of God to man, is unto our *senses* of things *sensible,* and thereby *Intelligible to our understandings:* Now we cannot get the Papists' assent that these Divine Revelations are certainly true: yea, they say that daily they are certainly false. God made Sense: God made the Intellect: God made the Medium, and God made the object. In the Lord's Supper all the sound senses of all men living Christians and Heathens, Papists and Protestants perceive *Bread* and *Wine,* by *seeing, smelling, touching* and *tasting.* Yet the Papists say, and their Priests swear that there is no Bread *and Wine,* and that God by another Revelation hath certified us that this *Revelation* to *Sense* and the *Intellect* by sense is *false:* He that will not swear that there is no Bread shall be no Priest: He that will not renounce this Divine Revelation in Nature, and all his senses, and all men's senses, is a Heretic to be burnt and damned. All Temporal Lords that will suffer such as thus renounce not sense and sensible Revelation, are to be excommunicate, and deprived of their dominions, and their subjects absolved from their oaths of allegiance. All this is in the Council of *Lateran sub Innoc.* 3. *Can.* 1. 3. And the *Trent*

Oath and Council. Is this now a Divine Revelation or not? If not, then they that heard Christ speak and saw his Miracles, and saw him after his Resurrection, had none. For their senses might be all deceived if all men's now may.

§. 3. And if God intendeth here the quite contrary to the Evidence, even of sensible natural signs, how can they ever prove that he doth not so in his word too, even in *Hoc est corpus meum,* and in every article of the faith, Certainty lieth in *Evidence,* and if all the declaring evidence may be false, because of the contrary intent, then who knoweth what is true? or whether ever God said true to man?

§. 4. And here Revelations are pretended against Revelation, yea the superstruct against the fundamental, the consequent against the antecedent, the less certain against the more certain; yea certain forgery fathered on God, against his Certain Natural Revelations. For, 1. We are *men* before we are *Christians;* we have *sense* before we have *faith.* We can have no certainty of faith, but by *means* of the Certainty of sense: For we cannot tell that there is any man or book in the world, nor that ever we saw a letter or heard a word. What then shall we believe?

2. And they have nothing but pretended Miracles against this Constant Evident Natural Revelation. For every Priest (how sottish and wicked soever) to turn *Bread* into no Bread and Wine into no Wine when he list: For all the Priests in the world these sixteen hundred years to do this every week, or each day that they celebrate their Mass, publicly or privately, must needs be an undeniable Miracle (if true) being as much beyond all natural power as raising *Lazarus* from death: And to make these miracles as universal, constant, and easy as God's worship in the Assembly, is to turn Miracles into the familiarest of God's dealings: And hath not all this need of good proof, to prove God's natural Revelations to be as ordinarily and universally false?

3. Yea, the Miracle is doubled, while the accidents remain: They deny them to be the Accidents of Christ's body and blood. If they are Accidents then, it is either of *Bread* or of

Nothing: An Accident of Bread which is no bread, the *Quantity and Colour* of bread which is no bread, or of wine which is no Wine, is a plain contradiction. If they be the Accidents of nothing; the *Quantity* of nothing, the *weight* of *nothing,* the locality of nothing, the *colour, taste, smell* of nothing, all these are as plain contradictions. Then God must be said by his Omnipotence to cause Contradictories, and to work constant Miracles for that end, and all to prove his Natural Revelation false.

§. 5. And what cogent Evidence bringeth them to all this? Why, *Hoc est corpus meum;* No more than *David's* [*I am a worm and no man*] or Christ's [*I am the vine* and *ye are the branches*] and *Paul's* [*that Rock was Christ*], Though *Paul* becometh Christ's expositor, and three times in the three next verses, 1 *Cor.* 11. calleth it *Bread* after the Consecration; And the old Fathers as often as *Edmundus Albertinus* hath showed in folio. Yet because the foresaid *Lateran* and *Trent* Council have in the later end of the world, new made this Article of the Papists' faith, by their exposition of Christ's words contrary to St. *Paul,* all Christ's fore-revelation in nature must go for falsehoods, and God daily worketh Miracles to deceive all the common senses of the world, when yet no word or Miracle can be believed, but on supposition of the certainty of senses.

§. 6. This, his blind supposition called me to premise; that you may see how far Papists and we are or are not agreed that all God's Revelations are true? and how impossible it is for them to know what is a Divine Revelation, or when God's meaning is agreeable to his Revelations. These are things near and plain and weighty.

CHAP. VI.

Quest. III. *What Certainty we have what is a real Revelation of God?*

§. 1. *Answ.* AS I have before partly distinguished of Certainty, I will now tell you as to some sorts, what it is that goeth to make up *Certainty,* and then how much and what of this we have.

§. 2. I suppose you to remember that it is not *subjective Certainty* (in ourselves) that we speak of, but *Objective;* which may be at hand when men see it not. And that it is not *mere Truth* which we now speak of, but the *Evidence* of Truth, or its *perceptibility,* and that neither the *lowest, nor only the highest degree,* but *any of the various degrees* which truly *satisfy quiet* and *resolve* the soul.

§. 3. And that Objective Infallibility or Certainty, is 1. Not only that which *deceiveth no man which receiveth* it (for that's the case of *all truth*) 2. Nor yet that which *no man can be deceived about* (for that is nothing at all, that I remember, unless it be *me cogitare, vel sentire.*) 3. But it is that which, in all its right conditions, may give a man satisfactory, resolving certainty of mind.

4. To this is necessary, I. That the Thing have intrinsically the requisites of an Object. II. That it have extrinsically the necessary concomitant conditions.

§. 4. I. To the *Nature* of a *perceptible Object* it is necessary; 1. That it be something whose nature is within the reach of the perceiving faculty, and not out of its orbe (as spirits are to sense).

2. That it have a perceptible degree, or Magnitude: For the *Minima rerum* are not perceptible to man.

3. That it be *Hoc aliquid,* a distinct being, or *unum* as its called.

4. That it have a special congruence to the special perceiving faculty: For Light must be seen and not *heard,* and so of the rest. In a word, that it be *Ens, Unum, Verum, Bonum,* thus agreeably conditioned. And the contraries reductively, or rather the Propositions about them.

§. 5. II. To the Accidents and Extrinsic Conditions which go to make up Evidence, it is necessary, 1. That the Object have a due Position or site. 2. That it have a due distance, neither too far off, nor too near; 3. And a due *Medium* (as the *air* is to the sight and hearing) 4. And a due abode or stay; For neither sense perceiveth motion perfectly swift, nor the Intellect things absolutely instantaneous, that have no Time of continuance.

§. 6. Because *Objective Certainty* is Relative to *Subjective,* I must add what is necessary to that, I. On the part of sense, II. Of the Intellect.

I. To true sensible *perception* it is necessary, 1. That the sensitive faculty of the soul intend the business: Else the Organs will be as a Lute not touched: as we see in hard Students, that hear not the Clock at hand. 2. It is necessary that the spirits which are actuated in sensation be present and sufficient for their part. 3. It is necessary that the Organs be in a competent soundness. 4. It is necessary that it be the proper Organ that is used which agreeth with the object (not the eye to hearing, *&c.*) 5. That the sense be not oppressed by Impediments.

II. And further to Intellective perception, 1. Of things sensible; It is necessary, 1. That the thing be truly perceived by the sense, 2. And truly Imagined, and therefore that the Imagination have a Competent soundness; 3. That the soul be Attentive to the matter, and not alienated: 4. That the internal sense, Imagination and Sensitive-memory be in a fit state of vicinity, conjunction or union for the Intellect to operate on and with them. 5. That the Intellect itself be in act, according to its formal Virtue.

2. But to the Intellection of our own Immanent Acts of Intellection and Volition, there is no more necessary but that *such Acts be;* and then we can Intuitively perceive them.

3. And by easy collection, the Intellect without further help of sense can gather, that [I that *understand and will, am sure I have a Power so to do: For nothing doth that which it cannot do: And hereby I apprehend that there are Intellective Volitive Agents, and what they are*].

§. 7. It is here supposed, that God hath not a Voice to speak by as man hath; but yet that he can cause a voice at his pleasure, either by the use of a creature, that naturally hath a voice, or by the motion of other creatures, a thousand ways, of which it is not needful for us to be acquainted.

§. 8. When God revealeth his mind, not by voice, but by inward Inspiration, it carrieth its own notifying Evidence with it, which no man can formally conceive of, but he that hath it; But this is the case of Prophetical persons only, and not of us.

§. 9. In this Question, *How to know that a Revelation is of God?* It is supposed that the Revelation itself, that is, the *notifying sign,* whether *Voice, Writing,* or other *Act* or *thing,* be known already, For we must first know that such a thing *really is,* before we can know *whence* it is. And this is afterward to be spoken of.

§. 10. And here it is not enough to know that God is some way a Cause of that Act, Voice or Writing. For no doubt but he is a universal cause at least, of all the *Real beings,* and *actions* in the world: But we must be sure that he is the *Determining Cause* of this *special* and *individual act* or *thing* as such; so as that he may properly be called *The Author of it,* and *it* be called His *work.*

§. 11. And here (Negatively) 1. We have not *sensible Evidence* ascertaining us, that these *words* or *signs* are the *word* of God. Sense is not the perceiver of this, as it is of light, heat, motion, *&c.*

§. 12. 2. Therefore neither doth the *Intellect* perceive it, by *the sense,* as it doth these sensed things forementioned.

§. 13. 3. Nor is it the object of *Immediate Intellective Intuition,* or known as we know the acts of the soul itself, by Immediate perception, as that we Think, Know, Will, and Feel.

§. 14. 4. Nor do we (always at least) know it as we do *self-evident Principles,* which a man using Reason about them, cannot choose but understand.

§. 15. 5. Nor are all the Parts of Divine Revelations, notified to us with *equal Certainty,* nor altogether by the same *media;* nor are they all of equal necessity to be known to be Divine, and so to be believed.

§. 16. But (Affirmatively) 1. We know these Revelations to be Divine, as we know the Truth of Conclusions, by Virtue of the Evidence of their Premises. 2. And this variously, as the Consequence is more or less evident and certain.

§. 17. 1. Supposing that we are Certain that there is a God; (whether as a self-evident Principle, or as the Certainest of Conclusions) and so that he is Perfect, and therefore True, we are certain, as of a most near and Evident Conclusion, that all *God's Works* are his *Revelations* to man (which are within our reach): that is, That they are signs by which God Revealeth Himself and his Will to us: The Glass in which he must here be seen: The Divinity of this Natural Revelation is past doubt: But all the doubt is of the *sense* of it.

§. 18. 2. There are Naturally Evident Verities in the Scriptures, which upon the first considerate hearing we may be sure are true: As that *there is a God, that he is One, that he is Infinite, Perfect, most Powerful, Wise and Good, the Beginning, Governor and End of all things; that he is our Owner, Actor, Ruler, Benefactor and End: That we ought to Love him, Please and Obey him, above all others, with all our hearts and Powers.* The whole Body of the necessary Law of Nature is there contained; and so is known by a double Revelation.

§. 19. 3. There are other points which are so greatly congruous to the common experience of mankind, as that they have also a Certainty in the thing from that experience; As the common pravity of man's nature, and the great necessity that we have of Deliverance by Pardon and Sanctification; the malice and endeavour of Devils or evil spirits to tempt us from God, and destroy us; the need of God's continual help against them

and ourselves, with such like. And these also we have a double Revelation of.

§. 20. 4. The Principal part of the Supernatural Revelations, are so exceeding congruous to those which are of *Natural* and *Experienced* Certainty, and are so aptly adjoined to them, and have so Divine a design and tendency apparent in them, as that they are the more easily believed.

§. 21. 5. And the main frame of the book hath so much of the same spirit and design, and is adapted to the Communication of these principal parts (that is, the Essentials of Christianity) and thereto so compaginated, as that the Belief of the said Essentials, maketh it the more easy to believe that the whole system of books is of God.

§. 22. 6. But where we are uncertain of anything whether it be really a part of that book or system (as some questioned Books, some various Readings, some Texts whose sense is not understood) we must needs be equally uncertain whether those be the *word of God.*

§. 23. 7. But that Medium which *ascertaineth* us that these supernatural Revelations are indeed Divine (I mean the proper Truths of Christianity) must be something, which is Lower, or is *Notius & prius cognitum, better known* than Christianity, and known (in order of Evidence) before it. For all proof of conclusions must be from something *first* and *better known.*

§. 24. 8. These things which are *sooner* and *better* known than the supernatural Revelation, can be nothing but *Natural Revelations,* by God's works in the Nature of things compared, and our natural experience. For there is nothing else antecedent to be a *medium* of proof. The forementioned natural Verities, about *God* and *Holiness* carry their own Evidence with them, either as first principles or as certain conclusions; And the *Essentials* of *Christianity* have a *self-commending Goodness,* which rendereth them *sweet* to a man that is already a true Believer, and *desirable to all* truly rational men, and the Congruency rendereth it credible, supposing further proof. But that really the Incarnation, Deity, Life, Satisfaction, Resurrection, Ascension, Offices and Coming of Christ, are truth, with the Trinity

of persons, and such other points, must be proved by some more notorious *Medium,* proving that they are Divine assertions; which must be some Natural Verities.

§. 25. 9. Therefore the Ascertaining Inference must be this, that If this be not a *Divine Revelation,* then some *Certain Natural Verity* must be *denied;* (which at last will amount to the denying of a God.)

§. 26. 10. Here the Matter of fact is supposed to be known by *sight* and other senses to the first Christians, and the first Churches, where Christ and his Apostles, and multitudes of other Christians wrought them. And to be known by Certain History to those that saw them not; And the existence of the Persons, Words and Books is supposed known the same way. And on this supposition, we infer that [*These Impressions of Divine Power, Wisdom and Goodness, set upon this Doctrine: and all these Miracles by Christ, and multitudes of his servants wrought, in attestation of it, and all this sanctification of all true Believers by this word through the world, are either done by God's will, or against his will. If they be done by his will, he is the Author of them and approver: And seeing it is evident that they are to the common capacity of mankind, so notorious a signification that God is the Author or approver of that word which he so evidently and wonderfully attesteth, if yet this word prove false, mankind is unavoidably deceived, and Governed in the greatest concernments and business of all his life by this deceit. For he hath no principle, no means left him to know that these are not Divine attestations, nor to disoblige him from judging them so to be. But if God shall thus necessitate mankind to a false belief and thereby Govern him, while in Nature he hath taught man to value Truth and hate Lying, he must do this either for want of Power to do otherwise, or for want of Wisdom to do otherwise, or for want of Will and Goodness to do otherwise. And if he wanted any of these he is not God. Or if he Govern not the world himself, but permit some Evil Spirit to do all this; he is not God. For to be God is to be the Supreme Governor, and to be every where, the nearest universal Agent.*]

These consequences being plain, (though there are vain Objections which I must not stay to answer) we certainly infer:

There is a God who is the perfect Governor of the world, and therefore is Gracious, *True* and *Just;* and therefore doth not rule even the best of men by unavoidable deceit and falsehood: and therefore this word is True which he so notoriously owneth and attesteth as aforesaid.

§. 27. And hence it is that we take ourselves bound about the Sacrament to *believe* that all men's senses are not deceived; because if they be, man hath no remedy: For God hath made our sense the perceiver of things sensible; and if it be not a *Certain perceiver,* we have no *Certainer* nor *other* about those objects. And if the apprehensions of sense be uncertain, (having all the natural requisites) then all God's *Miracles* by which he attested the word, (as well as the word itself) are so: And if it be not contrary to God's perfection, Veracity and Justice, to deceive all men's senses in the Sacrament, we cannot prove it contrary to them to deceive them by Miracles.

§. 28. As an unbeliever is not so well disposed to receive the Gospel as a holy person after is, and *recipitur ad modum recipientis;* so usually a more wavering belief goeth before a fuller Certainty: And the *holier and more experienced any man is,* the more he is *Certain* of the truth of the Gospel, because he hath the witness in himself, in the *Gust* and Certain Effects of it: But yet there is that *Evidence* of Truth which Preachers may and must use to the Conviction of Infidels, to bring them to true belief.

§. 29. The holy Scripture Containing all the Divine Revelations belonging to Religion, completely, Essentials, Integrals and Accidentals; the parts of it are not of *equal necessity* to us. All that truly have the Essentials in Head and Heart and Life, shall be saved: yea though culpably they understand not other points as plainly revealed, and so believe them not to be Divine. For this is the Covenant of Grace: No wonder then if many less necessary parts are less evident.

§. 30. We have a fuller Evidence that all these Miracles, Prophecies and subsequent operations of the Sanctifying Spirit, do attest the New Covenant, and Substance of the Gospel, than we have that they attested every book, (e.g.

the Chronicles, the Canticles, *&c.*) or that they attested every phrase, method, yea or the truth of every word of the penmen, so as that none of them could through oversight or forgetfulness, misrecite a name, number or circumstance. Though we have here sufficient satisfaction, yet not so full a Certainty as we have of the Doctrine of the Gospel, which the Apostles converted the world by Preaching of, before the New Testament was written; and which in the Sacramental Covenants, the Creed, Lord's Prayer and Decalogue and Catechisms, was distinctly by itself delivered to the Churches; and so cometh to us by a double way of tradition.

CHAP. VII.

Quest. IV. *What Certainty have we of the Copies.*

§. 1. *Answ.* THE same that we have of the Statute Books in England (save that the Recorded Originals of some Laws remain) And the same that you have of the Copies of the most Certain Councils, and Authors extant.

§. 2. 1. They are delivered to us by men of so many Countries, minds and interests, as could not possibly agree to falsify them, in the substance, and in those points in which the Copies agree.

§. 3. 2. They were constantly read in the holy Assemblies through the Christian world, and by private Christians, and especially all Teachers: And therefore any great depravation could not grow common.

§. 4. 3. The Copies all over the world, of Greatest antiquity, still agree so far as is aforesaid; and the Commentaries of the Fathers, containing the Text, with all the Citations, are the same in the main. So that we have a Historical Certainty of the Copies so far as they are commonly known to agree: which the Old Translations also Confirm.

§. 5. The words in which they disagree, though many, are such as no article necessary to Salvation dependeth on: and are plainly the errors of Scribes, and not of the holy Penmen.

§. 6. In the points where any late or inconsiderable Copy differeth from the generality which have Evidence of Antiquity and Concord, that singularity, is no cause of doubting.

§. 7. Many slips are such as the Context will sufficiently detect.

§. 8. In all those points where the Copies so differ, as that it cannot be proved which is the truest, by certain proof, we can have no certainty: Nor is our uncertainty of any danger to us.

CHAP. VIII.

Quest. V. *What Certainty have we of the Canonical Books.*

§. 1. *Answ.* 1. OF all those Canonical Books which the Christian world now commonly receiveth, there is the same Certainty by the same means, which I before mentioned of the Copies. The *Doctrine* of them was spoken of before, it being that Divine Revelation which God hath attested as was opened. We have the Certain History and Tradition of all ages from the first common notice and reception of them, agreeing which are the true Books.

§. 2. 2. But yet even of these Canonical Books agreed on, the Evidence of Divinity is not equal. For, 1. Some of them have. more *Evident Impressions* of God's Image upon them in the Matter than others have (As the *Psalms* more than *Ruth,* the *Chronicles,* &c. The Doctrinal Books more than the Genealogies, Chronologies, particular Histories,) 2. God did confirm some more notoriously by Miracles and public attestations than others: So *Moses* his words, had more confirmation by Miracles than *Ruth, Chronicles, Ecclesiastes, Canticles,* &c. 3. Some have had a fuller testimony by Tradition than others; As the Pentateuch and Psalms, more than the *Chronicles,* part of *Daniel,* &c. 4. In all these respects, *the New Testament* cometh to us with fuller and clearer Evidence than the Old: As being of later date, and so the Historical proof more discernible; And hath more clear Impressions of Divinity, and was confirmed by the most notorious multiplied long-continued Miracles, and by the most notable effects of holiness in all true Believers, *&c.* And indeed its attestation to the Old Testament is not our weakest proof of its Divinity.

§. 3. There is less doubt of those few books of the New-Testament, which were unknown or doubted of but by some Churches for a time, than of those which are controverted as belonging to the Old.

§. 4. As to those Books which he saith the *Ebionites* and *Valentinians* denied, they have as full Historical proof as any; And those that denied them denied Christ's Resurrection or some Essentials of Christianity, and were no Christians, but mad-brained factions withdrawn from Christians, (the *Valentinian Gnostics* in their whole heresy, plainly showed themselves cracked-brained Fanatics, as *Irenaeus* and *Epiphanius* describe them,) so that for Number, Quality and Cross-interest their Exceptions were not any considerable discredit of the History; and did but excite the Christians the more carefully to examine and preserve their Canon: Nor were their exceptions so much against the Matter of Fact (whether *Mark,* &c. wrote those books,) as about the Divinity of them: And were but of the like nature with all the Turks, Heathens and other Infidels' exceptions against the whole Gospel.

§. 5. And as for those Apocryphal books which are in Controversy between the Papists and us, some Protestants say that they are *Certainly* none of God's word, and some that it is *utterly uncertain to any* man that they are his word: And let the Papists who assert the *Certainty that they* are, give us the proof of it, and we will thank them. Till then our *denial* or *uncertainty* of those books, maketh no alteration in the *Great* and Necessary Articles of our faith.

CHAP. IX.

Quest. VI. *What Certainty have we of the truth of Translations.*

§. 1. *Answ.* 1. THose that understand the Original and the Language into which it is Translated; have a Certainty from the Known signification of the words, answerable to the degree of their skill in those tongues. The signification of the *words* is Certain to them by Infallible Tradition. The use and sense of the words in Hebrew and Greek is known by Lexicons, and the constant use of Authors, and by the confession of all parties, friends and Enemies, and by present use: so that as your Priests understand a true Translation of any Latin, Greek or Hebrew Author, (*Cicero, Plutark, Demosthenes, Antonine, Maimonides,* &c.) by the same means do the Learned know a true Translation of the Bible.

§. 2. In the Essentials of Christianity, and all the necessary Articles of faith, the Ignorant themselves have an Infallible Certainty that the Translations are true, so far as that all that is necessary to Salvation is contained concordantly in them all. 1. Because it hath pleased God to deliver all those *Necessary points,* in various words, distinctly by themselves by all Baptizers and Pastors of the Churches, as is aforesaid: With which the Scripture Translations do agree. 2. Because there is a *natural Impossibility* that men of so various minds and interests as all the Translators, and all the Defenders of those Translations, should agree till this day to deceive the world, and not be discovered.

§. 3. And by the same evidence it is certain to an unlearned man, that all other plain points in which the Translators agree, are truly translated: Though the knowledge of it in lesser points is not so necessary.

§. 4. And thus (and no other way) both unlearned Protestants and Papists, that cannot read, must know that there is

a Bible in the world, and that the Priests do ordinarily read truly that publicly read it to them, and that there are Canons of Councils in the world, *&c.* Because it is not possible, for so many men of cross interests to agree in feigning it, without detection.

§. 5. There are some passages in some Translations so palpably distorted to the Translators' interests and ends, as that the Text and Context to the Learned, and the common agreement of the world to the unlearned, may notify the error.

§. 6. There are many passages or words so difficult, about which Translators differ as that few or none are Certain which of them is in the right. And this uncertainty is of no danger to the Church or to men's souls.

CHAP. X.

Quest. VII. *What Certainty have we of the true sense of the Text.*

§. 1. *Answ.* THis Question is partly the same with the former; For to Translate is to give the sense of the original, in other words. The sense is either, 1. The sense of *single terms;* 2. Or the sense of *propositions and sentences,* 3. Or the sense of *many sentences* conjunct in *Method.*

§. 2. The first is known to Translators as is aforesaid; As you know the sense of all words of all languages; by common usage and common Tradition.

The second is made up of the first by common reason; As a sentence is made up of common words. He that understandeth what these words [*Repentance*] and [*is*] and [*necessary*] signify; may know without a Pope, what this sentence signifieth [*Repentance is necessary*].

The same is to be said of divers sentences conjunct. The sense is known by the way that men learn to talk and to understand one another's speeches. And as you understand *Baronius, Bellarmine,* the Councils, or any of your Priests; even by the common acception of words, and reason setting them together, as man from his Infancy is taught to reason.

§. 3. But as Infants understand not common talk till they are taught, nor children and untaught persons so well as men and Scholars; so the plainest things in Scripture require some use and consideration, and Teaching to the understanding of them: Much more the harder parts. And God hath made it the duty of Parents to teach the Scripture to their children at home and abroad, lying down and rising up, *Deut.* 6. *&* 11. without asking the Pope the sense of it: And God hath appointed the elder and wiser to teach the younger and more ignorant, and especially Pastors and Teachers, to teach the world, and instruct their flocks, to understand the word of God. Not barely

to rest in their opinion and words, but to show men the same Evidence which doth convince themselves. Which Teaching is not a *final Judging.*

§. 4. But yet where the Teacher knoweth what the Learner doth not, the Learner must have the humility of a Disciple, and not set his untaught wit conceitedly against his Teacher, and wrangle before he understandeth; but must judge his Teacher (whether it be Grammar, Logic, or Theology, words or sense, that he Teacheth him) to be wiser than himself. Else why will he be his Scholar? And so he must believe him as a fallible man, with a human faith, in order to his attaining of a proper Certainty.

§. 5. But there are in Scripture many passages so exceeding difficult, that we have no Certainty of the sense; And some that only a few extraordinary Students have a Certainty of; neither Protestants nor Papists further understanding them. And this is no disparagement to the Scripture, nor hazard or injury to us.

CHAP. XI.

Quest. VIII. *What Unity of faith may be expected to be conserved by our foresaid Certainties.*

§. 1. HEre are two Questions for haste included: I. What Unity in faith may be expected? II. What Certainties are necessary thereto.

§. 2. I. To the first, 1. A Unity in all the *Essentials* of the Christian faith, is already existent among all Christians in the world; For they were not Christians if they agree not in all Essentials of Christianity.

§. 3. 2. *A Unity* of faith in the *Integrals* of Christianity is desirable, and so far hopeful, as that the wiser all Christians are, in the more of the Integrals they will agree.

But here will never be an universal Concord or Unity, any more than in men's age, strength, Stature and complexions: This *Paul* openeth at large, 1 *Cor.* 12. *&* *Rom.* 14. *&* 15, &c.

§. 4. 3. A *perfect Unity* in the common knowledge of all things in Scripture, or all the revealed Accidentals of Religion, will never be found between any two persons in this life; because that no ones knowledge is perfect.

§. 5. II. From hence the other Question is easily answered. 1. To a Unity of *Christians* as Christians, or the body of Christ and Church Universal, and of necessity to Salvation, no Certainty is necessary but of the Essentials of the Christian Religion.

2. To the more Comfortable progress, and the *melius esse* of Christians and the Churches, as great a Concord and Certainty in the Integrals of Christianity is needful, as the *degree* of *melius esse* doth require.

3. To men's peaceable and comfortable Communion in Christian Societies, an Unity and consequently knowledge of the points of Christian Love and holy communion is necessary.

4. To our Heavenly Union, Heavenly perfection is necessary.

§. 6. But to insinuate that a Certainty of the sense of all the Scripture, or all that God hath revealed to us Objectively, or of all that Popes and Councils determine, is necessary to that unity of faith, which maketh all Christians to be Christians, and one body of Christ, is but a cheating trick, which is against Scripture, reason and their own Doctors.

CHAP. XII.

Quest. IX. *What Determination is necessary to this Certainty and Unity.*

§. 1. *Answ.* 1. God's Determination of the Object, by *Verity* and *Evidence,* and his helping the faculty in determining itself in act, is necessary.

§. 2. 2. The inward true Determination of every man's own perceiving faculty, (sense and Intellect) is necessary to his true perception.

§. 3. 3. A Parent, Schoolmaster, Senior, and Pastor, must tell the Scholar their own Judgement, and then open to him the Evidence of truth.

§. 4. A Magistrate or other Superior (Parent, Master, *&c.*) hath a determining Judgement, under God and his Laws, in order to the ends of their proper Government; and no further. That is, They are the only public Judges in their Society, who shall be punished or not punished by the sword; restrained or encouraged, as teaching false Doctrine or true. But this is not an absolute and unregulated power. If they determine contrary to God's word, they sin, and bind not me to obey them though I am bound to continue my subjection, and not to resist.

§. 5. Even so it is with Pastors in the Church, who have power to try particular men's cases, and judge them according to God's word, and that only in order to the ends of their Society, which is holy Communion in Love.

§. 6. But this much power (as it supposeth the sense of the Law, and declareth it only as far as the decision of the particular case requireth, and not an Universal Regulating determination which hath the nature of an Universal Law itself, so) it belongeth to none but true Pastors of the Church, and that only within their proper charge: And if any one will do

as the Pope, who will be Ruler in all Churches of the world, his usurpation maketh him a sinner, but not an obliging determiner.

§. 7. And thus you have our Answer to all his Questions, which he thrust into one, as plainly and distinctly as I can well speak. And because his snare lieth in putting you on the deciding of all these cases, while he doth nothing to it himself, that so he may *destroy* where he cannot build, and so would make the world believe that they have a greater *Certainty* in all the cases propounded than we have, I will next try *their Certainty* compared with ours and show you the difference; And withal I will tell you why we use not their *Medium* and take it not for any Certification at all.

§. 8. But withal professing that if I knew where to find that Man or company of men that I could be sure could Infallibly certify me of all the doubts and difficulties in the matters of faith, it would save me such abundance of labour in my long studies, and so gratify my love of ease, and my earnest desires of the greatest Certainty in these greatest things, that I would spare no possible labour and cost to find out such an Oracle: And I wonder not that slothful men had rather conceit that others (by number or prerogative) are *Certain*, and so to trust upon a common faith, than to search and pray till they have a Certainty of their own.

CHAP. XIII.

What the Papists' ascertaining Medium is, and why we reject it.

§. 1. THough I will not entitle my Answer as Mr. *Pool* doth his book, The *Nullity of the Romish faith,* yet you might be ashamed if you have any modesty left, to go about still with confident challenges with the same case, whilst neither that book of his, nor his Dialogue, nor the many in which I fully answer this very Question, have any reply. And indeed I have said so much to this point already, that without repeating the same things, I scarce know what is yet to say. Almost the whole book called *The Safe Religion* is of it; But most directly all the third part: Where *pag.* 186, 187. I briefly and plainly give you the grounds and resolution of the Protestants' faith. And *pag.* 189. and forward I show you the lamentable difference among the Papists about the Resolution of their faith. And *pag.* 195. and forward I give you abundance of irresistible Arguments to prove, 1. That It belongeth not to the Pope and Roman Church to be the Judge of Scriptures to all the world. 2. That they are not Infallible. 3. That our faith must not be resolved into their Infallible Judgement. And in my Reasons for the *Christian Religion;* and in my *more Reasons for it,* and in my *Life of Faith,* I have fully opened and defended the reasons, resolution and certainty of our faith. But seeing their Impudency and Designs are such, as that nothing of this must be considered (though they are referred to it,) but they must lay snares for souls, by canting over the same things, and calling out for that Answer which they will not take notice of when it is before them, some more they shall have, for the sake of those whom they would deceive: But in great brevity lest I tire the Reader by repetitions of things that have been so often said.

§. 2. Though the Papists are disagreed greatly among themselves in this matter, yet the most prevailing opinion is, that

it is upon the *Authoritative Determination of the Bishop of* Rome *and a General Council if he approve it, that all Christians in the world must have the Certainty what is indeed the word of God: And men must take all for Certain which is so determined of, and no more: even because this Authority hath so determined: And that this is to believe by the common certain faith of the Church, when otherwise men must have but an uncertain private faith of their own: And consequently that he that will convince an Infidel and convert the world, must first make them believe that the Pope and Council are Authorised or Enabled, to determine judicially* (and not only to Teach by Evidence) *what is God's word and what not, before anything can be Certainly taken for God's word*]

§. 3. The difference between the Papists' opinion and ours, for brevity sake, shall be included in our Reasons against their pretended Certainty: which are these.

Reason I. We have *another Certainty* already by notorious Evidence of many things in your present Question. And must we quit all that Certainty, to take the same things only on trust from your Pope and his Council? We cannot do it; Because some evidence is Cogent, and the Intellect is necessitated by it: Must we not know that [*Thou shalt Love God and thy neighbour*] is God's word, by its proper Evidence? We have the witness within us; we see on all true Christians that Holiness wrought by this Gospel, which God will not use a lie to effect (even to save men from sin, and recover the hearts of men to himself, and repair his Image on man's soul). Must I needs give the lie to this Evidence till the Pope speak. He that *Loveth God* may be sure by inward perception (yea Intuition if *Ocham* say true) that he Loveth him; and consequently is beloved of him; and this Gospel wrought it. Must I not know that [*He that believeth shall be saved*] is truly translated out of the Original, till the Pope determine it? Must I believe no Grammar, no Lexicon, no Ancient Author, no Jew, no Teacher of Greek or Hebrew, no vulgar use, concerning the sense of words till the Pope determine it? Must I not know what the Baptismal Tradition of all Christians in the world doth tell me, that *we must believe in God the Father, Son and Holy Ghost* till I know that the Pope

determineth it? Must I not receive the Creed, Lord's-Prayer, or Decalogue by all other Evidence till his word cometh in? Then I must throw away Certainty for uncertainty?

II. Your own party do not thus receive all in your Question. They teach and learn the Hebrew and Greek Grammars, and the Rules of Translating, and Criticize upon the Text, and search after the Copies to discern the best by intrinsic Characters, and by comparing them, as any man may see who readeth all your Grammarians, Critics and Commentators: And yet must we know Translations and Copies only by the Pope's determination?

III. Your own Popes *ex Cathedra* have given the Church various Translations: That Edition of the Vulgar Latin made by *Sixtus* 5. and that made about two years after by *Clemens* 8. differ in so many hundred passages, and abundance of whole verses and sentences, that if a Bible be a Divine Revelation, one of them shamefully erred about Divine Revelations, or *de fide.* See Dr. *James* his *Bellum Papale,* and its Defence against *Gretser.* Where then is your Certainty?

IV. You are utterly uncertain and disagreed among yourselves, who it is that hath this *Ascertaining Determining Authority:* You say it is your Church: But some say that the Infallibility and Power is in the Pope alone, *in Cathedra.* Some say it is a General Council though the Pope dissent: Some say that the Pope and Council must agree: and some say that the Church Essential of all Countries must receive the decrees before they are infallibly ascertaining. And who can be Certain of God's word by an Authority which is itself so uncertain? See the proof in *Safe Relig.* p. 192, 193, 194.

V. Your own sentence condemneth your own Judges as uncertain: General Councils (as *Constance* and *Basil*) have concluded that Popes may err in matters of faith: yea accused and Condemned them as Heretics, if not Infidels. And shall we not believe a General Council in matter of present fact, and yet must believe them what is God's word? And that one Council hath Condemned another, and Popes have Condemned Councils, I have *ibid.* proved at large. And if Popes

and General Councils distinct are deceitful, how shall we be sure that two false parties when they meet do make one true one?

VI. Popes and General Councils have often erred from the faith (as our Church of England truly asserteth): and therefore we are not sure that they never will do so more. *Bellarmine* himself noteth about forty Popes charged with error or Heresy. *Liberius* subscribeth the sentence against *Athanasius,* and received the Arians to Communion, and subscribed the Sirmian faith, *Hanc ego libenti animo suscepi in nullo contradicens:* See his *Epist.* 7. *in Binnius To.* 1. *p.* 465. and his notes on it. See more in my *safe Relig. p.* 249, *&c.* And of Councils, *p.* 274, &c. The sixth General Council at *Constantin.* approved by Pope *Adrian* and by the seventh Council, hath many errors, as have many others there instanced in. What Certainty then can they give us?

VII. The Ancient Christians and Churches received not the Certainty of their faith upon the Authoritative determination of a Pope and Council. Therefore there is a Certainty to be had without it. The Churches that Paul or any Apostle Converted, believed not at first upon the Authority of a General Council, nor of a Pope. Till the Council of *Nice,* for above 300. years the world was without a General Council: And were they without faith? *Frumentius* and *Aedesius* that preached to the Indians and all other Christian Preachers that then converted souls took another course. They did not first convince men of the Authority of a Pope and General Council to tell them what was God's word, before they brought them to believe it.

VIII. Scripture itself never mentioneth this Method or Evidence: And would it be silent of the only way of Certainty? It never saith to the world [You must know by the Judgement of *Peter,* or the Pope and a General Council what is the word of God] Did Christ forget it?

IX. The Ancient Defenders of the Christian Faith did all go another way: *Justin, Tertullian, Athenagoras, Tatianus, Minutius Faelix, Arnobius, Lactantius, Eusebius* in his two first Volumes *de Praepar. & Demonstrat. Augustine,* and all such writers, seek

to prove our faith by other Evidence, and never say [*the Pope and a General Council are the only ascertaining declarers* of it.]

X. Our Proof of the Matters of fact is incomparably more certain than yours: For, 1. As to the Power of Judging, we maintain a concurrence of the people's *Discerning Judgement,* the *Pastors' Teaching* or *Directing Judgement,* and both *Magistrates'* and *Pastors'* Deciding and Governing Judgement, not to be the only Determiner of men's minds *de fide,* but to Rule the public Doctrine and Communion of the Church according to God's foreknown Laws. And as to the Truth of Copies, Miracles, and the actual delivery of the Gospel in the Scripture, and in the distinct Catechistical Articles aforesaid, we rest on *Tradition* which hath a *Natural Infallibility,* and not a pretended *Authoritative Judge. Your Tradition* receiveth its credit from *pretended Power to Judge,* which all the wise men in the world will deny till its proved. *Our Tradition* hath its credit from a *Natural Impossibility* that the *History should be false.* I have showed you the proof of this in my *More Reasons* for the *Christian Religion* and elsewhere: If you will not read them there, I know not whether you will read them here, and therefore will not write them again. *We* have *all your Evidence* which is *Evidence indeed,* and *far more with it;* And as *Hierom* saith, *The world is more than the City. Your Tradition* is that of a *Pope's judging Power only* as some say; and of a *Pope with his Council* as others say; and of the Pope with his *subjects* as your few moderate Latitudinarians say. You are not above the third or fourth part of the Christian world: If you deny this, your Impudent lying may cheat a woman that never read the state of the world, but will shame you the more with learned men: And is not the Tradition, 1. Of all the Christian world for 300. years before there was any General Council, 2. And of all the Christian world since (even Greeks, Armenians, Syrians, Copties, Abassines, and all others) more than the Tradition of a Pope and a few enslaved Priests? The Council of *Trent* had for a considerable time but 42. Bishops, even when it set up your Tradition as a supplement to Scripture. And is the Pope and these 42. of equal historical credit to all the Christian world?

3. Yea our *History* takes in *Heretics,* yea and *Infidels* and *Heathens* too so far as they have left us any Testimony of these things. Even a *Pliny,* a *Celsus,* a *Porphyry,* a *Julian,* and any other the bitterest Enemies: Because we prove it Impossible that so many men of different Countries, and no converse, and contrary minds and Interests, should confederate or agree to deceive the world, and be undetected in such a matter. And what is the Pope and 42. or two hundred Prelates (most of *Italy*) to such Historical Evidence as this?

O that you could lay by partiality and base selfish respects but for one day or hour? What if the Question among us were whether ever *Paul* was at *Rome?* Or *Justin* wrote his Apology? Or *Origen* was a professed Christian? Or *Constantine* the Great professed Christianity? Or whether the writings of *Justin, Tertullian, Cyprian, Augustine,* &c. be true or spurious, *&c.* Whether do you think that the Intrinsic and Extrinsic Evidence, with the Consent of all the world that knew them, Christians, Heretics, Heathens, *&c.* be not a more satisfying Evidence of truth, than if a Pope of Rome and his Council should say, so and so it was, (as *Liberius* condemned *Athanasius,*) without or against the rest of the world? If the Question were whether ever there was such a man as *Gregory* the first or seventh, or such a man as *Luther,* or as *Charles* the Great, or *Car.* 5. or King *James* in England, or such a thing as the French Massacre, *&c.* Is not the current uncontrolled self-evidencing History of these matters, more certain than if the Pope and Council of Trent only had told us of them?

And we have all your valid testimony in, with ours. As you are part of the witnesses that received the Scriptures, and as you have among you the Teachers and Professors of them, or have any other Evidence of their truth, besides a *pretended Power to Judge for all the world,* you are a part (and but a part) of our Historical witness. And cannot the Pope and his Council tell us as credibly whether *Homer, Virgil, Ovid, Cicero,* were ever in the world, and their writings be not spurious, as they are *part of the world that hath credibly received it,* as if they pretend a *power to judge infallibly* whether it be so or not?

XI. It is an injury to God for such arrogant fellows to pretend that he hath entailed on them a power to do that, which he enableth men by Natural means to do as well and better without them. As to pretend that God hath given them a judicial power, to tell us whether the Statutes of England are true or spurious? Whether ever there were such Kings or Parliaments as made them? &c. Doth not the Certain Historical Tradition of the world suffice for this without a supernatural power? If you say *that soul-concernments must have more certainty than bodily?* I answer, 1. The more impudent are you that would give us less. 2. The nature of the matter alloweth ordinarily no more. As *sense* told the *seers* of Christ's and the Apostles' Miracles that they *saw them,* and the hearers and readers of the Gospel that they *heard and read it,* so all the difference between *their* way of faith and *ours* is, that what *they* took by *their own sense Immediately,* that we take by a concatenation of *successive senses and Tradition historical* by current proof. 3. You yourselves find you have no more certainty that the Scripture is not a forged writing than you have that there was such a man as King *James* in *England,* whatever you pretend: 4. Do you not know that you must resolve even your pretended *Authoritative Certainty* into our *Rational Historical Certainty.* He that knoweth not that ever there was a Pope, (*e. g. Greg.* 7. *Innoc.* 9. *Clem.* 8.) or that ever there was a Council (*e. g.* of *Trent, Lateran*) knoweth not what they determined: But how know you what Popes and Councils you have had but by *common Historical proof.* Do you believe it only by the *Judicial decrees* of later Popes and Councils?

XII. If the Pope and his Council know the Certainty of these things, it is either by *Evidence* and *History* as all men may do, or by *Inspiration.* If by *Historical Evidence,* it is extant before: If by *Inspiration,* let them prove themselves to be Prophets: Either by their Prophesyings, Miracles, or other Evidences, that may satisfy a man that is not mad.

XIII. *Alphonsus* a *Castro* tells us, some Popes understood not Grammar, and common history tells us what lads and ignorant fellows divers of them have been; And their own writ-

ers and General Councils tell us how horridly wicked many of them have been, (as *Joh.* 22. *Eugenius* and other damned as heretics by Councils: And *Honorius* the Monothelite, *&c.*) And is it probable that God should *Inspire to Infallibility, Heretics, Ignorant fellows, debauched wicked men,* and work a *Miracle* to teach them to know that Infallibly which they knew not at all? When the Scripture and Nature tell us how he abhorreth such men.

XIV. They give us *no Proof* of their Infallibility; Either from any promise of God antecedently, or subsequent effect: How then shall we be sure of it.

XV. It is impossible for us to know who is a true Pope: And is *every man* that will *call himself Pope,* or *only the true ones* possessed with this Infallibility? If all; then one of *our Bishops* may have it when he will: If not, no man can be sure of God's word for want of being sure who is a true Pope? Read but what a plunge poor Mr. *Johnson, alias Terret, alias* &c. is put to, as to the Questions about what makes a Pope in his answers to me, and you will see how they are bewildered: Their forty years' Schism, in which there were divers pretended Popes, and the uncertainty who is the true successor to this day, especially since *Eugenius* was deposed as a Heretic by a General Council, hath left this matter unrecoverably uncertain. If Electors give the Essence, People, Priests, Princes, Prelates, Cardinals, have been Electors by turns. If Consecration be necessary; it must be by an Inferior, and no man knoweth by whom, and some have been Popes unconsecrated, and their power defended. If the Church's acceptance be necessary, no man knoweth in many schisms which had the greater party; but certainly neither had the Church.

XVI. It is impossible to know which have been *true General Councils:* and therefore impossible to know which of their Decrees are God's word, and the Church's faith. They are utterly disagreed of this among themselves. *Bellarmine* and the Papalines tell us it is those only that are approved by the Pope, (and so if all the Christian world had no more wit than to send their Bishops from all parts of the Earth, to sit as long as the

Council of Trent did (divers Popes' Reigns) it is in the Pope's power whether they shall be Approved Councils when all is done). But how know we *which are Approved?* Is it by the *Decree of other Councils?* No: None hath ventured to determine it. It is therefore by *Common Historical Evidence:* And so your *faith* must be thereinto resolved. And yet *here* History faileth you. How many Councils are Controverted? *Bellarmine* will partly tell you. What wanted *Ephes.* 2*?* What wanted that at *Basil?* And many more such, I have elsewhere debated.

XVII. There never was a real General Council in the world (unless you will call the twelve Apostles one.) This is the great cheat of the Papists: which I wonder all men that ever read History do not see as plainly, as any lie in History can be seen. Was it not the Roman Emperors that called the Councils? Had they any power out of their own dominions? Were not all the Patriarchs only in one Empire? Is their Jurisdiction mentioned in the *Concil. Nicen.* any further extended? Read in *Binnius Surius* or any others, the subscribed Names to all the Councils, and then peruse the Maps and Topography of the Roman Empire and the *notitias Episcopatuum* (even *Aub. Myraeus* famed for a feigner) and you will see that all the Councils were made up of the subjects of the Empire alone, or such as had been thereto accustomed while they were their subjects, (and but few of them,) unless some odd Bishop that no man knows what he was: Indeed when *Scythia* and *Persia* wanted help, they placed a Bishop in an Imperial City near *Scythia* (as *Tomis*) and *Persia,* and gave him leave to help the Country as far as he could, and called him Bishop of *Scythia* or *Persia.*

But what is this to a true General Council representing all the Churches in the world (on the terms as Dr. *Holden* honestly requireth.) If you have a mind to laugh at the man's Ignorance in Cosmography you may read Mr. *Johnson, alias Terret's* Reply to me (which I am not so idle yet as to answer,) confuting me by instances out of *Thracia* and such like. But the thing is most Evident in History that as the *Scots* call the meeting of their Ministers a *General Assembly,* meaning of that Kingdom, and

not of all the world, so the Councils in the Empire were called *General,* only as to that Empire and not to all the world: which I am ready to make good to any man that can understand History. The Pope was by one Prince made the chief Patriarch of that Imperial Church as the Kings of *England* preferred the Arch-Bishop of *Canterbury;* And four others they joined with him; of which one claimed Primacy when the Imperial seat was removed thither (never dreaming of a Divine right; else he could never have laid that claim;) And the Councils were only as our Convocations, and seldom extended to half the Empire. And little did those Emperors think, that thence their subject Popes and Councils would claim Supremacy at the Antipodes, and turn the *orbis Romanus* to *orbis terrarum.*

XVIII. There never *will be,* nor *must be,* nor *can be* a *true General Council* in the world. I have fully proved it in the second part of my *Key* for *Catholics;* Read it there or Choose.

XIX. Your Popes and Councils *have made no determination* at all of many of the matters in your Question. Where have *they* determined, which are the true Copies of the Hebrew and Greek Text? Do you call us for our only Certainty to a Determination that was never made to this day! O for Modesty and Conscience! Where have they determined which are the right among all the various Readings? What need *Lucas Brugensis, Alba,* and so many others search after this with so much industry if the Pope have determined it? Where have they determined which are the only Current or true Translations (however they have extolled the Vulgar Latin.) Is *Montanus* and other such Condemned? Where are all the Translators' differences reconciled by the decision of Pope or Council? When did they determine the Controversies of Commentators of the sense of a thousand Texts of Scripture.

I must confess that a just indignation ariseth in me at the reading of such soul-cheating snares; where men have the Impudence to persuade us that we can be sure of none of our faith, unless we be sure of Copies, Translations, *&c.* by that Authority that never durst nor did determine of the many remaining Controversies thereabout? And where hath the Pope

or Council given us a Grammar or Lexicon to know the true sense of words by, for the future? Fathers differ: Papists differ; the world is disagreed of the sense of words and many Texts: The Pope hath an infallible skill, and power with his Council to decide all, and will not: Was there ever a crueller wickeder wight in flesh? To see all this difference and darkness, and not vouchsafe to speak a few words, or write one Infallible Commentary to end them? Just as if the plague or fever were common, and one Physician would say, all men shall die that will not believe that I can cure all men; when in the mean time he will not cure those that do believe it?

What is it that your Pope and Councils are to determine? Is it the great Essentials of Religion? We thank them for nothing: Cannot we know that there is a God, and a Christ, till the Pope judge it? Have we not the Sacramental Covenant of Grace, the Creed, Lord's Prayer and Decalogue surely delivered before any Pope or Council judged of them? Or is it of the hard controverted points: *Do it* then; and let us see that *you can do it.*

XX. Hath the Pope power to judge *in utramque partem, either way,* or only one *way?* May he judge that there is a God or no God, a Christ or no Christ, a Heaven or no Heaven, a Scripture or none, at his pleasure? If so, must we believe him if he be for the Negative? Take you that Certainty: we will have none of it: Or is he only to *Judge truly,* and then only to be believed? (that there is a God, a Christ, a Scripture, *&c.*) So may and must every Teacher, yea and every Christian Judge. If you say that he cannot go besides the truth, General Councils and Pope *Adrian* himself said otherwise.

XXI. The Pope and his Council differ from the Council of *Laodicea* and the *ancient Church,* upon *this very Question, What is the word of God,* even of the *Canon of the Scripture:* For full proof whereof I refer you to Bishop *Cousins* Book, which bringeth full testimony from antiquity.

XXII. The use of *Authority* is not to *disclose* all *Verities,* but to *Govern Societies* in the management of them; If the King of *Rome* could prove himself King of all the world, that would but enable him to *Govern* the world: When one man that is at

his footstool that is more *Wise and Learned,* may *know* better than he and his Council too, what's true or false.

XXIII. Your very foundation is a Contradiction in itself. What do you make a Pope to be but the *Vicar of Christ?* And (mark Reader) can any man be sure that he speaks true as *Pope* or *Christ's Vicar,* that never knew that he was *Pope* or *Christ's Vicar?* Or can any man believe that *Christ* hath an *Infallible Vicar* before he believe in *Christ himself,* and that *he is Infallible?* It's a contradiction to believe the Pope as his *Vicar* or *Pope,* before we *believe Christ.* If you believe that the Pope hath Power or Infallibility, you must believe that *Christ gave it him.* And if you believe that *he gave it him,* it must be by *some Revelation* that he gave it, and that you must believe it. And can you believe *that Revelation* that made him Pope or Infallible, before you believe any *Revelation?*

XXIV. The same contradiction there is in believing a Council or the Church, before you believe *Divine Revelation:* For you cannot know till you believe Divine Revelation, that Council or Church have any such being or power.

XXV. Either the Pope and Council themselves know the true Copies, Readings and *Translations* from the *Authority of former Councils,* or by *their own:* or by the *Evidence of the thing:* and *Common History:* or by *Inspiration* or *Supernatural Revelation:* If all the rabble of wicked Popes and Prelates pretend to Rule the Church and our faith by *Inspiration,* they are cracked-brained fanatics: Sure they *were* no Prophets *before* they were Popes or Councillors. But if it be by *their own Authority,* who will take a self-made faith, of men that Believe only because they Believe? And must have all others believe only because they believed before them? Then it is themselves and not Christ that they believe. If it be, *former Popes* and Councils that they believe, tell us whom and why the *first* believed? Mark, that you cannot arise to St. *Peter:* For the various Copies and Translations which we are in question of, were all made since St. *Peter's* days.

XXVI. When in a Council the major part carry it by vote (perhaps by one or a few) How shall we be sure that all the minor part were deceived?

XXVII. How shall all those *Abassines, Armenians, Indians* in *New-England* or others that know not that ever there was a Pope or General Council, in the world, become Christians? Or are you sure they are none?

XXVIII. We *see by experience* in the foresaid Nations, and *feel in ourselves,* that men may have a certain faith without receiving it from the Pope. Can you make me know that I do not believe, when I know that I do? And can you prove that only the third part of Christians in the world are true Christians, and have Certain faith, because all the rest receive it not from the Pope? and why may not the major part of the Church be sure as well as he?

XXIX. Hath the Church a twofold foundation for faith? If the Pope and Council believe God's word to be his word on one Ground, and all other men on another ground, (that is, because *they say it,*) then we have *two faiths* and *two Churches* on *two foundations.* But if otherwise, then Pope and Council do as we must do (by their doctrine,) even believe it, because they say it themselves.

XXX. The Councils' Decrees of Faith are so Voluminous that not one Priest of forty knoweth them all; and not one lay man of many thousand: The very bulk therefore of your faith, must make it more uncertain than ours is: And who can tell whether he have it all?

XXXI. The words of your Councils are as obscure as Scripture words; and are controverted by your Doctors: And how can it be otherwise when human language is so ambiguous, in such huge Volumes? How then shall the sense of your Councils themselves be certainly known?

XXXII. Councils are rarely extant: God only knoweth whether ever there will be another, (even a pretended one:) And must we have no judge in the mean time to give us a Certainty of the meaning of the very foregoing Councils themselves? Most confess that the Pope himself may err?

XXXIII. It is but few persons in the world that ever saw and consulted with a Pope and a General Council? How then shall we be all sure, what they said or determined? How know we whether the Records of them be truest in *Crab,* in *Surius,* in *Nicolinus,* in *Binnius* or in none of them? What was *Caranzas*'s fault that he is blamed for? Which of the various Copies of Canons are true which are given us oft by the same Author? Who knoweth what alterations the *Index expurgatorius* (not infallible) maketh in the books? Have we no more or other Certainty of our Creed than of all these Councils, so variously and doubtfully delivered?

XXXIV. Seeing that each lay man that never saw Pope or Councils, can know them only by *believing the Priest* that telleth him, This the Church saith, is that *Priest Infallible?* Can no man be certainer of the Creed than of that *Priest's words?* Is not the faith of almost all your vulgar Papists, resolved into the *Priest's affirmation?* And so is it not a human faith? And how ignorant and wicked is many a Priest? Is our faith uncertain because we take it not on such a man's credit?

XXXV. If you say that *an Implicit faith that all is true and of God which the Pope and Council saith is so,* will save men; 1. How do the people know whether the Pope and Council *determine anything at all* but on the *Priest's* credit? 2. Then all Infidels may be saved without believing that there is a Saviour or salvation, so they do but believe in the Pope and Council. 3. Then believing in the Pope and Council is made far more necessary than believing in Christ. 4. Why will not an implicit belief in Christ go as far as yours?

XXXVI. By your way we can *never be Certain* when we have *all* the *Christian faith:* For more Councils may still make *more decrees* as hitherto they have done; and who knows when they will have done? And so you make a Christian quite another thing, than he was in the primitive Church; And you cruelly make it far harder to be saved: when as then, a man might be saved that believed the *Covenant and Creed;* and foresaid *Catechism;* and now he must also believe so many Canons, as that the Councils containing them in the last Edition, exceed

the purse of a poor Minister to buy them; and the time and brains of most to read them.

XXXVII. *You confess all our faith and Religion to be true* (as far as I can learn) but *we deny all your additions: Both parties* therefore being *agreed* of the *truth of ours,* it's like to be the *surer.* Our Religion in the Essentials, is *nothing but the Sacramental Covenant, the Creed, Lord's Prayer and Decalogue with the Law of Nature;* And in the *Integrals,* it is nothing but the *Scriptures* which we receive as Canonical: And all this you commonly confess to be true: And I told you before how *Bellarmine, Costerus* and others confess less to be sufficient to Salvation (as commonly necessary.) But *your additions* we reject as uncertain or false.

XXXVIII. We *see* you to be a *Carnal Kingdom* set up against Christ's express determination, *Luk.* 22. 26. 1. *Pet.* 5. 3. As the Geographia Nubiensis saith (*In Urbe Roma,* &c. *In the* City *of Rome are the seats of a King called the Pope: Nor is there any superiority in dignity above the Pope, and Kings are lower* (*or inferior*) *than he.*) We see that you have compaginated your policy all for these *carnal Ends;* and that *dignity,* and *dominion,* and *riches,* and *worldliness* is promoted by your faith: And that your Religion is propagated and upheld by most inhumane cruelties and bloodshed, and they must be burned that seem not to believe as you do: And will it not raise suspicions in us of the fidelity of such men, when they *make* their own *faith,* and tell us that we have no certainty of ours but by their determination: When also we see the wickedness of men's lives among you, in common Fornication and other heinous sin; when the *certainest faith,* will have the *holiest life,* when it is Subjectively as well as Objectively certain.

XXXIX. You *destroy* or greatly *discredit* the *Grand Evidence* of the Christian faith, even *Miracles:* How then can your faith be the most Certain? For when you pretend that Miracles are as common through all the world as Priests' Masses are (in turning bread into no bread as aforesaid) and yet no man seeth any proof of one such Miracle, when really it is no less than *Christ's Resurrection* which you pretend to be so common be-

fore all the Churches; what is this but to tempt men to take all the Scripture and Apostolical Miracles to be no surer? And then where is our faith?

XL. Lastly, I end where I almost began: If our senses be true, the Pope and his Council are false, and therefore our faith not to be received only nor chiefly on their trust. For their faith teacheth us, *not to believe God's most Natural Revelations,* to *the sound senses and Intellective perception of all men in the world,* as I have showed about the Bread and Wine in the Sacrament: And when a Controversy is brought to sense itself we can bring it no lower: And when we must either believe *your faith* and its *foundation* false, or believe *God's most Natural Evident Revelation false,* and all men's *Senses and Intellective perception false,* we are *not able,* I say *not able,* to be of your faith.

And now judge whose *faith is more Certain* the Protestants' or the Papists'? And whether you do well so zealously and busily; to make use of such *soul-traps* and *fool-traps,* as the paper is which I have answered.

September 12. 1672.

FINIS.

APPENDIX.

CHAP. I.

I. WHereas I have here and more fully in my [*More Reasons for the Christian Religion*] asserted a Certainty in some Morals, it will give some light into the matter if I give you *Ocham*'s decision of the Certainty of *Moral Science* in itself; which because it is short I will translate. *Quodlib. l.* 2. *q.* 14.

[*Quest.* Whether there can be a Demonstrative knowledge of Morals?

Resp. It seemeth not: Because there can be no demonstrative knowledge of those things that are subject to the will: But such are Morals: *ergo,* &c.

But contrarily, Morals are a Science.

In this Question, 1. I will expound one Term of the Question; 2. I will give you one distinction: 3. And then answer the Question.

1. As to the first I say that *Moral* is sometime taken largely, for human Acts which are under the will absolutely:—Sometime more strictly, for Acts subject to the Power of the will, according to the natural dictate of Reason, and according to other circumstances.

2. As to the second you must know that Moral Doctrine hath many parts: of which one is *Positive,* another is *Not-positive. Moral Science Positive,* is that which containeth human Laws, and Divine, which oblige us to follow or avoid things, which are neither *good* nor *evil;* nor because prohibited and commanded by a superior to whom it belongeth to give Laws. But *Moral Science* not positive is that which without any command of a Superior directeth human actions: as Principles known by themselves, or known by experience, so direct; As that all that is honest is to be done, and all that is dishonest is to be

avoided; and such like of which *Aristotle* speaketh in his *Moral Philosophy.*

3. As to the third I say, That Moral Positive *Science,* such as the Science of Lawyers is, is not Demonstrative, though in many things it be regulated by that which is demonstrative. Because the reasons of Lawyers are founded on human Positive Laws, which receive not propositions evidently known. But *Moral Science not positive* is *Demonstrative;* I prove it: Because all knowledge deducing conclusions Syllogistically, from Principles known by themselves, or by experience of him that knoweth, is demonstrative: But such is Moral Doctrine: *ergo,* &c.

The Major is known: The Minor is proved, Because in Moral Philosophy there are many Principles known by themselves; As that the will is to conform itself to right reason; that all evil *is to be* avoided, and such like. In like manner, many Principles are known by *Experience;* as is evident to him that *followeth experience.* And I further say, that This is more Certain than many other things, in as much as every man may have more *Experience* of his own acts, than of other things: From whence it is plain that this is a *Science, very Subtle, Profitable and Evident.*

To the Argument for the Contrary I say, That of things subject to the will, may be formed Propositions, true and known by themselves, which can demonstrate many Conclusions.]

CHAP. II.

How much the wisest Papists are for our way of Resolving faith, before Luther's time by controversy perverted them.

IT was ordinary, till *Luther's* disputing convinced them that the Scriptures would not serve their turn, for the wisest Papists, 1. To make Scripture the perfect Rule of faith, without the supplement of Tradition to add more; 2. And to give such Reasons for their *Faith* as we now do for ours.

I. I must not be tedious in citing many. 1. *Aquinas Cont. Gent. Cap.* 9. *fol.* 3. saith [*But the singular manner of convincing an adversary of this truth, is by the Authority of the Scripture confirmed of God by miracles.*]

And *Summ.* 1. *q.* 1. *a.* 8. *ad secundum,* he saith that [*Sacred Doctrine useth the authority of the Canonical Scripture arguing properly and from necessity: but the authorities of other Doctors of the Church as arguing from its own, but Probably. For our faith resteth on the Revelation made to the Apostles and Prophets who wrote the Canonical Books; but not on the Revelation made to other Doctors, if there were any such. Whence* August. *to* Hier. *I have learnt to give this honour only to the Books of Scripture called Canonical, as that I firmly believe that no Author of them did at all err in writing them. But others I read so as that how excellent soever they were in Learning and Holiness, I take it not to be therefore true because they so thought or wrote.*]

Durandus in his Preface hath little else but of the Scripture excellency in Dignity, Goodness, Certainty and Profundity: And from *Hier. ad Paulin.* saith [*Let us learn that on Earth, the knowledge of which will continue with us in Heaven. But* this is *only in the Holy Scripture*—3. *The Holy Scripture exceedeth all in Certainty of Truth—We must speak of the mystery of Christ and universally of those things which merely concern faith, conformably to what the Holy Scripture delivereth. As Christ* Joh. 5. *Search the*

Scripture, &c. *If any man observe not this,* &c.—*The Measure is, not to exceed the Measure of Faith—which Measure consisteth in two things,* that is, *that we take not that from faith,* which *belongs to faith, nor attribute that to faith which is not of faith. For both ways* is the *Measure* of faith *exceeded, and men deviate from the continence of the Holy Scripture, which expresseth the Measure of faith: And this Measure God assisting, we will hold, that we may write or teach nothing dissonant* from the *Holy Scripture. But if by ignorance or inadvertency we should write anything, let it be* ipso facto *esteemed as not written.* And so on.

And *Prolog. q.* 1. his description of Theology is, 1. *For a habit by which we only or principally assent to those things, that are delivered in Scripture, and as they are there delivered. And so Theology differs not from faith. The reason of which is because the things that are delivered in the Scripture, are so only held by Divine Authority.*

Scotus Prolog. Q. 2. doth conclude *p.* 7. that the Doctrine of the *Canonical Scripture is sufficient to the attainment of our end:* And *that the Holy Scripture containeth sufficiently the Doctrine necessary to a Viator* (*a* man *in this life.*)

II. And to prove this Scripture to be true he giveth us these ten proofs; (which I must not repeat at large) 1. From the predictions of Scripture which God only could do. 2. From their notable concord. 3. He proveth that their own Doctrine against Lying and such like prove that the writers lied not. 4. From the great diligence and concord of the Receivers. 5. From the Rationability of the Contents. 6. From the unreasonableness of all other ways. 7. From the stability of the Church. 8. From the Miracles, which God would never affix to a lie, which he largely urgeth. 9. From the testimony of aliens and adversaries. 10. That God would not give up those to a lie who so seek him with all their hearts as many Christians do.

Abundance of their Authors more I could cite, who thus argue for the truth of Scripture, and not from an Authoritative decision of a Pope or Council only. And what in this they give to them at other times, doth but show that their foundation was so much weaker than ours.

CHAP. III.

That where the Learned Papists differ from us, they are so far from building on a Certainer foundation that, so far they are forced to deny all Certainty of faith.

TO prove this it may suffice to mind the Learned Reader how even the most judicious (as *Greg. Armin. Prolog. Estius* and commonly most Schoolmen, deny a proper Certainty of Evidence to faith: Not only that the Object is not Evident to sense, which all confess, but that the truth of the conclusion is not Demonstrable, and that Faith is a pious act of the Election of the will, which were not meritorious, if it had rational demonstration or evidence. And that it is but opinion which is resolved into human Authority: and yet that they believe the Scripture to be God's word, and this or that to be the sense merely, because the Church holdeth it. I cannot stay to cite many. Plain *Durandus* shall be instead of all: Who *Prolog. q.* 1. saith *p.* 6. *c.* 1. *Faith which resteth on human Authority differeth not from opinion: because the place from human authority is topical, and an argument thence taken is the weakest: And therefore the faith which resteth on that authority is the weakest opinion.* But *pag.* 9. of the faith which resteth on God's authority, he granteth us. that it may stand with Science of many of the same things, and that Divine authority and demonstrative reason may concur to cause the same assent. But *p.* 10. he dissenteth from them that *hold that God's attestations were such* to *those that saw Christ's Miracles and Resurrection,* &c. *as certainly proved the truth of his Godhead, and so of his word* (which is *Aquinas* his honest Doctrine 3. *q.* 43. *act.* 4. against which *Durandus* writeth this.) And because it is us as well as *Aquinas* that he opposeth I will briefly confute his reasons.

The first is, *Because Demonstration necessitateth the understanding to believe: But many that saw* Lazarus *raised,* &c. *believed not Christ to be God,* &c. *Therefore Miracles were not a sufficient demonstration.*

Answ. Not sufficient to *all things, but sufficient to do their own* part. By this you would prove that there is no demonstration of anything almost in the world; For there is almost nothing which convinceth all men. I distinguish therefore of a *disposed* and an *indisposed* understanding. And as to the later I deny the major. Demonstrations constrain not millions of undisposed Intellects. *Recipitur ad modum recipientis.* What need any other proof than your oft mentioned denial of Bread in the Eucharist? Because millions deny the perception of all men's Senses and Intellects thereby, are not things sensible demonstrable or evident? Can you hope to bring more cogent proof, And yet this is rejected: And so were Christ's miracles.

The second is *Gregory, Faith hath no merit, where human reason hath experience, and there is Science.*

Answ. A falsehood as easily denied as asserted without proof: If by Merit you mean Rewardableness. For it is only *Natural involuntary necessity* which evacuateth moral *Good or Evil.* The *will* may show its *virtue* or *vice* in receiving or rejecting Objective ascertaining Evidence.

The third is that it was *not known of itself that this miracle attested the truth of what Christ said.* But whether *per se* or by *consequence,* it is a most evident certainty, that a man, yea abundance of men that assert such a point of unspeakable consequence to the world, doing abundance of open notorious miracles as professed witnesses or proofs of their Doctrine, could not do this but by God's extraordinary providence. And that if this be not to be taken for a Divine Testimony, we know of none that mortals are capable of, nor a possibility of the world's escaping the deceit, as caused irresistibly by God. His Answers to this are not worthy the repeating.

The same Author, *li.* 3. *d.* 23. *q* 7. Enquiring of the Certainty of faith, whether it be certainer than Science, brings in the several answers of others: 1. That there is a Certainty of Evidence (and this Science hath,) and a Certainty of *Adhesion,* (and this Faith hath.) But this he rejecteth, and showeth (truly) that *Adhesion* is not properly *Certainty,* and also that the fullest Evidence causeth the closest Adhesion.

2. That *Faith* hath most *Certainty in se, in the thing,* and *Science* most *Certainty quoad nos,* as to us. But the vanity of this he truly showeth: For to be *Certain in itself* and not to us, is but to be *True:* And all things *True* are equally True: But no *truth* is Certain to us or *Credible,* without revelation to us. And as he saith (*The Certainty of Act or habit is not from the Certainty of the object in itself, but from the mode which the habit putteth as to the person, and the act: No way therefore* (saith he) *is the act or habit called Certain, unless it be certain as to us.*

Therefore he is forced to conclude that many habits and acts of Science are *Certainer to us than faith and its act, and that both extensively, Science having both certainty* of *Evidence* and *Adhesion* (*if that be* Certainty,) *And intensively; for Science hath no doubt permixed as faith oft hath.*

And he is forced to conclude his faith into the further uncertainty following.

CHAP. IV.

That the most Learned Doctors of the Church of Rome resolve their faith (*in earnest or jest*) *into such an Inspiration of the Pope and Prelates in Council, as the Apostles had, and so are mere Fanatics: And this against notorious sense and experience.*

THe said *Durandus* saith *ib. li.* 3. *d.* 23. *p.* 573. [*Nothing is more certain than experience, to which the resolution of other things is made, that we may have the fuller certainty.*] But experience telleth us that there is Bread after consecration: And that he took the *belief* of *human* authority, for *the weakest opinion I told you* before. And *v.* 12. he saith [*How are we sure that God saith what we believe? Non nisi quia sic tenet Ecclesia? Only because the Church so holdeth?*] Which he brings to prove that Divine Authority is not surest to us.

And *Ocham Quod l.* 5. *q.* 31. so answereth the question, *Whether the substance of Bread remain after consecration,* as I verily believe he did but Ironically jeer them, and show that he durst not speak his thoughts.

Mentioning three opinions: The first, that *the substance of bread which was there before, is after the body of Christ,* (I think he meaneth *Durandus's* opinion condemned by *Bellarmine,* &c.) he rejecteth. The second saith he (*that the substance of bread and wine cease to be, and the accidents only remain, and under them Christ's body begins to be*) *is the common opinion of all Divines, which I hold for the determination of the Church, and not for any other reason. The third* (*that there remaineth the substance of bread and wine with Christ's body*) *would be very reasonable, if the Church's determination were not contrary: for that opinion solveth and avoideth all the difficulties which arise from separating the accidents from* the subject. *And the contrary to it is not had out of the Canon of the Bible; nor doth it include any contradiction for Christ's body to consist with the substance of bread any more than with the*

accidents—And after more, answering the argument of Mass-miracles by every Priest he saith [*Sometime about some things there must more Miracles be put, though it might be done by fewer, and that because it pleaseth God; And the Church knoweth this, by some Revelation that so it is, and therefore the Church hath so determined.*] Either he jeereth them, or else he professeth that their faith even of *daily miracles,* against *common sense* is resolved into a *Revelation* which the Church hath of that which is not in the Bible; which must be Prophetically.

The like you have in *Paludanus, Durandus,* (save that he leaveth them as aforesaid) *Scotus,* &c. I will end with learned *Rada,* who *Vol.* 4. *Contr.* 7. *a.* 1. *pag.* 164, 165. having showed that *This is my Body* will not in its own proper sense infer what *Aquinas* and others gather, saith [*Yet indeed now* (we must not take that sense) *but as the Church taught by the Holy Ghost understandeth those words. For the Scriptures are expounded by that spirit which they were made by: And so it must be supposed that the Catholic Church by that spirit which delivered us the faith, even taught by the Holy Ghost, so expounded, and exploded the first sense, and chose this, being that other was not true, as to the remaining of* the substance of *bread after consecration. But this sense he chose which is true, and so delivered by our Lord himself, as it is solemnly declared* C. firmiter, &c. And he concludeth that [*This is my body*] is not enough to convince a Heretic; but [*as understood by the Church by that spirit by which they were given and delivered, they exclude the substance of bread*].

O all men of common sense and reason in the world; we appeal to your humanity in the Controversy between the Papists and us. While they assert a Miracle by every Priest every day that he masseth in all the world, and deny the truth of God's primary natural Revelation to all men's common senses, they resolve their faith of the Certainty of all this, not into the Scripture, but into such an Inspiration of the Holy Ghost as the Scriptures themselves were written by: The Scripture must not be our proof of this Inspiration, but must be proved by it. We must believe that thus every wicked Pope and the Prelates of the major vote in his packed Councils have this Inspira-

tion? When they do no Miracles, they live so much worse than other Ministers of Christ, that the Reforming of them hath long been the vain wish and attempt of the Christian world; They murder the servants of Jesus in their Inquisitions, and yet we must lay all our faith and salvation on it, that they have all a Prophetical spirit.

Well; *If it be proved Certainly to the world, that the Pope and his Church are all Prophets, or Inspired by the Holy Ghost as the Apostles were, then I declare that the Papists are in the right: If not, I will be no willing Subject* of the KING of *Rome,* while he so abuseth the Word, the Church, the Honour, of the Church's King.

FINIS.

Naked Popery;

OR, THE NAKED FALSEHOOD
Of a Book called the
CATHOLIC NAKED TRUTH,
OR THE Puritan Convert to Apostolical Christianity;
Written by *W. H.*

Opening their Fundamental Error of Unwritten Tradition, and their unjust Description of the *Puritan;* the *Prelatical Protestant,* and the *Papist,* and their differences; and better acquainting the ignorant of the true difference, especially what a *Puritan* and what a *Papist* is.

By *RICHARD BAXTER,* a Professor of mere Apostolical Christianity.

Trita frequansque via est per Amici fallere nomen;
Trita frequensque licet sit via, crimen habet.
The common beaten way of men's deceit
Is as a *Loving Friend* to work the Cheat:
But though this be the common beaten way,
It will prove criminal—another day.

W. H. this Author, *pag.* 25. saith [*If you do not find that—they* (*your Catholic Neighbours*) *hold nothing, nor Practise nothing, but what they are able to give a very satisfactory account of to any impartial Enquirer, then say, I am a Knave, a Liar, and a Cheat, one that deserveth no mercy from God or Man, in this World or the next.*]

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M DC LXXVII.

TO THE AUTHOR AND HIS RELATIONS.

CHAP. I.

WHEN the Confutation of the Treatise of Transubstantiation was in the Press, this Book came to my notice, written, if the Style may go for Proof, by the *same Author:* It is conjectured that your Name is Mr. *W. Hutchinson* of *Lincolnshire,* sometime of *Queens' College* in *Cambridge;* and that it is indeed your nearest Relations whom you so earnestly labour to pervert: Your *Style* persuadeth me that you are *serious,* and verily think that your way is right: And I suppose you see that we also are as confident of the truth of our Profession, as you are of yours: The Question is, whether it be *your* Zeal, or *ours,* that is according to Knowledge?

The Title of your Religion greatly pleaseth me, and is the same that I assume: For we are, I perceive, agreed in this, that it is [*the Apostolical Christianity*] that is the true and safe Religion: And hath God left the matter so obscure as that we cannot come to an agreement in so weighty a matter of Fact, as to know what [*the Apostolical Christianity*] was; when even Common History giveth us notice what the *Athenian* Philosophers held, and what the ancient *Romans* held, and so of almost every literate Nation? *You* study, and *we* study; *You* pray, and *we* pray: You would know the truth, whatever it cost you, and so would We. As a Man that looketh daily when I am called away to God, I solemnly protest, that if I could find that Popery were the true Apostolic Christianity, I would joyfully quit all the Friends, Hope, and Interests of this World, to embrace it. What is it that is your advantage, and what is our disadvantage? Are you more impartial in your search? I am so Conscious of my Impartiality, that I cannot believe that this maketh the difference. Is it that we have not read the Papists' writings? I have reason to believe that I have read as many of them, at least, as you have done, if you are not much above sixty years of

age (as I hear you are not near it). But you have Conversed with more of them than I have done? It's like you have: But is that the reason of my mistake? You earnestly invite your Relations to Converse with the Papists, because men's *writings* may be mistaken: And on this ground I perceive you build all the certainty of your Faith, That *our Fathers* and *our Grand-Fathers* have told us Infallibly, what they received from their Fathers and Grand-Fathers, and so on. This is your certainty.

I will tell you briefly what I take for the *Apostolical Christianity,* and by what Notices I receive it; and then I will again consider yours.

I take not *Christianity* to be a thing so hardly to be known, as you would make it; either as to *the Being* of it, or the *Publication.* I take it to have its *Essentials, Integrals,* and *Accidentals;* and that these are not to be confounded: If it cannot be readily known what Christianity is, how shall we preach it to Heathens? or how shall Christians be known to others, or themselves? and who can have the comfort of an unknown Religion?

You tell us that nothing of it is *written* in the New Testament, but the Life of Christ by four Men, and a few occasional Epistles, *&c.* But do you think that Christ himself did not institute Christianity, and tell Men plainly what it was? Did not those four Men write *Christ's Doctrine* as well as his *Life?* And is he not the *Author of our Faith?* Did he not preach the Gospel? And do you not call these four Books the four Evangelists? And doth not the Gospel contain and describe Christianity? Did not Christ oft tell us what it is to be his Disciples? And were not the Disciples called Christians shortly after, as words of the same signification? But what place is there for any doubt, when Christ himself did institute Baptism, and describe it? and command that all Nations being Discipled should be Baptized into the Name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost; as being the Faith which Disciples must profess? And do not you to this day profess, that Baptizing is Christening, and that Baptism washeth away all sin, (supposing the Baptized to receive it as Baptism, by true Covenant-consent at least?) And doth not Baptism enter us

into the true Church of Christ? Sure all this is past dispute; where then is the difficulty? Is not a truly baptized Person a Christian? And was it then as hard a matter as you make it, to know *what Faith was necessary to Baptism,* (in the Person at age, or the Parent of Infants?) Surely then the Scripture, that mentioneth the History of so many thousands baptized, would have told us of that grand Controversy, and how it was decided. But no such Controversy was then debated, for ought we there find. If Baptismal Covenanting with God the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost, as our God and Father reconciled in Christ, our Saviour, and our Sanctifier, be not the *Symbol* or *Badge* of *Christians,* and that which visibly maketh them such; your own Church, and all the Christian World is deceived. And we know that it was not the Custom of the Apostles and Pastors of the ancient Churches, to make a mere Ceremony and dead Formality of Baptism, by baptizing those that would but say the words [*I believe in God the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost,*] without understanding what they said: And therefore their ordinary Preaching was the Exposition of these three Articles: And the Creed called The Apostles, is the Exposition of these three Articles; which though some Clauses were since added, and though the Churches tyed not themselves just to the very same words, (as we find by the various forms of this Creed in *Irenaeus, Tertullian, Marcellus's* in *Epiphanius, Ruffinus, &c.*) yet for the substance and sense, and most of the very words, all Churches used the same. And when the Council of *Nice* taught them the way of making new Creeds, (which *Hilary Pictav.* so sadly complaineth of,) yet still the matter of the old Creed was the substance of them all. And the Eastern Creed, which was used before the *Nicene* Council, (for that such a one there was, the most Learned Antiquaries give us sufficient proof,) was but the same in sense as the Western, even the Exposition of the Baptismal Faith; and this the Baptized did profess before Baptism: And the work of Catechists was to teach this and the sense of it to the Catechumens. And that [*He that believeth and is baptized* (that is, truly devoted to God the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost, by the Bap-

tismal Covenant) *shall be saved, and he that believeth not shall be damned,*] is by Christ himself made the sum of his Gospel, or Law of Grace.

As the Image of the blessed Trinity on man's Soul is *Life, Light,* and *Love;* so the summaries of that sacred Doctrine which must imprint it on us, is the *Symbolum Fidei,* the *Creed,* the summary of things to be *believed;* and the *Lord's Prayer,* the *Symbolum* and summary of things to be *willed, desired,* and *sought;* and the *Decalogue,* the summary of *things to be practised;* being the Directory of Man's three Faculties, the *Intellect,* the *will,* and the *Executive Power.* And all this we believe was delivered to the Churches by the Apostles, and received by all Christians, many years (eight at least) before any Book of the New Testament was written: And for the fuller understanding and improvement of it, and for all the integral parts of Religion that were to be added, the Apostles and Evangelists more enlargedly preached them to the People in their Sermons, as Christ himself had done much of them. We receive all that, as God's Word, which by these Apostles was delivered as such to the Churches; because they had the promise of the Holy Ghost to lead them into all truth, and to bring all things that Christ taught and commanded to their remembrance. We are assured that all that is contained in the *New Testament* was written by such *inspired Persons;* and that the Spirit of God will knew, that when they were to dye, without written Records, the memory of Mankind would not faithfully retain, and deliver to Posterity, such copious matter as the *Integrals* and useful *Accidentals* of Religion, and therefore caused them to write it and leave it to Posterity.

So that our Christian Religion is contained and delivered to us in *three Formulas* or *Prescripts:* The *first* containeth the *whole Essence of Christianity,* and is the *Sacramental Covenant,* in which we are believingly given up to God the *Father, Son, and Holy Ghost,* and God to us, in the Relation of a God and Father, a Saviour and a Sanctifier. This is done initially, *ad esse,* in Baptism, and after *ad robur* in the *Lord's Supper.* This is delivered to us by *Tradition Naturally Infallible, de facto:* For *all Christians,*

as such, have received and entered this *Sacramental Covenant;* and full History assureth us, that the very same Form of it is come down in all the Churches to this day.

The second *Formula,* is the *Exposition* of the three Articles of this Sacramental Covenant, in the *Creed, Lord's Prayer,* and *Decalogue;* which hath been delivered by memory also, and kept unchanged (save the foresaid additions of some explicatory words in the *Creed,*) to all the Churches to this day.

The third *Form,* is *all the holy Canonical Scriptures,* (the Old Testament being as preparatory to the New,) which contain all the *Essentials, Integrals, and needful Accidentals.*

Our Religion then is all from Christ and his Spirit, in inspired men, commissioned to deliver it, and is well called as you do, the *Apostolical Christianity:* We own no other. It is all brought down to us by Tradition from the Apostles. The *Essentials* in the Covenant, and the explicatory Symbols or Summaries, are delivered to us two ways: First by *Memory and Practice* most current and certain from Generation to Generation, being no more than what Memory might well retain, whereto yet the helps of the *Ancients Writings* reciting the Forms were used for the fuller certainty of Posterity. Secondly in the *holy Scriptures,* where they are contained (as the *Brain, Heart,* and *Stomach,* in the Body) among all the rest as the *Principal* Parts. The third form is so large that Memory could not preserve it, and therefore God would have it delivered us in that Writing which we all call the Sacred Bible, or Canonical Scripture. This containeth thousands of words more than are of absolute necessity to Salvation; but no more than is useful or helpful to Salvation.

In all this I have showed you what our Religion is, (*Objectively* taken) and which way we receive it. Where you are therefore to note, 1. That all our Sermons, Writings, Church-Articles, *&c.* are but the Expressions of our *Subjective Religion,* telling other Men how particular Men, and particular Churches, understand those *Divine Forms* which are our *Objective* Religion: These are various as Churches and Persons are, every one having his own Faith and Religion in different

measures, and such expressions being but our *sides mensurata* may be altered and amended, and we pretend not to perfection in them: But the former being our *sides vel Religio mensurans,* our *Divine Objective* Faith or Religion, is inculpable and unalterable.

2. Note that *you Papists* do grant all *our Objective Faith and Religion,* even every word of it, to be *true, infallible, and of God:* You own, I say, every word of *our Religion:* That is, all the *Sacramental Covenant,* all the *Creed, Lord's Prayer, and Decalogue,* and all that which we call the holy *Canonical Scriptures.* But we own not all yours: So that you do not, you cannot find fault with the least Particle of our Religion as to the truth of it; but, 1. You think that it is not *enough:* And 2. That we come not to it the right way, that is, we take not our Faith upon the word of Papists, as Papists. Is not this the difference? And is not this all that you cry out against us for?

And now let us see whether your way be better and surer than this of ours is?

I. Your Religion is much Bigger than ours.

II. You hold it on other Reasons, and plead another way of receiving it.

I. Your Religion (Objective) containeth, besides all our Bible, all the *Apocryphal Books,* and all the *Decrees of General Councils,* and all the other *un-written Traditions* (if there be any more, who knows what?) you name yourself here, *fasting on Fridays, and on the vigils of Saints, Ember-days, Lent, and Images,* and such like.

Here now we humbly propose to your consideration; 1. Whether you will take all these into the *Essentials of Christianity,* or not? If not, a Man may be *a Christian;* and consequently of the Church or Body of Christ, and in a state of Salvation without them. Why then do you deny them this, and make them to be as out of the true Church and state of Life? If yea,

Q. 2. Did all that the Apostles Baptized, believe all the *Apocrypha* and all the *Decrees of your Councils,* and your Oral Traditions?

Q. 3. Did the ancient Fathers and Catechists teach all those to the Catechumens before they Baptized them?

Q. 4. And were not those all Christians, and in the true Church, and in a state of Life, whom the Apostles Baptized, without the profession of any such Belief?

Q. 5. What was the *Creed,* the *Symbolum fidei* used for, if not to distinguish the Faith of the Christian Church from Infidelity, Heresy, and all without? And if all the Decrees of Councils be as necessary to be the *Symbol of Faith,* why were they not all made up into a Creed? and why is the Creed differenced from them all to this day? And why do you not cause the Baptized to recite and profess all these Councils' Decrees, but only the old Christian Creed?

Q. 6. Doth not Christ at the Institution of his Sacrament, *Mat.* 28. expressly promise that *he that believeth* (according to Baptism, in the *Father, Son, and Holy Ghost*) *shall be saved?*

Q. 7. Is it not a reproach to God and the Christian Religion, to tell the World that God hath written us by his Spirit so great a Book as the Bible is, and yet there is not in it enough to Salvation, but that abundance *unnecessary* to Salvation is in it, and some necessary things left out?

Q. 8. Have your Oral superadded Traditions more *Evidence of Truth than the Bible,* or more *Evidence of Necessity* to be believed? Not more Evidence of *Truth:* For you confess the certain *Truth* of all the Bible, and that as fully manifest as your Additions. If it have more Evidence of *Necessity,* what is it? It is not because it is a *Divine Revelation:* For so you confess all the Bible to be? And do you pretend to a Tradition that saith, [You may be saved without most of the Bible, though it be of God, but not without fasting on *Fridays,* or on the Vigils of Saints'-days, or other such Traditions?] But if you will make both the whole *Bible* and *Tradition necessary to be believed,* it must be either Explicitly, or as you call it, *Implicitly:* If Explicitly, (that is, as each Point is particularly understood and believed,) then it's doubtful whether there be one Man in the World that is a Christian, and can be saved? If *Implicitly,* that is, *Virtually* as it is in some General Proposition, what is that *General?* Is it

that *All that God revealeth is true?* Or that *All that the Spirit of Christ in his Apostles delivered to the Church as his word, is true.* These we all agree in, if this will serve the turn? Is it that the Church is the *Ministerial Keeper* of the Sacred Doctrine as delivered? This also we agree in. Or is it that *the Church de eventu shall never corrupt, alter, or lose, this word, or any part of it?* If you mean it of every particular Church, we are agreed of the contrary. You confess that many Churches have fallen to Heresy, and many Apostatized from the Faith: If you speak of the *Universal Church,* we are agreed that the *Universal Church* shall never Apostatize; for if Christ had no Church, he were no *Head* of it. And we are agreed that they shall never turn such *true Heretics,* as hold not truly *all the Essentials of Christianity:* For such also are *no Christians;* because each Essential part is necessary to the *Essence.* But whether the *Universal Church,* much more the *Greater part,* may not make or receive some culpable alteration by Amission, Omission, or Commission, we have reason to question? We never heard any Proof that the Negative was necessary to Salvation, nor is it held by all yourselves; and whether by any one man I cannot tell: For you take the Bible to be God's Word, and your knowledge of the various Readings of the Hebrew and Greek Copies, and the multitude of Errors in the Vulgar Latin corrected by *P. Clem.* 8. and *Sixtus* 5. do satisfy all the World, that you hold that the Universal Church, or the major part, even your own, may culpably err, or alter the very written Word of God. And who would then believe you, if you said, [*But the Unwritten Word it cannot alter?*] It's true indeed, the *Essentials* considered, as Written or Unwritten, all the true Church, nor any one Christian, while such, cannot deny: But sure, if many thousand Errors may be found in that Book which you take yourselves for the Word of God, and this through the fault or failing of such as have had the keeping of it; and *all Divine Revelations* are to be *believed,* and all the *Word of God is Divine Revelation,* it notoriously followeth, That your own Church hath not kept all that is *matter of Divine Faith* from alteration. So that though many of your Wranglers will not distinguish the *Essentials* of Christianity

(called Fundamentals) from the *Integrals* and *Accidentals,* (as if Christianity were nothing, and had no determinate Essence,) yet this showeth, that you must do it whether you will or not; or else you must confess that your Church may alter anything, or everything, as it hath done all these fore-mentioned: Which we will not confess of the Church Universal.

But, I suppose that we have not yet met with the Faith that you account necessary to salvation: *It is that the Pope of Rome, and a General Council, cannot err, in delivering to us the Apostolical Doctrine to be believed.* And this is an implicit believing of all that is written in Scripture, and that is delivered orally from the Apostles. If so, words and names go very far with you as to men's salvation. Is this to believe a thousand things which a man never knew or heard of? if he do but believe the Infallibility of your Church? What! Believe that which I never once thought of? But this is but *Implicit Faith?* A cheating Name for *No-belief of those things:* For by *Implicit* here you can mean only *Virtual,* and that is no *Actual Belief* of that thing at all, but of something else, which would infer more were it known: Nay *Virtual* is too high a Name for it.

But will this serve the turn to salvation, to believe that *the Pope and his Council are Infallible?* What! though the same Person believe not in God the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost, nor any of the Articles of his Creed, no not a Life to come? If you say, Yea; Then will you call this Christianity, to believe in the Pope, and not in Christ? Or do you mean, that men may be saved without Christianity, but not without Popery? If so, why was not the Pope's Name, rather than Christ's, put into Baptism and the Creed, or at least with Christ's?

But the insuperable difficulty is, How must I believe that the Pope hath this Infallibility? From Christ, or otherwise? If not from Christ, tell me which way, and why I must believe it? If from Christ, can I believe that the Pope hath Power from Christ, before I believe that there is a Christ, that hath such Power to give? And can I believe in Christ, and not believe that there is a God that sent him? Can I believe that Jesus is the Christ, and not believe that he is a Sacrifice for sin, or a

Mediator between God and Man, and came to save his People from their sins? And can I believe this, and not believe that we are all sinners, and that sin deserveth that punishment which Christ came to save us from? Is not our Saviour, and our Sin and Misery relatives? as a Physician, or Medicine and a Disease? And can we believe that we have sin and desert of Punishment, without believing that God is our Governor, and gave us that Law which we broke, and which obligeth us to Punishment? Can we believe in Christ, and not believe that he is God and Man, that he dyed, rose, and ascended into Heaven, and will judge us at last? and that he pardoneth sin, reneweth Souls by his Spirit, and will give us life hereafter? All these are included in believing in Christ, as Christ. And how must I believe that Christ hath given the Pope this Infallibility or Power? By any written word which granteth it? or by Oral Tradition? If by the written Word, then I must believe that that Word is true, before I can believe that the Pope is made Pope or Infallible by it? If by Oral Tradition, whose must that be? Then I must believe some bodies Oral Tradition as true and infallible, before I believe in the Pope at all. If it be the first Hearers of the Apostles, then either the Pope was one of those, or not. If *yea,* and he hath a Negative Voice in the credible report, then I must believe him as Infallible, before he is proved Infallible, in order to my believing that he is *Infallible,* which is a contradiction. If *Not,* Then I must believe the Infallibility of *other Hearers* of the Apostles, before I can believe the Pope's? And the Question will recur, How I shall know them to be Infallible? And who they were that were those Infallible Witnesses? Whether Pastors only, or the People? Whether of some one Church, or of all the Churches? And how I shall prove that they gave such a Testimony?

So that your pretence of a Necessity of receiving God's Word, or the Christian Faith, from the Pope and his Council cometh too late: For it seemeth that we must believe it first, before it be possible to believe in the Pope and Council as authorised by Christ.

And if my Implicit Faith be the Belief of this Article, [*Any Church in all the world, yea, the greater part of all the Churches, may err in matters of Faith, or Apostatize, and only the Pope of* Rome *and his Council cannot:*] What Proof, or whose Tradition doth this rest upon?

Q. 9. Do not *Bellarmine, Costerus,* and many of your Writers profess that the Scriptures contain all things ordinarily necessary to Salvation? Yea many Writers, that the Creed hath all that is absolutely to be believed? Yea some, that it hath more than all? Yea abundance (Cited by *Fr. a Sancta Clara*) that the Belief in Christ is not necessary to all? And will you say then, that he that believeth Explicitly the *whole Bible* cannot be saved without believing also your pretended Traditions?

Q. 10. And do you not hereby, instead of the *light burden and easy yoke* of Christ, and his *Commands which are not grievous,* bring Christians under a harder yoke than that which the *Jews* were not able to bear? When it seemed good to the Holy Ghost in the Apostles to impose but a few and necessary things, *Act.* 15. 28. And how large a Law is all the Bible, and all your Councils' Decrees, and Oral Traditions, set together? Do all your Priests themselves, or one of an hundred, understand them all, or know what they are?

Q. 11. While you pretend a Necessity of your numerous Ceremonies, (as Fasting on *Fridays,* and such other named by you,) do you not lay a snare of perpetual Division in the Churches? and do you not make as many inconsistent Churches, as there be Societies of Christians that differ (and still will differ) about any of those Traditions or Ceremonies?

Q. 12. And do you not lay open your own Church, to the accusation of *innovation, mutability,* and *corruption,* when it is not to be denied, but in such things as those they have been mutable or innovated? Have you not long left the Custom of *adoring on the Lord's-days without genuflexion,* though the first great General Council (*Nic. Can.* 20.) and the ancient Fathers commonly, made it a Tradition, and Practice of the whole Church? and it was Decreed to be so used by all? Abundance of such Instances may be given.

Q. 13. You do very injuriously to your own Sect and Cause, here to pretend Tradition as coming down from the Apostles, for such things as your own Doctors plead but your Church's later Institution for: It's fully proved by *Daleus de jejuniis,* that the Lent Fast was long but for a short time, before it came to forty days: And it's an odd thing, if you will pretend Tradition from the Apostles, for the Holy-days, or the Vigil Fasts, of those Saints that were born many hundred years after the Apostles' death?

We confess our Faith is not so big as yours? We have many score Texts of Scripture that promise Salvation to them that believe much less than the Bible itself containeth. Yet we profess ourselves ready to believe as much more as you shall ever prove to us, to have been delivered by the Apostles, to the Church, to be believed.

II. And for the second, (that we *receive not our Faith the way that you do;* that is, from the *Authority of the Pope and Papists,* and from *your Tradition:*) We crave your consideration of these Questions.

1. When the Apostles (*and Disciples, Act.* 8.) were scattered, and preached the Gospel to many Nations, Were they not true Christians, and saved, that received the Gospel from any one of them, or from any Person whatsoever? If *Aquila* or *Priscilla* Converted a Sinner, such a one saved a Soul from Death, though *Peter* did it not; nor his Authority was known to such a one?

2. Do you believe that if the *Roman* Bishop or Church's Revelation or Proposal were necessary to true Faith and to Salvation, that Christ would never have told Men so? Nor any of his Apostles have left it us on Record? When there were Heresies and Schismes so woefully troubling the Churches as we find in *Paul*'s Epistles to the *Cor. Gal. Col.* and in the *Rev.* 2. and 3. *ch.* should we never have found one word for this speedy way of decision, to appeal to the Church of *Rome?* Would *Paul* have rebuked them for saying, *I am of Cephas,* and made him but a *Minister by whom they believed,* without ever mentioning his Office and Dignity? would he never have told

the Church of *Rome* of their Mistress-ship and Infallibility above the rest? Would so necessary a Fundamental of Faith have been so much silenced?

3. Did the Apostles, Evangelists, or ancient Fathers, use to Convert Infidels by any such Method, and telling them that they must believe, first the Infallibility of the Bishop of *Rome* and his Clergy, and then believe the Gospel because he saith it is true? Had this been the old Method, would there not have been more Books necessary, and written, to prove this first Fundamental (the *Infallibility of the* Roman *Bishop and his Councils*) than to have proved the Gospel itself directly? Is it not a wonder that we should have such Volumes as *Eusebius* his *Praeparatio & Demonstratio Evangel.* and so many written by those before and after him, to prove the *Gospel,* and none of them hit on this Method, nor write at large to make it good? The Church's Authority and Unity, is ordinarily pleaded against *Heresies and Schismes,* but who ever *Converted Infidels* by the Authority of the Papal Church, either proved or asserted as the necessary *Medium* of Faith?

4. Do you not confess that all other Churches may err besides the *Roman?* And their plea of Tradition you account invalid: Your Book called [*Considerations on the Council of Trent,* by *R. H.*] *p.* 40. saith, [*All Conciliary Definitions are not only Declarations and Testifications of such Apostolical Traditions as were left by them evident and conspicuous in all Christian Churches Planted by them; but are many times Determinations of Points deduced from, and necessary consequents to, such clear Traditionals, whether written or unwritten.* 2. *If the Acts of General Councils were only such Declarations of Apostolical Tradition, yet it is possible that some particular Church, may in time, depart from such a Tradition entrusted to them; else how can any Church become Heretical against any such Tradition?*]

Do you not at this day accuse the *Greek Church,* the *Muscovites,* the *Armenians,* the *Jacobites, Syrians, Copties, Abassines,* the *Protestants, &c.* as having departed from, or corrupted the first Tradition? And how *small* a part of the *Universality* of Christians are the *Papists?* And if the *greater* part of Christians

may so forsake the Apostolical Tradition, why may not the Pope of *Rome* and his Council? How shall we be sure of their exemption from such danger? You tell us over and over of our receiving this and that from our Fathers and Grand-Fathers? And is that a certain Proof that it is Apostolical? Why is it not so then with all the rest, the *Abassines,* the *Armenians, &c.* and the Majority of Christians? But of this I have spoken in the former Treatise.

5. And there I have desired you to tell us, whether your *Grandfather,* or *his Priest,* was *Infallible?* If yea, how, came he by it more than *all those Churches?* If not, do you not delude your Relations, by drawing them to build their Faith on a fallible man, or upon nothing? Your Relations were not at the Council of *Trent,* or *Florence,* or *Laterane:* How shall they be sure what the Pope and Council agreed on? What Foundation, but the words of your Priest or Grandfather, have you for your assurance? May not one of your Priests lie as well as all the *Greek, Abassine, &c.* Churches? When Pope *Coelestine* himself falsely urged the *Nicene* Council for Appeals to *Rome,* contrary to *Augustine* and the *Carthage* Council? Either tell your Readers plainly, that it's *you,* and such *as you,* that are the *Infallible Foundation* of their Faith; or bid them stay, and not go your way, till they are certain what the Pope and his Council say; and that he is a true Pope, and it a true Council, and that they are more Infallible than the major part of Christians. And our Faith can be no stronger than the weakest necessary *medium* of it, from whence it must arise.

6. I have said so much of this in a small Book, called, [*The certainty of Christianity without Popery,*] which I entreat you impartially to peruse, where I have also showed the utter uncertainty that Popery would reduce our Christianity to; that I will now only tell you, that after your talk of Tradition, and Church, and Fathers, and Grandfathers, if we had not much more *testimony of Tradition* for our Religion than you have for Popery, we should think our Faith were very lame. Compare ours with yours: 1. Yours is *A pretended Authoritative determination,* which rests upon a supposed *Inspiration* of some Persons,

by virtue of a special Privilege peculiar to themselves. 2. It is the Tradition of the *minor part* of Christians against the *major.* 3. It rests on the pretended *Infallibility* of a *Pope, which great General Councils* have said may be a *Heretic,* and have deposed divers as Heretics, and worse: And upon the Infallibility of *General Councils,* which by Popes and other Councils are pronounced fallible, unless confirmed by a Pope (who may be a Heretic.) 4. It rests upon a Foundation (*viz.* the Pope's Divine Right of Primacy and Infallibility) which is expressly denied by two of the first four great General Councils, approved to this day; *viz.* that of *Calcedon* reciting the sense of that of *Constantinople* against the said Divine right, affirming, that the *Pope's Primacy was given him by the Fathers, because* Rome *was the Imperial Seat.* 5. It rests upon an Authority (of Popes and General Councils,) which being at first but the *Clergy* of *one Empire,* hath thence claimed the same Power over *all the Christian World,* which they had got in the Dominions of *one Prince.* 6. It rests on a Claim downright contradictory to itself, as aforesaid, *viz.* That we must believe that the Pope hath this Power and Infallibility given him and his Councils, by Christ and his Gospel, before we can believe that there is a Christ and a Gospel authorized and true.

Now our Tradition is this: For all the *Essentials* of our Religion, the Sacramental Covenant, and the three expository *Symbols,* we have the current Tradition both of the Papists and all the rest of the Christian World: Yea, that *every Book* that we call Canonical is the true Word of God, not only the Papists but almost all the Christian World confess: And, *defacto,* that these *Books* came down from the Apostles, at least that the Gospel was preached by them, we have the Testimony also of Enemies and Persecutors. And are not all these more than the Testimony of one *Sect* alone? 2. And in this we have as much to confirm us as you have, of the *wisdom, piety, care of the Church* to *preserve* the Gospel, and much more too; for we have the *Piety* of *all the Churches* to plead, and not *your Sect alone:* And we undertake to prove such a *moral Infallibility* as is also *Natural, viz.* That Man's *Nature* and *Interests* supposed, it is no more

possible for so many Persons and Nations of cross Interests to have agreed in their Testimony for the Gospel, than for all the contentious Lawyers in the Land to have agreed falsely to inform us, that our Statutes were made by such Kings and Parliaments. But a domineering Faction alone might easilier have deceived men.

3. Yea, even as to *Christ's Promise,* we can better prove that the *Universal Church,* or *Body of Christians,* shall *never lose the Faith,* than you can prove it of *Rome alone,* or the *Papal Sect. Bellarmine* himself dare not say, that *Rome* shall not cease to be the feat of the *Papacy,* or shall not be utterly destroyed. And then how can there be a *Bishop of Rome,* when there is no *Rome?* But you'll say, that if he dwell at *Avignion,* he may be *called Bishop of Rome?* But if he be *called so* when *he is not so,* at least when there is *no Rome,* or *no Christian Church there,* sure a *false Name* is not an Essential part of our Religion. If you say, that at *Avignion,* or *Ravenna,* or *Vienna,* he may be S. *Peter*'s Successor, and so the Universal Monarch still. I answer, Then it seems that the Council of *Calcedon,* as afore-cited, was in the right, (that *Rome's Privilege was given by the Fathers, because it was the Imperial Seat:*) And so that the Pope is not S. *Peter*'s Successor, *eo nomine,* because *he is Bishop of Rome.* But if the Bishop of *Avignion,* or *Vienna,* might become S. *Peter*'s Successor (who never was Bishop there,) how shall we know that the Bishop of *Rome* is his Successor *now?* We have hitherto had no better means to prove it, and deceive the World, than by saying that S. *Peter* dyed Bishop of *Rome,* where the Pope is Bishop: But S. *Peter* dyed not Bishop of *Avignion.* If the *Place* prove not the *Succession,* tell us, if you can, what doth? Is it the *Election?* By whom? Who are those men that have the Power of choosing S. *Peter* a Successor? You know, I suppose, that the Pope hath been chosen, 1. Sometime by the People, (witness the bloodshed at the choice of *Damasus* in the Church:) 2. Sometime by the People, and the Neighbour Ordaining Bishops: 3. Sometime by a Synod: 4. Sometime by the Emperors: 5. And lastly, by the *Roman* Cardinals. If any of these may choose, then we may have four or five lawful Popes, chosen four or five sev-

eral ways, at once. If only one of these have the Power, S. *Peter* had no Successors under all the other Elections. So that the Claim will fall rather to *Antioch* than to *Avignion,* or any other Town, because they say it was S. *Peter*'s first Bishopric, from which he removed for a greater. If you are driven with poor Mr. *Johnson,* alias, *Terret,* to say, that *Any way will serve which serveth for the truth of an Election of Princes, &c.* then still we may have four Popes at least. I doubt you must be forced to say as some, that it is the *acceptance of the Universal Church,* which must prove who is the *Universal Monarch.* 1. But some must be *Electors,* before it comes to *acceptance.* And who hath the Power of *Electing?* And 2. what if now the major part of the Church should prefer the Bishop of *Constantinople?* I hope you are not so ignorant of Cosmography as not to know that the *Greek* Church when they first preferred the Bishop of *Const.* was far greater than the *Latin.* 3. And I suppose you know that it is not near half the Christian World that now accepteth of the Pope as their Governor. 4. And I pray you do but get the Pope to suspend his claim till *the Church Universal* accept him, and we shall not be troubled with him: For how shall they signify their acceptance? If in a General Council, you know how they of *Constance, Basil,* and *Pisa,* are reviled by the Pope and those that now go for your Church, for pretending to a power to depose and choose Popes; and how *Eugenius* the fourth prevailed against such a Deposition. And if these Councils were not your Universal Church representative, where shall we think to find it?

In sum, we have the *Tradition* of a Church as *big as three of the* Roman *for all our Religion;* and of *all the* Roman *Church* itself; besides the Confession of the *Enemies* of the Church, Pagans, Infidels, Mahometans, Jews, and Heretics; we have not one word that's part of our Religion, which yourselves confess not to be true: We believe that the *Faith of the Universal Church shall never fail,* nor the Gates of Hell prevail against it: And so you see that we may far better tell how Infallibly we have received our Religion from our Forefathers, than you can do of yours: But we believe not that this Universal Church hath any

Head but *Christ;* no Human Vicarious Monarch or Governor of all the World: We believe that Men must Believe in Christ before they can know that the Pope is his Vicar, if it had been true: We know, as sure as History can tell us, that the Pope's first Primacy, and the rest of the Patriarchates were but the Human Ordinances of the Clergy of one Empire, and not of the whole Christian World. And we know not (nor you) but *Rome* and its Church and Bishop, may yet all cease together.

But you make me most admire at you, that (in this Book also) you tell your Relations, and other Readers, of the *uncertainty of notice by Books* in Comparison of *converse* and *talk* with those of your *present Party;* yea that your *own Religion* is not to be known by *Books,* as being liable to be misunderstood, so well as by talking with Papists, and asking them what is their Faith or Religion. Sir, I judge by your Style that you are a man of zeal and conscience in your way, and therefore that you write not this fraudulently against your conscience. Sure then you must needs be a man of more than ordinary ignorance, that can believe what you say. 1. Is it your *Objective* or your *Subjective* Faith that we are disputing of? If it be not the *Rule* and *Object* of your Faith, every man indeed may tell us what *he believeth himself,* but no man can tell us what *another* believeth. And then you have as many Religions as men; for every man hath one of his own, and no two men in the world know and believe just all the same things, neither more nor less: And what shall those of us think of your Religion then, who find that one of you affirmeth what another denieth? For instance, A worthy Person of your Religion affirmed to me, that notwithstanding the Fifth Commandment [*Honour thy Father and Mother,*] a Mother hath not any Governing Power over a *Child,* nor the *Child* oweth any obedience to the Mother, during the Father's life, because it were confusion were there more Governors in a House than one, though subordinate one to the other. Is this your common Judgment? May I say therefore that this is other men's belief? You know that when we allege the sayings of your most Learned Writers, we are ordinarily told, that it is not the judgment of particular Doctors, but

of the Church in Councils, which we must call your Church's Judgment. You undertake not to justify any more. And if I talk with any of my Neighbours and ask him what he believeth, have I any more than a single Doctor's opinion? Is his Answer, the Faith of your Church? But would you have any one past seven years old believe you, that *writing* is of no more use to Memory for conservation of Antiquities? when God would not trust his *Ten Commandments* to the People's *Memories,* but would write them in Stone, and put them in the Ark, (which you have so little skill in Antiquity as to say here was the *first writing:* Sure if you will read your Jesuit *Euseb. Nirembergius de Antiqu. scripturae* you will not say that your Grand-Father taught you truly that Opinion as the Tradition of the Church.) Why do *you write* to your own Relations, if writing be so unintelligible? Could the *Bible* have been kept as well in Memory as by *Writings?* Why were the Gospels written then? Do you go to *Tradition,* or to *Books,* to decide any Controversy now of the various readings? Did Pope *Clem.* 8. and *Sixtus* 5. reform the vulgar *Latin* by *Memory* or by *Books?* Pope *Pius*'s *Trent* Oath sweareth Men to Interpret Scripture according to the consent of the Fathers: Do any of your Doctors know how that is by *Memory and Oral Tradition,* or by *Books?* Did *Possevine,* and *Sixtus Senensis,* and such others, Correct Books by Oral Tradition, or by Books? Did *Celestine* and the *Carthage* Council debate the Case of the *Nicene* Canon (a narrow Instance which Memory might have served for) out of Men's *Memories,* or out of *written Records?* Why doth *Pisanus* bring us out new Forged Canons, and why do the Copies of many Councils differ in the recital of Canons, if Memory and Universal un-written Tradition can reconcile the difference? Was the *Athenian* Philosophy propagated and preserved better by Memory, or by Books? Why is not the Stoics, and Epicureans, and others, as fully known now as *Aristotles* and *Plato's,* if Memory without Books could have done? Have you as full notice now of the Acts of *James, John, Matthew, Thomas, Bartholomew, &c.* without Book, as you have of *Paul*'s by the Book? Is memory sufficient to have preserved to us the Statures of the Land, without Books

and Records? Yea, or the Common-Law without any Records or Book Cases? Why are all your Councils written? and all the Decretals? to say nothing of the Civil *Roman* Laws, Institutes, Pandects, and Digests. Can you decide the Controversies about the Decretals, published by *Isidore Mercator,* by Tradition? What are all your Libraries for at the *Vatican, Florence, Paris,* and in each Learned Man's House, if Books be so useless and unintelligible? If one of your Relations ask you, what is in the Council of *Trent, Florence, Laterane,* and so upward, can you tell him fully without Book by Tradition? And are not these Councils your very Religion? Doth every Papist Neighbour carry them all in his brain, more certainly than in Books? Or could your Grandfather and Grandmother have told us more certainly what is in them, than *Crab, Surius, Binius, Baronius, Justellus, Albaspinaeus, Petavius, Sirmondus, &c.* could do? Or is all left uncertain because it is written?

Through God's Mercy our Essentials, and somewhat more, are delivered certainly down to us by two hands, by Oral and Practical Tradition, and by the Scripture, because they lie in a narrow room. But yet if you had the front to tell the World, that your immutable Church hath never changed the Creed itself, we could not believe you, because *Books* contradict you. Tradition from your Great Grandfather cannot assure us that [*Filioque*] was in the Creed from the days of the Apostles: Nor that [*the Holy Catholic Church, the Communion of Saints,*] and the other words mentioned in *Vessius,* and *Usher de Symbolis,* were in so long: Nor that the *Greeks* added no words to their Creed at *Nice,* nor afterward at *Constantinople,* in General Councils; nor that all S. *Hilaries* outcry against Creeds was in vain. Nor can Tradition without Book yet assure us, what were the very words of the Creed used commonly by the *Greeks,* immediately before the *Nicene* Council; nor who wrote that ascribed to *Athanasius:* Nor among the various *Formula's* of that called the Apostles, found, as aforesaid, in *Irenaeus, Tertullian, Epiphanius, Ruffinus, &c.* which of them was in constant use; or whether liberty of such alteration of words was not then used.

And no Unwritten Report of your Grandfather can assure us, that your Mass-Book or Liturgy was the same in the Apostles' days as it is now; nor that it was for 600 years the same in all the Churches of one Empire; and that every Bishop had not power to use what Liturgy he pleased, in his own City or *Parochia:* Nor can your Tradition assure us, that what the Father and Grandfather used, was used from the Apostles, when the Church of *Neocaesarea* clamoured at S. *Basil* for his singularity and innovations, and S. *Basil* retorts on them, that they at *Neocaesarea* had scarce left anything unchanged: I hope this is not the less credible because *Basil* hath *written* it.

At least, I pray hereafter give over your ill practice of leading simple Readers into a Wood of *Church-History,* to lose them and the Question there among a multitude of Citations of old Books, when you know not what else to say (as *William Johnson* did,) because there the ignorant know nothing themselves, but may as well believe the Affirmer as the Denier; and at least the diversion to voluminous Controversies about particular men's words may hide your Errors. Do not resolve all the Controversy, yea the Faith of your Followers, into a multitude of *Books* of *Councils* and *Fathers* which they never saw. And do not take so much care to corrupt and alter Books, for your interest, as instances and your *Indices Expurg.* tell us you have done. Resolve without Book the Controversy about your great *Laterane* Council, whether Dr. *Taylor,* Dr. *Pierson,* Dr. *Gunning,* (and Bishop *Cousins* lately) that say *Innocent.* 3. made and published the Canons, and the Council did not consent to them, be in the right, or rather they that answered Dr. *Pierson* and Dr. *Gunning,* and indeed your Church, which holds the contrary (which Mr. *Dodwell* seemeth to me lately to have fully proved, in his Book about tolerating Papists.)

Nay why may we not expect that you lay by your Book Catechisms, your Office Books, your Controversy Books, and teach your People all without Book?

But by this Counsel to your Relations, you fully show that you would have them to have no certainty at all, either what Christianity is, or what Popery is. For they shall never speak

with the *Universal Church,* or with a *General Council,* while they live: And all their. Neighbours, to whom you send them, are fallible Persons. I suppose you one of the chief of them, and alas, how fallible you are, you have in two Writings grossly showed.

Having said thus much more, to show that your Foundation is Sand, who send us from *Books* to our Grandfathers, as infallible and that this is no better a ground than the *Abassines, Greeks,* and others, may build on as well as you; and that we ourselves have a far surer and Universal Tradition than the Papacy hath, and have your own consent to every word of our Objective Religion, I now proceed to consider of your Character of Parties.

CHAP. II.

YOU describe to us four supposed Parties. I. The *Puritan.* II. The *Prelatical Protestant,* (whom your *Fitz-Simmons* calleth, The *Formalist.*) III. The *Papist,* as you suppose us *falsely to describe him.* IV. The *Papist,* as you suppose him *truly described,* whom you call *The Apostolical Christian.* In all which you show that you are far from Infallibility, and a man unfit for your Relations to trust in so great a Case.

I. I confess you give the *Puritan* a very laudable description, in comparison of the *Prelatist Protestant,* and the *feigned Papist.* And you tell us, that you were once a Puritan yourself, and you own still that which you describe as *Puritanism,* only adding *Popery* to it, which you think it wants. I confess you speak incomparably more honourably and charitably of *Puritans,* than some malicious interessed Persons, of their own Protestant Profession will do. But,

1. You deal not informingly, in your *describing* a *Puritan,* before you *distinguish* that *ambiguous* ill-made word. It hath three common acceptions among us at least.

First, The *ancientest,* as it signifieth the old or later *Catharists,* who held that they *were perfect* (if they are not belied:) And none come nearer these than the Papists and Quakers, certainly *Protestants* are far from it.

Secondly, the *old Non-conformists* had the name of *Puritans* put on them, by those that were against them: For what reason, I leave them to answer to God.

Thirdly, and because these *Non-conformists* lived *strictly,* and were for much preaching, and praying, and holy conference, and spending the Lord's-day in holy Exercises, and serious diligence in working out our Salvation, and were sharp against drunkenness, swearing, and such other sins, therefore the *vulgar Rabble* of vicious ones, that durst not rail at Piety under the name of Piety, took the advantage of the Bishops' displeasure at the Non-conformists, and of the name *Puritan,* and put that name upon all Christians among them, that were *notably serious in practical Godliness,* persuading themselves that they were all but *Hypocrites:* And so the name

among the *vulgar Rabble* grew common to *godly Conformists and Non-conformists:* And as if *loquendum cum vulgo* had been a Law, by this means the Devil did more hurt both to *godliness* (rendering it among the vulgar to he but odious Hypocrisy and Singularity) and to *Episcopacy* (making Multitudes that disliked the wickedness of the Rabble, to think that all this came from the Bishops,) and it did more to advance and honour the *Non-conformists,* (because the name was formerly *theirs* as such) than by any one thing that I remember in all my younger days. This the godly Conformists grievously complained of, (as Bishop *Downame* in his *Spittle Sermon,* called *Abraham's Trial,* and Mr. *Robert Bolton,* who saith, that he *believeth that never poor persecuted Word passed through the Mouths of wicked Men with more bitter scorn, since Malice first entered into the Heart of Man:*] Really the permitting of the common Rabble of all the debauched Sinners of the Land to make serious godliness a common scorn under the name of Puritanism, had as great a hand as anything I know in all our Confusions.

Fourthly, and it added Fuel to the Fire when some brought up a fourth sense of the Word (some say, *Mar. Ant. de Dom. Spalatensis* was the inventor of it,) and that was *Doctrinal Puritans,* by which name they understood those by some called *Calvinists,* by others *Anti-Arminians,* who held the Doctrine of your Dominicans, or of the Jansenists.

Now who can well tell which of these sorts of Puritans you *were,* and *talk of,* while you Characterize the *second sort,* as well as the *first,* and yet distinguish them from *Prelatic Protestants?*

2. But which ever it is, observe here that you own the *Puritans' Religion* still, and say, [*I have not so much left Puritanism, as Prelatics call it, as added that to it wherein I found it come short of the holy Apostles' Doctrine and Institutions,*] *p.* 1. And when you have described the Puritan as one seriously conscionable and regardful of his Salvation, (at large) you add, [*If this be to be a Puritan, would to God all the World were Puritans! I am so far from being Converted from thus much of a Puritan, that I most heartily wish I could Convert all the World to it.*]

3. But yet your description of him is so very false, that I may conclude when you turned, as you think, from being a mere Puritan to be a Papist, you never knew what a *Puritan is,* nor indeed ever were a *Puritan* yourself, unless you take the word as fitted to yourself, and such as you.

If you had meant by a *Puritan* a mere *Non-conformist* as such, you would not so laudably have described the work of God upon his Soul and Life as you have done: For if most Non-conformists be such, yet so are many others as well as they. And it's easy to see what a deceitful course it is to take up a name of many significations, and such as signifieth no different Religion at all, as to any one Article of Faith, nor any more difference in, or about Religion, than such as is among most Christian Churches; and much less than is among yourselves.

Besides that the plainer name of a *Non-conformist* is of no determinate nor certain signification, save only in general to notify one that Conformeth not to all that is imposed on him; but *what that is,* the *name* doth not signify.

A *Non-conformist* in *Scotland* is one thing, in *England* another thing, as the Impositions are different. Nonconformity twenty years ago, or forty years, was one thing. Non-conformity since 1662. is quite another thing. And Non-conformists differ among themselves: If twenty things be imposed as necessary to the Ministry, he is a Non-conformist who consenteth but to nineteen of them; and so is he that consenteth but to eighteen, or to seventeen, or to sixteen, and so on, as well as he that consenteth to none of them. And that there is so much difference among them is no wonder to them, nor any considerate Man; for they hold Christian Love and Communion with those that agree with them in the foresaid common Principles and Practice of Christianity, (as far as they require not them to sin:) And they are not of a different Religion from every one that *fasteth not on Fridays,* or *Saints' Vigils, &c.* as you seem to be, nor from every one that doth so; nor from every one that thinketh not in everything as they think, or that prayeth in other words than they; for no two Men in the World should on such Terms be of one Religion: They believe *Socrates* and

Sozomen, who tell us of the great diversity of Rites and Orders in the ancient Churches, which all consisted with the same Religion, Faith, and Love. They abhor the Principle of hating, persecuting, yea and separating from one another for such differences as will unavoidably adhere to the imperfect condition of Christians here on Earth.

At this time in *England* a considerable part (if not the far greatest) of the *silenced Ministers* are for the *Primitive Episcopacy*, and *some Liturgy*, as you may see in their offer of A. Bishop *Usher*'s *Reduction* to the King, and their desires of a *reformed Liturgy.* Among the *old Non-conformists*, there were divers degrees: such as Dr. *Regnolds*, Mr. *Perkins*, Dr. *Humfrey*, *Paul Bane, &c.* did yield to more than some others could do. How can you tell then by the name of a *Puritan*, what to charge any single Person with?

But it seemeth you take their *Non-conformity in General*, and their *temper of mind and life together.* But then you greatly wrong them, and seem not at all to know what their Religion is.

There are two things which you say they mistake in: 1. Their Doctrine of *Imputed Righteousness, and the Covenant, and not solicitously endeavouring after the acquisition of Virtue*, because they trust to the *Imputed Righteousness;*] your words are too large to recite: You partly here unworthily injure them by ascribing to them the very *opinions* and *words* of the *Antinomians*, whom they have better confuted than ever you did. And as to their Doctrine of *Imputed Righteousness*, even *Bellarmine* in one sense owneth it: And whether our sense be sound I provoke you to try particularly by your perusal of my own Writings on that Subject, especially a late *Treatise* of [*Justifying Righteousness* and Imputation,] and a Treatise called [*Catholic Theology:*] In which if there be nothing which you *dare* or *can* confute, judge whether your mere derision of [*Imputative Righteousness*] be not delusory: If you dare say, that *you trust not to Christ's Sacrifice, and meritorious perfect righteousness*, as procuring you *pardon and life*, (*Jus ad Impunitatem & Regnum Coelorum*,) enjoy your self-confidence while you can. But if you say in this *as we*, then make public Confession of the injury of your

reproach of such *Imputed Righteousness,* as you trust your salvation upon yourself.

I imagine you will say, that *my judgment* is no certain signification of the judgment of the Puritans; for I am *singular,* and therefore what I say in these Books is no proof of the sense of the Non-conforming Puritans. But, 1. *my* judgment of their sense is as good as *yours.* 2. Do you know of any one Nonconformist that hath published any dissent to what I have written? (Dr. *Tully* was a *Conformist.*) 3. You profess (before) to borrow the name [*Puritan*] from the *Prelatists.* And I have this to say for my Authority in declaring the sense of Puritans, that one or more (whose *genius* is of kin to the *Roman,* but far *less mild* than *yours*) who are Prelatical or super-Prelatical, have about 17 years ago (being Masters of that Language) branded me with the Name of [*Purus putus Puritanus, & qui totum Puritanismum totus spirat.*] (The *Pseudo-Tilenus* hath just the same style as the late *Unmasker of the Presbyterians, who revileth modest, judicious, pious, and peaceable J. Corbet,* and in the most ingenious strain of wrath and malice doth valiantly militate against *Love.*) Therefore Prelatists being Judges, I may as credibly as another tell you what is the *Puritan Judgment.*

2. Your second accusation of the Puritan is, that [*He begins to quarrel with all external Worship and Ceremonies.*] But this is also spoken ignorantly and untruly: You before mistook the *Antinomian* for the *Puritan,* and here you seem to take the *Separatist* for the *Puritan.* Read the Reformed Liturgy, and other Papers offered at the *Savoy* to the Bishops, and you may see that though they are not for *silencing, excommunicating,* and *damning men* for a *Ceremony,* nor for making as many Religions, as there are differences about Ceremonies, yet they are for doing all things to edification, decently and in order; and for *external* as well as *internal* Worship of God: As knowing that the *Body* is his, and made to Worship him as well as the *Soul,* and therefore should fall down and *kneel* before him, and reverently and holily behave itself in his Service.

You say, p. 5. [*He is much confirmed in this his imagination, by considering the open profaneness, and little sense of God, he ob-*

serveth generally in zealous Conformists. And on the other side he taketh notice of his Brethren the Non-conformists, that they are generally free from open and scandalous sins, and at least sigh and breath after interior spirit and devotion, which certainly must be that must give us a title to Heaven, rather than a few Cringes, and exterior Verbal Devotions, which any one though never so profane may easily exercise.]

1. But do you not here and in your former description quite contradict yourself, when you charge them as neglecting *inherent righteousness?*

2. We are not so foolish as not to know, that the unreverent hypocritical abuse of God's external Worship, by others whosoever, will not excuse us for neglecting it. Of the Conformists we must speak anon.

3. By the way I would you could impartially consider, if the Puritans be so good men, as you fairly confess them to be, what the reason is that Papists generally are far more fiery against them than against those whom you speak so meanly of as *Prelatical Protestants?* Remember how your Writer after the *London* Fire, answered by Dr. *Lloid,* did flatter these as more suitable to the Papists' *genius* in comparison of the Puritans: And the *Unmasker* against *J. Corbet* will tell you out of *Watson* (an honourable Witness hanged for Treason in *Cobham*'s, *&c.* Conspiracy) how bad the Puritans are, (comparing them with the Jesuits:) And if your Laws took place in *England,* what abundance of these Puritans would you make Bonfires of? yea your own Relations were not like to scape you. They have told me to my face, how quickly they would otherwise silence me than the Prelates do, if I were in their power. And the Decrees *De Haereticis comburendis & exterminandis* more fully tell it us. Yea, whence is it, that most certain experience proveth it, that by how much the nearer any Protestant's genius is to the Papists, by so much the more *bloody, cruel, malicious,* or *slanderous* and *unmerciful* he is to the *Puritans?*

You'll say for both, that it is because the *Puritans are most against them, and Interest ruleth the World.* But I answer, 1. God's Interest is highest with every true Christian: 2. I confess it's

true, that Puritans are most against Popery: But truly as far as I have been acquainted with them, they are not most against your *Persons,* nor would have any injustice or cruelty exercised against you: But the fear of your *Faggots,* or *Powder-Plots,* and such *Massacres* as were in *France,* (of Thirty Thousand, or Forty Thousand;) or in *Ireland,* (of Two Hundred Thousand,) hath made them think your *Power* inconsistent with their safety: 3. And you must remember that the *Positive Additions* of the Church of *Rome,* are in the Judgment of the Puritans very great sins: But you have truly no charge against the Puritans, for any one Article of their Religion; but only for *not receiving,* and for *protesting against your Additions.*

4. But I perceive, *p.* 5. your Instances of their defectiveness are, that they are not for [*fasting days, particular Garments for Priests, set Forms, Christmas-day, Good-Friday, Ascension, Whitsuntide,* &c. *which they take for mere Human inventions and Will-worship; Because they think that the New Testament was written to instruct us Christians in the whole Body of Gospel-worship, &c.*

But you are best prove this only by telling us that you know some persons of that mind: And when you have done, I will demand your Proof that those Persons are *no more* than Puritans: They have oft told you that their judgment is, that for all that substance of God's Worship which is of Universal necessity to the Church, and is of Divine Institution, the holy Scripture is a sufficient Rule: But that very many Circumstances and outward Acts have in Scripture but a General Law (that they be all done to edification, decently, orderly, in Concord, *&c.*) and it is left to Human Prudence to order them by such Rules: We condemn no one that useth holy Fasts or Feasts, but think them needful: We judge not those that celebrate the Memorial of God's great Mercies to his Church, by giving him thanks for the holy Life and Doctrine of his Eminent Saints, *&c.* But will you plainly have our judgment?

We think Saint *Paul* was in the right that taught the Church of *Rome* itself, both the *Rulers* and the Flocks, that they must neither *judge* nor *despise* each other for differences about Meats and Days, but *receive each other* (to Communion notwithstand-

ing such differences) as *Christ received us, Rom.* 14. and 15. And we will not believe your Grand-Father, nor Great-Grand-Father, if they told us that the Apostles by Tradition did institute Holy-days, and Vigils for St. *Tecla,* or St. *Bridgit,* or St. *Thomas Becket,* or any that were not born till they were dead: And any one *Day* or *Order* which you truly prove to us that the *Apostles* by Tradition ordained for the *Universal Church,* we profess ourselves ready and resolved to obey.

But if you plead not *Tradition* for any of *these things,* but the *Church's Commands,* (as you must do, or be singular, or ashamed;) here you come to the quick of our difference: 1. We know not of any *Universal Vicarious Law-giver* under Christ that hath any power to make Laws to the Universal Church throughout the World: and we dare not own any such *Usurper* lest we be guilty of Treason against the only Head of the whole Church.

2. We know not of any power that the chief Bishop in the *Roman* Empire hath over other Empires, Kingdomes, or Churches.

3. But to our own *true Pastors* which are set over us according to Christ's order and his Apostles' recorded in Scripture, we Puritans will submit in all such Circumstantials, as aforesaid, which are left to their prudent determination, not putting us on any sin.

But, 4. We detest making such things as you here name to be taken for the Characters of *distinct Religions,* or *distinct Churches,* as if we might not with Love, Peace, and Christian Communion, differ about a Garment, a Holy-day, Fast, or Vigil. Thus far then you seem not to know what a mere Puritan is.

II. But, Sir, I have much more than all these little things against your Description of a Puritan: I plainly perceive in your greatest praises of him, that you know not what his very Religion itself is; or else you would never describe him as only taken up with *fears and cares, and good desires to be better,* having yet *greedy desires of the things of the World,* without any mention of the *Love of God above all,* and of his *Neighbour,* and a *holy and*

heavenly Mind and Life, with *self-denial, mortification* of the *Flesh,* &c.

Either you judge of a *Puritan* by what you were *yourself,* or by what your *acquaintance* were, or by what they *commonly profess* to be their Religion.

For the first you have no reason: It followeth not that *they* have no better a Religion, because *you* had no better.

For the second you had no reason: For it's ten to one you knew not the hearts of your acquaintance, so well as to be able to know that they had not the *Love of God, &c.* And if you were so unhappy in your acquaintance, what's that to other Men?

Thirdly, Therefore as you look that your own Religion should be described, not as we find it in this or that man, but as your Church professeth it, so do we: And I have told you before what our Religion is. I have the more boldness in speaking the sense of others, as I said, both because I am as aforesaid stigmatized for a *total Puritan,* and because the generality of all of them of my acquaintance as far as I can discern are of this mind.

A *Puritan* then, as the Word is commonly taken by the Rabble, is a *serious Christian Protestant, who truly believeth and practiseth what he doth profess,* and doth not mortify that Profession which should help to mortify his Sin: His Religion is, to be understandingly and sincerely devoted in the Sacramental Covenant to God the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost; renouncing the Vanities of the World, the Lusts of the Flesh, and the Delusions of the Devil: He believeth that all that truly consent to this Covenant, have a right, and part, in, and to, the Love of God the Father, the Grace of the Son, and the Communion of the Holy Ghost; and that he that hath the Son hath Life, Pardon, Adoption, Justification, and Right to Life Eternal; and that this Right is continued, he performing his Covenant, and continuing in that Faith which worketh by Love, and not living impenitently in sin, but sincerely obeying God his Father, Saviour, and Sanctifier: He taketh the *fear* of God's Justice, and godly Sorrow, to be but the lower steps of Holiness; but that the Kingdom of God is (not Meats and

Days, but) Righteousness, Peace, and Joy in the Holy Ghost; and that the Spirit of Christ, without which none are his, is not the Spirit of Bondage, but of Power, Love, and a sound Mind; even a Spirit of holy LIFE, LIGHT, and LOVE, which are the Essentials of true Holiness; and the Spirit of Adoption, and Supplication, causeth us with Love to cry to God, and trust him as a Father: They take Christ to be the only Mediator between God and Man, whose sufficient Sacrifice for Sin, and perfect Righteousness, Habitual, Active, and Passive (as called) advanced in dignity by the Divine Nature, is the Meritorious cause of all their Mercies to Body and Soul, Remission, Justification, Holiness, and Glory: They put up all their Services, as into, and by, the Hand of Christ; and from his Mediatory Hand they expect all mercies: They take the Holy Ghost within them to be Christ's Advocate and Witness to them of his Truth and Love; and their Witness, Earnest, Seal, Pledge, and first Fruits of endless Life: They take Eternal Glory for their full Felicity, and this World, and Flesh, (Pleasure, Riches, and Honour,) to be so far useful as they signify God's Love, and further our Love and Service to him; but to be *Vanity* as separated from God in our Hearts, and Enmity, or Mischief, as Competitors, or as against him. In a word, Faith working by Supreme Love and Obedience to God, and Brotherly Love to Man, by Honour to our Superiors, Justice to all; and by all the good that we can do in the World, and by Repentance for our Sins, patience in sufferings, and by a Heavenly Mind, and Life, is the Sum of their Religion; or plainlier as is said at first, The Gospel-Covenant as expounded in the Creed, Lord's Prayer, and Decalogue, as the Summary of things to be believed, desired, and practised; and the holy Scriptures as the full and comprehensive Records of the Doctrine, Promises, and Laws of God, containing the Essentials, Integrals, and necessary Accidentals of Religion. This is the Christian Religion, and the Puritan in question is but the SERIOUS CHRISTIAN distinct from the HYPOCRITE, or dead Formalist.

But if you add *Non-conformity* to the sense of the Word, and to his Character; so I need not tell you what the Impositions are which some deny Conformity to, as to Oaths, New-Covenants, Subscriptions, Declarations, Practices, *&c.* which he protesteth that he would never deny Conformity to, if after his best enquiry he did not believe that God forbiddeth it: (As you may see at large in their *Savoy Petition for Peace* to the Bishops.) These two it seems you join together; and what their Objective Religion is, I have better told you, than you have told your Relations. But as to the clearness of their Judgment in it, and the measure of their Practice of it, there are, I think, as various Degrees as there are Persons, no two Men in the World being in all things just of the same Degree.

And now Sir give me leave patiently to ask you these two Questions: 1. Why would you by temerity go about to deceive your Relations, and other Readers, by talking to them against that which you did not understand? Even then, when you blame others as dealing so by the Papists? And why do you dishonour your own Relations so, as to make so bad a Description of them? Are they such as have *no Love to God as God, no delight in Holiness, no Heavenly Minds? nothing almost but fear and its effects?* Have they *still the Flames of Concupiscence,* and greedy *desires of Money* and the *things of this Life, &c.* If it be not so, you should not have told the World so of them: If it be so, I am sorry for them: I suppose it is contrary to their professed Religion; and you may have the greater hopes to make them Papists?

II. What wonder is it that you that were no better a Puritan than you describe, are turned Papist? You that profess you were a Puritan, must needs be judged to tell us what a one you were yourself, when you tell us what they are? Alas poor Man! How came you to be so false to your own Profession, against your Baptismal Vows, as to keep so much of the World at your Heart, in greedy desires after Money, and to have no more Love to God and Man? no more Righteousness, Peace, and Joy in the Holy Ghost? Could you think that a Man could

be saved without *Love and good works?* Were you deluded by such *Antinomian* conceits as you describe, and took that for Puritanism? How else did you quiet your Conscience in such a state of Hypocrisy? If God and Holiness had not your chief Love (as well as Fear) you were but an Hypocrite.

And here give me leave to repeat what I have oft written: What wonder is it at any Man's turning Papist? when according to your own Principles, no Protestant, Puritan, or other Christian turneth Papist, that doth not thereby declare that he was a false-hearted Hypocrite before, and had no true Love to God in his Heart: And was not this your case? For, 1. You affirm that all Men that have true prevalent Love to God are in a state of Grace, and have right to Salvation, (till they lose it:) 2. You affirm that none of us are in a state of Grace and Salvation, that are not of your Church, that is, the Subjects of the King, or Pope of *Rome:* 3. Therefore it followeth that you take none but such Subjects or Members of your Church, to have the true prevalent Love of God. But you know that in our Christian Covenant and Profession we all take God for our God, the infinite and most amiable Good, our Father in Christ, and Love itself, and that Faith working by Love is our Religion: *And if any Man,* saith Saint *Paul, love not the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be Anathema Maranatha:* And he *that loveth the World, the Love of the Father is not in him,* 1 *Joh.* 2. 15. So that by turning Papist you confess that before you were no true Christian, nor had any true Love to God and Godliness, nor to Jesus Christ: And if so, you were a false-hearted Hypocrite: For as a Christian you professed and Covenanted it. And what wonder then if God forsook you and gave you up to strong delusions, when you would not receive the Truth in the Love of it, that you might be saved, 2 *Thes.* 2.

And note here, that if any Man know that he truly loveth God and Goodness, you tell him that he is none of those that you persuade to Popery: For you persuade none to it, but those that are ungodly Hypocrites, having no true Love of God within them.

But can you think, Sir, in good earnest, that Popery tendeth more to fill Men with the Love of God, than our simple Christianity doth? Is not Popery a Religion of Bondage and Servitude, consisting mainly in Terror, and its superstitious effects? What are most of your Tasks of Pilgrimages, Penances, and abundance such, but the effects of servile fear? The best of Religion next Heaven should be that which is nearest to Heaven. And do you think you can love God better in the *Fire* of Purgatory Torments, than if he took you unto Christ in Paradise? Could you love God better in this Life, if he tormented you in the Fire, than if he give you comfort by his mercies?

You say that the Puritan [*is made negligent* (by his trust in Christ) *to adorn his Soul with Piety, Charity, Meekness, Patience, Humility, and other Christian Virtues; partly thinking them impossible to be attained, partly deeming there is no absolute necessity of them to his Salvation, he having nothing to do but to believe that Jesus Christ hath done all for him.*] *Answ.* I had hoped there had been few such left in *England:* Even *Crisp* and *Saltmarsh,* were scarce so erroneous: And *were you* such a one? O miserable Man that was such a Puritan! Who did bewitch you so grossly to contradict the whole Tenor of the Gospel? It is just with God to leave you, to set now as light by the *Meritorious Righteousness of Christ* as procuring you Pardon, Grace, and Glory, as you did then set by *Christian Virtues, Piety, and Love?* But what if it was so with you, will that allow you to belie so many others? How many score Volumes have the Puritans written which assert not only the possibility, but the absolute necessity of Piety, Charity, Humility, *&c.* without which none can see God, (Infants Case is not here meddled with.) I know not one Person in all the Land, or World, that will not abhor, as false, what you here charge in common on the Puritans, unless he be a very gross Antinomian, or some grosser Heretic here unknown: Protestants, Puritans, Separatists, Anabaptists, yea, Quakers, all abhor it: And yet you feared not to put this in Print? Perhaps you will pretend for it the Doctrine of Justification by Faith alone? But they that say that Faith alone going first with Repentance, doth justify

them, by procuring the pardon of their sins, and their Union with Christ, do say that at the same moment of time it also sanctifieth them, by procuring from Christ the Spirit of Sanctification, giving them Love, Humility, Piety, *&c.* And that this is of absolute necessity to their Salvation, *Heb.* 12. 14. *Mat.* 18. 3. *Rom.* 8. 1. 6. 7. 13. So much of your false self-condemning description of a Puritan.

CHAP. III.

II. YOU next Characterize the *Prelatical Protestant:* Having said before *p.* 5. [*Their Preachers in their Sermons have little Life or Zeal; and seldom discourse of such Truths as are apt to awaken Men's Consciences, and make them lay to heart the great concern of the Salvation of their Souls. Or if they do at any time preach of Judgment, or of Hell, Repentance, or a New Life, they do it very coldly and imperfectly, and seem to talk like Parrots, of what they have learnt by rote or out of others Books, and not what they have had any experience of in their hearts.*] And *p.* 6. [*Generally speaking,* (*I wish it were a slander*) *Prelatic Protestants are very Profane, and give no signs of any interior trouble of Conscience: And if any of them begin to be heartily troubled for his sin, he is observed either to turn Fanatic or Papist.*]

Answ. If by a *Prelatic Protestant* you should unhandsomly mean only such as are *worldly Clergy-men,* like too many of your *Roman* Prelates and their Curates, who take Gain for Godliness, and who allow their Flesh, their Pride, their Covetousness, and Voluptuousness, and Sloth, to choose their Religion; whose God is their Belly, who glory in their shame, and who mind Earthly things, and are Enemies to Cross-bearing; and through Enmity to those that are better than themselves, are Cross-imposers, and Persecutors, and Silencers, of sober faithful Ministers, because they cross their Pride and worldly Interest; such it's like may be no better Men than you describe them. But why should you take the Word in so narrow a sense?

But if by *Prelatic Protestants* you mean all such Protestants whose judgment is for Episcopacy, 1. You deceive, and I suppose are deceived, in your distinguishing these from *Non-conformists:* It's true that there are envious false-hearted Prelatists in the World, that make false names for their Brethren, to procure the belief of their false reports of them: And God will cut out the lying Tongue. But I will tell you the truth, whose malice soever is against it; there are *Episcopal* as well as *Presbyterian* and *Independent Non-conformists* now: Yea, divers that are against the late Wars of

the Parliament, and against the Covenant, and never took it, and some that have been Soldiers for the King, and suffered for him: Yea so considerable is the number of them that are *Episcopal,* that in 1660. when the King called them to treat in order to agreement, they offered him *no other Form of Church Government, than A. Bishop* Usher's *Reduction,* in which not a *Pin of Honour,* nor one Farthing of *their Revenue* was desired to be taken from Archbishops, Bishops, Deans, Archdeacons; but only the Parish Ministers enabled under them, to have done somewhat more that belongeth to their Office, instead of Lay-Chancellors, *&c. Most Non-conformists* of my acquaintance would be glad of the terms contained in the King's Declaration about Ecclesiastical Affairs, where Bishops and Archbishops are left as rich and high as they were before: So far are *Non-conformists* [*Episcopal Protestants.*]

2. And though *Conformity* be very much changed from what it was heretofore, *Episcopacy* is not. And I must tell you, that I do not think that the Christian World hath more godly learned worthy Ministers, than many of the Episcopal were heretofore. Do you know what men Bishop *Jewel,* A. Bishop *Grindall,* and many more of old were? And A. Bishop *Usher,* Bishop *Hall,* Bishop *Davenant,* and many more of late? Who hath written more earnestly and hotly for Episcopacy, than Bishop *Downame* (who wrote the great Latin Book to prove the Pope Antichrist;) yet who that knew him did ever question his piety or diligence? And if you look to the old Conformable Presbyters, read their Books, and enquire of the Lives of many of them, and then confess that they were better men and better Preachers than you describe. Peruse the Writings of Mr. *Rob. Bolton, William Whateley, William Fenner,* Dr. *Preston,* Dr. *Sibbes,* Dr. *Stoughton,* Dr. *Gouge,* Mr. *Thomas Gataker,* Mr. *Crook,* and abundance of such others, and enquire how they laboured and lived, and you may hear that they were neither such *Parrots* nor *profane* ones as you mention.

There may be some proportionable alteration supposed to be now made in the persons of the Conformists, answerable

to that which is made in Conformity itself: But surely, if you know *London,* and many Miles near it, and many Parishes in the several Counties, you must confess that now there are many Learned, Pious Conformists, who Preach zealously, and live religiously, and hate Covetousness and Persecution, and long to see the promoting of Piety, Peace, and Concord.

But if you expect a better Vindication of them, I must desire you to consider of two things. 1. That in most Countries and Ages the *worldliest men* (that is, the *worst*) have been the greediest strivers and seekers for Church-Power and Preferments; and he that seeketh most diligently is the likeliest to find: And that ordinarily the Vulgar do dance after the Pipe of him that is uppermost, and will be of the Religion of them that can help or hurt them, be it what it will be. Most will be of the Religion which is owned by Law, or countenanced by the Greatest, be it right or wrong. In the best Countries, the most are too bad: And bad men will have a prospering Religion, and not one that will expose them to Death, Banishment, Imprisonment, Beggary, Contempt, or Silence. Most will be on the upper side.

2. And remember that you yourself here confess the scandals of some of your Romish Party, and what carnal profane ones they are. Had you not confessed it, I would have desired you to read two Books, 1. *Josep. Acosta,* of the wicked slothful Priests in the *Indies,* as the great hindrance of their Conversion. 2. *Stephanus* his World of Wonders, taken most out of the Book of the Queen of *Navarre,* of the horrid Villainies of your Priests.

And one thing I cannot disregard: I marvel not if the Papists be most bad in *Spain, France, Italy, &c.* or the *Lutherans* in *Denmark, Saxony,* or *Sweden;* or the *Calvinists* in *Holland;* or the Prelatists and Conformists in *England;* because the *most* (who are commonly the *worst*) will be of the stronger side. But that *Greeks* should be ungodly in *Turkey,* or *Protestants* in *France,* or *Papists* in *England,* where they are *singular,* and under the discountenance of the Times, and most hold their Religion with some *self-denial,* this seemeth to me a more grievous thing.

And if it prove true, that even in *England,* where you make the World believe that you have suffered grievously, your Followers are too often found mere *Formalists,* living in Swearing, Drinking, Lying, Uncleanness, or some of *these,* what shall we think of such a Religion as this, as in a Land of uprightness would teach men to do unjustly? I wonder not what should make a Drunkard, Fornicator, or other debauched Sinner to be a Papist in *France, Spain,* or *Italy:* But what should make such a one be a Papist in *England,* unless his Religion favour sensuality, *or else* he think that it will yet prove the upper side, I cannot easily conjecture.

But you accuse the *Prelatic Protestant* for *agreeing with the Puritan in expecting Salvation by the extrinsical righteousness of Christ without him, not by any interior righteousness in his own Soul.*] *Answ.* I told you your memory faileth you: Why did you before then describe the Puritan as so well qualified within, and desiring after more? But were you bred among Puritans, and yet talk so ignorantly and falsely? This had been more tolerable in a *Cochleus,* a *Genebrard,* or other transmarine Calumniator, that never knew us here. Read but *Davenant de Just.* and see how you slander the Conformists. And read my forenamed Books, and Mr. *Trumans,* Mr. *Woodbridges,* the Morning Lectures at S. *Giles* of *Justif.* Mr. *Wotton de Reconciliat.* Mr. *Bradshaw de Justif. Praefat. &c.* Mr. *Gataker* in many Books, *Jo. Goodwin* of Justif. *&c.* and see how you slander the Puritans. In a few plain words, Sir, the Protestants do not expect Salvation by their own personal righteousness as coordinate with Christ's, but as subordinate to it, nor as a Righteousness so denominated from the same *Reason* as Christ's is, but from a lower Reason, and so as of a lower sort. That is, [We all hold, that God's Law to perfect man was perfect, being the Effect of his perfect Holiness, and required personal perpetual perfect innocency and obedience in man: And that man breaking this Law, was according to the Justice of it liable to its Penalty, which is temporal, spiritual, and eternal death, or to be forsaken of that God whom he forsook, and to be under the sense of his displeasure, or Justice: We believe that

Christ Redeemed us from this Punishment, by the merit of his perfect Holiness and Obedience, and the satisfactory sacrificing of himself on the Cross, where he was in his measure forsaken of God, as in our stead and for our sins; whose punishment, as far as was fit for him to undergo, he voluntarily undertook to suffer. We believe that he never intended by this Redemption, to take man from under his subjection to God, or make him an ungoverned lawless Wight; but that by purchase he himself, as Mediator, became his Lord and King, and God's chief Administrator of the Redeemed World: And his Lord-Redeemer, with the Will and Authority of God his Creator, made him a new Law and Covenant, *freely giving Right to Impunity* (saving paternal healing Corrections, and temporal death, and degrees of desertion if men neglect Grace) and *Right* to the *Heavenly Glory,* as thus merited for us by Christ; and also the Communion of the Holy Ghost on Earth, to fit us by Holiness for Heaven, and to conquer our sins; and this to all that will by a true effectual Faith, accompanyed with Repentance, unfeignedly accept the Gift of God, that is, that will truly consent to the Baptismal Covenant, taking God for their reconciled God and Father, Jesus Christ for their Saviour, and the Holy Ghost for their Sanctifier and Comforter, renouncing the Devil, the World, and the Flesh, and engaging themselves as in a Holy War against them, as the Enemies of the blessed Trinity, and them. And this Covenant they must keep: For as it giveth Right to Life to such Believers, so it denounceth certain damnation to Unbelievers and unthankful Neglecters of so great Salvation.

So that when by [RIGHTEOUSNESS] we mean that which answereth God's perfect Law, having no sinful imperfection, we all profess that we have no such Righteousness of our own to trust in, there being no man without sin; and all sin by the Law of Innocency denominating the sinner unrighteous and punishable by death: But instead of such a Righteousness, God's Justice is so far satisfied by the Sacrifice and perfect Righteousness of Christ, as that he freely giveth us the foresaid Covenant, and its Free Grace and Benefits: But be-

cause we must be judged by the Redeemer according to his Law of Grace, therefore we must in ourselves personally have the Righteousness which that Law or Covenant hath made necessary to our Justification first, and our Salvation afterwards; which is first our foresaid Faith or Covenant-Consent, and after (to our salvation) our keeping of that Covenant in true Obedience and Holiness to the end, and our Victory over the three Enemies which we renounced. So that briefly, God justifieth as the Donor and the Judge: Christ God and Man, as Mediator, justifieth us *meritoriously,* as aforesaid, and by *donation* and *final* sentence; our *Jus ad Impunitatem & Gloriam,* our Right to *Impunity* and the *Heavenly Glory,* justifieth us as our *Formal Righteousness* (which is a Relation) against the Accusation that we ought to be shut out of Heaven and damned to Hell. The Covenant of Grace justifieth us, by giving us Right to the Love of the Father, the Grace of the Son, and the Communion of the Holy Ghost: Even as God's Donative and Condonative Instrument, or Act of Grace. Our Personal Faith including Repentance justifieth us, as the matter of our Formal Righteousness, against that particular Accusation, that we are *Impenitent Unbelievers,* and so have no part in Christ and his Covenant Gift. And our sincere, though imperfect, Holiness added to our Faith, is our material Righteousness, against that particular Accusation, that we are unholy, and so unqualified for Heaven: So that the formal Nature of Righteousness being Relative, and the word having various senses according to the variety of respects, and all these fore-mentioned having their several parts or offices, to the Being of our final perfect Justification, all these may accordingly be the Reasons of our expectation of salvation. I forgot to adde, that we are so far justified by the *Holy Ghost* also, as he is the Author of this Holiness, which is our necessary qualification for eternal life. 1 *Cor.* 6. 10. 11. *Tit.* 3. 3, 4, 5.

I have here truly, distinctly, and plainly told you the Protestant and Puritan, that is, the *Christian Doctrine* of Justification.

As to the sense of the word [*Imputing*] see how we do, or do not own it, briefly in Mr. *Bradshaw*'s Preface, or largely in

my *Treat. of Justifying Righteousness and Imputation.* And in my *Cathol. Theolog.* I have done you and Christianity the service, to prove by plain Citations, that many of your Learnedest Divines do say herein the same as we, or very little differ from us; and if you will as a Make-bate prove the contrary, you will do it to the Dissenters shame. If you trust not Christ alone, as we do, you will find the want of a Saviour in your necessity, and Purgatory will not serve your turn.

But you tell us, that [*Some of the Prelatic Clergy begin to scoff at the Doctrine of Imputative Justice: One of them lately, in a Sermon before his Majesty, called it, and not improperly, the Mummery of Imputative Justice.*] I will transcribe no more of your Scoff: It's dangerous mocking at such matters: *Imputed Righteousness* is oft mentioned by the Holy Ghost in Scripture. It is not some men's mis-exposition that will justify your derision. It's no strange thing for men of undigested thoughts on both sides, publicly and privately to revile at each other as erroneous, when if they had but the skill of speaking distinctly, and understanding one another, they would presently profess that they are agreed; or if it be for want of understanding the matter, it's pity but they should be quiet till they understand it. I am of their mind that think it is here safest to keep close to Scripture phrase; for want of which many wrangle about their own ambiguous or ill made words, that in the matter disagree not.

But, Sir, when you say, *pag.* 6. [*An Imputative holy man is a mere Christmas Mummer;*] And after your jesting with the Boys and Girls, and the Cobblers' and Botchers' Regal Attire, and the Daw and her fine Feathers, you conclude [*such will be the sad Lot of merely Imputative Saints, who to themselves and their Brethren seem very fine in the extrinsical Righteousness of Christ, put on by their fantastical Faith, whilst God and his Angels under all this conceited assumed Bravery see a lascivious, wanton, covetous Miser.*] I must crave leave to call upon your Conscience, to judge whether a man that professeth that while he seemed a Puritan he was *but an unholy, lascivious, wanton, and covetous miser,* and since his turning Papist tells the World in Print, that

he is now a *most false calumniator,* be a fit person to invite his Relations to such a pitiful change, to save their Souls? While you talked but of [*Imputative Justice*] some men's ambiguous words gave you an excuse: For some Protestants think that nothing should be called *Justifying Righteousness,* which is not sinless and perfect: But this is but a Controversy about a *Word* or *Name* of Righteousness. But when you here pretend, that they are for *merely Imputed Holiness,* I must say that I remember not that ever I read a more impudent Slander: And he that will dwell in God's holy Hill must not receive a false Report, especially in despite of the fullest evidence that man can desire: Are not our Booksellers Shops full of Books for the necessity of personal Holiness? and that none can be saved but Saints? Is it not one of our dislikes of your Way, that Saints must be made rare Canonized Persons, when all Christians hold, that without Holiness none shall see God? When almost all the Sermons that ever I heard Preached by any man of sense in my life professed this, and almost all our Books are on this very subject, who would have thought that a man on earth could have been found, that would deny it in the open face of the Sun? Yea, one that saith he was a Puritan, and an University Student? Even when the poor Puritans are ruined, and hunted about, and cast into Goals, because they dare not give over preaching the *necessity of Personal Holiness to salvation* (for that is the most of all their Sermons that ever I heard) dare you stand forth with such an accusation as this? as if they held no Holiness necessary but Imputative? Why then are we devoted in Baptism to the Holy Ghost? Yea what are the very Separatists more accused of, than that they would have none but real Saints in their Communion, too far presuming to judge the Heart? You seem a zealous man, though very ignorant; I pray you study not to excuse this, but let us hear that you as openly repent as you have sinned.

The most of your further dealing with the *Prelatic Protestant,* is to tell him that his Ritual Principles lead him to turn Papist, or else he cannot answer the Puritan: I take not myself any further fit to interpose herein, than to tell you, that

in all things truly Indifferent, there is a just middle between any mistaken Scruplers that hold them sinful, and a Papist that maketh them a part of his Christianity or Religion, and will not be of the same Religion and Church with those that be not of his mind, nor will willingly suffer them to preach or live. I told you that S. *Paul,* and the Churches described by *Socrates* and *Sozomen* (about *Easter*) were of this middle way: They neither thought Liturgies or Ceremonies so bad (or unlawful at all,) as some on one side called Puritans do, not so necessary as to make them a Partition Wall between Churches and Churches, or to forbid Communion, or the Preaching of Christ's Gospel, or Christian Peace, to those that differ about them. And I think this middle way is approved by God and Angels, and by many at death, or after long experience, who were against it before in prosperity and passion.

The Instances which you give, are,

I. That [*the Prelatic Protestant is very angry with the Puritan, that he will not abstain from Flesh in* Lent, *on* Fridays, Emberdays, *and* Vigils *of Saints—Though practically speaking nobody takes less notice of them than himself—And the poor Puritan, because he will not solemnly invite the People to observe, what himself never intends to take the least notice of, must for this be silenced and suspended both from Office and Benefice.*]

Answ. 1. Here you show what things they be that you turn Papist for: Is not eating Flesh on *Fridays, Lent,* or *Vigils,* a worthy matter to make another Religion of, or to prove men to be of differing Churches?

2. I told you before, that the Puritans' judgment is as *Paul*'s, that such things should be left indifferent, or at least make no breach among us; by our *judging* or *despising* one another: And that neither the Pope, nor any men on Earth, have Authority to make Universal Laws for them to all the Christian World; and that there is no true Tradition of Apostolical Institution of them: But yet that such Fasts and Feasts as are appointed by true Authority of Prince or Pastors, not against the Laws of God, and such as shall be proved to be instituted by the Apostles, they will observe.

3. But the *poor Puritan* is indeed in hard Circumstances, were there no life after this! Some of them have no Flesh to eat, either on *Fridays,* or any day in the Week, but live thankfully upon Bread and Milk, and some such things; Fish they would gladly eat, if they could get it. There are now among them such as with many Children have for a long time lived almost only on brown Rye-bread and Water: Many of them take it for a sufficient quantity to eat one temperate Meal a day, though they are in no want; and the Papist that forbeareth Flesh, and eateth better than the Puritan feasteth with, or that fasteth with one Meal a day, which is many Puritans' fullest Diet, doth condemn the poor Puritan as an Heretic, and perhaps burn him at a Stake, or cast him into the Inquisition, for not Fasting. Poor *John Calvin* did eat but one small Meal a day, and the Papist who fast much at the rate as *Calvin* feasted, record him for a gluttonous person. And so did the Pharisees by Christ and his Disciples; *why do not thy Disciples fast, &c.*

II. Your second Instance is, [*The Prelatic Protestant wonders the Puritan should scruple adorning the Communion Table, with two Wax Tapers, &c.*]

Ans. The former Answer serveth to this: Hear, O ye Puritans, wherein the *Roman* Religion doth surpass yours! Their Altars have lighted *Tapers on:* Do you not deserve to be burnt yourselves, if you will not burn Candles on your Altars?

Yea the Pope, who hath power to set up and take down Emperors and Kings, being not only the King of *Rome,* but the Monarch of the whole World, doth appoint these Lights as a Professing *sign* [*before God and Man that he is of that Church which in the Primitive Times for fear of Persecution served. God by Candle-light in Dens and Caves,*] And is not this to prove the *immutability* of their Church, that vary not in a *Circumstance* from the *Apostolical Institution?* Doth his domineering over Kings and Nations, and the Hosts of Great Princes, Cardinals, Prelates, Abbots, Clergy, Regulars, Seculars, that obey him, show also that he is of that *old Candle-lighted Church?*

But while you seem still to plead *Apostolical Tradition* for all these Great Parts of your Religion, tell the poor Puritan, whether it was by Prophecy, or how else, that the Apostles delivered to the Church the use of these *Lighted Tapers,* in commemoration of that which was done in *Dens* long after the death of these Apostles? I doubt rather, the Pope doth by this practice condemn himself, and sets up these Lights to show the World how much he and his Church are changed since those forementioned days.

III. You next say, [*The Prelatic Protestant wonders what hurt the Puritan can see in making the sign of that on the forehead of a new baptized Infant, yet smiles at a Papist when he makes it on himself, or his Victuals, &c.*]

Ans. None of us are ashamed of the Cross of Christ, nor loth to profess this as openly as you: But if we do it by *Word,* by *Writing,* by *Obeying,* or by *Suffering,* we are of another Religion from you, (it seems by you,) unless we will do it also by *crossing:* The *Jews* were the *Crossmakers:* And there are now so many *Cross-makers* in the World, whose Trade we like not, that we are not forward to set up *their sign* at *our doors.* But yet there are Puritans and Prelatists, that were they among the Deriders of a Crucified Christ, where the use were not a Formality, or worse, but convenient to tell the Infidels their mind, that they are *not ashamed of the Cross of Christ,* would not refuse seasonably to Cross themselves. But the Puritans think, that when it is made [*a solemn stated sign of the Duty and Grace of the New Covenant, dedicating there by the person to God, as one hereby obliging himself to profess the Faith of Christ Crucified, and manfully to fight under his Banner* against the Devil, the World, and the Flesh to the death, *in hope of the Benefits of his Cross and Covenant, and so is made a Badge or Symbol of our Christianity,*] then it is made a *Sacrament of the Covenant of Grace, added to Christ's Sacrament of the same use;* or at least *too like it,* though the *Name* be denied it: And they think that Christ hath given none power to make *such new Sacraments or Symbols of Christianity;* he having done that sufficiently himself. They have a conceit that the King would not be pleased with them that ei-

ther frame a new *Oath of Allegiance* added to his, as the *Badge* of his *Subjects' Loyalty,* nor yet that would make a new *Badge* of the *Order of the Knights of the Garter,* without his consent. At least, the Puritans think that *Baptism, and Christianity, and Christian Burial should not be denied to those Children, whose Parents do not offer them to be baptized with this additional Symbol:* And if the poor men be deceived in such thoughts, it is but in fear of sinning against Christ, and not that they are more ashamed of his Cross than you, or more disobedient to Authority.

IV. Your next instance is, [*The Prelatic Protestant wonders that the Puritan can doubt the holy Euchrist is really and truly the body of Christ,* &c.] And you cite Dr. *Cosins Hist. Transub. p.* 44.

Answ. 1. The *Prelatic Protestant* and the *Puritan* differ not at all about the real presence of Christ's body in the Sacrament, as I have showed you elsewhere. What need you more proof than King *Edwards* old Rubric against the Real Presence in a gross sense, lately restored to the Liturgy. And as for Dr. *Cosins* words and book, I again tell you, all the Doctors of the Roman Church are never able to answer his full proof that Transubstantiation is a late innovation; and none of the doctrine of the ancient Churches. We challenge you all to give any reasonable answer to that book: And you still Cunningly balk the main Controversy between us and you, which is not whether *Christ's Body be* there, but whether *Bread and Wine be* there. For I have told you, 1. That we who know not how far a Glorified Spiritual Body is extensive and invisible to us, cannot tell you where it is present or absent, no more than of an Angel. 2. But we all hold, as a piece of Plate or Silver Barrs, is really and truly turned into the King's Coin, so the Bread and Wine is really and truly turned into Christ's *Sacramental Body and Blood;* and yet one is *Silver* and the other is *Bread and Wine* still: The change is *true, but Relative* by its Separation to that holy use: as a Common person may be Really Changed into a *King,* or a *Lord,* or a *Judge,* or a *Captain,* or a *Bishop,* or a *Doctor,* and yet be a *man* still. This *real* change we all Confess. But the question is, whether there be *no Bread.*

V. You say [*The Prelatic Protestant wonders* that the *Puritan when he is going out of this world should find difficulty to make a particular Confession of his sins, if any grievous matter lie on his Conscience, and humbly desire the Prelatic Priest's absolution, saying &c.*].

Answ. I know of no difference between the Prelatist and the Puritan about *Confession* or *Absolution.* Dr. John *Reynolds* a true Puritan, received *Absolution* before he dyed: Mere Puritans believe that it is a duty to Confess our sins to men. 1. In Case of such injury to any as must have a Confession towards the injured persons *Satisfaction:* and *forgiveness.* 2. In Case of such difficulty about either the nature of the *sin,* or *Consequent dangers* or *dutyes,* as make a particular Guide necessary, who cannot resolve our doubts till he know the Case. 3. In Case that the Conscience be so burdened with the sin, as that the sinner cannot by other means find ease, till he have disburdened himself by such Confession. 4. In Case it be necessary to heal any scandal given to others; It is a very great duty for drunkards, fornicators, deceivers, and such others to go to their Companions, and lament their sin, and persuade them no more to do as they have done: And if required by the Pastors to take public shame before the Congregation, and acknowledge that the doctrine of Christ never countenanced them in any such sin, that Religion and the Church may not bear the reproach of their delinquency. And to beg the prayers of the Congregation for their pardon, and that the Pastor by virtue of his office will pronounce it.

But we are not ashamed to confess that neither Puritans nor Prelatists think it lawful to make the people believe that they must needs tell the Priest of all the sins that they commit, and dutyes that they omit; Nor to uphold pragmatical Priests in the trade of knowing all men's thoughts and secret actions, even Princes, by which they may betray them. 1. The number of people and of their sins, is so great as render it impossible: In this Parish it's thought there is above threescore thousand souls: How many thousand sinful thoughts, or words or deeds a great part of these may commit in a year, I leave to

your Conjecture: only I must tell you that if all men High and Low, that are called Papists about us, should but tell the Priest of every time they are drunk, and every Fornication they have committed, every profane Oath they have sworn, every Lie they have told, (especially against the Protestants,) and of every filthy and profane Word that they have spoken, and every Oppression of the poor, and every filthy or covetous thought that hath been in their hearts, they had need of a very Traditional Memory to remember them, or great plenty of Ink and Paper to record them, and a whole Diocess of Clergy-men in one Parish to hear them. How many hundred Priests must this Parish have, if all should thus confess all sins of Commission and Omission? every cold Prayer, and omitted Prayer, Exhortation, Alms, Example, *&c.* especially the great Omissions of the Soul, in the defects of the exercise of Faith, Hope, Love, and Patience, *&c.*

2. And what good will it do a man, that is himself of sound understanding and integrity, to open his Conscience to an ignorant or unconscionable man, that will call evil good, and good evil, and will put him upon sin; as you here do by your Relations; or that dare himself sin as boldly as you here do, when you accuse Puritans and Prolates as holding *mere Imputed Holiness.*

3. And how great a temptation and injury may this be to your Priests, in such instances as *Montaltus* the *Jansenist* mentioneth, with which I will not defile my Paper? when, alas! most of them are not men fit to bear such temptations: What if twenty thousand People in one Parish should each make this Confession to a Papist Priest, [*I am afraid I have sinned in believing the common Report, that you are a very ignorant drunken sot; and a common whoremaster, and a proud, covetous lying man;*] would it not be like to enrage the Priest into an enmity against his Flock? If all the Fornicators in such a Parish should tell such Priests of all their filthy thoughts, and words, and their *immodest actions,* and *actual Fornications;* how like were it to make such impressions on the poor Priest's Fantasy, as would pollute him with many filthy imaginations.

VI. You adde, [*The Prelatic Protestant wonders at the Puritan's niceness, that he can by no means be persuaded to bow at the Name of Jesus: When Nature teacheth us a Relative Reverence, &c. The sound of the Name Jesus is vanished and gone, before the superstitious Worshipper can make his mimical Congie: Whereas the Picture, a far more lively representation of the same great Lord, remains.*]

Ans. 1. The Puritans think it not unlawful to bow when God or Jesus are named. But, 1. They are loth to serve those men, that would turn all serious Religion into a dead Image of it. 2. And they like not bowing at the Name Jesus, and not at the Name [*God*], or [*Christ,* or *Immanuel,* or *Jehovah,* or the *Holy Ghost.*]

2. As to Images, I will but refer you to Dr. *Stillingfleet*'s last Book against *Godwin,* which hath fully proved, that you use them as truly Idolatrously as did the Heathens.

VII. Your next Instance is, [The *Conformists* rejecting the Popish *Girdle, Stole,* and *Casuble,* and yet wondering at the *Puritans'* rejecting the *Surplice.*]

Ans. The former Answers serve to this: Some *Puritans* would use the Surplice, if that would serve and satisfy. But they see, that if they say [*A*] first, they must say [*B*] next, and so on to the end of your Alphabet. But still you tell us what great things your new Religion doth consist of, and what great cause you had to turn from the Puritans to the Papists? If you had known no more than Books can tell you, and your Grandfather had not known better than *Baronius* himself, what the Apostles did and instituted, we should never have known that the Religion which is integrated by a *Surplice, Girdle, Stole,* and *Casuble,* had been herein Apostolical, and not rather a novel thing.

VIII. Your eighth Instance is about *praying for the dead:* But whatever you say of the Rector of S. *Martins* in *Oxford,* there is no difference between the *Puritans* and the *Prelatic Protestants* in that point: You mistake the matter: It is *another passage,* or *two* or *three* at Burial, which the Puritan sticks at, *viz.* which pronounceth of every individual person in the Kingdom, Atheists, Infidels, Papists, and Impenitent Sinners that

we bury, except only the *Excommunicate, Unbaptized,* and *Self-murderers,* that [*God of his mercy hath taken to himself the Soul of this our dear Brother, out of the miseries of this sinful life, &c.*]

IX. Your last Instance indeed toucheth the quick of our Controversy with *Rome:* You say [*The Prelatic Protestant wonders at the Puritan's Pride, that he will not submit his judgment in matters of Faith, to the determination of a Council of all the Reverend Bishops of the Land, his Majesty as Supreme Head and Governor presiding,*] yet submit not [*to the determination of a General Council of all the Learned Bishops of the Christian World, his Holiness the Pope as Supreme Pastor presiding, and believe as the Universal Church of Christ believeth: It's fitting, says the Conformist, that for Order sake in Christ's Church, there should be in every Nation some Supreme Governors, to whose Directions in matters of Divine Worship, all should submit; else we shall have as many Christian Religions and ways of Worship, as there are Parishes, Families, or Persons. The Puritan replyeth, It seems as rational that Christ should for the same Reasons of conserving union, decency, and order in his Church, appoint one Supreme Pastor over all Christians, dispersed in all the Nations of the World, whom all should obey in the vacancy of General Councils.*]

Ans. This deserveth our wakeful Remarks: I. So your sacred Cardinal *Bertrand* (in *Biblioth. Patrum*) said, that *God had not been wise else, if he had not placed one Supreme, as his Vicar over the World.* And so you can tell what *God hath done,* by your superlative Wit which can tell us what he *ought to do.* God doth all wisely: But if he had not made an Universal Head of the World under him, he had not done wisely; *ergo,* he hath made such an Head, *&c.* This is Historical Logic.

II. But is this Monarch the Head in *Civil* Government, or only in *Ecclesiastic?* Why is your *One Church* no more *One* in answering this Question? Nay why were poor *Barclay, Withrington,* and such others, whose Writings *Goldastus* hath preserved, so hardly judged of, for pleading for King's Supremacy in Civil Government? And if you are of their mind, tell us if you can, why God must not be judged as unreasonable and unwise, if he have not made *One Universal*

Civil Monarch of all the World? I undertake, when you will come to a due trial, to prove, that *Civil Government* is such as may as well, and *far better,* be done by *Officers* and *Deputies* than the *Ecclesiastical Government* can: And I pray who is the Universal Monarch? Or who must be he? Or how must he be chosen? I would have our King have no mortal King set over him, at least without a choosing Vote. And shall they meet in a General Council of Kings to choose one? By that time the Place and Time be agreed on, and the Kings have all left their Kingdoms, and be come from the *Antipodes,* and the *Terra Australis incognita,* and all other Kingdoms to that Council to choose a Monarch of the World, they will be too old to return home again. Or shall they fight it out, till one have Conquered all the rest? Alas, who shall bear the charge of the Conquest at the *Antipodes,* and who shall answer for all the Blood? When one cannot get all *Europe* at a cheaper rate, than will be expressed by many Kingdoms groans, and the Soil dunged with men's flesh and blood. I have long ago on this subject given (in my *Key for Catholics*) an Answer to *Richlieu,* and to *Carol. Boverius,* who wrote for the Honour of Ecclesiastic Monarchy, from the similitude of Civil, to have perverted our late King; as if he would have made him believe, that the World must have one mortal Monarch.

Contrarily, If it be *Madness and Hostility to all Kings and States, for any one man on earth to claim and seek to be the Monarch of all the World in Civil Government, it is madness and hostility to Kings, Pastors, and People, for any one man to claim and seek to be the Monarch of all the World in Ecclesiastic Government. But the former is true:* Ergo, *so is the latter.* I am ready to make good the Comparison.

III. But, Sir, if the Pope be S. *Peter's* Successor, is not his *Apostolic office* as Universal as his *Monarchy* or Ruling office? Surely the *first part* of the *Apostles' office* was to preach and *baptize,* and *make Christians* and *gather Churches,* and the Governing of them was but the second part: And is the Pope the *Apostle* of all the world? Then it seemeth that he is a betrayer of most of the whole earth to the Devil, that neither preacheth

to them *per se vel per alios.* But S. *Peter's* Charge was not *Universal* but *Indefinite.* And even as to *Government,* why did he never so much as send his Deputies to govern the Abassins for so many hundred years? Nay hence it seemeth to follow, that all the preaching and Church-order that hath been for so many hundred years, either there or in any other Nation, by which millions have been turned to Christianity and edified, without the mission or Commission of the Roman Monarch, should have been left undone, and all was unlawful?

IV. But must your *Pope* be obeyed as Supreme but in the *Vacancy of General Councils?* Dare you preach this at *Rome?* 1. How then come the Councils of *Constance* and *Basil* for such Doctrine to be *unapproved or reprobate Councils?* How came Pope *Eugenius* to keep up and continue the succession, when so great a General Council had deposed him as Heretical, Simoniacal, and many ways flagitious? 2. And what? Have we a Catholic Church with two Heads? that are *per vices* the Vicars of Christ? A *Pope* one year, and a *Council* another? Then sure they are *two Churches,* seeing the *Pars imperans* is the *specifying part.* 3. But the best is, it is at the Pope's will, whether ever there shall be a General Council more? And he knoweth which side his Bread is Buttered on? Nay, they say, no Decree is valid without his approbation: And if ever a *John,* or *Eugenius* of them all will approve of his own Deposition for Heresy, Simony, Adultery, *&c.* he is not the Man that I took him for. 4. But if the name [*General Council*] be not a Cheat, and taken for a Council very far from being General, as to the *whole Christian World,* let the Pope set his heart at rest, I will undertake to secure him from the danger of such a Council, and to prove that such there never *ought* to be, *will be,* or *can be,* unless Christianity come much nearer to be rooted out of the Earth, and the Church brought into a narrower room.

V. But you have a reflecting Comparison between the *King's presiding* and the *Popes,* and between a *National Council* and the *Bishops of the whole Christian World.* To begin at the later part. Alas poor *ignorant Man,* if you believe this yourself? And alas *unfaithful Man,* if you believe it not and yet dare say it? Do you

yet know no difference between the *orbis Romanus,* and the *orbis universalis?* Or will you with *William Johnson,* alias *Terret,* prove your Councils to be Universal, because such places as *Thracia* had Bishops there, as if *Thracia* had been without the Empire? or because such a name as *Johannes Persidis* is found at *Nice?* Read all the subscribed names, and return to a sounder mind! *Theodoret* knew what he said, when he gave the reason why *James* Bishop of *Nisibis* in *Persia,* or near it, was at the Council of *Nice, Because* Nisibis *was then under the* Roman *Emperor.*

Do you not know that most of the Christian World (two to one) are not of the Pope's Subjects; and are *All the Bishops of the Christian World* then on your side? And do you not know that when *Constantine* presided at *Nice,* his Dominion was full as large as the Bishop of *Rome*'s was, and a little larger.

VI. But because you shall find us reasonable, we will tell you, that we consent to General Councils where the Pope consenteth not? We consent to what the great Councils at *Calcedon* and *Constantinople,* before mentioned, say of the *Human Institution of his Primacy,* and the *Reason* and *Mutability* of it; and so doth not the Pope? We consent to the Councils at *Constance, Basil, Pisa,* that the Pope may be deposed as a Heretic, and worse; but the Pope doth not: Is it not he then that dissenteth from *all the Bishops of the World?*

VII. And for the King's presiding we wholly own it: He is the Governor of *Clergy-men,* as well as of Physicians; and he is to see that they abuse not their Function to the common hurt. The difference is here, 1. Our King Governeth but his own Dominions: But your Pope would Govern all the World. 2. Our King hath an undoubted Title: Your Pope is an Usurper. 3. And as to your name [*Head*] he hath given the World full satisfaction, that he did never claim to be a *Priest-Head* or *Governor,* a *Constitutive* Head of a *properly called Church,* nor to have the power of *Word, Sacraments,* and *Keys,* so as to administer them; but to be a Civil *Head* and Governor of Priests, and the Churches in his Dominions; as he is of Physicians, *&c.*

VIII. And you mistake the Puritans, if you think they are not for this Government: Why else take they the Oath of Supremacy? Yea, and if you think that they are not for as much Unity and Concord of all the Churches in a Kingdom, as can be had without a greater hurt, than the lesser particularities of their concord will do good: And they are not against National Synods for such Concord: And they hold the King to be the *Regular Head or Governor, or* Principium *of that Concord:* But not *principium essentiale ipsius Ecclesiae:* And therefore the Puritans differ from judicious *Ric. Hooker,* who saith, [*If the King be the Head of the Church, he must needs be a Christian:*] For we hold that an *Infidel King* may be so the Head, that is, the *Rightful Governor* of the Christians and Churches in his Dominion; or else how should they be obliged to obey him?

IX. And you are mistaken, if you think that the Puritans and the Prelatists differ about submitting our Faith to the judgment of the Church: We subscribe the same Articles, which say that General Councils may err, and have erred, even about matters of Faith.

X. But I must tell you, that the Puritans, who are accused of *disorder* and *confusion,* do many of them loath *disorder* and *confusion,* even in *words* and *doctrine.* And they distinguish here between the *Church's keeping* and *teaching* the Christian Faith, and the *Church's judging in matters of Faith.* The first they are wholly for: We must receive our Faith from our Teachers, and *oportet discentem fide humana credere.* But if by *Judging* you mean strictly a *Decisive judgment,* in which we must rest, which way soever the sentence pass, as if the Church might not only teach us the truth of our Religion, but judge *in partem utramlibet,* whether it be true or not, the Puritans own no such power in the Church, nor will so submit their Faith to the judgment of it. They believe that Pastors in Councils have power to judge that there is a God, Almighty, *&c.* a Christ, a Holy Ghost, that Christ dyed, rose, *&c.* that the Scripture is true, that there is an absolute necessity of Holiness, that there is a Resurrection and Life everlasting, that God's Commandments must

be kept, and sin not committed, *&c.* But that no Council hath power to judge that there is no God, no Christ, or the contrary to any one of these, or any other revealed Truth of God.

XI. And I must not let pass your Schismatical inference, that [*else there should be as many Religions and ways of worship as Parishes or persons*] if some supreme Governor determined not in matters of worship: For 1. It was not so, when no Supreme Governor determined, on earth: 2. But either you mean the *Substantials* of God's Worship or the *Circumstantials:* In the first as *faith* is not to be got by force, so neither is *Godliness,* but yet Governors should here do their best: But as to the other we abhor the Conceit, that there are as *many Religions,* as there is difference about *vestures, gestures, days and meats:*

But perhaps you take the word *Religion* in the Roman sense, as you confine it to those that you call [*the Religious*] (as if you took the people of your Church to be irreligious:) And so *you* have indeed *too many Religious,* however they come to make one Church: The Religion of the *Carthusians* is one, and of the *Benedictines* another, and of the *Franciscans* another; I cannot name them all: One eateth Herbs and Fish, and another eateth Flesh seldom, another often; one weareth one habit, and another weareth another; one Religion hath one Rule of Life, and another hath another. But with us there is but *one Religion* (which is the *Christian*) though one man wear cloth and another stuff, one white and another black, one eat Flesh and another Fish, and another can seldom get either; though one wear his Hair long and another short, though one be old and another be young, yet we are all of one Religion: Yea, though one preach and pray in English, another in Welsh, another in French, and another in Dutch, yet we take not these to be so many Religions: No nor though one think *Free praying* fitter for Ministers than an *imposed Form,* and another think an *imposed Form* only fit, and a third think as the mere Puritan, that *both* having their Conveniences and Inconveniences, there should be seasons *for both.*

And I pray you here tell me two things if you can. 1. Whether the great *difference of Liturgies* (which are the very

Words and *Order* of the *Church's Worship*) be not liker a *difference of Religions,* than the *colour* of our *clothes,* or the *meat* we *eat,* or the *lighting* of a *Candle, &c.* And yet do I need to tell you how many Liturgies are recorded in the *Bibliotheca Patrum?* Yea, that it was six hundred years and more before the Churches in *one Empire* used all one and the same Liturgy? and for some hundred years, that every Church used what the Bishop pleased? Yea, that the first restraint of *free-praying* that we find was, by a Council ordaining that the Presbyter should first show his Prayer to the Fathers that they might be sure it was sound? And had *Basil* and *Chrysostome,* and all others that varyed, as divers *Religions* as *Liturgies?*

2. Whether all the *doctrinal* Controversies among yourselves, as between all your School *Doctors* about Predestination, Grace, and free will, about Perseverance, about the Immaculate Conception of the Virgin *Mary,* about the Power of the Pope over all Kings in Temporals, and about the killing of excommunicate Kings, and the absolving their Subjects, and whether after excommunication they *are Kings* or *no,* (of which *Hen. Fowlis* hath cited great store on one side,) and all the Moral Controversies about loving God, about Perjuries, Vows, Murder, Fornication, Lying, Stealing, Drunkenness, Gluttony, (of which you may see great store in *Montaltus*'s Letters, The Mystery of Jesuitism, and Mr. *Clarkson's* late Book called *The Practical Divinity of the Church of Rome:*) I say, is not Religion as much concerned about all these differences, and all the rest among you which make many Horse-loads, yea I think Cart-loads of Volumes, as it is in the colour of the Preachers Clothes, or the Meat he eateth? And are not Protestants (that is, *mere Christians* disowning Popery) as justifiable in their Unity and Charity, for taking Men to be of the same Religion, who use not the same Garments, Gestures, and Ceremonies, and that bear with differences herein, as your Church that beareth with all these loads of different Doctrines in your most Learned Famous Doctors (and not in the weaker Priests alone) even whether excommunicate Kings may be killed or no; and whether the Pope hath Power

to put down and set up Emperors and Kings? If you say that your *One Religion* and *One Church* hath no such difference, it must be by saying that you all agree to *Gregory* the seventh in *Concil. Rom. & Innoc.* 3. in *Concil. Lateran.* on the worser side, and all own the Doctors cited by *H. Fowlis* aforesaid: But indeed I must speak better of you, even that some are of a better mind, whom *Goldastus* hath gathered and preserved, and divers of the Learned Men of *France,* and some in *Spain.* But we think the difference even between the Prelatists, Presbyterians, Independents, yea and the moderate Anabaptists, to be far less than these which your unanimous agreeing Church doth constantly bear with, without Silencing, Imprisoning, Ejecting, or Condemning, or so much as *disowning* the judgments of the worser side.

He that readeth *Parsons* on one side, and *Watson's Quodlibets* on the other; *Barclay* and *Witherington* on one side, and *Zuarez* and the far greater prevalent Party on the other, will either wonder at the *strength of your Unity* which no doctrinal differences even about the Blood of Kings can at all dissolve; or else he may wonder at the lax and sandie temperament of such Protestants as cannot bear with a Man that readeth not in their Book, and singeth not in their Tune; and is still crying out against others as Sectaries, because they *have piped to them and they have not danced;* and such as no Man can live quietly within reach of, unless they swallow every Morsel which they cut for them, having Throats neither wider, or at least no narrower than theirs. As if King *Henry* the eighth's days were the measure of true Discipline, when one Man was burnt for being too far from Popery, and another hanged, or beheaded, for being Popish, and it was hard to know the middle Region, and harder to know how long it would be calm? till strangers cried, *Deus bone, quomodo hic vivunt Gentes.* But as none are more cruel in Wars than Cowards, (nor in Robberies than Women,) nor any more gentle and pitiful than valiant experienced Soldiers; so few are so insolent and bloody obtruders of their Dictates and Wills upon the World, as those that being least able to prove them good, have nothing but

Inquisitions and Prisons, Silencings and Banishings, Fire and Faggot, effectually to make them good.

But if St. *James* be in the right, who saith, that *Pure Religion and undefiled is this, to visit the Fatherless and Widows in their adversity, and to keep ourselves unspotted of the World,* then certainly the *Jesuits' Morals,* and the *Mystery of Jesuitism,* and *Clarkson*'s *Roman Practical Divinity,* and *Fowlis*'s Treasons of the Papists, contain more of the concerns of Religion, than preaching in a consecrated or unconsecrated place, and than eating Flesh, Fish, or neither, in *Lent* or on *Fridays,* doth. O the strange difference between your Unity and Concord, and the Protestants! How fast is yours? How loose is ours?

And it is to be considered we pretend not to so much perfection in this world, as ever to expect that all Men should be just of the same Size and Complexion, or speak the same Language, or have all the same Opinions, Thoughts, or Words: If we can keep the *Unity of the Spirit in the Bond of Peace,* in the seven Points named by the Apostle, *Eph.* 4. 3, 4, 5, 6. so far as we have attained do walk by the same Rule (of Love and Peace) and mind the same things, till God reveal more to such as differ, (*Phil.* 3.) we shall be glad of such a measure of Union: For we believe it impossible to be perfect in Concord, while most, yea all are so woefully imperfect in Knowledge, Faith, Love and Obedience. We wait for perfection of all in Heaven; and we find that few things in the World ever did so much against Unity, as pretending to more than is to be hoped for, and laying it on so high terms, and so many as we know will never be received. Therefore our Mutual Love and forbearance with different Forms and Circumstances, is agreeable to the Principles of our Religion.

But for you that pretend to *Unity, Concord, and Infallible Judgement,* to tolerate Cart-loads of Doctrinal Controversies, divers Expositions of many hundred Texts of Scripture, divers readings of the Text itself, contrary Doctrines about God's Grace, about all the Ten Commandments, about the Estates and Lives of Kings, and never so much as to condemn either side nor silence the Preachers, never imprison them, or

banish them five miles from Cities and Corporations, never put them to any disgrace, but still honour them as renowned Doctors, as if the Lives of Kings, and the rest of these things were less than a Form of Prayer, or a Ceremony, yea when your Inquisition torment poor Protestants for smaller matters, (as reading the Bible, or a Protestant Book;) methinks all this showeth that Christian Concord is founded on better Principles than yours, and that yours is but the Bond of your Clergy interest.

CHAP. IV. *His own false Description of Papists.*

YOUR next work being to give your Relations, first the *false* and then the *true* description of a *Papist,* it's most deceitful work that you make in both.

I. In the false description you do quite pass over the great *Constitutive* Causes of Popery, in which it is that it differs from *Apostolical Christianity:* And you name a few of the superstructures or remoter differences, and cite not one Protestant that speaketh those words, but only the present *Arch-bishop of York,* and as you say, the *vulgar* conceit: And you are ordinarily careful, in every Paragraph, to put in *some one word,* by the disowning of which you may disown the sentence.

But, 1. Is it not a mere deceiving trick to word your own Accusations so in the Protestants' name, as you know you can easiliest plead, *Not Guilty?* May not one alter some *one word* in every Verse of any Chapter in the Bible, and then protest, that *not one of all those Verses is in the Bible?* So if the Printer have some *Errata* in each Leaf of your Book, may you not protest that not one Leaf of it is yours?

2. And is it not deceitfully done to appeal to the *Vulgar* as the Accusers, that thus charge you, when you know how vain it is to expect, that, (how sound soever their judgments be) the Vulgar should state any Controversies so exactly, as not to miss it in a *word* or *more;* when they hit the sense? And you knew how hard it is to disprove you: For who shall judge what is the opinion of the Vulgar? If I should say that *few* or *none* of my acquaintance do charge you to speak those very words, you may say that *you know some that do,* and I cannot confute you.

3. And have you not the Differences between you and us voluminously stated and handled long ago, by many whose Books have been received by the Churches, and Licensed by Authority, when the *Vulgar stating* of them was never Licensed nor owned? Why did you not gather out of *Jewel,*

Usher's *Answer* to the *Jesuits Challenge*, Dr. *Challoner, Chillingworth*, Dr. *Field*, Dr. *Crakenthorp*, Dr. *Reignolds*, Dr. *John White*, Bishop *Morton*, Dr. *Ames, Sadeel, Chamier, Whitakers*, or such others, what the things are that Protestants charge you with? And answer what is there charged on you?

I myself have enumerated many of the things which we take for Popery, and not to be defended, in my *Key for Catholics*, and in my *Safe Religion*, and in One *Sheet against Popery*, almost twenty years ago; and since then in my [*Full and easy satisfaction which is the true Religion*,] and in my [*Certainty of Christianity without Popery.*] And you have given no answer to any one of them that I ever heard of: But you can better dispute, it seems, with your *Relations*, and with the *Women* and *Country-Labourers*, or *Tradesmen*, that never use to speak in that strictness of words as shall prevent the Cavils of a studied Sophister.

4. As for the A. B. of *York*, I am almost a Stranger to him, and more to his Book, which I never saw: But two things I can say, 1. That we are no more obliged to justify his words, than you to justify the words of any one of your Doctors. 2. That no man is so fit to answer for him as he is for himself: Because no man knoweth so well in what sense he took the word [*Papist.*] I suppose you know that *Grotius*, who persuadeth us all to an *obedient Union with your Church, under the Pope's Government according to the Canons, owning the Decrees of all the Councils, even that of* Trent, yet for all this doth speak against *Papists:* But he tells you that by *Papists* he meaneth *those Flatterers of the Pope, who approve of all that he saith or doth.* And that it was not the *Government* or *Doctrine* of that Church that was to have been *reformed*, but the *Opinions* of some *Schoolmen*, and the *excesses*, and *ill lives* of *many* of the *Clergy*. Now could not *Grotius* easily have produced such *Papists* as these, as having said as gross things as you recite?

And how far Bishop *Bromhall*, and the Doctor that lately published him, own *Grotius*, I will not tell you, but refer you to their own words: To which many more might easily be added. Now suppose that Dr. *Heylin*, or A. Bishop *Bromhall*, or his

Prefacer should say, that by [*Papists*] they mean such as *Grotius* did, do you think that they could not prove as gross words, as any cited by you, in some such Flatterers of the Pope? And you know, I suppose, that some of late would not have the *Church of Rome* called *Papists,* or at least so charged, but only the *Court of Rome.*

But let us take notice of some of the Particulars.

I. Your first Article is, That *Papists are said to Worship Stocks and Stones, Medals, and Pictures of Jesus Christ as Gods, and pray to them, and put their whole confidence in them, as the ancient Heathens did in their dumb Idols of* Jupiter, Mars, *&c.*

Ans. 1. Your Doctors are oft charged with maintaining that the Image of *Christ* and the *Cross* must be *worshipped with latria,* which is the Worship called Divine: And instead of this you put in the word [*as Gods.*] It is not [*as reputing these Images to be really Gods,*] but [*worshipping them as God only should be worshipped,*] contrary to the second Commandment, which forbiddeth such *Bodily actions* as were symbolical of Idol-Worship, though the *Mind* were kept never so free from accounting God to be like Idols, or Idols to be Gods.

2. Who chargeth you of putting your *Whole trust in Images?* Is not *part of it* too much?

3. How prove you that the Heathens ordinarily did so? Or that they took *Jupiter, &c.* to be nothing but *the Image,* and not a *Celestial Power?*

4. But instead of saying any more on this point, I again tell you, that Dr. *Stillingfleet* hath in his new Defence against *T. G.* so fully proved that the generality of the Heathen Nations did worship one Universal Supreme God, and worshipped their inferior Gods much like as you do Angels, and worshipped their Images, not as being Gods themselves, but with such a Relation to the Deity, as you do your Images; and that your Image Worship is such as the ancient Fathers condemned in the Heathens; that none of you will ever be able solidly to confute him, or defend your Idols any more: So dear do you pay for *T. G.* his temporary triumph.

II. Your second feigned Charge is, [*That the Pope can give men leave to commit any sin for money—or so pardon any sin after, as you shall not be in the least danger of any punishment for it temporal, or eternal, in Purgatory, or in Hell.*]

Ans. I will take your part in this, and prove that the Squib-maker, who drew up this Charge, doth do you wrong. What a Sot was he to think that any Pope would ever be sick, or sore, or dye, if he could forgive *all temporal punishment?* Unless the unhappy man can forgive all others, and not himself? At least he would preserve some of his Friends in health and immortality on Earth? And the Whores, that *Baronius* himself saith made Popes at their pleasure, would have found some Popes so grateful as to have saved them from dying, if not from bringing forth in pain. And truly I should hope that at least the Pope that by a Council was condemned for an Infidel, and believing not any life to come in Heaven or Hell, would have been so tender-hearted as to forgive all the world the punishment in Hell. And it was a great mistake in these Slanderers of you, to except no sin: As if the Popes could forgive them that would diminish their Kingdoms, or restrain their Domination; much less that would depose them. Could Pope *Eugenius* ever forgive the Universal Church, as it's called, that is, the great General Council which in vain condemned and deposed him? When he can scarce forgive a poor Protestant the Rack and Fire, for reading the Bible or serving God out of the *Roman* way.

And doubtless he is wronged by this Charge, that he can nullify all *pain, death, Purgatory, and Hell;* for I think you will say, that *quoad potentiam ordinatam* Christ cannot do it, or at least he will not. And were this believed by all the World, no wonder if they willingly obeyed him, and called him, *Our Lord God the Pope.* For he could conquer any Kingdom, by saving all his Soldiers from hurt and death.

It is enough that he can forgive some *part* or *time* of Purgatory Torments, and that (as great Doctors say) he can (and lesser Priests than he) forgive the pains of Hell to a sinner that hath no true *contrition* for sin (that is, repenteth not out of any

Love to God or Goodness) but only *Attrition* and the *Sacrament of Penance and Absolution,* (that is, repenteth only for fear of Hell, and would sin still if he durst.)

And though you may hope that there are no Copies of the old Pardons yet to be seen, or any of *Tecelius* Merchandise now extant, yet the sure History of them is common, and if you deny it, it will be proved to your shame. What a multitude of Writers have better cited your practice and confuted it?

But yet I remember (to do you right) that even *Hildebrand* himself (*Greg.* 7.) in a *Roman* Council saith, that [*neither the Sacrament of Baptism, nor Penance is of any force to pardon any impenitent Hypocrite,*] which is well said; and as for true *Penitent Believers,* we verily believe that they are pardoned *ipso jure* by the Gospel, as to destructive or hellish Punishment; and that every true Minister of Christ may validly deliver this pardon ministerially, by true absolution, in the Sacrament, and without it. But in what *measure* God himself will remit *temporal Chastisements,* few men can know till the event tell it them: And neither Pope nor Priest can forgive without him; nor know what God will remit, any more than another man may know, that is, by God's Word, and by the event.

And again, I say if it were in the Pope's power (however you may absolve him from Bribery or the Love of Money) that there would be more difference in point of bodily suffering, between his Subjects or Favourites and other men, than was ever yet perceived. It's policy therefore to confine the business to *Purgatory,* that no witness may be able to disprove it.

You add to the Charge, [*That of all Christ's Merits the Pope is the Supreme Lord, to dispose of them to the living and the dead, as he by his unerring Spirit thinks fitting.*]

Answ. Here the Charger wrongs you too: For seeing all men's Lives and Mercies are the Fruits of Christ's *Merits,* if this were true, the Pope could kill all his Enemies at his pleasure, and when he hath killed them could cast them into Hell, or keep them out of Heaven: And then no one in his wits would be against him, or displease him. It's enough to be able to do as aforesaid.

III. Your next is [*the Papist honours the Virgin* Mary *much more than he does her divine Son, or God the Father: for one Prayer he says to God, he says ten to the Virgin.*]

Answ. This is injurious too, whoever made it: The Pagans honour not their Inferior Gods, so much as the Supreme! And for the *number* of Prayers, it's not like that all Papists use the same, or by the same Beads: But whether you give *inordinate honour* to the Virgin *Mary,* and put not up a very large proportion of your Prayers to her; if Dr. *Stillingfleet,* and abundance before him, may not be trusted in their Citations, I hope your own Prayer-books may be believed. It's bad enough to make her like *Juno,* though you should not equal her with *Jove.* Angels have refused smaller honour.

IV. You add [*His Prayers are a company of Latin words, he neither understands, or cares to understand them, which if he do but patter over in such a number, though his heart and mind be wholly taken up with worldly thoughts and desires, he thinks,* &c.]

Answ. At the first line one would have thought you had grown past blushing, and had *denied* your *Latin Prayers,* not understood; but you never want *one word* to help you out in renouncing the whole Sentence: You make me think of that sorry Religion which teacheth men, that if *one Article in a Vow,* among many, be unlawful, they may renounce all Obligation to anything else that there is Vowed; and so a Knave may be disobliged to all Vows and Covenants, if he will but drop in anything that is unlawful. Do not your unlearned Multitude join in your *Latin Prayers?* Do Mass-books, and your daily Masses, all deceive our Eyes and Ears? No, that's not it; what then! must all be *desirous* to understand it, if they cannot? I rather think the Calumny is, that [*his mind and heart may be wholly taken up with worldly desires?*] But who was it that put in that into the Charge? was it not yourself? We know that you say, *There should be some General kind of Devotion and good Desire, though he know not what is said;* and *a General Belief,* called *Implicit,* which is *no Belief of any of the Particulars,* and a *General Implicit Desire,* which is *no Desire of any express Particular,* being *a Faith* that is *no Faith,* and *a Prayer* which is *no*

Prayer, would make a Religion which is no Religion, if you had no better.

V. The next is [*If he do but believe as his Church-men believe, though he be wholly ignorant of their Belief, his Soul is safe enough.*]

Answ. What is a Man but his Wit? The Word (*wholly*) craftily put in by yourself, enableth you also to renounce this Charge: For we all confess that your Doctors commonly hold, that this one Article must be believed, [*That the Church is to be believed and obeyed,*] and that's one Particular. But I pray tell us if you can: 1. Dare your Church say that every word revealed must be believed Explicitly of necessity to Salvation? No: 2. And have they in any General Council determined what those Particular Articles are that are so necessary, (since you departed from the sufficiency of the Creed?) Or do not your Doctors, without any Decree of the Church, use to debate it as a free opinion? 3. And do they not differ among themselves, as all in pieces about the Point? And do not your chief Learned Schoolmen cited at large by *Fr. a Sancta Clara* on our Articles hold that the Particular Belief of Christ himself, or the supernatural Articles of the Creed are not of necessity? And I know not of any one thing that you are agreed to be necessary, besides the Belief that the *Church,* (that is, the *Pope and his Council*) *are Infallible,* or to be believed and obeyed; and it is a Learned School Doctor and Jesuit *Fran. Albertinus Corol. p.* 250. that justifieth a Countryman that should believe a falsehood if twenty Bishops tell it him, and that the Command of Faith doth oblige to believe falsehood, it being *not per se, but per accidens, &c.* And I think the old man is now among you at *London,* (*Fr. a Sancta Clara,*) who having cited abundance of Doctors against the necessity of believing in Christ or any Supernatural Point, or in some cases knowing the Law of Nature and the Decalogue, saith *p.* 20. [*To speak my sense freely, I think that the Common People committing themselves to the instruction of the Pastors, trusting their knowledge and goodness, if they be deceived, it shall be accounted invincible ignorance, or probable at least:* So Herera; *which excuseth from fault: Yea, some Doctors give so much to the Instruction of Doctors on whom the care of the Flock lyeth, that if they*

teach hic & nunc *that God would be hated, that a rude Parishioner is bound to believe them.* See abundance more in him cited, *Deus, Nat. Grat. Probl.* 15, *and* 16. And that you may know that this opinion is not rare, he addeth, *p.* 123. [*It seemeth to be the common opinion of the Schools and Doctors at this day, that the Laity erring with their Teachers, or Pastors, are altogether excused from all fault: Yea, by erring thus many wayes materially they merit for the Act of Christian Obedience which they owe, their Teachers, as* Valentia *saith* To. 3. Disp. 1. q. 2. p. 5. *and others with* Angles, Vas. quez. *&c.*]

And if this be true, what Prince, Lord, or any other Lay-man, that would be out of all danger of Sin and Hell, would not be a Papist, and be sure to choose a Priest that is ignorant enough to take Perjury, Drunkenness, Gluttony, Adultery, Fornication, Persecution, Oppression for no Sin, and then he may be sure that it's none to him, but he meriteth by obeying him that will persuade him to it?

And what if these bid Subjects kill their Kings, would it not be sinless and meritorious by this Rule?

But you'll say, These be but the words of Writers, and Books may be misunderstood, when they say that this is the common Opinion of the Doctors. And perhaps if I talk with you, or another, you will protest that this is none of your belief. But how shall I know that *W. H.* or his Neighbour, or Grandfather, know better what is the Faith or Religion of the Papists than the old Queens Confessor, and all those famous Doctors, whom he citeth, and all that I myself have read?

And remember your Undertaking, cited in my Title Page.

Is it not the most common Opinion of your Doctors, that all men are bound to know and believe according to their opportunities, and probable instructions? But what is commonly necessary your Learned Church-men cannot tell us, no not the Pope or Councils? And who can tell what other men's capacities and opportunities have been? and so whether he be a Believer indeed, or not? or bound to be so?

VI. Your next part is, [*He makes Gods of—sinful men:—He maketh less scruple of violating God's Laws, than he doth any Ordinance of the Pope, or any Law of his Church*]

Ans. That one word [*any*] is either the falsehood of your Accuser, or the *craft* of the Clark that drew up the Indictment: And I think it should not be drawn up of these Laws compared *formaliter,* but *materialiter:* For I cannot think you so unreasonable, as to think that the Pope is above God; but that when you cast away God's Laws to keep the Pope's, it is because you think that the Pope hath power to change and abrogate God's Laws, or dispense with them; or that you are bound to believe that it is none of God's Law, if the Pope say it's none: For Instance, 1. I know that you cast away Christ's Law for receiving his Body and Blood, the Cup as well as the Bread in the Sacrament: But *why* you do so, I am no Judge.

2. I know that you break the Second Commandment, and usually leave it out of the Decalogue too: But why you do it, I am no Judge.

3. I know that the Pope and his approved General Council at *Laterane* make a Law against God's Law for obedience to the higher powers, and this Papists profess to receive as part of their Religion: But on what reasons you do it, I leave to you.

You Instance [*If he commit Fornication it is but a Venial Sin*] Do You hold that any of your approved Councils have defined it to be a Mortal Sin? If so, I hope you will take those for Heretical that think it is not always so: I refer you to Mr. *Clarkson's Practical Divinity* aforesaid, and the Jesuits' Morals. But doubtless all of you have not the same Judgment either of Fornication or Murder, (as is there proved;) for you are not bound to be so far agreed, in such little things: But your craft put in the *saving word* next, [*and sprinkling himself with a little Holy Water he is as free from all spot as a new Baptized Infant.*]

Answ. They say, *No Man wrongeth himself:* You may lay a false Charge against yourself that you may the easier deny it; There must be somewhat more than *Holy Water,* else what need of *Attrition* and Confession, and Penance, if it please the Priest, or Commutation of Penance? what need the Crusado's to have

killed so many thousands of the *Waldenses* and *Albigenses* to procure the pardon of their sins (O dreadful way to pardon!) What room for Pilgrimages, satisfactions, or for Purgatory, or for Masses to be said for the Souls in Purgatory, or for praying to the Virgin *Mary,* and abundance such, if *Holy Water alone* would do all the Business? Was not he much overseen, or did grossly prevaricate, that drew up this Charge? Might I but choose my Adversaries Advocate, and agree with him to say nothing but what I can disprove, I would certainly have the better, and be justified.

VII. The next part is, [*And as for his obedience to Magistrates, if they be not of his Religion, he owes them no allegiance: And if he have by Oath obliged himself, he has a holy Father can dispense with him for that, or any other Oath, for a piece of Money: If his Prince persecute him for his Religion, let him but have so much desperate courage as to sacrifice his own life to stab or poison his said Persecutor, he shall at* Rome *be canonized for a Saint: Nor can private Persons expect any fidelity from him, when he is thus traitorously rebellious against his Liege Lord and Sovereign,* &c.]

Ans. Now I perceive you are over bold, and do too hardly blush, when you have the face to bring in such an instance, and by the inserting of a word or two of your own, to dare to wash off from your Religion the blot of Perfidiousness and Rebellion, when it is part of the Decrees of your approved General Council. The Prevaricator wrongeth you, 1. By making [*not of his Religion*] to be all that's necessary to free you from allegiance. 2. By putting in [*or any other Oath for a piece of Money:*] I have not yet found that the Pope undertaketh to dispense with a man that will swear to *believe the Roman Church,* or the rest in Pope *Pius* his *Trent* Oath, nor yet with the Vow of Baptism, if seconded by an Oath. 3. By saying only [*If his Prince persecute him;*] for the Doctors say that he must be first *excommunicate,* or a Heretic at least, and some say he must have the Pope's Order before he may kill a King; and the Council only speaketh of *Deposing,* and not of killing. 4. And the Prevaricator too rashly promised [*Canonizing:*] He that murdered one of the *French* Kings, was but *praised* in an Oration by the Pope,

(proved by many) but not Canonized: *Garnet* was not every one.

But because I see you grow so bold, (and also in what follows return to what you had said before) I will, instead of following you farther, tell you what such as I mean by a *Papist,* and what some other men mean by him.

CHAP. V. *The true History of the Papacy, its original and growth.*

Though I reserve the opening of the ambiguities of the word *Papist* till near the end, I shall so far anticipate that, as to tell you here also, that the word [PAPIST] is equivocal: I. In the sense of *Grotius,* and all our Reverend Country-men that are of his judgment, [*Papists are those that without any difference do approve of all the sayings and doings of Popes, for honour or lucre sake as is usual,*] Discus. p. 15.

If of all, then of all the Adulteries, Murders, Simony, Heresy, Infidelity charged on some of them by their own Writers and by Councils. I am sorry if this be [*usual*] I hope yet that there are few of these Papists in the World, and that few Popes themselves will deny that they are sinners.

But he elsewhere desireth the Reformation, 1. Of some bold disputes of the School-men; 2. And the ill lives of the Clergy; 3. And some Customs which have neither Councils, nor Tradition.

II. Some who are for the Supremacy of *General Councils* above the Pope, do call those *Papists* that are for the *Pope's Supremacy above such Councils;* or that give him the Legislative as well as the Judicial Power over the Universal Church: Though themselves give him the Supreme Judicial Power when there is no General Council.

III. Protestants call those Papists who hold that the *Roman Pope is rightfully the Governor of the Universal Church on Earth, either as to Legislative or Judicial-executive Power, either with Councils or without.* Two things are here included in our Judgment. 1. *That there is no rightful Universal Governor under Christ over all the Church on Earth,* either as to *Legislation,* or *Judgment:* 2. That the *Roman Pope therefore is no such Governor.*

In this third sense now I am to tell you what we Protestants mean by a *Papist* more particularly. And first I must tell you what a *POPE* is, before I can well tell you what a Papist is:

Which I shall do, I. *De facto Historically:* II. *De jure* as to the *Power* which he *claimeth.*

I. A long time the Bishops of *Rome* were seldom called *Popes,* and other Bishops were so called as well as they: At first the Bishops of *Rome* were pious persecuted Men, and many of them Martyrs, and usurped no Power over any Churches but their own; which with *Alexandria* were the two first that brake *Ignatius* his Test of Unity, who saith, [*To every Church there is one Altar, and one Bishop with his fellow Presbyter and Deacons.*] But *Rome* having long called herself the Mistress of the World, and being the Seat of the Empire and Senate, and of the Governing Power of the *orbis Romanus,* the Christians there grew greater than others, and the Bishop as it increased kept it under his Power: And when Christians had peace (which was under the far greatest part of the Heathen Emperors, and for the far longest time) the Greatness of *Rome* giving Greatness to that Church, and so to the Bishop, and great opportunity to help other Churches, because the Governing Power of the Empire was there, this Bishop grew to be of *greatest wealth* and *interest:* And in times of Peace the Strife which Christ once ended was taken up among the Bishops [*which of them should be the greatest:*] And St. *Paul* having taught Christians that they should not *go voluntarily to Law against each other before Heathens,* if there *were but a wise man among them to be an Arbitrator;* the Christians supposing that they had none wiser or fitter than their Bishop, made him their Common *Arbitrator* in things Civil, as well as Ecclesiastical: By which means Custom making it like a Law, Bishops became *de facto Church-Magistrates:* But they had no Power to execute any *Penal Laws,* either *Jewish* or *Roman,* or to make any of their own, except as Arbitrators or Doctors to those that would voluntarily receive them: And they had no Power of Life and Death, nor to dis-member any, nor to beat or scourge them, nor to Fine them or Confiscate their Estates: But being entrusted by *Christ* as his Ministers with the Power of the *Church-Keys,* and by the *People* with the Power of *Civil Arbitrations,* they were by this the *stated Governors of all Christians;* who yet obeyed the *Roman* Heathen

Magistrates, but brought none of their own differences voluntarily before them.

And because that Multitudes of Heresies took advantage of the Church's liberty, and swarmed among them to their great weakening and disgrace, and christ had commanded his Servants to serve him in as much *Unity* and *Concord* as they could, duty and necessity drove the Pastors of the Churches to *Correspondences,* and to *meet together* on all just occasions, and at last to *Associations* for the ordering of these Meetings! In which they agreed in what *Compass* and in what *Place,* or by *whose Call* such Meetings should be held, and what Bishops in those Meetings should *preside* or sit highest, and first speak and subscribe: And usually they thought that to follow the Order of the Civil Government, and give precedency to those that were Bishops of such Cities as had precedency in the Civil Government, was the most convenient Order: And in these Meetings they agreed on such Canons or Orders for all in that Compass to observe, as they thought best tended to their ends: And having no forcing Power (as is aforesaid) they formed their Impositions on voluntarily penitents so as might serve instead of the Power of the Sword: Even Murderers, Incestuous, Adulterers, they could not punish with Death, Stripes, or Mulcts, and they were loth to disgrace Christianity so much as to accuse such to the Heathen Magistrates; and therefore they laid the greater shame upon them, forbidding them Communion with Christians for so many years as they thought meet, and before they restored them they were humbly to beg the Prayers and Communion of the Church. But yet these Synods were small and few and rare, and never any dreamt of them as a Council of all the Church on Earth.

But when God blessed the *Roman* World with a Christian Emperor after the sharp Persecution of *Dioclesian,* and this Emperor had by Religion and Interest made the *Christian Soldiers* his *chief confidents* or *strength,* he studied the utmost *increase of the Christians,* and to that end invited all to Christianity, by the favour of the Court, and by such Honours, Commands, Wealth, and Dignities, as they were capable of;

and above all he exalted the Christian Bishops, whom he *found* the Rulers of the Christian Societies: He gave them Honours, and Wealth, and Power: He made a Law that no Christians should be forced to go to the Civil Heathen Judicatures, from their Bishops, and gave Power to the Bishops to be the Christians' Judges, some few heinous Crimes being in time excepted: And so the Bishops were by *his Law* made *Civil Magistrates* or *Arbitrators;* yet not with any Power of Life, or Limbs, or Estate: So that all that would become Christians, and would be subject to the Bishops' Canons, and Church Discipline, were freed from Death, Stripes, and Mulcts, for many Crimes which all others were liable to, and Excommunication and some Penance was instead of all: By such means Multitudes of worldly Men, and by the Preaching of the Gospel Multitudes that were sound Christians, came together into the Churches: And Bishoprics being now very desirable for their Power, Honour, and Wealth, Men that most loved *Power, Honour,* and *Wealth,* (that is, *Proud, Worldly, Carnal Men*) did earnestly seek them, and strive for Precedency in them: But yet while the People had the choice, or a Negative therein, and the old Spirit of Christianity remained in many of the Bishops, in many places bad ones were kept out, and many excellent Men were preferred.

The Heresy of *Arius* and the *Alexandrian* Contentions thereabout, required a remedy for the Church's Peace: The Bishops could not end it themselves: It spread so far that it was *Constantine*'s great grief to see Christians so quickly disgrace themselves, and weaken their Religion in the Eyes of the Heathens: Therefore he called a Council of Bishops consisting mostly of those of the Eastern parts where the troubles arose: Two Priests of *Rome* were there, but not the Bishop, nor but few of the West: Where the Emperor's open Rebukes and Lamentation for their Contention, and his earnest Exhortation to Peace, and his burning all the Libels or Accusations which the Bishops brought in against each other, and his continual presence and moderating oversight of them, brought

that meeting at last to that good and peaceable End, which else it was never like to have attained.

It never came into *Constantine*'s mind to call this Council as an Universal Representative of the whole Christian World, or as the Governors of the Churches that were out of his Dominions; but as a fit expedient to end the strife that was raised in those Parts: For as few of the West were there, so none of all other Kingdoms were once called. For who should call them! *Constantine* that called the Council neither did it, nor ever pretended to a power to do it. The Pope called not the Council, much less did he call the rest of the Christian World: *Socrates* tells us, *l.* 1. *c.* 15. that St. *Thomas* had Preached to the *Parthians,* and *Bartholomew* to the *Indians,* and *Matthew* to the *Ethiopians,* though the middle *India* was not Converted till *Constantine*'s days, by *Frumentius,* and *Edesius,* and *Iberia* by a Maid:] And so *Euseb. l.* 3. *c.* 3. who saith, that St. *Andrew* Preached to the *Scythians;* and *in Vit. Constant. l.* 4. *c.* 8. that there were many Churches in *Persia:* And no doubt these Apostles Preached not in vain: *Scotland* and other Countries that were out of the *Roman* Empire had Churches. Yet any Neighbour Bishop that desired it, might voluntarily be present. When *Theodoret* (in his Life) tells us that [*James* Bishop of *Nisibis* (in the borders of *Persia*) was *at the Council of* Nice: *For* Nisibis *was then under the Government of the* Roman *Empire,*] he plainly intimateth that none but the Subjects of the Empire were called: And the names yet visible, of the Subscribers prove it.

Notwithstanding this Council's decisions, the Contentions continue, and the Major part of the Bishops went that way usually as the Emperors went: And so in the Reign of *Constantius,* and *Valens,* they most turned to the *Arians,* at least in words: And many General Councils (so called, of the Empire) the *Arians* had, in which they prevailed, and made Creeds for their turn as they at *Nice* had done against them, and brought Persecution on the Orthodox, silencing, and ejecting them, and scattering their Meetings as prohibited Conventicles, the Emperor himself sometime executing their dispersions

and restraint: And among other *Liberius* the Bishop of *Rome,* against his Conscience Subscribed to them.

The Fathers at the Council of *Nice* did determine of the bounds of the Patriarchs of the Empire, which being at first but three, (*Rome, Alexandria,* and *Antioch,*) *Jerusalem* was after added, and after that *Constantinople:* For *Constantine* having now strengthened himself by the Christian Interest, and being further out of the danger of mutable Soldiers, than his Predecessors, did that which none of them was ever able to do, by removing the Imperial Seat from *Rome* to *Constantinople,* and so leaving that Famous City as naked and almost neglected: Whereby two great changes befell the Clergy, 1. The Bishop of *Rome* was left more absolute and uncontrolled in the West; 2. And the Bishop of *Constantinople* set up against him for the *Primacy* in the Empire: At first he claimed but an *Equality,* but afterward a *Priority as Universal Bishop,* because his Seat was the Imperial Seat.

The Patriarch of *Jerusalem* was so far from the Court, and of so small power, that he made the least stir of any of the five, though he had the fairest pretence incomparably for a claim of Supremacy on Religious reasons, if a *Supreme* there must have been (*Christ* himself having been there a *Minister to the Circumcision,* and Shepherd of the Sheep of the House of *Israel,* and his Kinsman *James* then Bishop after, and that being the *Mother-Church* out of which sprung all the rest.) But the other four Patriarchs (especially three of them) became as so many *Generals of Armies* militating frequently against each other: and he that got the *stronger* Party of Bishops and Court-favourers carried all, against the rest. But no place more turbulent, nor no Bishop more unquiet than those of *Alexandria:* Pride and Worldliness now grew apace, and so corrupted the Clergy, that in their Synods the *fleshly* part too oft prevailed against the *spiritual!* When Court and Councils were for the *Arians,* the whole Eastern part of the Empire was embroiled in the Contention, and the Orthodox in the greater Bishoprics cast out: When they were down and cast out themselves, the temporizing and turbulent Bishops usu-

ally got the Major Vote: Excellent *Gregory Nazianzen* for the great service that he had done against the *Arians* was chosen by the People, and made Patriarch of *Constantinople:* But the Synod of Presbyters envied him and rejected him, to whom he gave place and would not strive. *Dioscorus* of *Alexandria* and his party fought it out at the General Council, and killed *Flavianus:* And being after overcome and outed of his Seat, did still claim and keep the Title with his followers, and the most of his Patriarchate of the People stuck to him; so that he propagated his Opinion and Interest in all those remote parts of the Empire: Yea among Volunteers in *Ethiopia* and other *extra*-imperial parts, which no Law or Canon had subjected to him; while the Patriarch that succeeded him by the Council's Decree, had his party only as the rest, *within the Empire:* So that to this day the *Syrians, Ethiopians,* and abundance others profess themselves the followers of *Dioscorus* as the true Bishop injuriously, say they, cast out.

Chrysostome afterwards was cast out of his Patriarchate of *Constantinople,* by a Synod of Bishops and the Court.

At *Rome* the Bishopric was such a prey, that contending for it troubled the Public Peace: At the choice of *Damasus* they fought it out in the Church, and his party won that sacred Field, leaving many Carcasses there to the Church-Communion of the dead.

But it became the great advantage of *Rome,* that when the Empire was divided, the Western Emperor proved Orthodox while the Eastern were oft *Arians:* Which kept up the honour of the Western Bishops who had not the temptations of the East; where sharp persecutions and the desolation of their Flocks, and the boast of the *Arians* as the Major part, that was also settled by Authority, caused the ejected Bishops sometime to solicit them of the West for help, by sending them some to acquaint the *Arians* that their Cause was owned by the Western Bishops, or to put some Countenance on their depressed Cause (and indeed the Western Emperor did rescue them.) This occasioneth the Papists to this day to pretend that this was an Act of their subjection to the Pope: St. *Basil* was the

chief in this solicitation, and you shall read his words (Translated.)

Verily the manners of proud men (speaking of the Western Bishops) *use to grow more insolent, if they be honoured: And if God be merciful to us, what other addition have we need of? but if God's anger remain on us, what help can the pride of the West bring us? when they neither know the truth, nor can endure to speak it; but being prepossessed with false suspicions they do the same things now which they did in the Case of* Marcellus, *contentiously disputing against those that taught the truth, but for Heresy confirming it by their Authority?* Indeed I was willing, (*not as representing the Public Person of the East*) *to write to their Leader* (Damasus) *but not about Church-matters; but that I might intimate that they neither knew the truth of the things that are done with us, nor did admit the way by which they might learn them. And in general, that they should not insult over the calamitous and afflicted, nor think that Pride did make for their dignity, when that one sin alone is enough to make us hateful to God.* But this Epistle of *Basil Andr. Schottus* the Jesuit left out of *Basil*'s Works when he published them, *Antw. Lat. A. D.* 1616. *Tertullian* had made as bold with the Bishop of *Rome* long before, *lib. de Pudic. pag.* 742. against *Zepherinus:* So had *Cyprian* and *Firmilian* against *Stephen: Hilary Pictav.* with *Liberius* and the Councils, even that of *Nice:* But most notable was the sharp Contest of the *Carthage* Council, of which *Augustine* was one, against *Zosimus,* and *Boniface* and *Celestine;* when the Pope falsely alleged a Canon of the *Nicene* Council for Appeal to *Rome,* they denied his claim, and evinced the forgery, and stood it out against him to the last.

I. And here you may see that they took not the Pope's Power to be of God (*jure divino:*) For they searched only all the Archives to find out the *true Copies of the Nicene Council,* (*Pisanus* Canons being not then made;) and did not go to the *Scripture* to decide the Case, nor to *Tradition Apostolical,* only pleading *Church-Laws* and *Order* as on their side.

And that they never dreamt of a *Divine Institution* of this *Roman* Papacy or Primacy, but only as the Arch-Bishop of *Canterbury* in *England* hath precedency by the King's Laws,

and not by God's; so *Rome* was the first Seat by the mere appointment of man, even Emperors and Councils, is yet fully evident; 1. In that the *same Power* that made the other *four Patriarchs,* made the Bishop of *Rome* a Patriarch; and he was not made Pope or *Prime Patriarch* before he was made *Patriarch:* But no man dreameth of a Divine Institution of the *other four* Patriarchs: *Ergo.*

2. Because the whole Eastern Church, which was far greater than the Western, first equalled the Patriarch of *Constantinople* to him of *Rome,* and after preferred him; when yet they never dreamed of a Divine Institution of the Patriarchate of *Constantinople:* For it was but lately made: And no man of reason can judge, that all the Catholic Emperors, Bishops, and People of the far greatest part of the Imperial Church, would professedly equal or prefer a *Human* Office before one which they believed to be of *Divine* Institution.

3. To this day all the *Greek* Church show themselves to be of that judgment, by adhering to the Patriarch of *Constantinople,* whom they confess to have been made such by Emperors and Councils. And in the Contest with them the case is commonly pleaded accordingly.

4. *Gregory Nazianzen* would never have wished so earnestly that there were no *inequality, superiority,* or *priority of Seats,* if he had taken them to be of Divine Institution: Durst he have so opposed the Law and Order of God?

5. But to put all out of doubt, it is expressly determined by the most famous General Councils, even two of the four which are likened to the four Gospels, *Constantinople* and *Calcedon,* that the Primacy was given to *Rome* by the *Fathers* (so they called Councils) *because it was the Imperial Seat;* and therefore they give *equal* Privileges to *Constantinople,* because it is the Imperial Seat. The words of the Council of *Calcedon* (oft cited) are these (translated.)

Act. 16. Binii pag. 134. [*We following always the definitions of the holy Fathers and the Canons, and knowing those that have now been read of the* 150 *Bishops most beloved of God, that were congregated under the Emperor, of pious memory,* Theodosius *the*

Greater, in the Royal City of Constantinople, *New* Rome, *have ourselves also defined the same things, concerning the Privileges of the same most holy Church of* Constantinople, *New* Rome: *For to the Seat of old* Rome, *because of the Empire of that City, the Fathers consequently gave the Privileges. And the* 150 *Bishops most beloved of God, being moved with the same intentions, have given equal Privileges to the most holy Seat of New* Rome; *reasonably judging that the City adorned with the Empire and Senate, shall enjoy equal Privileges with old Regal* Rome.

This *Council* was called by the Emperor *Martian;* and his Lay-Officers were called the Judges: And the Bishops, to show what they thought of *Rome,* cried out [*They that contradict it are Nestorians: Let them that contradict it walk to* Rome. *Bin. p.* 98.]

If such a General Council *be not to be believed,* farewell all the Papists' Infallibility, Authority, Tradition, and Religion: If it *be to be believed,* the Pope is a Human Creature, and not a Divine.

But *Binius* saith, that *Rome receiveth not the Canons of this Council* of *Constantinople,* which this confirmeth, *but only their condemnation of* Macedonius: And he saith [*That every Council hath just so much strength and authority as the Apostolic See bestoweth on it: For* (saith he) *unless this be admitted, no reason can be given why some Councils of greater numbers of Bishops were reprobated, and others of a smaller number confirmed,*] Vol. 2. p. 515. And yet must we hear the noise of [*all the Christian World, and all the Bishops, and General Councils, and the Tradition of our Forefathers, &c.*] as against us, when all is but the *Pope of Rome, and such as please him?* and it is *He* and his *Pleasers* that refuse the most General Councils and Tradition? Away with this false deceitful talk.

6. Once more hear their own Confession; Their late English Bishop (of *Calcedon,* a fatal name) *R. Smyth* in his Survey against Bishop *Bromhall* saith, *cap.* 5. [*To us it sufficeth, that the Bishop of* Rome *is S.* Peter*'s Successor, and this all the Fathers testify, and all the Catholic Church believeth: But whether it be* jure divino *or* humano *is no point of Faith.*]

Ans. 1. Is not that a point of your *Faith* which the General Councils affirm? at least of your Religion? Who can tell then

what is your Faith? 2. If an *historical* point be not to be believed from *General Councils,* why should the History of *Peter*'s being at *Rome,* and Bishop there, be believed as from *Fathers?* (which *Nilas* hath said so much against.) 3. Do not the Fathers as much agree that *Peter* was *first Bishop of Antioch?* If then you have no more to show than they, where is your Title? 4. If your *Divine Right* of succeeding *Peter* be no point of Faith, then he that believeth it not, doth not sin against any point that God would have him believe as from him, and therefore is not to be thought erroneous in the Faith. 5. And yet upon this, which is *no point of Faith,* you build your *Faith* and *Church,* and would have all Christians do the like, on pain of damnation.

II. And as the *Roman Primacy* was but of *Man's devising,* so I next prove, that it was but *over one Empire,* unless any Neighbours for their own advantage did afterward voluntarily subject themselves. 1. Because the Powers that gave him his Primacy, extended but to the Empire. The Emperor and his Subjects ruled not other Lands.

2. Because the four other Patriarchs, made by the same Power, had no power without the Empire: As appeareth by the distribution of their Provinces in the Council of *Nice,* and afterward: *Pisanus*'s Canons we regard not, that take in *Ethiopia.*

Obj. *The* Abassins *now receive their chief Bishop from the Patriarch of* Alexandria.

That proveth not that ever they were under *Rome:* For there is not the least proof that ever they did so, till *Dioscorus* and his Successors separated from *Rome,* being rejected by them as Heretics, and by long and slow degrees enlarged their power over many Neighbour Volunteers.

3. Because the *General Councils* in which the Pope presided, were but of the Empire. And the Popes never claimed a more general extensive power then, than the *Councils:* Who indeed with the Emperors made the Papacy in its first state.

4. Because when the Patriarch of *Constantinople* claimed the Primacy, yea called himself *Universal Bishop,* which *Gregory* sharply reprehendeth as Antichristian, yet he never claimed

the Government of the whole Christian World, but only of the Empire. And in all their Contests there is no intimation of any such different Claim of the Competitors, as if *Rome* claimed *all the World,* and *Constantinople* but the Empire, or *Roman*-World: Their Contest was about the same Churches or Circuit, who should be Chief.

5. The Instances of the several Countries that were never under the Pope, do prove it: Even the great Empire of *Abassia,* and all the rest fore-named without the Empire. Of which and the Exception more under the next.

III. The *General Councils* were all so called only in respect to the generality of the Empire, and not as of all the Christian World; which was never dreamed of. Proved,

1. Because the Emperors that called them (*Constantine, Martian, &c.*) had no power out of the Empire.

2. There is no credible History that mentioneth any further call; much less of all the Christian World.

3. It was the Affairs only of the Empire that the Councils judged of, as is to be seen in all their Canons.

4. The Names of the Bishops yet to be seen, as Subscribers, fully prove it.

5. It was not a thing probable, if possible, that the *Indians, Persians,* and other Nations, should send their Bishops into the *Roman* Empire, which was usually at War with them, or dreaded and detested by them.

6. *Theodoret*'s foresaid words of *James* Bishop of *Nisibis* showeth it [*that he was at the Council of* Nice, *for* Nisibis *was then under the Roman Empire.*]

7. I have oft cited the words of *Reynerius,* saying, that the outer Churches planted by the Apostles were not *under the Church of Rome.*

8. The *executive* part neither could, nor ever was performed upon the Churches without the Empire. When did any Patriarch, or any Provincial, or General Council send for any Bishop or other person out of *India, Scythia, Ethiopia,* or any other exterior Nation, to answer any Accusation? or pass any

Sentence of Deposition, or Suspension against them? or put any other into their places?

9. General Councils are confessed by Papists to be but a *Human* and not a *Divine Institution:* and what Human Power could settle them in and over the Church Universal? If you say It is by *Universal Consent;* prove to us that ever there *was* such a *Consent,* or that ever there was any meeting or treaty for such Consent, of all the Christian World, and we will yield it to you. Surely if there be any Christians at the *Antipodes* they were not sent to in those days when *Lactantius, Augustine,* and others, denied that there were any *Antipodes,* and derided it; nor when the Pope by our Countryman *Boniface* his Instigation excommunicated *Virgilius* for holding that there were *Antipodes.* Hear their great disputer *Pighius, Hierarch. Eccles. lib.* 6. *c.* 1. *fol.* 230. [*General Councils* (saith he) *have not a Divine or Supernatural Original, but merely an Human Original, and are the Invention of* Constantine *a Prince; profitable indeed sometimes to find out in Controversy which is the Orthodox and Catholic Truth, though to this they are not necessary, seeing it is a readier way to advise with the Apostolic Seat.*] So that General Councils are *Novel, Human,* and only of the *Empire* then.

10. But to end all the Controversy, the names of the Subscribers are yet to be seen, who were not the representatives of the Christian World, but of the *Empire,* as is notorious.

Aeneas Sylvius Epist. 288. saith that [*before the Council of Nice there was little respect had to the Church of Rome.*] And though when he was made Pope, Interest caused him to revoke his judgment of the Councils' being above the Pope, he never revoked such historical narratives.

Their great Learned Mathematical (yet militant) Cardinal *Cusanus li. de Concord. Cathol. c.* 13. *&c.* saith [*that the Papacy is but of Positive right, and that Priests are* jure Divino *equal, and that it is subjectional Consent which giveth the Pope and Bishops their Majority, and that the distinction of Dioceses, and that a Bishop be over Presbyters are of Positive Right, and that Christ gave no more to* Peter *than the rest; and that if the congregate Church should choose*

the Bishop of Trent *for their President and Head, he should be more properly* Peter*'s Successor than the Bishop of* Rome.]

Object. *Oh but this Book is disallowed by the Pope.*

Answ. No wonder: So is all that is against him.

The Exceptions which we grant are these. 1. There were some Cities of the Empire that were near to other Nations, where the Princes being Heathens, Christians were underlings and few: And the Bishops of these Cities extended their care to as many of the Neighbour Countries as would voluntarily submit to them: So the Bishop of *Tomys* was Bishop of many *Scythians,* and so some that were on the Borders of *Persia,* had many *Persians,* and were at *Nice.*

2. There were some Countries that were sometimes under the *Roman* Power, and sometime under the *Persian,* or others, as Victory carried it; and these when they had been once of the Imperial Church, took it (when they fell under Heathens) to be their Honour, Strength, and Privilege to be so accounted still, and so would come to their Councils after if they could: So it was with the *Armenians;* and the *Africans,* when the *Vandals* had conquered them, *&c.*

3. There were some Bishops that lived on the Borders of the Empire, under Heathens, that needed the help of Neighbour Churches, and accordingly were oft with them, craving their help: So it was with the old *Britans,* as to the Bishops of *France.*

4. There were some small Countries adjoining to the Empire, who took the Friendship of the *Roman* Power for their great Honour and safety, and therefore were glad to conform in Religion to the Empire, and to let their Bishops join with them.

5. And there were some Neighbour Countries who were turned to Christianity by the Emissaries of the Bishop of *Rome;* who therefore (rejoicing also in so powerful a Patronage) were willingly his Subjects: But this was long after the first great Councils. These two last were the *Saxons* case in *England.* Accordingly you may sometimes find two or three out of such Countries at some of the General Councils of the

Empire. Which yet were called *General* but as to the *Empire,* and not as to the World.

To proceed in the History: When Christians were (mostly) exempted from the Magistrates Judicatures (that were most Heathens, though under a Christian Prince,) and so the *Bishops' Canons* were to them, as the *Laws of the Land* are to us, it is no wonder that Councils must then be very frequent, and Canons of great esteem; and hereupon Bishops by prosperity growing more and more worldly and carnal, made use of their Synodical Power, as is aforesaid, to accomplish their own Wills: So that the Synods of Bishops became the great Incendiaries and Troublers of the Empire. You need no more to satisfy you of this, but to read the Acts of the Councils, and the words of *Nazianzen* (called *Theologus*) against Synods and contentious Bishops, and the sad Exclamations of *Hillary Pictav.* They that had too little zeal against Ungodliness, Unrighteousness, Pride, and Malice, were so zealous against any that withdrew from their Power and contradicted them, that they easily stigmatized them for Heretics, and made even godly sober Christians suspected of Heresy for their sakes; while notorious Vice was used gently in those that adhered unto them. Even holy *Augustine* saith [*Drunkenness is a mortal sin, si sit assidua, if it be daily or constant;* (what, not else?) *and that they must not be roughly and sharply dealt with, but gently and by fair words:*] Vid. Aquin. 22. q. 150. a. 1. 4. ad 4. & a. 2. 1.

And their Great *Gregory,* [*That with leave they must be lest to their own wit,* (or disposition,) *lest they grow worse if they be pulled away from such a Custom,*] (as Drunkenness.)

But when it came to such as withdrew from under them, they were not so gentle. *Lucifer Calaritanus* is made the Head of a Heresy, because he was but too much against the receiving of such as had been *Arians.* The large Catalogues of Heresies contain many that never erred in Fundamentals. They prosecuted the *Priscillianists* so hotly, that if godly men were but given to fasting and strictness of life, they were brought into suspicion of Priscillianism: And the Vulgar took advantage of the Bishops' turbulency and ill disposition to

abuse the godly. S. *Martin* therefore separated from the whole Synod of the Bishops about him, and neither would join with them, nor have any Communion with them, as supposing them proud men that suppressed piety, and strengthened the wicked, by their intemperate prosecution: Whereupon they suspected and accused him also as an unlearned Fellow, and a Favourer of the Priscillianists. They did not only bring in the use of the Magistrates Sword in Religion against Heresy, which *Martin* could not bear, but they owned and flattered an usurping Emperor, that they might have the help of his Sword to do their work: So that in all those parts of *France, Germany,* and the Borders of *Italy,* I find not a Bishop that refused to own the Usurper, save S. *Ambrose,* and *Martin,* and one *French* Bishop: And *Sulpitius Severus* tells us that they were men too bad themselves, and that upon his knowledge *Ithacius* the Leader of them scarce cared what he said or did. S. *Cyril* at *Alexandria* is noted by *Socrates* as the first Bishop there that used the Sword; and his Kinsman S. *Theophilus* went beyond him, and took upon him even to favour the Error of the *Anthropomorphites,* that he might have their help against such as he hated, and prosecuted *Chrysostom* till he had procured his ejection, which made a rupture in that Church, and caused the separation of his Adherents, whom the Bishop would have taken for a new Sect, and called them *Joannites;* such skill had the domineering sort of Prelates in making and multiplying Heresies and Sects; and calling themselves still the Catholic Bishops because they kept the upper hand, and major Vote, except where the *Arians* over-topped them, who then claimed the Catholic Title to themselves. And by what Arts some of them kept the favour of the Emperors, to do their work and keep up their greatness, *Socrates* tells you in the instance of the said S. *Theophilus,* who sent one before the great Battle between *Theodosius* and *Eugenius* another Usurper, with two Letters, and a rich Present, and bid him stay till the Battle was over, and then give the flattering Letter and the Present to him whoever that got the better.

But though still since the *World* came into the Church, the Greatness, Power, and Honour of Prelacy made that Office a very alluring bait to the desires of the most worldly fleshly men, yet God kept up some that maintained their integrity, and bare their testimony against the pride and carnality of the rest; and though the scandals of the Catholics turned many to the *Novatians,* and other Sects that professed more strictness, (yea *Salvian* makes the *Arians, Gothes,* and *Vandals* themselves to be men of more honesty and temperance than the Catholic Clergy) yet sound Doctrine had still some holy Men that did maintain it.

But what were the *Popes* doing all this while? Sound Doctrine by the advantage of the soundness of the Western Emperor as is said, yet kept out Arianism, Pelagianism and such other Heresies there: but they were still striving to be the *Greatest: Leo* one of the best of them was one of the first that laid claim to an Universal Headship within the Empire: I told you how *Zosimus* and his Followers strove with the *Africans,* to have Appeals made to *Rome* from the *African* Bishops and Councils: which the *Africans* stiffly opposed as contrary to the Canons, to Custom, and to the reason of Discipline, which required that Cases should be judged and ended where persons and things were known, and not by Strangers afar off, where Witnesses could not without intolerable charge and trouble be brought beyond Sea to prosecute the suite. The words of the *African* Council translated are these: [Let your Holiness, as beseemeth you, repel the wicked refuges of Presbyters and the Clergy that follow them, because this is not taken from the *African* Church by any definitions of the Fathers, and the *Nicene* Decrees did most plainly commit both the inferior Clergy and the Bishops themselves, to the Metropolitans: for they did most prudently and most justly provide that all business should be ended in the very places where they began, and the Grace of the Holy Ghost will not (or should not) be wanting to each province: which Equity should by the Priests of Christ be prudently observed, and most constantly maintained: especially because it is granted to every

one to appeal to the Councils of their own Province, or to an Universal Council, if he be offended with the sentence of the Cognitors: unless there should be any one that can think that our God can (or will) inspire a Justice of trial into any *One Man*, and deny it to innumerable Priests that are Congregated in Council. Or how can that sentence that is past beyond Seas be valid, to which the necessary persons of the Witnesses could not be brought, because of the infirmities of Sex or Age, many other impediments intervening? For that any (that is *Legates*) should be sent from the side of your Holiness we find not constituted by any Synod of the Fathers (*it seems they never thought* of a *Divine right*) because that which you sent us by our Fellow Bishop *Faustinus* as done by the *Nicene* Council—(*they prove was false*)—send not your Clergy Executors (or *Agitators*) to potent men: Do not yield to it, lest we seem to bring the Secular arrogancy into the Church of Christ, which preferreth the light of simplicity and day of humility for them that desire to see God: For of our Brother *Faustinus* (*the Pope's Legate*) we are secure that the safe Brotherly love in your Holinesses honesty and moderation, can suffer him to stay no longer in *Africa.*]

The Popes took this heinously from the *Africans;* that they should stop them in their ascent to the Universal Monarchy: So that Pope *Boniface, Epist. ad Eulal.* saith, Aurelius *sometimes Bishop of* Carthage, *with his Colleagues, did begin by the Devil's instigation to wax proud against the Church of* Rome, *in the days of our Predecessors* Boniface *and* Celestine.] O how little do proud men instigated by the Devil know themselves, when they think that the Diabolical pride is in them that will not serve their pride!

And *Harding* against *Jewel, Art.* 4. *Sect.* 19. saith [*After the whole* African *Church had persevered in Schism, the space of twenty years, and had removed themselves from the obedience of the Apostolic Seat, being seduced by* Aurelius *Bishop of* Carthage, *&c.*]

Here note, 1. That so numerous were the Bishops in *Africa,* that one of their Provincial Councils had far more Bishops than the Council of *Trent,* or divers others called General. 2.

That they were men of the most eminent learning and piety, and that had kept up Discipline above almost any Church in the Empire. S. *Augustine* was one that subscribed the foresaid Letter: and were such Men like to be seduced by *Aurelius?* 3. Note with what Impudency even such men as *Harding* yet pretend that St *Augustine* was for their Papal Claim, when yet he professeth him to be one of the Schismatics that cast off obedience to the Seat of *Rome.* 4. Note what good Company we have in our reproach of the same pretended Schism. 5. Note how shamelessly the Papists still tell us of *all the Bishops of the Christian World* being for them, and asking us, *where was our Church before Luther,* that is, a *Society* of *Christians that obeyed not the Pope;* when they confess that *Augustine* and all the *African* Church for twenty years obeyed him not: (and alas, soon after the *Vandals* came and conquered them, and persecuted and destroyed those famous Bishops that did survive.)

And that you may further know that they had yet more disobedient Resisters than *African* Bishops, you may remember that even the *Egyptian* Monks, so long famous for their great austerity and sanctity, had renounced not only obedience but Communion with the Pope and his Adherents: *Fulgentius* was about going to live with them for their holiness, but he was told of this, and turned his course: *vid. Vit. Fulgent.*

And how great were all those Churches of *Aethiopia, Armenia* (*exterior*) *India, and the rest which the Apostles converted,* which *Reynerius* aforesaid truly saith, *are not under the Church of* Rome? *Cont. Waldens. Catal. in Biblioth. Patr. To.* 1. *p.* 773.

I have formerly recited the words of *Melch. Canus,* one of their great Bishops, saying [*Loc. Theolog. li.* 6. *c.* 7. *fol.* 201. *Not only the* Greeks, *but almost* ALL THE REST OF THE BISHOPS OF THE WHOLE WORLD *have vehemently fought to destroy the privilege of the Church of* Rome. *And indeed they had on their side both the Arms of Emperors, and the* GREATER NUMBER OF CHURCHES; *and yet they could never prevail to abrogate the Power of the one Pope of* Rome.

See here their own Confession, 1. Where Christians opposing the Pope were before *Luther.* 2. And of what credit their

boast of Universality and Catholic Tradition is. One while (*W. H.*) saith, *The Bishops of the whole World* were for them: But when their cause leads them to tell truth, they say, *Almost all the Bishops of the whole World have vehemently fought against the Pope,* and the Arms of *Emperors and the greater number of Churches were against them.*

And indeed, if it had been none but the *Greeks,* he might well have said [*The greater number of Churches:*] For the Contest which begun upon the Emperor's removal to *Constantinople,* and at the first General Council, increasing more and more, till *Gregory* opposed *John*'s Claim of Universal Bishop, as Antichristian, at last *Phoc as* the cruel murderer of *Mauritius* gave the Title to the Bishop of *Rome:* But that no whit ended the contest, following Emperors being contrary minded, and the *Greeks* continuing their Claim, the Bishops of *Rome* and *Constantinople* excommunicating one another; so that by this abominable striving which should be the Chief or Greatest, the Churches that were of old in the Empire have been divided, and so they continue to this very Day, as unreconcilable as ever.

And when *Gregory* sent his Emissary hither to Preach to the *Saxons,* they found the Christian *Britans* and *Scots* not only averse to the Government, Orders, and Ceremonies of *Rome* (so that in many Kings' Reigns neither words nor force could make them yield) but also such as refused their Communion, and would not so much as eat and drink with them in the same house.

No wonder then that *Marinarius* at the Council of *Trent* complain, *that the Church is shut up in the Corners of* Europe: and that *Sonnius* Bishop of *Antwerp* say (*Demonstr. Relig. Christ.* li. 2. Tract. 5. c. 3.) [*I pray you what room hath the Catholic Church now in the habitable World?*] *Scarce three Ells long in comparison of the vastness which the Satanical Church doth possess.*

The truth is, saith *Brierwood, Divide the known World* (and alas how much is unknown?) *into thirty parts, and about nineteen are Heathens, and six Mahometans, and five Christians of all sorts:* And of these Christians the Papists at this day are as

some think about a fifth part, some think a fourth part, and some think a third part.

And after the assuming of the Universal Title, their Popes more and more degenerated to such odious wickedness at last as we hope few Pagans are guilty of: which we speak, not as from Enemies, but from their own Historians and Flatterers, such as *Platina, Baronius, Genebrard, &c.* Nay, not so much from them as from Councils General and Provincial which have accused, condemned, and deposed them. Read in my *Key for Catholics* pag. 220, 221, 222. the words of *Baronius, Genebrard, Platina: CL. Espensaeus, Corn. Muss, Guicciardine,* &c. *Nic. Clemangis, Bernard, Alv. Pelagius* say more. Let any impartial man but read the Articles on which the Council at *Constance* condemned and deposed *John* 23. about 70 in number, in which they make him almost as bad as a man out of Hell can be, and indeed say, he was commonly called, [*The Devil incarnate.*]

Read the Articles on which the Council at *Basil* condemned and deposed *Eugenius the Fourth as a perjured Wretch, an obstinate Heretic,* and all the rest.

Read the Articles on which another Council deposed *John* 13. *alias* 12. And read the Lives of many more in their own Historians.

And what came the *Church* to when it had such Heads? when *Baronius* saith, *ad an.* 912. that [*the face of the holy Roman Church was exceeding filthy: when the most potent whores did rule at* Rome, *by whose pleasure Seats were changed, Bishops were given, and which is a thing horrid to be heard, and not to be spoken, their Lovers were thrust into* Peter's *Chair, being false Popes, who are not to be written in the Catalogue of the Roman Popes, but only for the marking of such times:* And *what kind of Cardinals, Priests, and Deacons, think you, we must imagine, that these Monsters did choose, when nothing is so rooted in Nature as for every one to beget his like.*] For *near* 150 *years,* saith *Genebrard, about fifty Popes were rather Apostatical than Apostolical.*]

And where was their *uninterrupted Succession all this time?*

Pope *Nicolas* in his *Decretals Caranz. p.* 393. 395) saith [*He that by Money or the favour of Men, or Popular or Military Tu-*

mults is intruded into the Apostolical Seat, without the Concordant and Canonical Election of the Cardinals and the following religious Clergy, let him not be taken for a Pope nor Apostolical, but Apostatical.] And of the Clergy he saith [*Priests that commit Fornication cannot have the honour of Priesthood;*] Yea, [*Let no Man hear Mass of a Priest whom he certainly knoweth to have a Concubine or Woman introduced.*] (And shall not *Protestants forgive* those that will not hear such, or as bad?) Where then was the Papacy under such?

For above forty years together there were more Popes than one at once, and sometimes more than two, one dwelling at *Rome,* and another at *Avignion,* or elsewhere: One set up and obeyed by one Party, and another by another Party, each condemning the other as an Usurper. And had the Universal Church then any *one Head?* And with what wickedness are they charged, one destroying what the other was for; see in *Wernerus Fascial.* and my *Key p.* 28, 29, 30.

Wernerus and others say, that *Silvester the second was made Pope by the help of the Devil to whom he did homage, that all might go as he would have it—but he quickly met with the End that such have that place their hope in deceitful Devils.*] When one Pope cuts another in pieces, and casteth his Carcass into the Water, as unworthy of Christian Burial (as you may find in the Lives of *Formosus* and *Sergius*) must we yet suppose such the Lawful Rulers of the World?

The fourteenth Schism (saith *Wernerus*) *was scandalous and full of confusion, between* Benedict *the Ninth* and five others: *Which* Benedict *was wholly vicious, and therefore being damned, appeared in a monstrous and horrid shape, his Head and Tail were like an Asses, the rest of his Body like a Bear, saying, I thus appear because I lived like a Beast. In this Schism* (saith the Author) *there was no less than six Popes at once.* 1. Benedict *was expulsed.* 2. Silvester *the Third gets in, but is cast out again, and* Benedict *restored.* 3. *But being again cast out,* Gregory *the Sixth is put into his place: Who because he was ignorant of Letters, caused another Pope to be Consecrated with him, to perform Church-Offices, which was the fourth: Which displeased many, and therefore a third is chosen instead of the*

two that were fighting with one another: But Henry (*the Emperor*) *coming in, deposed them all, and chose* Clement *the Second,* (who was the sixth of them that were alive at once.) In my Opinion this *Gregory* the Sixth showed himself the honestest Man of them all: Who though he could not read himself had the humility by choosing a Partner to confess his ignorance. And I am persuaded if the question had come before him, which was the truest Translation of the *Hebrew* or *Greek* Text, or such like, the Man would scarce have pretended to *Infallibility* in judging. The *nineteenth Schism, was between* Innocent *the Second and* Peter Leonis, *and* Innocent (saith the Author) *got the better because he had more on his side.*] A good Title no doubt! and thence a good Succession.

The twentieth Schism (saith *Wernerus*) *was great between* Alexander *the Third and four others, and it lasted seventeen years.*

After Nicolas *the Fourth* (saith he) *there was no Pope for two years and a half* (where was the Church then?) *and* Celestine *the Fifth that succeeded him resigning it,* Boniface *the Eighth entered, that stiled himself Lord of the whole World in Spirituals and Temporals; of whom it was said, he entered as a Fox, lived as a Lyon, and dyed like a Dog.* I have as good hope of the salvation of *Celestine* the Fifth and *Felix* the Fifth as any two of them, because as they were drawn in as simple Men in ignorance, so their resignation showed some hope that they repented.

The 22. *Schism* (saith *Wernerus ad an.* 1373.) *was the worst and most subtil Schism of all that were before it: for it was so perplexed that the most Learned and Conscientious Men were not able to find out to whom they should adhere: And it was continued for forty years to the great scandal of the whole Clergy, and the great loss of souls, because of Heresies and other evils that then sprung up, because there was no discipline in the Church against them. And therefore from this* Urban *the Sixth to the time of* Martin *the Fifth, I know not who was Pope.*] (Nor I neither: nor any one else I think).

The twenty third Schism, was between *Felix* the Fifth and *Eugenius* the Fourth, of which saith *Wernerus* [*Hence arose great contention among the Writers of this Matter,* pro & contra, *and*

they cannot agree to this day: For one part saith *that a Council is above the Pope; the other part on the contrary saith, no, but the Pope is above the Council: God grant his Church Peace, &c.*] The Christian World being all in Divisions because of sidings for these several Popes, the Emperors were constrained to call General Councils to end the Schismes: That at *Constance* thought they had done the Work; but they left Work enough for that at *Basil,* and more than they could do: When they found not a fit Man among the Clergy, they chose a Lay-man to be Pope, the Duke of *Savoy,* a Man noted for honest Simplicity and Piety, and called him *Felix* the Fifth: But *Eugenius,* who was cast out by the Council for his wickedness, kept the place, and made the Duke glad to resign and leave the Popedom.

Should I stay to tell you after the Barbarous Age 900. what work the Popes made in the World, how many thousand they forced to death upon the Wars at *Jerusalem;* how many score thousand *Waldenses* and *Albigenses* they Murdered; How they forced Kings to kiss their Feet, and trod on the Neck of *Frederick* the Emperor: How they divided the Empire by a Rebellious War against the Emperors *Henry* the Third and Fourth; And how they Armed their Subjects and Neighbours against them, yea the Emperor's Son against his own Father; And how the Writers of those times are divided, and open the lamentable Divisions of the Ages in which they lived; What work they made here against the Kings of *England;* and what passed between *Boniface* the Eighth and the King of *France,* and the Coin on which he Stamped his Resolution to *destroy* Babylon, *&c.* you would little think that either *Holiness* or *Unity* were any Property of the *Roman* Church.

Qu. *But if most did not favour them, how did they ascend to so great power? Ans.* 1. The old Name of the *Imperial Rome,* and the *Pope's Primacy* in the *Empire,* kept up a Veneration for him in the ignorant. 2. The Eastern Emperors seated at *Constantinople* were so taken up with Wars, Rebellions, and other Difficulties at home, that they could not take sufficient care of the West; but left the Popes too much advantage to grow great: and wickedness also increasing among them (though the Prince's

presence kept *their Patriarchs* in more order and submission, than the Popes that were become masterless) provoked God to give them up to be conquered by the *Mahometan Turks:* And by the Ambition of the Popes, the Emperors wanted the due assistance of their Western Subjects, to resist their Enemies. And the Pope took the advantage of the Eastern Emperor's weakness, to lead the West into a settled Rebellion, offering the King of *France* the Western Empire, which he embraced, the Pope making his Bargain with him for his own advantage. 3. And in the Wars of Christian Princes, the Pope used to obtrude his Arbitration, in such a manner as tended to his gain: so that he shortly got to be a temporal Prince of a great part of *Italy,* and to have Crowns and Kingdoms made feudatary to him. 4. And he got *Germany* to be broken into so many small Republics and Liberties, as that they were not able to unite to resist him. 5. And he took great advantage of the religious humours of any that were devout, and allowed them so many and various Societies, and with so great Privileges, as obliged them generally to uphold and serve him. Though he cruelly persecuted all that were against his Power and Interest, yet he allowed almost all the Diversities of such as would but unite in him and serve him. 6. And as he so twisted his own and all his Clergy's Interest, that they were all ready to obey and defend him against their several Princes, and thereby had a great power in every Christian State in *Europe,* so, keeping all his Clergy unmarried, their wealth still accumulated and flowed into the Church: And the Eastern Empire being first weakened and then overthrown, and the Western Nations kept weak, and in continual Wars against each other, there was none well able to resist his Pride, but one party still was ready to flatter him, partly to keep their own Clergy in Peace, and partly to have his help against their Enemies.

And the grand Cheat by which they were commonly deceived was, that they looked more at his present possession of Primacy, than at the reason and right by which he claimed it; and so he that had been Prime Patriarch in one Empire, set up by the Prince, still claimed the right of the same places when

the Empire was dissolved: as if the Subjects of the Kings of *France, Spain,* &c. must obey him, because they did so when they were the Subjects of *Constantine, Theodosius, Valentinian* &c. For by little and little he changed his Title mentioned in the Council of *Calcedon,* into a pretended *Divine Right,* and so they that would not have obeyed him as set up by *Caesar* and his Councils, obeyed him as if he had been set up by God: For the name of St. *Peter and his Chair and Successor* was used as the common blind.

And next to that he did by degrees change his claim of a *Primacy in the Empire* into a claim of Primacy in *all the World:* and his claim of a mere *Primacy,* into a claim of *Sovereignty,* or *Governing Monarchy.*

If you ask me, how could he blind Men so far as to make such a change? You seem not to know Man-kind, nor to observe common experience. Do you not consider what power the Clergy had every where got with the People? What an advantage possession and St. *Peter's* name were? And how lamentably ignorant they kept the People? Do we not see that even in our more knowing times, yea among Protestants, yea with some Divines, the evident distinction between their *Human Right* and their pretended *Divine Right,* and between an *Universal Council or Church of the Empire,* and of the *whole World,* have not been sufficiently observed in our Disputes against them?

And the additional Countries of voluntary Subjects in *Brittain, Hungary, Sweden, Denmark,* &c. which of later times, since his Imperial *Primacy,* have fallen in to him, have much helped to blind the people herein, and to serve his Claim as by Divine Right. For which ends his Emissaries have taken great pains, at the East and West *Indies,* in *China,* and *Japan* and *Congo,* (and once they made an attempt in *Abassia,*) and among the *Greeks* and in many other Nations of the World; laudably seeking to win some Heathens to Christ, that they might win them to the Pope; and turbulently seeking to disturb the *Greeks* and other Christian Churches, to draw them to the obedience of the Pope.

The Doctrines by which they promote their design are more than I may now stay to open.

I. One of the chief is, by depressing the Honour of the sacred Scriptures, as insufficient to acquaint us with all God's will that is necessary to our salvation, without *supplemental Tradition;* that so all men might be brought to depend on them as the Keepers of Tradition.

But 1. Is their Tradition yet written in any of their *own Books,* or not? If not, where are they kept? And who knoweth what they are? Is it not strange that so many Doctors in so many Ages, all remembering them, would none of them ever write them down? Are they in the Memory of the Pope only? (What of those that could not read, or that were condemned as Heretics of Infidels?) Then all the World must receive them from the Pope's Memory. If so, must it be *Word or Writing?* And had he no Memory of them before he was Pope? But if it be in *other Men's* Memories that your unwritten Traditions are kept, in whose is it? If in all the Doctors of your Church, why did not *Luther, Melancthon, Pet. Martyr* and the rest that turned from you, know them? Or did they suddenly *forget* them all when they turned Protestants? And how vast must your necessary Religion be, if yet it must have more in it unwritten, than is to be found in all your great Volumes of Councils, and your huge Libraries?

But I suppose you will say that all your unwritten Traditions are *now written:* If so, they are not *unwritten:* And *how long* have they been written, and by whom? If Fathers and Sons could keep them unwritten in memory a thousand years, why not 1100, and why not 1600? *&c.* If they were written in the beginning, where be the Books? Are they not such as other Christians can read and understand as well as you, (or an illiterate Pope?) If there be a necessity of having them in writing now, was there not the same necessity to former Ages?

2. I suppose you will send us to your *Councils* for those *Traditions:* But if the Bishops know them not before they come to the Council, how do they begin to know them then? Do they

go thither for a new miraculous Revelation of an old Tradition left with the whole Church?

1. But do not Councils oft determine things confessedly uncertain to the Church before; and yet out of utter uncertainty, it suddenly becometh an Article of Faith? For Instance, the great Council at *Basil* saith (*Bin. sess.* 30. *p.* 80.) [A hard Question hath been in divers parts and before this Synod, about the Conception of the glorious Virgin *Mary,* and the beginning of her Sanctification: Some saying that the Virgin and her Soul was for some time, or instant of time, actually under Original Sin: Others on the contrary saying, that from the beginning of her Creation God loving her gave her Grace, by which preserving and freeing that blessed Person from the Original Spot—We having diligently looked into the Authorities and Reasons which for many years past have in public relation on both sides been alleged, before this holy Synod, and having seen many other things about it, and weighed them by mature consideration, do *Define* and *Declare,* That the Doctrine affirming That the glorious Virgin *Mary* the Mother of God, by the singular preventing and operating Grace of God, was never actually under Original Sin, but was ever free from all Original and actual Sin, and was holy and immaculate, is to be approved, held and embraced of all Catholics as godly and consonant to Church-worship, Catholic Faith, right Reason, and sacred Scripture: and that henceforth it shall be lawful for no Man to Preach or Teach the contrary.

Where was this Tradition kept before, that was so hard a Controversy till now?

2. And do not General Councils bring in Novelties? I cited formerly the words of *Cajetan* in his Oration in the Council at the *Laterane* under *Leo* 10. charging the Council of *Constance, Basil* and *Pisa* with Novelty, and such Novelty as would have quite defaced the Church and was inconsistent with it. And *Pighius* chargeth them with the like. Yea I told you before where he saith that General Councils themselves are a Novelty devised by *Constantine.*

3. Be not General Councils themselves approved or reprobated at the pleasure of the Pope? What a number of reprobated Councils were there? that yet were as numerous as the approved, and as lawfully called and assembled. *Bellarmine* instanceth in the 2. of *Ephesus, Constance, Basil,* and many more: Of which more before.

II. Another of their deceits is by pretending to *Vinc. Lerinensis* Rule, *quod ab omnibus, ubique, semper,* &c. as if *Antiquity* and *Universality* were on their side. I must remember that I have long ago confuted these and the rest of their deceits in my *Key for Catholics:* Yet I will briefly speak here to these two.

1. For *Antiquity* we willingly stand to it, and to the rejecting of all Novelty in Religion: But we must have better proof than the word of our Grand-fathers, or a Priest. 1. Is any of their Books or Traditions elder than the holy Scripture? 2. Either the *Greeks, Armenians, Abassines, &c.* have been sure Keepers of *Antiquity,* or not: If yea, then we may take their Testimony as well as the Church of *Rome's.* If not, why may not you prove as ill Keepers of it as they?

3. But are they not *certain Novelties* that you would impose on us under the colour of *Antiquity?* Read but *Pet. Moulin de Novit. Papismi*, or Mr. *Th. Doolittle's* Discourse in the *Morning Lectures* against Popery, and you shall see the Novelty of your Religion fully proved. Take now but these few instances. 1. Your very *Patriarchate, Primacy,* Claim of Universality, General Councils, are all proved Novelties before.

2. Your own Writers confess that the denying the People *Christ's Blood* (or the Cup) in the Lord's Supper is a Novelty, that prevailed by Custom by little and little, and was not common long before the Council at *Constance:* Dare you say that it was so from the beginning, or of old?

3. Can you possibly believe that your forbidding men to read the Scriptures in a known Tongue without a Licence is not a Novelty, if ever you read *Chrysostom, Augustine, Jerome,* or anything of the Ancients?

4. Is it not a Novelty for the public Prayers of the Church to be ordinarily made in a Tongue not understood by the generality of the People? But I must stop.

2. And as to *Universality* I have before proved, 1. That by their own Confession most of the Churches and Bishops of the World have been against them. 2. That at this day they are not above the third part of Christians. Too small an Universal Church for any man of Charity and Consideration to be a member of: A Sect that call themselves *All the Church. Jacob. a Vitr. Histor. Orient. Cap.* 77. tells us that, *the Churches in the Easterly part of* Asia *alone exceeded in multitude both the Greek and Latin Churches.*

As for their telling us that all these followed *Dioscorus* a Heretic, or were *Nestorians,* and that all the *Abassines, Armenians, Georgians, Syrians, Coptics, Greeks, Protestants, &c.* are Heretics, or Schismatics, I have answered it so oft at large that I must not repeat what I have said. Only, 1. I say that if the Censures and Revilings of Adversaries can un-christen all others, and appropriate the Church to them that have least Charity, perhaps the Quakers may shortly have as fair a Title as the Papists. If *General Councils* be not to be believed when they Hereticate Popes, I will not believe a Railer when he Hereticates most of the Christian World, whom he never saw or spake with Sure that man judgeth persons unheard. 2. I repeat the words of *Barchardus* one of your own, that long lived among them, and spake what he saw, *p.* 325, 326. [*And is for those that we judge to be damned Heretics, as the* Nestorians, Jacobites, Maronites, Georgians, *and the like, I found them to be for the most part good and simple men, and living sincerely towards God and Men, they are of great abstinence, &c.*—And p. 324. he saith, that [*the* Syrians, Greeks, Armenians, Georgians, Nestorians, Nubians, Jubeans, Chaldeans, Maronites, Ethiopians, Egyptians, *and many other Nations of Christians there inhabit; and that some are Schismatics not subject to the Pope, and others called Heretics, as the* Nestorians, Jacobites, *&c. but there are many in these Sects that are very simple, knowing nothing of Heresies; devoted to Christ, macerating the Flesh with Fastings,*

and clothed with the most simple Garments, so that they far excel the very RELIGIOUS *of the Church of* Rome.] And, *p.* 323. of the Papists, whom he calleth by the Name of Christians, as if it were proper to them, he saith, [*There are in the Land of Promise men of every Nation under Heaven, and every Nation liveth after their own Rites; and to speak the very truth to our own great confusion, there are none found in it that are worse and more corrupt in Manners than Christians;*] (that is, Papists.)

3. If greater Errors and Vices than are among the *Armenians,* the *Abassines, Syrians, &c.* will allow us to reject men from our Communion, how much more cause have we to renounce Communion with Popes and Papists than with these Churches?

4. How can any man say that Nations and Countries are to be rejected as Heretics, unless the single persons guilty were tried and heard? when there is no Heresy but what is in individuals, and no Law of God or Reason condemneth the innocent for the guilties faults; much less all Posterity for their Ancestors.

III. But they never gain more than by aggravating the Divisions that are among other Christians, and boasting of the Unity of their Church: And the Contentions that have been among us have given them such advantage, as that some in the sense of their former guilt, having been Sect-masters themselves, have turned Papists, as thinking it the state of Union; and having found no settlement in those ways, which they have tried, because they never rightly understood the true temperament of the Christian Religion which they professed, they think to find it in that way that they never tried; as sick men turn from side to side for ease, while the cause of their weariness and pain is within them, and turneth with them.

Here let the Reader note, 1. That Fools judge of Differences in Religion by the *noise* that it makes in the World; but men of Reason judge of it by the *greatness* and *number* of the points of Difference. Verily our Differences here in *England,* and the Neighbour Protestant Churches, have showed in us much personal peevishness, unskilfulness, and other faults; but in my

judgment they are such as greatly commend our *real concord* in the same Religion, and partly our *Conscience* in valuing it, and being loth to lose it.

If you see Latin Grammarians reviling one another, about the *spelling* or *pronunciation* of a word or two, and critically contending with *Varro, Gellius, &c.* which is the right, when a man that never knew a word of Latin but Welsh or Irish, never strove about such Questions in his life; which of these will you think have more agreement in their Language? I would say that those men that disagree but about the pronunciation of a few words are very much agreed, in comparison of a Barbarian, that agreeth not with them in a Sentence or a Word. Even the old Schoolmen were in Language more agreed with *Erasmus, Faber, Hutten,* and other Critical Grammarians that derided them, than any illiterate man was with any of them. All *Gruterus* his Volumes of Grammatical Controversies, show not so much distance in Language, as the peaceable silence of an unlearned man doth.

And no one strives much about that which he doth not much care for: Countrymen can contemptuously laugh at Logical Disputes or Criticisms. Horses or Oxen will not strive with us for our Gold or Jewels, Clothes or Food, as we do with one another; and yet they are not so like us in the *estimation* of such things, as we are to one another.

When I hear religious persons contentiously censuring each other, about some little points of Ceremony, Order, Discipline, or Form, which are but the *fimbria,* or the Welts and Laces of Religion, I am angry at their weakness and defect of love; but I must needs think that there is very great concord in the *Faith* and *Religion* (Objective) of these men, who differ about no greater matters than such as these. If men that were building a Palace would fall together by the Ears, only about the driving of a Pin, I should marvel at their concord that differed in no more; though I could wish them, like wrangling Children, whipt for their folly and frowardness till they were quiet. The *great* things that *Protestants* have paltrily wrangled about, are, 1. The Doctrinal Controversies called *Arminian:* 2.

And the matters of Discipline. and Ceremonies. The former I have showed lately in a large Volume, hath much more of *verbal* than of *real difference,* and is cherished by the ambiguity of words, and the unskilfulness of too many to discuss those ambiguities, and find out exactly the true state of the Controversy: It is oft but Stubble that maketh the greatest blaze.

And as for the other, I would not undervalue the least things of Religion, but I will say, that *Engagement, Faction* and *worldly Interest* are magnifying Glasses to many men, and make a Mote to seem a Beam, and a Gnat to seem a Camel. And it is one of the Devil's old Wiles, to keep men from learning of Christ, how to Worship the Father of Spirits, in spirit and truth, by starting such Questions, as, *whether in this Mountain or at Jerusalem men ought to worship?* and to hinder *godly edifying by doting about questions that gender strife.* And fighting for Shoo-buckles may show the quarrelsomness of men, but it proveth not the Greatness of the matter.

2. Note further that though *Subjective Religion* (the *measures* of our belief, Love and Obedience) be as various as persons are; yet the *Objective Religion of all true Protestants* is the same: Not only the same in the Essentials (*one God, one Saviour and Lord, one Baptismal Covenant, one Creed, one Spirit, one Body of Christ, and one Hope of Glory, Eph.* 4. 4, 5, 6.) but also the same in all the *Integral parts:* For it is *Integrally* the *Holy Scripture* which containeth all that they take (with the Law of Nature) to be the whole Law of God, and so the Rule of Divine *Faith, Desire* and *Duty.* They may *subjectively* have some difference in understanding some Texts, (as the most Learned and holy in the world have:) But *Objectively* they have no other Divine Faith or Religion.

3. And note, that the Church that *Protestants,* yea *Greeks, Armenians, Syrians, Abassines* are of, are all certainly one and the same Church: For a Church is constituted of the *Ruling* and the *Ruled* Parts. And they perfectly agree that *Christ* is the only Essentiating and Universal Head; In him they all unite, and confess that there is no other. Even the Patriarch of *Constantinople,*

as I have showed, claimeth but a Primacy in the Empire, and not the Government of all the World, no not of us in *England.*

And as for the Ruled Constitutive part, we are agreed that it is All *Baptized Christians* that have not apostatized, nor forsaken any Essential part of Christianity, nor are excommunicate by Power from Christ. So that we are clearly all of one and the same Church.

But how far the Papists differ in the *Greatness* and *number* of their Controversies, I think to tell you a little more anon.

IV. I may not stay to show at large, how they vary their shape and course as may fit their Interest: How sometime they put on the person of Infidels or Atheists to plead men into an uncertainty of all Religion, that they may be loose enough to follow them into theirs: For even so *Car. Boverius* would have persuaded our late King, *Apparat. ad Consult.* [*The first thing is* (saith he) *seeing true Religion is to be inquired after by you, that before you address yourself to search for it, you first have all Religions in suspicion with you; and that you will so long suspend* (or take off) *your mind and will from the Faith and Religion of the Protestants, as you are in searching after the truth.*]

Reader, doth not this tell you whence much of our late Atheism and Infidelity cometh, and what it tendeth to? I tell thee not the words of a Novice, but a person chosen to have seduced our King, when he was Prince, in *Spain.* And is not this way very suitable to the end? How must men become Papists? *Boverius* will teach you: First *suspect* all Religion, and with your very *Mind* and *will* cease to believe that there is a God, or that he is Powerful, Wise or Good, or that we are his Creatures and Subjects, or that there is any Heaven or Hell or Life to come, or that Christ is not a Deceiver but a Saviour, or that any of the Bible is true: Cease from Loving, Fearing, Obeying or trusting God, and from loving man for his sake: Cease praying to him, and forbearing any wickedness, injustice, cruetly, perjury or filthiness as being forbidden by him, and this as long as you are searching after the truth.] Verily this devilish counsel is so notoriously followed now by some, that we may fear what truth it is that they are searching after.

Certainly this way is of the Devil, and how it can lead to God I know not. I love *Cartesian* Philosophy the worse because its principle is so congruous to this.

And their Doctrine of lawful hiding their Religion by Equivocation is commonly known. And what they say about coming to our Churches I have formerly cited at large out of *Thom. a Jesu,* and the lawfulness of denying the person of a Clergyman or a Religious man: And the ground of all, [*because human Laws for the most part bind not the Subjects' Conscience when there is great hazard of life, as Azorius* hath well taught, *Inst. Moral.* To. 1. l. 8. c. 27. See the Author's words *de Convers. Gent.* li. 5. Dub. 4. pag. 218. and Dub. 5. p. 218, 219. and Dub. 6. p. 220. We may find them in our Churches and garb when their interest requires it. But again I must for all these points refer the Reader to *my forementioned Book* (*A Key for Catholics.*)

The history of the Papacy being thus briefly given you, I should next briefly tell you, I. What a Pope is; II. What a Papist is; III. What the present Papal Church is: But it requireth more than this short Writing, to open any one of these to the full: But take this breviate.

CHAP. VI. *What the Pope is.*

1. WE are not to describe the Bishop of *Rome* as he was at the beginning, but as in that Stature to which he is since grown up. And so unmeasurable a Potentate must be described to you but *by parts, and inadequate Conceptions;* And I will no more undertake to enumerate all, than to Name all the Kingdoms known and unknown to us *Europeans* which he claimeth the Government of. But I remember who it was that showed Christ all the Kingdoms of the world, and said, *All these things will I give thee if thou wilt fall down and worship me, Math.* 4. 9. Or as *Luk.* 4. 6. *All this Power will I give thee and the Glory of them, for that is delivered to me, and to whomsoever I will I give it.*

I. *The Pope of* Rome *is an Usurper, who from the lawful Episcopacy of one particular Church aspired to be a Bishop over many Churches and Bishops, and a Metropolitan, and thence to be a Patriarch,* and the *first Patriarch in the* Roman *Empire in order of Dignity, and entered a Contest for the Primacy with his Competitor of* Constantinople, *which is not ended to this day: And next claimed an Universal Government in the Empire as well as a Primacy; And also the Government of such Neighbour Churches as had once been in the Empire, or had been lately converted by any of his Clergy; And lastly being made a King of* Rome *or Secular Prince in* Italy, *he also claimed a Monarchy or Government over all the world under the name of Ecclesiastical.*]

All this is proved in the foregoing History of the Papacy, and may better be found out by any that will peruse the History of the Church and Empire, than by particular Citations.

II. *By the name of Ecclesiastical power he understandeth not only that which is truly spiritual or sacerdotal, by which God's word is preached and applied to particular persons, by reception into Christian Communion, and exclusion from it, sententially; But also a power of erecting Courts of Judicature in all Kingdoms to judge of cases about Ministers, Temples, Tithes, Testaments, Administration of Goods, Lawfulness of Marriages, Divorces and many such like, in a manner of Constraint which is proper to the Magistrate:* Abusively calling *this the Ecclesiastical Power* in foro exteriore, *dis-*

tinct from the sacerdotal in foro interiore, *cheating the World with words.*

Experience fully proveth this.

III. *For the performance of this Deceit they appropriate to Princes and other Magistrates the Titles of* [CIVIL] or [SECULAR] *making the world believe that as Soul and Body differ, so the Pope and his Clergy being Governors of the Soul, or in order to salvation, excel Kings and Magistrates who are but Governors for bodily welfare and Civil Peace.*

Whereas indeed the difference of the Offices of *Christian Magistrates* and *Pastors,* is not, that one is but for the *Body* and the other for the *Soul;* for both are to further men's Salvation, and true Religion, and the obedience of God's Laws in order thereto: But it is in this, that Princes and Magistrates have the Power of Governing men in things Secular and Religious within their true Cognisance *by the Sword,* that is, by *external Compulsion and Coercion,* by *Mulcts and Penalties* forcibly executed; whereas the Pastors have only the Charge of Teaching men *Christ's Doctrine,* and Guiding the Church in the administration of God's Worship, and by the *Keys or Authority* from Christ, judging who is capable or uncapable of Church Communion, and declaring pardon and Salvation to the penitent for their Comfort, and the contrary to the impenitent for their humiliation; and all this only *by Word of Mouth, without any Constraining force.*

Proof of the Character.

Pope *Innoc.* 3. (*vid. &* Cosins *Hist. Transub.* p. 147, 148) [*God made two great Lights in the Firmament of Heaven,—and of the Universal Church; that is, he instituted two Dignities, which are the Pontifical Authority and the Regal Power: But that which ruleth the Day, that is, things spiritual, is the greatest, and that which ruleth carnal things is the less: that it may be known that the difference between Popes and Kings is such as is the difference between the Sun and the Moon.*

If this were true, the lowest Priest were incomparably more honourable or amiable than Kings, as the Soul is more excellent than the Body: But *David, Solomon, Hezekiah, Josiah,* and

all good Kings, did show that Religion was the matter of their Government and the principal part of their care. Read for this fully Bishop *Bilson* of Christian obedience, Bishop *Buckeridge* for the Magistrates Power, and Bishop *Andrews Tortura Torti;* excellent discourses against the Papal Usurpation.

IV. *The Office which he thus claimeth as over all the Earth, is to be the Vicar of Christ or of God, or the Vice-Christ or Vice-God, as Kings have their Vice-Kings in remote Provinces.*

Proved.

I have elsewhere cited the words of Popes saying, that they are *Vice-Christi* and *Vice-Dei,* at large: And Pope *Julius*'s words [*we holding the place of the Great God, the Maker of all things and all Laws:*] And *Carol. Boverius*'s words, *Consult. de. Rat. fidei,* &c. to our late King, saying [*Besides Christ the Invisible Head of the Church, there is a necessity, that we acknowledge another certain visible Head, subrogate to Christ and instituted of him,* &c.] And *Card. Betrand's.* words in *Biblioth. Patrum,* that saith, *Almighty God had not been wise else, if he had not sent One only to Govern the world under him:*] *And Boverius* reason [*Christ was himself on Earth once a visible Monarch; And if the Church had need of a visible Monarch, it hath need of one still.*] Christ said that it was necessary that he went away that the Paraclete might come, whom *Tertullian* calleth his *Agent;* But the Papists will not part with him so, but they will have his *Body* here still, and yet a Vice-Christ or visible Monarch also in his stead: See their own words, which I have cited at large in my Answer to Mr. *Johnson.*

V. *The pretended ground of this his Claim is, that St.* Peter *received this power from Christ, and that St.* Peter *was Bishop last at* Rome, *and that the Pope succeedeth him in his Bishopric, and Power.*

This is professed commonly by them.

But 1. It is false that St. *Peter* received any such Power from Christ, as to be the Governor of all the rest of the Apostles and Christians in the World: He never exercised or claimed such a Government, but in cases of Controversy *Act.* 15. and *Gal.* 2, &c. He dealeth but on equal terms with the rest. And they that said *I am of Cephas*, are as well rebuked as they that said, *I am of*

Paul.] And 1 *Cor.* 12. 28, 29, &c. Apostles are said to be but *chief Members* of the Church, and *Christ* the only *Head:* And when the Disciples strove who should be the greatest, Christ giveth it not to *Peter,* but forbideth it to them all: And *Peter* himself as a fellow Elder exhorteth all Elders to oversee and feed the Flock, *not as Lords over the Heritage,* &c. and never claimeth a Sovereignty to himself. No word mentioneth any Power that St. *Peter* had greater than his Apostleship: And *Bellarmine* professeth that the Pope hath not his power as succeeding him in his Apostleship, but as an ordinary Pastor over the whole Church.

2. There is no certainty that ever *Peter* was at *Rome* (as *Nilus* hath showed;) but a human Testimony of many later Fathers, upon the words of uncertain Reporters before them, which are to be believed indeed as probable but no more; There being as great a number of Papist Writers I think (about 60) that tell us there was a Pope *Joane,* and yet it is uncertain if not least probable. But if he was at *Rome,* Apostles were no where proper Bishops. Bishops were the fixed Elders or Pastors of particular Churches: Apostles were movable and Itinerant, having an Indefinite Commission to go preach the Gospel to all the world as far as they were able. Though the ancient Fathers used to call them Bishops because *pro tempore* they Ruled (persuasively) where they came: Though indeed their work was to settle Churches and Bishops, and not to be settled Bishops themselves.

3. *Paul* was certainly and long at *Rome,* and liker to be as a Bishop there of the two: If *Paul* was not one, *Peter* was not; for there is no more, but less proof of his Government there. If *Paul* was one, then one City had two, contrary to the old Canons.

4. There is no proof that *Peter's* being *last at Rome* gave his Power to all or any following Bishops of *Rome,* any more than to the Bishops of *Antioch* who are said to succeed him in his first Bishopric; or any more than Christ's dying at *Jerusalem,* the Mother Church, did fix the Supremacy there: or any more than the other eleven Apostles did leave their power which

they had above all ordinary Bishops, to the places where they abode (either last or first.) If *Peter's* dying Bishop at *Rome* prove such a succession of Universal Monarchy, the aforesaid Successions will be proved by the same Reason, which yet none affirm: Even *Alexandria* claimed but from St. *Mark* who was less than thirteen Apostles: But no *Testament* of *Peter* declaring any conveyance of such a Monarchy is pretended by the Popes (which is a wonder:) Nor any word that ever he used of such importance.

5. I have showed that General Councils' (*Calced.* and *Constant.*) have declared that *Rome's* primacy had a later human rise.

Yet would they have exercised no other Government than St. *Peter* did, the world would not have been troubled by them as they have been.

VI. *The Papists seem not resolved themselves whether the Pope have an Universal Apostleship or Teaching office, as well as the Universal Monarchy or Government.*

Though *Bellarmine* say that he succeedeth not *Peter* as an *Apostle,* but as a *Pastor;* yet most others that I have seen meddling with it, say otherwise. If he succeed not in the Apostleship, he is no true Successor of St. *Peter* at all, in any supereminence of Power: For what he had was as an Apostle: If he do, then he is bound to go preach himself to the Nations of the world as *Peter* was: To send others to preach, and not do it himself was no *Apostleship:* They were sent themselves. *David* and *Solomon* set up Priests, and yet were themselves no Priests: *Hezekiah* and *Josiah* sent and set up Preachers, and yet undertook not that office themselves.

VII. *This Pope claimeth the sole Power of calling General Councils of all the Christian world* (*yet never did it*) *And consequently of being the Judge when any shall be called, and so whether ever there shall be any or not. And though former General Councils voted that they should be every ten years, yet he prevaileth to the contrary.*

VIII. *Also he claimeth the sole power of presiding in such Councils, and also of making their Decrees either valid by his approbation or null or invalid by his Reprobation, as he please: so that nothing*

that they Decree is of force but as it pleaseth him; whence we have distinct Catalogues of Approved and Reprobate Councils.

Yet no mortal man knoweth oftentimes how much of a Council's Acts and Decrees the Pope approveth. When *Martin* the fifth had consented to all done by the Council of *Constance,* the word [*Conciliariter acta*] seemed to the Council to mean [*all that they did de facto as a Council.*] But the Popes ever since yet reject that Council on pretence that by [*conciliariter*] was meant *all that* de jure *as a Council they might do. Gregory* the first approved of the four first General Councils, receiving them as the four Gospels (and if his Predecessors did not, it was because their consent was not taken to be necessary, nor much sought.) And yet now *Bellarmine* raileth at the Council of *Calcedon,* and they tell us how much of it they receive and how much not. And so of many others.

And nothing is more evident in such History, than that the Emperors and not the Pope, were they that called divers of the first Councils.

IX. *The Pope accordingly claimeth a supremacy above General Councils; that he may dissolve them; but they cannot question or depose him; though General Councils have decreed the contrary.*

I recited *Binnius* words before, *Vol.* 2. *p.* 515. *Pighius, Gretser*'s, *Bellarmine*'s, and multitudes more might soon be produced to the same sense; The eighth General Council at *Constantinople* saith, *Can.* 21. that [None must compose any Accusations against the Pope] Vid. *Bellarm. de concil. li.* 2. c. 11.

Saith *Pighius,* Hier. Eccl. li. 6. [The Councils of *Constance* and *Basil* went about by a new trick and pernicious example to destroy the Ecclesiastical Hierarchy, and instead of it to bring in the domination of a promiscuous confused popular multitude; that is, to raise again *Babylon* itself; subjecting to themselves, or the Community of the Church (which they falsely pretended that they represented) the very Head and Prince of the whole Church: and him that is the Vicar of Christ himself in this his Kingdom; and this against Order and Nature, against the clearest light of Gospel Verity, against all

Authority of Antiquity, and against the undoubted faith and judgment of the Orthodox Church itself.] (And yet our Papists would persuade us that their Grandfathers, much less great General Councils cannot bring in Novelties on pretence of Antiquity, and mislead them.) Truly said *Lud. Vives, in August. de Civ. Dei* l. 20. c. 26 [Those are taken by them for Edicts and Councils which make for them; the rest they no more regard than a meeting of Women in a Work-house or a Washingplace.]

X. *He claimeth a power of Legislation to all the Christian World, Kings, and States, and single Subjects; and that no Kings can nullify his Laws to their own Subjects: As also the power of receiving Accusations and Appeals, and of judging and executing accordingly.*

This needeth no proof, being not denied.

XI. *He claimeth power to Interdict whole Kingdoms; that is, when they think the Rulers give them Cause; to forbid the preaching of the Gospel and public worship of God, to all the People of the Land; yea forbidding the Clergy who are Subjects to obey their own Princes who shall command them* (*as the Kings of* Israel *did the Priests and Levites*) *to do their offices.*

That is, If the State or King offend them, they will be avenged on God by denying him all Public Worship, and on the souls of millions of innocent people by doing their worst to send them to Hell, (where the unbelieving ignorant, and those that worship not God, must go.) The instances in *Germany*, and the *Venetian* Interdict and others are too full proof of their Claim and Practice.

XII. *The Pope claimeth power, even by the Decrees of an approved General Council to oblige all men to believe that all theirs and all other men's senses and perception upon sense, are certainly deceived, when they think that there is real Bread and Wine after Consecration: And this denial of all men's Common sense, he hath made an Article of faith, and necessary to salvation.*

XIII. *He hath by the same Council decreed that all those that do not thus far renounce all their senses, shall be exterminated and made uncapable to make any will,* &c. *And by other of his Laws,*

that they be all burnt as Heretics; and delivered to that end to the secular power.

XIV. *By the same Council he hath decreed that Temporals Lords shall take an Oath to execute this Decree, and shall be excommunicated if they exterminate not all such Believers of sense from their dominions: And to dishonour Kings by Excommunications* (*whom the fifth Commandment bids us honour*) *is an act of Papal power.*

XV. *By the same Council he hath Decreed to depose all temporal Lords that will not thus destroy or exterminate their Subjects, and to give their Dominions to Papists that will do it: So that the Pope's power to depose Princes is become an Article of their Religion.*

And in his *Roman* Councils *Greg.* 7 declareth that he hath power to take down and set up Kings and Emperors: And in his Letters to the *German* Clergy: And what he said, he did practise by bloody and unnatural wars, to the great distraction of all the Empire.

Saith *Innocent* 3. Serm. 2. [*To me it is said, I have set thee over Nations and Kingdoms, to set up and destroy, and scatter—I am set up as a middle person between God and Man; on this side God, but beyond Man; yea greater than Man; who judge all, and can be judged of none: I am the Bridegroom, &c.*]

XVI. *By the same Council he hath power to dispense with the Oaths of all the Subjects of such Princes, and to disoblige them, how many soever, from their Allegiance; so that the Pope's Power thus to dissolve the obligation of Oaths is also become an Article of their Religion.*

I prove all these together, by giving you the words of the Council in English. Once again (though I have oft cited them) *c.* 1. they say that [No man can be saved out of their Universal Church.] And *c.* 2. that [The Bread and Wine in the Sacrament of the Altar are transubstantiate into the Body and Blood of Christ, the appearances remaining.] And *c.* 3. [We excommunicate and anathematize every Heresy extolling itself against this holy Orthodox Catholic Faith, which we have before expounded, condemning all Heretics by what Names soever they be called—And being condemned, let them be left to the present Secular Power, or their Bailiffs, to be pun-

ished, the Clergy being first degraded of their Orders. And let the Goods of such condemned ones be confiscate, if they be Lay-men; but if they be Clergy-men, let them be given to the Churches whence they had their Stipends. And those that are found to be noted *only by suspicion,* if they do not by congruous purgation demonstrate their innocency, according to the considerations of the suspicion, and the quality of the person, let them be smitten with the Sword of Anathema, and avoided by all men, till they have given sufficient satisfaction; and if they remain a year excommunicate let them be condemned as Heretics: And let the *Secular Powers, in what Office soever,* be admonished and persuaded, and if it be necessary, *compelled* by Ecclesiastical censure, that as they would be reputed and accounted Believers, so for the defence of the Faith, *they take an Oath publicly,* that they will study in good earnest, according to their power, to exterminate all that are by the Church denoted Heretics, from the Countries subject to their jurisdiction. So that when *any one shall be taken into Spiritual* or *Temporal Power,* he shall by *his Oath* make good this Chapter. But if the Temporal Lord, being admonished by the Church, shall neglect to purge his Country of heretical defilement, let him by the Metropolitan, and other com-Provincial Bishops be tyed by the bond of Excommunication. And if he refuse to satisfy within a year, let it be signified to the Pope, that he may from thenceforth denounce his Vassals absolved from his fidelity, and may expose his Country to be seized on by Catholics, who rooting out the Heretics may possess it without contradiction, and may keep it in the purity of Faith, saving the Right of the Principal Lord, so be it that he himself do make no hindrance hereabout, nor oppose any impediment: And the same Law is to be observed with them that are not Principal Lords. And the Catholics that, taking the Sign of the Cross, shall set themselves to the rooting out of the Heretics, shall enjoy the same Indulgences and holy Privileges which were granted to those that go to the relief of the Holy Land. Moreover we decree, That the Believers, Receivers, Defenders, and Favourers of Heretics shall be Excommunicate; firmly de-

creeing, that after any such is noted by Excommunication, if he refuse to satisfy within a year, he shall from thenceforth be *ipso jure, infamous,* and may not be admitted to public Offices or Councils or to the choice of such, or to bear witness: And he shall be intestate, and not have power to make a will, nor may come to a succession of Inheritance: And no man shall be forced to answer him in any Cause but he shall be forced to answer others: And if he be a Judge, his sentence shall be invalid, and no Causes shall be brought to his hearing: If a Notary (or Register) the instruments made by him shall be utterly void, and damned with the damned Author: And so in other like cases we command that it be observed. They further command Bishops by themselves or their Archdeacons or other fit persons, once or twice a year to search every Parish where any Heretic is found to dwell, and to put all the Neighbourhood to their Oathes, whether they know of any Heretics there, or of any *private meetings, or any that in life and manners do differ from the Common Conversation of the faithful, &c.* And the Bishops that neglect this are to be cast out, and others put into their places that will do them.

Here you see that no man must live on Earth (for all Kingdoms must be subject to the Pope) that will not renounce his humanity and animality or common senses, and declare himself below a Beast, That all Kings are the Pope's Subjects, commanded by him, and must take a new Oath when they are crowned to destroy all their Subjects that believe their senses; That even the suspected are undone if they prove not the Negative: That Princes must be a thousand fold worse than hang-men, who hang not whole Countries but a few condemned Malefactors: That Popes can and must depose Kings, and Lords that will not do such things as these, and give their Dominion to others: That the sign of the Cross is the Cross Makers sign: That all the promises of the pardon and happiness that were made to the invaders of the holy Land are given to those Wretches, that when they have lived in filthiness and wickedness will expiate it by murdering the innocent (as they did, say Historians, by above an hundred

thousand.) This is the *Roman* way to heaven. That the very favorers of these men that will not renounce humanity are to be also utterly ruined. That (as in the *Japan* persecution of the Christians) all the neighbour-hood must be Sworn to detect them? And the office of a Bishop is to see all this done: And now if you *will see* you see how the Church of *Rome* is upheld, and propagated: And what the Religion called Popery is? And consider whether as Angels and Saints are near of Kin, or like in disposition, it be not so also with *Devils* and *wicked men:* And whether all Protestants be not Dead men in Law, or condemned, where the Papal Religion and Laws are received: And what will follow hereupon.

And besides *Gregory* the first's Declaration in his *Roman* Councils before mentioned, he saith in *Epist.* 7. l. 4. [And for the conspiracy of Heretics and the King, we believe it is not unknown to you that are near them how it may be impugned by the Catholic Bishops and Dukes; and many others in the *German* parts: For the faithful of the Church of *Rome* are come to such a number, that unless the King shall come to satisfaction, they may openly profess to choose another King; and observing Justice, we have promised to favour them, and will keep our promise firm, &c.

XVII. *The Pope, though pretending to be the infallible Judge of Controversies, doth tolerate his most famous Learned Doctors, in great numbers, without any Condemnation or disowning, to write that excommunicate Kings are no Kings, and may lawfully be killed, as some say by the Pope's consent or direction, or as others say, without it.*

Henry Fowlis in his Book of *Popish Treasons,* hath so largely proved, by citing the *express words* of their chief Doctors, Jesuits, Dominicans and others, that this is their ordinary assertion, that I must remit the Reader thither for full satisfaction beyond all denial.

I briefly refer you but to the words of Learned *Suarez advers. sect. Angl. l.* 6. *Cap.* 4. *sect.* 14. and *Cap.* 6. *sect.* 22. 24. *Azorius Instit. Mor. part.* 1. l. 8. c. 13. And *Dom. Bannes in Thom.* 22. q. 12. a. 2. saith [*When there is evident knowledge of the Crime, Subjects*

may lawfully exempt themselves from the Power of their Princes, before any declaratory, sentence of a Judge, so they have but strength to do it.] [*Hence it followeth that the faithful* (Papists) *of* England *and* Saxonie *are to be excused, that do not free themselves from the Power of their Superiors, nor make war against them: because commonly they are not strong enough, to manage those wars: and great dangers hang over them.*

So then, the disability of the Papists is all the security we can hope for from them.

Augustine Triumphus saith (*de potest. Eccl.* q. 46. a. 2.) *There is no doubt but the Pope may depose all Kings, when there is reasonable cause for it.*

Part of *Suarez* words are (*Defens. fid. Cath.* l. 6. c. 4. §. 14.) [*After sentence he is altogether deprived of his Kingdom, so that he cannot by just title possess it: Therefore from thence-forward he may be handled as a mere Tyrant, and consequently any private man may kill him.*

I have elsewhere cited *Card. Perrons* words out of Bishop *Usher* professing that, *if the Pope may not depose Kings, it will follow that he is Antichrist who hath so long professed it:* I grant the consequence.

XVIII. *The Pope professeth the fallibility of General Councils, but that he is infallible himself.*

The first is proved by his reprobating many. For the second, saith *Leo* 10. *in Bull. cont. Luth. in Bin.* p. 655. [*The holy Popes our predecessors never erred in their Canons and Constitutions.*]

XIX. *They hold this gift of infallibility to be by supernatural Inspiration, beyond all natural faculties and means; even to men that cannot Read or have no Learning, at least none in the Text of Scripture, to judge of such Texts, the translation and exposition of them.*

That they pretend to be Judges in Controversies *de fide,* I need not prove: Nor that some have been Lads, and some Men unlearned, as I proved before of *Greg.* 6. Their own Histories agree in this.

XX. *Though the Decrees of General Councils be their very Religion, and pretended immutable, the Pope pretendeth to a Power to*

change them. (And yet they pretend that all is old and from their forefathers.)

Both these foregoing parts are proved, by Pope *Julius* 2. in his General Council at the *Laterane* with their approbation, *Monitor. cont. Prag. Sanct. Bin.* Vol. 4. p. 560. [*Though the Institutions of sacred Canons, holy Fathers, and Popes of Rome—and their Decrees be judged immutable as made by Divine Inspiration, yet the Pope of* Rome, *who though of unequal merits, holdeth the place of the Eternal King, and the Maker of all Things and all Laws on Earth, may abrogate these Decrees when they are abused.*

XXI. *By the same pretended Power he changeth Christ's own Instituted Sacrament, even in the substance of it, denying all the Laity the Cup, while they condemn all that will not believe that the Wine is turned into his very Blood; And he that eateth not the Flesh of Christ, and drinketh not his Blood, hath not Life,* (*which they expound of the Sacrament.*)

Christ said when he had given them the Cup, *Drink yes all of it, Mat.* 26. 27. And *Paul* delivereth it to the *Laity* from the Lord, 1 Cor. 11. 23. 25. 28. [This do ye, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me.] And [as oft as ye eat this Bread, and drink this Cup, ye show the Lord's death till he come: Let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of this Bread, and drink of this Cup] 1 *Cor.* 10. 21. Ye cannot drink the Cup of the Lord, and the Cup of Devils, is given to the Laity as a reason against their Idol Communion. In relation to the Sacrament it's said that [all were made to drink into one Spirit.] The reception of the Spirit being likened to that drinking. And if the Pope may abrogate one half the Sacrament, why not the other.

XXII. *The Pope declareth all the World to be damned except his own Subjects.*

See the foresaid first Canon of *Innocents Laterane* Council.

Leo 10. *Abrog. Pragm. Sanct. Bul. in the* 17. General Council at *Laterane* saith [*And seeing it is of necessity to salvation that all the faithful of Christ be subject to the Pope of* Rome, *as we are taught by the Testimony of Divine Scripture and of the holy Fathers, and it is declared in the constitution of Pope* Boniface *the* 7. *&c.*

Pope *Pius* 2. was converted from the supremacy of Councils by this Doctrine of a Cardinal which he approveth (or by the Popedom,) *Bul. Retract. in Bin. Vol.* 4. *p.* 514. [I came to the Fountain of truth which the holy Doctors both Greek and Latin show, who with one Voice say, that he cannot be saved, that holdeth not the Unity of the holy Church of *Rome;* and that all those Virtues are maimed to him that refuseth to obey the Pope of *Rome;* though he lie in Sackcloth and Ashes, and fast and pray both Day and Night, and seem in the rest or other things to fulfil the Law of God.

(*Bellarmine* saith *de Eccles. l.* 3. *c.* 5.) that [No man, though he would, can be subject to Christ, that is not subject to the Pope.] And therefore he saith that our Baptism implicitly subjecteth us to the Pope; or we are so baptized to him.

And saith *Gonzal. Rodericus in Godignus de rebus Abassin.* l. 2. c. 18. p. 323. to the Emperor's Mother, [*I denied that any one is subject to Christ that is not subject to his Vicar.*] But said the old Woman to him, [*Neither I nor mine do deny obedience to S.* Peter: *We are in the same Faith now that we were in from the beginning: If that was not the right, why was there no one found in so many Ages and Generations that would warn us of our Error?*] (See here what Tradition is, and whether the Papal Church and Charge was Universal.) The Jesuit answered, [*The Pope of* Rome *who is Pastor of the whole Church of Christ, could not in the years that are by-past send Teachers into* Abassia, *because the* Mahometans *encompassed all, and had left no passage to them; but now the Maritime way to* Aethiopia *is open, they can do that which they could not do before.*]

So that it seemeth, 1. Christ hath made the Pope Governor of Countries that he cannot send to, and set the poor man an impossible task. 2. He hath made it necessary to salvation to whole Kingdoms to believe in a Pope that they could never hear from; nor whether there were such a Man or City in the world. 3. Or else their Faith groweth new as the Sea passage is open. And wo to them if their new acquaintance with the Pope make all, all, all his Laws necessary to them, which they

might have been saved without before. How much happier were they when they never heard of his Name?

See here, all you Jesuits, one old Woman is able unanswerably to confute you all, if she stand but on equal ground with you, and be not under your power, inquisition, or fear.

XXIII. *In so doing the Pope damneth and unchurcheth about two or three parts of the Christians upon earth, and so would destroy the Body Politic of Christ.*

For the Body is rather to be denominated from the greater part than from the less: Else why do Votes in General Councils go for the sense of the Church? And I have showed before that the *Abassines, Copties* in *Egypt, Syrians, Armenians, Georgians, Greeks, Moscovites, Protestants,* and the rest, are far more (two or three to one) than all the Papists in the World. Much more when *Mahometanism* had not drowned so many Countries that were of the *Greek* Profession, was it so.

And how the Saviour of the World will take it for this Usurper to rob him of the most of his Flock, and damn most of his Church, (and corrupt the rest) consider and judge.

XXIV. *By so doing the Pope sets a Sect, or small divided Parcel of the Church, and calleth it the whole Church of Christ.*

Even as some Anabaptists (I hope not many) and other Sects appropriate Christianity, or true Church-Communion, *to themselves,* and say, *We are all the Church!* so doth the Pope: His Universal Church is *too small* for any understanding Christian to own, as such, and to be a Member of, as such.

XXV. *The Pope damneth not only two or three parts of the Christian World, but also his own Representative Body, or Church, called Papists; such an Abaddon is he.*

Proved. The General Councils at *Constance* and *Basil* (to say nothing of many others) were the Representative Church of the Papists, and took it to be *de fide that a Council was above the Pope:* But the Pope hath damned them for this as an error, and for their deposing Popes: See *Concil. Later. sub Jul.* 2. and *sub Leone* 10. *& Concil. Florent.* Review the fore-cited Speeches of *Cajetan* and *Pighius* against them. Many more Councils have they condemned.

XXVI. *Yea Popes have damned Popes also,* (*and it is most to be feared lest they damn themselves, more than others.*)

I need not tell of *Marcellinus,* nor of *Honorius* condemned for an Heretic by divers Popes; nor repeat the Schismes and Damnations of each other therein, nor the Story of *Sergius* and *Formosus* and *Stephen, &c.* nor their forementioned wickedness. *Watson* in his *Quodlibets* tells you of *Bellarmine's* Sentence against *Pope Sixtus Quintus,* [*Conceptis verbis, quantum capio, quantum sapio, quantum intelligo, Dominus noster Papa descendit ad infernum:*] And as others report him [*Qui sine poenitentia vivit, & sine poenitentia moritur, ad infernum descendit.*] See *Baronius* forecited.

XXVII. *Though the Pope condemn and unchurch so many, yet doth he tolerate in his own Church abundance of differences,* de fide, *and abundance of Controversies in Theology, and abundance of Differences and Errors in great and dangerous matters of Morality, and abundance of Sects that variously serve God, so they will serve him, and uphold his Kingdom.*

1. The holy Scripture is all *de fide,* that is, a Divine Revelation to be believed: The Popes tolerated Translations that differ in many hundred places, or that *erred* so oft; and *Commentators* that differ in many hundred Texts as to the *Exposition;* yea, they tolerate those that deny the immaculate conception of the Virgin, after a General Council hath defined it.

2. He tolerateth vast Volumes of Theological Differences, in the School Doctors.

3. He tolerateth all the *Moral Doctrines* for *murdering Kings* before mentioned, and all those cited by Mr. *Clarkson* in his *Practical Divinity of the Church of Rome,* and all those mentioned in the Provincial Letters, and the Jesuits' Morals, about Murder, Adultery, Perjury, Lying, seldom loving God, not loving him intensively above all, *&c.* See my *Key, &c. p.* 59.

4. He tolerateth abundance of Religious Sects, Jesuits, *Augustinians, Franciscans, Carthusians, &c.* who differ from each other in their serving God, as much as many of the Sects of Protestants, who are despised for their discord.

XXVIII. *He pretendeth a necessity to the ending of Controversies that he be the Judge, and yet will not end them by his Judgment, but continueth many hundred undecided.*

If we dispute with a Papist, and cite the Scriptures, they ask us presently, *who shall be Judge of the meaning of them?* As if the Pope would decide all: And yet to this day he will neither write any deciding Commentary on the Bible, nor on one Book of it; nor end the Controversies among his own Commentators. Nor will he end any of the fore-mentioned Controversies in *Morality,* of great importance.

XXIX. *He sweareth all his Clergy never to take or interpret Scripture, but according to the unanimous sense of the Fathers,* (see the *Trent* Oath:) *when yet the Fathers do not unanimously expound the Scripture, nor any one Book of it.*

And few Priests know what the Fathers are unanimous in, nor can do, unless they read them all; which by this Oath they seem obliged to do. Was not *Greg. Nazianz.* one of the Fathers? who saith, *Orat.* 18. [I would there were no Presidency, nor Prerogative of place, and tyrannical Privileges; that so we might be known only by Virtue, (or deserts:) But now this Right side and Left side, and Middle and Lower Degree, and Presidency and Concomitancy, have begot us many contentions to no purpose, and have driven many into the Ditch, and have led them away to the Region of Goats.] Is not this Heresy, or worse, with you?

Was not *Isidore Pelusiota* a Father? (but a sharp Reprover of proud and wicked Priests and Prelates) who saith, *lib.* 3. *Epist.* 223. *ad Hieracem* [And when I have showed what difference there is between the ancient Ministry and the present Tyranny, why do you not crown and praise the lovers of Equality?] Doth not this deserve a Faggot with you?

How ordinarily doth *Cajetan,* and others of yours, reject (deservedly) the Expositions of Fathers? *Bellarmine* chargeth *Justin, Irenaeus, &c.* with error, *de Beat. SS. li.* 1. *Cap.* 6. He saith, [*There is no trust to be given to* Tertullian, *de Rom. Pont. li.* 4. *c.* 8. He saith, *Eusebius* was addicted to *Heretics, and that* Cyprian *seemed to sin mortally, de Rom. Pont. li.* 4. *c.* 7. *Dionys. Petavius de*

Trinit. citeth the words of most of the ancientest as favouring Arianism (almost like *Sondius* himself or *Philostorgius;*) and is fain to go to the [*Major Vote of the Nice ne Council as the proof,*] that most of the ancients were not really of the *Arians* mind. *Dallaeus* hath told you more of the Fathers' differences, and unsatisfactory expositions.

XXX. *He confesseth all the Scripture to be God's infallible word, yea his Doctors have asserted its sufficiency as a Divine Law; and yet his pretence of its Insufficiency without Traditional supplement, is one of the Pillars of his Kingdom.*

The second part needs no proof: For the first, the elder Popes oft assert it; And the School-men in their Prologue to the Sentences (*Scotus, Durandus* and many others:) But when Reformers confuted them by Scripture, they found that would not serve their turn, (as *Micaiah* of *Ahab,* it prophesyed not good of them but evil.) And since then, they cry up the *Church* and *Tradition,* and depress the sufficiency of Scripture.

Even *Card. Richlieu pag.* 38. confesseth [As for us, we assert no other Rule but Scripture, neither of another sort, nor total: yea we say that it is the whole Rule of our salvation, and that on a double account: both because it containeth immediately and formally the sum of our salvation; that is, all the Articles that are necessary to man's salvation, by necessity of means; and because it mediately containeth what ever we are bound to believe, as it sends us to the Church to be instructed by her, of whose infallibility it certainly confirmeth us.] Here the sum of our Religion is granted.

At the Council of *Basil Ragusius*'s oration (*Bin. p.* 299) saith [That Faith and all things necessary to salvation, both matters of belief and practice, are founded in the literal sense of Scripture, and only from that may argumentation be taken for the proving of those things that are matters of Faith and necessary to salvation, and not from those passages that are spoken by allegory, *&c.* And *sup.* 7. [The holy Scripture in the literal sense soundly and well understood, is the infallible and most sufficient rule of Faith.] See more of his oration opened in my

Key pag. 93, 94, 95. The Testimony of *Bellarmine, Costerus* and others I have formerly recited.

XXXI. *The Pope teacheth us that we cannot truly believe the Articles of our Faith or the truth of Scripture, but because of the Authority and Infallibility of the Pope and his Church declaring them; so that we must believe that the Pope is Christ's Vicar and authorized by him, and made infallible, before we can believe that there is a Christ, or that he hath given any authority or gifts to any.*

This is not to be denied: And *Knot* against *Chillingworth* hath no other shift, but to resolve their belief of the Church's infallibility and authority, not into any word or donation of Christ, but into *Miracles wrought by the Church.* So that no man can be a Believer that is not first certain of the Papists' Miracles (and how can millions know them, when they see them not? and in all my life I could never meet with one that saw them.) And he must next be certain that those miracles prove the infallibility of the Pope; when yet they confess that they prove not the Infallibility of him *that doth them. Valentine Greatreaks* hath done and still doth more wondrous cures by *touch* or *stroking*, than ever I heard by any credible report that any Papist did: and yet he pretendeth to no Infallibility.

And those Canonized Saints that have been most credibly famed for the greatest Miracles, have born their Testimony against Popery, and therefore Popery was not confirmed by them. For instance, St. *Martin* is by his Disciple and Friend *Sulpitius Severus* affirmed to have done more Miracles than I have ever credibly read done by any since the Apostles: I scarce except *Gregory Neocaesar:* And yet, whereas the Papal Councils give high privileges, of pardon, *&c.* to those that will take the Cross to kill the *Waldenses*, and compel Princes to it, and uphold their Kingdom by such means, St. *Martin* separated to the death from the Synods and Bishops' about him, for seeking the Magistrates Sword to be drawn against even *Priscillian Gnostics,* and he professeth that an *Angel* appeared to him and chastised him sharply for once communicating with the Bishops at the motion of *Maximus*, when he did it only to save

men's lives, that were condemned as *Priscillianists.* Here are Miracles against the very Pillars of Popery.

So also the *Egyptian* Monks were the most famous for Miracles of any People. And yet (as their Miracles were no confirmation of the error of the *Anthropomorphites* which their simplicity and rashness involved them in, so) they renounced Communion with the Church of *Rome,* and therefore confirmed it not by their Miracles.

How few Christians be there on Earth, if none are such but those that by known Popish miracles believed the Pope to be infallible before they believed that there was a Christ?

And thus they must believe him to be Infallible not as Pope, but somewhat else: For to be Pope, is to be [*Christ's pretended Vicar:*] And to believe that he is authorized or Infallible as *Christ's Vicar,* before they believe there is a *Christ,* is a madman's contradiction and impossible. What Infallible wight then is it that we must first believe the Pope to be, before we believe him to be Pope? To what impudence will interest and faction carry men?

I will again recite the words of an honest Jesuit, *Joseph. Acosta de tempor. novis. li.* 3. *c.* 3. [To all the miracles of Antichrist, though he do great ones, the Church shall boldly oppose the belief of the Scriptures: And by the inexpugnable testimony of this truth, shall by most clear light expel all his jugglings as Clouds—Signs are given to Infidels; Scriptures to Believers; and therefore the primitive Church abounded with miracles, when Infidels were to be called: But the last, when the faithful are already called, shall rest more on the Scripture than on miracles: yea I will boldly say, that all miracles are vain and empty, unless they be approved by the Scripture; that is, have a Doctrine conform to the Scripture. But the Scripture itself is of itself a most firm argument of truth.

Obj. But he grants that Infidels had miracles.

Ans. He lived long in the *West-Indies* among them, and in his *Treat.* of the *Convers. Ind.* and his *Hist. Ind.* he professeth that the Ignorance, Drunkenness and Wickedness of the Roman Priests there, was the great hindrance of their Conversion; but

that *Miracles* there were none. God had not given them there any such gift.

Once more, Did the Miracle which *Thyraeus de Daemoniacis, p.* 76. reciteth out of *Prosper,* that [*A person possessed by the Devil was cured by drinking the Wine in the Eucharist*] confirm the Pope's Religion, who hath cast out the Cup; or the Protestants that use it?

XXXII. *Though S.* Paul *say, Let every Soul be subject to the higher Powers, and give honour to whom honour is due, the Pope as far as he is able exempteth all his Clergy from the Government of the Magistrate; yea they are forbidden to fall down to Princes, or eat at their Tables, but Emperors must take them as equals.*

The first part is commonly known: *Caranz. pag.* 395. reciteth this Decree of Pope *Nicholas,* that [No Lay man must judge a Priest, nor examine anything of his life: And no Secular Prince ought to judge the facts of any Bishops or Priests whatsoever.

The Eighth General Council at *Constantinople* saith, *Can.* 14. [Ministers must not fall down to Princes, nor eat at their Tables, nor debase themselves to them; but Emperors must take them as equals.

XXXIII. *The Pope confesseth every word of our Objective Religion to be true; for all his killing and damning us as Heretics.*

Proved before: We have not a word of our Objective Religion, but the Sacramental Covenant, and its Exposition in the *Creed, Lord's Prayer,* and *Decalogue,* and the *Canonical Scripture,* which we receive. And they confess all this to be infallibly true, and so justify all our Positive Religion.

XXXIV. *The Popes to this day will not tell the Church so much as what a Christian is, and what must make a man a Member of their Church, in the Essentials of a Member.* Of which more anon.

XXXV. *While the Decrees of General Councils are made* quoad nos *the Church's Faith, the Pope will never let us know how big our Faith must be, nor when we shall have all.*

If every General Council add new Articles (or many) *quoad nos,* who knoweth when they will have done? and whether we have yet half the Christian Faith, or not?

XXXVI. *The Pope's Religion maketh Contradictions necessary to be believed;* that is, *impossibilities.*

The Contradictions of *Transubstantiation* I have opened in my [*Full Satisfaction*] Confirmed General Councils they commonly agree do make Decrees which must necessarily be believed: And it is notorious, that such Decrees are Contradictory. The General Council at *Constance* confirmed by *Martin* 5. and that at *Basil* confirmed by *Foelix* 5. do make it *de fide* for a Council to be above the Pope. *Bin. p.* 43. 79. 96. *Conc. Basil. Sess. ult.* they say, [Not one of the skilful did ever doubt, but that the Pope was subject to the judgment of a General Council in matters of Faith; and that he cannot without their consent dissolve or remove a General Council; yea and that this is an Article of Faith, which without destruction of salvation cannot be denied, and that *de fide* the Council is above the Pope, and that he is a Heretic that is against this.] *Eugenius* also owned this Council, *Bin. ib. p.* 42.

But the Councils of *Florence,* and at the *Laterane sub Jul.* 2. and *sub Leone* 10. say the clean contrary.

The 6. Council at *Constant.* approved by Pope *Adrian* is now said by them to have many errors.

XXXVII. *The Pope arrogateth power to alter the constitutions of the Spirit of God in the holy Scriptures.*

Proved. The Council of *Constance* taking away the Cup saith [Though in the Primitive Church this Sacrament was received by Believers under both kinds, *&c.*] yea though Christ so instituted it, yet they altered it.

I elsewhere cited Pope *Innocents* words [*By the fullness of our Power we can dispense with the Law, being above the Law.*] And the Gloss oft saith, [*The Pope dispenseth against the Apostle, against the Old Testament, &c.*

The Council of *Trent* say, *Sess.* 21. *cap.* 1, 2. that [*This power was always in the Church, that in dispensing the Sacraments, saving the substance of them, it may ordain or change things as it should judge most expedient to the profit of the Receiver.* (But is not the Cup of the substance, as truly as the Bread?)

Andrad. Def. Conc. Trid. li. 2. *p.* 236. [Hence it is plain that they do not err that say, the Popes of *Rome* may sometimes dispense with Laws made by *Paul,* and the four first Councils. And *Vasquez* saith *To.* 2. *Disp.* 216. *N.* 60. [Though we grant that this was a Precept of the Apostles, yet the Church and Popes might on just causes abrogate it: For the power of the Apostles was no greater than the power of the Church and Pope in bringing in Precepts.]

One of *Luthers* Opinions opposed as Heretical by *Leo* 10. was this, [*It is certain that it is not in the hand of the Church or Pope to make Articles of Faith.*] See more in my *Key, p.* 243, 244.

XXXVIII. *The Pope setteth up a Public Worship of God, in a Tongue not understood by most of the Worshippers; and forbiddeth men, without Licence to read the Scriptures in a known Tongue.*

Practice and the *Trent* Council prove both these.

XXXIX. *The Pope determineth that the Image of Christ be reverenced with equal honour as the holy Scriptures.*]

So it is decreed *Concil. Constant.* the eighth *General Can.* 3. And yet Images are man's work, and at the best unnecessary, and the holy Scriptures are God's work by his Spirit, and the Law by which we must live, and be judged at the last.

XL. *And when all this Power over the whole Earth is thus claimed, there is no possible means left for any mortal man, much less for the* Antipodes, *to know who is the man that hath this Power, and whom on pain of damnation we must obey, and believe in before we can believe in Christ.*

Proved: If there be any possibility of knowing it, it must be either, 1. By personal qualifications of mind; 2. Or by right of election; 3. Or of Ordination; 4. Or of Possession; 5. Or of Acceptance by the Church after Possession. I cannot Imagine any other way. But there is no possibility of knowing who is Pope by any of *these wayes.*

I. The first is not pretended by them: But anon we shall thence prove their *Nullity* for want of necessary Qualifications.

II. If *Election* will tell us, then it is either *any Election whatsoever,* or else *Election by authorized Persons.* Not the first; else the

Turks, or the *Greeks,* or the Adversaries of *Rome* might elect a Pope: And an hundred might be elected at once several ways. Not the later; For if any *one way of Election* be necessary, Popes were no Popes when that way failed: Sometime they were elected by the *People of Rome* (and were *they* the Choosers for *all the World?*) Sometimes by the People and the *Presbyters:* Sometimes by the *Neighbour Bishops* and Ordainers: Sometimes by the Emperors: And lastly by the Cardinals. If one way only be valid, the rest were invalid: And how shall we prove which? If any of these ways are valid; then six men or five may be chosen at once by the several ways: And where is the proof?

III. If *Ordination* be the notifying Title, then, 1. Those Lay men that were put in full possession unordained were no Popes; and where then is the Succession? 2. And who is it that hath that *ordaining Authority?* If some Bishops ordain one, and some another, and so twenty (as they long did divers in many years Schism) which of these is the true Pope? or is it *all?*

IV. If *Possession* were the Title, then the *Turk* may be Pope; or he that can get it by the Sword: Then there can be no Usurper, but the strongest hath best Right. Then he that kept at *Rome* had better title than he that was in *Germany,* or at *Avignion.*

V. If it be the Church's *after acceptance;* then, 1. He was an Usurper before. 2. And what or who is that *Accepting Church?* Sure they that must make a Pope of no Pope, by after acceptance, should have the antecedent Election: Else Popes must all be first Usurpers, before they are true Popes. But, 1. If it must be the *major part* of the *Christian World,* then there is no Pope, because two parts are against him. If it must be one Sect of Christians only like the Papists, that will but think themselves the Church, or better than the rest; who is it that can prove their title to this Choice? And must it be *All of them,* or but *Part?* If *All,* 1. How shall we ever know it? Never such a thing was tried. 2. And then there was no Pope in the 40 or 50 years Schism. If it must be *Part,* how shall we ever know *which part* it must be? If the *major* or the *melior,* how shall it be ever tried and known in a division? None to this day knoweth who had the *major* or *melior* part in many a Schism.

If they say that *silent non-opposition* is *Consent.* I Answer, That's a known Falsehood, when most men, even a thousand to one, have neither Call nor Opportunity to signify their dissent effectually; and when no wise men that love their time and peace, will run to *Rome* by thousands out of all Kingdoms, to tell them their dissent.

2. But it was no *silent submission,* when *several Popes* were upheld by *several Kingdoms.* So that there is no way of certain notice who is the true Pope, but he must go for the man, as *Eugenius* 4. did after his Deposition, who can keep possession, which is no title at all.

2. Yea, I prove certainly, according to their own Principles, that *there is no Pope* at *Rome,* nor *hath been* for many an hundred years.

For they hold themselves, that the Right must be derived by an uninterrupted Succession from S. *Peter,* (and call us no Ministers for want of Succession:) But that they have no such uninterrupted Succession is notorious.

For, 1. An Infidel and Heretic Pope, so openly judged, can be no Pope: Else a *Turk* might be Pope. For he that is no Christian, is no Christian Bishop. But Popes (before mentioned) have been judged Infidels, Heretics, incarnate Devils.

2. A Pope actually deposed as an uncapable wicked Heretic, by a General Council, was no Pope: Yet such was *Eugenius* 4. who yet kept the place, and the rest are his Successors.

3. There have been sometimes several years without any Pope at all: And if two or three years make no interruption, how shall we know how long time doth it?

4. *Baronius, Genebrard,* and others aforementioned, confess that for 50 of them together they were Apostatical, and deserve not to be named among the Popes, being wicked men, made and ruled by Whores, *&c.* Where then is the succession?

And if it were possible for those at *Rome* to know that there is a Pope, and to know who and which is he, yet how should all the rest of the world have any assurance of it? You'll say, it is not necessary: Possession and common Report must satisfy them in *China, Congo, Abassia,* and the *Philippines,* &c.

Answ. No Building can be stronger than its Foundation, nor Conclusion than its Premises: How then shall such men have assurance of their Religion when they must take it on the Credit of a Pope as infallible of whom they have no assurance? And how shall they be certain that they are of the right Church, when they are uncertain who is the Head whom they must be subjects to?

CHAP. VII. *What a PAPIST is.*

II. HAving showed *what a Pope is,* I am next hence to tell you what we Protestants take a *Papist to be.*

And first as to the *name,* it is equivocal: There are so many sorts that are called commonly by the one name of *Papists,* that it is hard to enumerate and describe them all.

1. There are some that believe that the *Pope* is but a *Human Creature,* that hath run up his power into Tyranny by abuse, and it were well if he were either down, or reduced to his first state: But they take themselves to be as those that live under other abusive, oppressing or tyrannical Governors, who must live in Patience and Submission, and are not bound to ruin themselves, by opposing him in vain; and though he impose on them many things which they like not, but had rather they were reformed, yet it being not in their power, and Princes and Magistrates commanding them the same, they take *Conformity* to be orderly, and *Nonconformity* to be unpeaceable and of ill fame; And if any of the things commanded them prove sinful, they hope God will forgive them (for bowing in the house of *Rimmon*) and will lay it on Popes, Princes and Prelates, and not on them that are not bound to study Controversies; and who do what they do but in obedience and for peace (pretenses that quiet their Consciences in self-saving Conformity:) I verily think that the greater part of those called Papists in all the world, are of this *self-saving sort.* As we see in all Countries that the greater number are or seem to be of the Religion of those in power, be it what it will be. And we ordinarily hear that the common people will thus talk against the Pope's Doctrines and Practices, and yet quiet themselves on such terms of *Conformity* as I here describe.

II. Another sort called Papists do believe that the Pope is a mere human creature also, not over all the world but in the Empire and where Princes let him: And consequently as men set him up, men might take him down. But yet that it is an *Orderly* Institution, as Kings and Emperors, and that his place is *Lawful,* and that it is the duty of the Church to obey him, especially when Princes also do command it: And that men

have power from God to make, as *National, Provincial,* and *Patriarchal Churches* and *Rulers,* so also an *Universal Church* and *Ruler for Order and Unity sake* over many Countries, and that it is good and desirable to these ends.

Of these there are two sorts. 1. One sort take the *Papacy* and *Patriarchs* to be a lawful and laudable institution of *Constantine,* confirmed by other Princes. 2. The other sort take them to be laudable Institutions of *General Councils,* or else of *particular consenting Bishops* before the first General Council (whom thy call the *Church.*)

III. Another sort called Papists, do believe the Pope (as the former) to be a *human Creature, viz.* of the first or ancient Bishops by mutual consent; but that it was a *necessary thing,* which by God's General Laws, and his special Inspiration, they did well, and were bound to do for the Church's concord and strength; and that it is not lawful for the Church now to alter it, or any Prince in his Dominions.

These also are of three sorts: 1. Some think that the *Roman* Seat may be altered, and the Church upon just cause may remove the Primacy to another Bishop. This seemeth to be the opinion of Cardinal *Cusanus* afore cited *de Concord.* who saith, The Church might make the Bishop of *Trent* chief. 2. Others seem rather to think, that God hath by Decree annexed the Supremacy to *Rome,* and yet (as *R. Smyth,* the Bishop of *Calcedon,* and Ruler of the *English* Popish Clergy afore cited) think, that it is not *de fide,* that the Pope is *Peter's* Successor. 3. Others say that they are not sure but *God* may destroy *Rome,* and remove the Primacy; but *Men* may not do it.

IV. The whole *Greek* Church seem yet of the second or third opinion, (that the Pope had a just Primacy in one Empire, which was justly removed to *Constantinople:*) But there are some that think the Pope had also a just Primacy in all the *Christian World,* and yet that he hath it but by *Human Institution.*

V. There are other that think the Pope is the Universal Head by *Divine Institution;* even as S. *Peter*'s Successor, by derivation of the Power which Christ gave *Peter.*

And as about the *Foundation*, so about the *Subject* and the *Measure* of Power, yea *who is the true Chief Ruler* over the Universal Church, there are these several sorts of Popery.

I. Some believe that it is *General Councils* that are the Subject or Possessors of *Supreme Church Power* and *Infallibility*, and that the Pope is but the first in order of the five Patriarchs in such *Councils;* who hath no necessary right to call them, nor no negative Voice in them, nor any Government over the other Patriarchs, or their Churches; but only the first Seat, if he be there; just as the Patriarch of *Alexandria* first, and of *Constantinople* after had when the Patriarch of *Rome* was absent. And thus indeed it was in the Empire, for a long time. But those five Patriarchs ruled not *all the World;* no more than our two Provincial Archbishops do.

II. Others called Papists do go farther, and believe that General Councils indeed have the supreme Legislative Power, and the chief Executive while they sit, and are the Seat of Infallibility: But because they are not to be *always* or *ordinary*, God hath not left the *four Patriarchs,* and *all the World,* ungoverned in the Intervals; but the *Roman* Pope is the *Supreme Governor of the World,* when there is no General Council: Yet so that he must Govern by *their Laws* or Canons.

III. Another sort (and I think the most numerous among the Learned) called Papists, hold that *Neither the Pope alone, nor the Council alone, are the Seat or Possessors of the supreme Legislative Power,* or the *Infallibility, nor of the supreme judging and executive power* sedente concilio; *but it is both of them agreeing* or conjunct: And two Fallibles joining, become one Infallible.

IV. Another sort of Papists, and very numerous especially in *Italy,* hold, that the Pope alone is Supreme and Infallible in Legislation and *Judgment,* and that Councils are but his Counsellors, to prepare Laws, to which his *Fiat* giveth *Authority and Infallibility.*

All these indeed are commonly called PAPISTS, because that more or less they are Subjects of the Pope. But who can give *one definition,* or the same *marks* of men that are really of

so many minds? If I describe one sort, the other will say, this is not our Opinion; you do us wrong. And so of all the rest.

And here you may see, that when the Question is, *Whether a Papist may be saved?* and *Whether a Papist be a Heretic?* or the like; that it cannot be well answered, till we know of which sort of Papists you speak.

But because I find that already my Writing is swelled beyond my first intent, I will give you the Properties or *inadequate conceptions* of only one sort of Papists, which is the third sort in the last distribution, who hold the *Sovereignty and Infallibility to be in the Pope and Council conjunct, and that by Divine Right.* Because if I speak of any of the other sorts, I find they fly for refuge hither, and most Writers go upon this ground, and will own nothing as their Religion but what is in *Approved General Councils.*

And here I desire the Reader to peruse what I have said in my [*Full and easy satisfaction, &c.*] out of *Veron,* and others, as they describe their Faith themselves.

I. *A PAPIST of this sort is one that believeth that the Pope and his Council, or Church, is Infallible in proposing the will of Christ; and believeth in Christ, and receiveth the Gospel as true, for the Authority and Infallibility of this Pope and Council, and hereon layeth all the hopes of his salvation, as on the Church's Faith: And all this Authority and Infallibility he believeth before he believeth that there is a Pope or a Church of Christ, or a Christ indeed, or a promise or gift from Christ of any Authority or Infallibility to them: Much more before he knoweth who is the true Pope, and which are true General Councils, or whether ever there were any such, or what it is that they have decreed to be believed.*

1. That they take all their Faith in Christ and the Gospel on the credit of the Church (that is, the Pope and Council) proposing it, the moderatest of all this sort profess; as out of *Veron,* and others, I proved as aforecited. Hence it is that one tells us that the Scripture is so full of seeming Contradictions and Improbabilities, that he would no more believe it than *Esop*'s Fables, were it not for the Authority of the Church. Another said [Would I ever believe the Trinity, the Incarnation,

that if you lay a man to dye in a close Chest of Lead or Marble his Soul could get out to Heaven, that the Body shall rise again, *&c.* were it not for the Authority of the Church?]

2. They believe this Infallibility and Authority of the *Pope* before they can believe that there is any Pope at all. For to be a *Pope* is essentially to be *Christ's Vicar* as they describe him: And, as I said, it is impossible to believe that *Christ hath a Vicar,* before they believe that he is *Christ.* As it is to believe a *Son* without a Parent.

3. They believe the *Infallibility* and *Authority* of the *Church,* (as they profess) before they believe that there is any *Church:* For to be a *Church* is essentially to be a *Society* of *Christians:* And he that yet believeth not that *Christ* is truly *Christ,* cannot believe that *Christians* are truly *Christians,* save *de nomine;* nor that *Christ* hath a Church: For they are Relatives, as *Wife* and *Husband.*

4. They *believe* the *Infallibility* and *Authority* of the *Church,* that is, the Pope and *Council,* before they believe that *Jesus is the Christ;* For they profess to believe in him, because of the said Church's Authority and Infallibility: And the Premises go before the Conclusion.

5. They believe the said Infallibility and Authority of the Church, before they believe that ever *Christ gave* them such *Authority* and *Infallibility:* For they cannot believe that Christ gave it them, before they believe that there is a *Christ,* and a *Word of gift.*

And now is not here a Riddle hard enough to pose the wisest? *Which way do all these Believers, through all the world, come to know that the Pope and Council, or Church, are authorized and Infallible, before they believe that Christ ever gave it them? Which way do they think that they came by it?* Let him unriddle it that can.

6. They believe thus in the Pope, before they know *what a Pope is,* or *who is he* that they must thus believe in. For alas, how can all or any in the world know what is necessary to make a Pope? what *Election?* what *Ordination?* what *Qualification?* and

whether the man *had* all these? And of divers Pretenders *which is he* that hath the proofs of a true title?

7. They believe thus in *Councils,* when they know not what *Councils* are true, and what not; nay whether ever there were any: For I have elsewhere fully proved that there never was any, nor ever will be, that are truly Universal as to all the Christian World.

8. Much less do these beginners know certainly, what General Councils have decreed to be believed by those that will be saved.

That which will be said to all this is, that *It is not necessary that all men receive their Faith from Councils; it is sufficient if it be from the Church-real, though not from the Representative.*

Ans. Very good: 1. Else no man was a Christian, nor could be, before the first General Council, which was above 300 years.

2. But still this answereth none of the Contradictions about believing in and from the *Pope:* May we all take our Faith from the Church-real, without taking it from the Pope, or not? If *yea,* we may possibly be good friends at last. If *not,* all the Contradictions about him are still upheld by you.

3. And if you must take it from the *Authority* and *Infallibility* of the *Church Real,* still all the Contradictions will follow as if you took it from *Councils:* For can you believe that this Church is *Christ's Church,* and hath this power and gift from him, before you believe that he is Christ, and that ever he made such a gift or promise to them?

4. And *who* or *what* is this *Real Church,* that must be *first known* to be thus impowered and *infallible:* Is it *some few,* or *many,* or must it be the *most?* If a *few* or *many,* you profess that they may be *Heretics,* and have not that authority or gift. If it must be *all,* or the *greater* part; 1. Then the Church of *Rome* goeth down, that is at most but a third part. 2. How shall every poor man (or any man) know which is the judgment of the major part? Can he take the Votes of all the Christian World? 3. And have all that were converted in the Apostles' days and since, first known the Major Vote of the Christians, or were

they converted by the foreknown Infallibility or Authority of the Majority? (or of the Pope?)

Some will say, we see the Madness of this Popery, but how then do you say that the *faith must be received, if not from* the Church? I answer I have told you at large in a Treatise called *The Reasons of the Christian Religion,* and briefly in a smaller Treatise called *The certainty of Christianity without Popery*

Briefly, *Judging is one thing,* and *Teaching is another thing.* Before I submit to the *Decision* of a *Judge* I must know his *Commission* or *Authority;* and I must then stand to his Sentence which way ever he decide the Case. Men be not converted to Christianity by such *Judges,* but by *Teachers;* Nor will I believe the Judge if he say *there is no Christ, no Life to come, &c.* But a *Teacher* is to make intelligible to his Hearer or Scholar, the *evidence of truth* which is in the matter taught, and to draw men to believe by telling them those true reasons upon which he did believe himself: And no man takes him for his Teacher that he is persuaded knoweth no more than himself. And the greater reputation of Knowledge and Honesty the Teacher hath, the easier we apply our minds to learn of him, and a human trust or faith prepareth us to receive that evidence of truth which may beget a Divine Faith by the help of Grace. But still the Learner truly believeth no more than he thus learneth. And I may hear a stranger tell what he hath to say, and be convinced by the evidence that he giveth me of the truth, though I know not of any *Authority* that he hath to teach me, much less *judicially* to *decide* the Case. I little doubt but most that were converted by the Apostles themselves, were persuaded to believe in Christ by the *evidence of truth proposed* (the Spirit co-operating) before they knew of any *Authority* of the Apostles; much less before they heard what they said in a *General Council,* or what was the Vote of the *Universal Church;* or what *any Pope* said as *Ruler* of the rest. These things are very plain and sure, and they that will be wilfully blinded by faction, and prejudice, and worldly interest against plain truth, have no excuse if they perish in darkness.

II. *A PAPIST* (*of this sort*) *is one that believeth that the Pope of* Rome *is the rightful Governor of all the world; that is, that all Christians immediately, and all Infidels and Heathens mediately, are bound by God to obey him, as Christ's Vicegerent on Earth: And that he, with his Council, is thus an Universal Lawgiver and Judge to all Kings, States, and Persons, that dwell round about the Earth.*

But a Protestant denieth this, and holdeth that there is no Universal Monarch, or Legislator, to all the world, but God and our Saviour; and that he hath made no such Vice-Christ, or Vicegerent; and that such a Claim is High-Treason, as usurping his Prerogative. And that if Pride had not *in tantum* made them mad, no men could think themselves thus capable of Governing all the World. Protestants believe that there is no such thing on Earth, as an Universal Church headed by any mortal Head, Pope or Council, but that Christ is the only Universal Governor or Head.

III. *This Papist is one that holdeth, that the Church of Christ on Earth is no bigger than the Pope's Dominion, and that it is necessary to salvation to be subject to the Pope; and consequently he unchurcheth two or three parts of the Christian world, and damneth most of the Body of Christ, and robbeth him of the greatest part of his Kingdom, as far as denying his Right amounts to: And consequently is a notorious Schismatic or Sectary, appropriating the Church title only to his Sect.*

This is proved before from the Masters of their Religion.

IV. *This Papist is one that holdeth, that those Councils which were General as to one Empire, were General as to all the Christian world: And that such General Councils there must be,* (*if it please the Pope to call them,*) *though they must come from all the Quarters of the Earth, and whence they have no Sea passage, and out of the Empires of many Princes, and many that are Enemies to the Christian Name, and perhaps at Wars with Christians; and when the Voyage or Journey is such, that if the Churches be deprived of a thousand Bishops, twenty of them are never like to live to return home to the remotest Nations. Nor could they converse as a Council, by reason of the number and diversity of Languages, if they were equally gathered.*

Or they hold, that if a small part of the Christian World assemble (*as at* Trent) *when the rest cannot come, this is an Universal Council of and to all the Christian World.*

V. *This Papist is one that holdeth, If a fallible Pope and a fallible General Council do but agree, their Decrees are infallible: As if an unlearned Pope* (e. g. *that understands not the Text of Scripture in the Original*) *and an unlearned Council* (*as to the most*) *should agree, their Decrees would be learned;* e. g. *in judging which is the true Translation of a Tongue which they never understood.* As if ten purblind men if they meet together might produce the Effects of the clearest sight, or Fools by conjunction become wise.

VI. He holdeth that Tradition from Fathers to Children is the sure way of conveying all the matter of Faith and Religion; and yet that the greatest General Councils, which are the Church representative, may err in matter of Faith, and have erred; unless a Pope (who is fallible) approve of their Decrees.

VII. And when he hath trusted to this way of Tradition, he denieth the Judgment and Tradition professed by the greater half or the Christian World.

VIII. He believeth that all men are bound on pain of damnation to believe that the Senses and perception of all men in the World are deceived, in apprehending that after Consecration there is true Bread and Wine in the Sacrament. And he that will so believe his own and others Senses, should suffer as an Heretic, and be rooted out of all the Dominions of all Christian Lords on Earth. So merciful is he to his Neighbours.

For an approved General Council hath decreed this, and such Councils are his Religion. Were it his own Father or Mother, Wife or Child, that cannot thus renounce all his own and other men's Senses, and believe that there is no Bread or Wine in spite of his sight, taste, touch, *&c.* he believeth that they should be *burnt as Heretics,* or *exterminated.* He may be a *good natured* man that is loth it should be so; or he may be one that is *ignorant* of his own Religion, and doth not know that this is one Article of Popery; or he may be an *unconscionable* man, that will not obey that which he knoweth to be his Re-

ligion; or he may be *unable* to execute such Laws: But *it is his Religion* to believe that he ought to do it.

IX. If he be a Temporal Lord of a Protestant Country, it is part of his Religion to take himself obliged to root out, destroy, or burn all his Protestant Subjects, and all others that deny Transubstantiation.

Obj. *The King of* France, *and some others, do it not.*

Ans. No man is bound to do that which he *cannot do.* But if he *can do it,* and he be a *Papist,* by the express words of an Approved General Council he is bound to do it, and to *believe* that it is his duty. I speak not of what *men do,* but what their *Religion binds them to do:* Though interest or good nature hinder them.

X. He believeth that all Temporal Lords that will not first take an Oath thus to root out their Subjects, and then do it, may be first Excommunicated by the Pope, and then deposed if they repent not, and their Dominions be given to be seized by another Papist that will do it.

The words of the Council are before cited.

XI. He believeth that in this case the Pope may absolve all the Subjects of such Temporal Lords from their Oaths, and Duties of Allegiance or Fidelity to such Rulers.

This also is express in the Council's words.

XII. He is one that believeth that the Privileges of the *Roman* Church were given it by the Fathers, because it was the Imperial Seat, and therefore *Constantinople* had after equal Privileges: (*For so saith the forecited General Council:*) And yet he believeth the clean contrary, even that *Rome*'s Privileges were given it by S. *Peter,* and *Constantinople*'s are not equal. (For Popes and Councils also are for this.)

XIII. He believeth that it is *de fide* that General Councils are above Popes, and may judge them, and depose them if there be cause, even as Heretics or Infidels, Adulterers, Murderers, Simonists, *&c.* And yet he believeth that all this is false, and the contrary true.

For the approved General Councils of *Basil* and *Constance* say the first, (and others;) and those fore-cited at the *Laterane* and *Florence* say the latter.

XIV. He maketh uncharitableness, and bold damning all others, a comfortable mark of the safety of his state, and the truth of his Religion, and our Charity a mark that ours is worse; whereas Christ hath said, *By this shall all men know that ye are my Disciples, if ye love one another.*

It's usual with them to say, [*You say that a Papist may be saved, and we say that a Protestant cannot; therefore we are in the safer state.*] As if *our* case were ever the more dangerous for *their* condemning us. As if a man that doteth in a Fever, should say to those about him, [*You say that I may live, and I say that all you are mortally sick; therefore my case is better than yours.*] God saith, *Judge not, that ye be not judged;* and *who art thou that judgest another man's Servant?* And these men hope their case is safe, because they sin against this Law, and damn the most of the Universal Church.

XV. A Papist thinketh that all the Bible is not big enough, or hath not enough in it, to save those that believe and practise it, or to make us a saving Religion; but other Tradition must be received with equal reverence; and the Decrees of all the approved General Councils must make it up.

XVI. He confesseth every Article and word of the Religion of the Protestants to be infallibly true; and yet holdeth that they are to be burnt and damned as Heretics.

For he confesseth every part of the Canonical Scripture to be true, and we have no more in our (objective, positive) Religion, not a word. Our Negations of Popery are not properly our Religion, any more than our speaking against Diseases is our Health: But as our health containeth our own freedom from an hundred diseases which we never thought of, as well as those that we once had or feared; so our Faith and Religion is *free from* Popery, and containeth that which is against it.

XVII. A Papist is for swearing men to take Scripture in that sense as the holy Mother Church doth hold, and hath held it: Whereas, 1. Their Church hath given them no Commentary

on the Scripture, one way or other. 2. And their Translations have been altered in many hundred places by *Clement* 8. and *Sixtus* 5. so that their Clergy is sworn to take one Translation to to be right one year, and a different one to be right the next.

XVIII. They are for swearing men to take or interpret Scripture but according to the unanimous sense of the Fathers, and consequently never to interpret the most of it at all.

XIX. A Papist hath a thriving Faith and Religion, which groweth bigger and bigger, as fast as General Councils add new Decrees; so that they know not when they shall have all: And yet they cry out against novelty and change, and boast of Antiquity.

XX. He holdeth that Priests or Prelates may not fall down to Princes, or eat at their Tables, nor debase themselves to them; but Emperors must take them as equals. *Concil. Gen.* 8. *Const. Can.* 14.

XXI. He is satisfied that their Church hath a Judge of Controversies, though he decide them not: And he gloryeth in the Unity and great Concord of their Church, whose Doctors differ *de fide* even in the Exposition of many hundred Texts of God's Word; and where they differ in the Morals before cited, about Murder, killing excommunicate Kings, *&c.* and in Volumes of Controversies. And yet he looketh upon far smaller differences among us with great offense, as if they were intolerable, and were so many different Religions: And all because in all their differences they agree in one Pope. As if it were not as good an Union to agree in one God, one Christ, one Spirit, one Body or Church of Christ, one Faith (Creed and Scripture) one Baptismal Covenant, and one Hope of life eternal, *Eph.* 4. 3, 4, 5, 6. which is the Union that God describeth.

XXII. He believeth that the Pope doth justly take away from the People one half of the substance of Christ's own Sacrament, and deny them that which they hold to be his very Blood.

XXIII. They believe that they ought not to read the Scripture translated without a Licence. So saith *Con. Trid.*

XXIV. They believe that the Image of Christ is to be reverenced equally with the holy Scriptures.

It is a Council's words before cited: Yea they must believe the second Council at *Nice,* that *Latria is to be given only to God:* and yet a canonized S. *Thomas* 3. *q.* 25. *a.* 3. *&* 4. maintaineth that *Latria* or Divine Worship is to be given, 1. To the Image of Christ, 2. To the Cross that he dyed on, 3. And to the Sign of the Cross. And how largely *Jac. Nauclautus, Cabrera,* and multitudes of the Schoolmen are for it, see my *Key, p.* 165, *&c.*

XXV. They will publicly pray to God, and praise him, in an unknown Tongue, because the Pope will have it so.

XXVI. They think that the far greatest part of the Body of Christ are tormented in the Flames of Purgatory, to make satisfaction to God's Justice for some Sins, notwithstanding Christ's sufficient satisfaction.

XXVII. Expecting to go to the Flames of Purgatory when they dye, they cannot possibly be willing to leave this World, and consequently must be worldlings, and never truly willing to dye. For the basest condition on Earth will seem to them more desirable than Purgatory.

XXVIII. They think that the Flames of Purgatory do perfect men's preparation for Heaven: whereas he is readiest for Heaven that is likest to those in Heaven and most holy, and that is they that most love God! And they that are angry here with every one that hurteth him, and do not think that tormenting men will win their love, yet look that the torments of Purgatory should help us to love God, better than all the mercies on Earth will do.

XXIX. The generality of Papists believe a fallible Priest, or Printer, or such other person, telling them what is the Faith of the Universal Church, and yet think that this is an Infallible Faith.

XXX. A Papist is one that layeth his hopes of salvation upon his belief of and obedience to a Pope which by their own Principles is no Pope, and a General Council which is no General Council, never was, nor never will be; and on his Communion

with a Catholic Church which is no Catholic Church, but a Sect. All which hath been proved already, and more shall be.

I have told you in part what we take a Papist to be. Some things, before mentioned in the description of a Pope, have been here necessarily repeated.

CHAP. VIII. *What the Papists' Church is:* (*called the Roman Catholic Church.*)

What their CHURCH is may so easily be gathered from what is said, that I shall say but little more of it.

In General, *It is a Society called Ecclesiastical, constituted of such a Head, and such Members, as I have described.*

Particularly, I. It is a Human Church as to the Efficient Cause of its Form; made by Man, as distinct from that Church-form which was instituted by Christ; even by the Fathers, because that *Rome* was the Imperial Seat. As is proved before.

II. It is a Human Church as to the constitutive Head, as distinct from the true Universal Church, which hath no Head (single or collective, Pope or Council) that is not God.

III. It is a Sect consisting of about the third part of the Christian world, calling themselves the whole Church, and condemning all the rest for not subjecting themselves to this Usurping Head.

IV. It is a new Church in comparison of Christ's Universal Church, as having a new Human Original. (As is proved.)

V. It is a treasonable Church, as set up without Christ's Authority, and challenging his Prerogative, and weakening his Kingdom, by unchurching the greatest part.

VI. It is an unholy Church, as distinct from the holy Catholic Church, and that both in the essential Matter and Form. 1. In the Matter, its Head which is a constitutive part, having been oft a condemned Heretic, Infidel, Murderer, and other flagitious wicked man. 2. As to the Form, being not of God it is not holy. 3. Besides that, as to the Head, he was long made by the most wicked Whores.

All this is before proved at large.

VII. It is a Church that hath had its pretended succession interrupted (*as is proved;*) sometimes by long Vacances, sometimes by long Schismes, when no one was the Universal Head; sometimes by the Incapacity of the Persons, being Lay-men,

or Infidels, Simoniacal, condemned deposed Heretics, and therefore no Bishops.

VIII. It is a Schismatical Church, that cuts off itself from all the rest of the *Christian Church:* And by making a false Head and Principle, and conditions of Unity, which the *Universal Church* never did, never will, or can unite in, is the grand cause of the greatest continued Schism.

IX. It is a traitorous *Church* against Princes, making it their very Religion to force bloody Oaths on them, and to excommunicate and depose them, and give away their Dominions, and that tolerateth its most famous Doctors to maintain, that being excommunicate, they are no Kings, and may be killed; and to maintain, that the Pope is above them in Temporals, and may set up and pull down Kings when he seeth cause.

All this is expressly proved before.

X. It is a *Church* that believeth Contradictions (*as is proved in their Councils*) *e. g.* The *Council* of *Basil, Sess. ult.* saying [No one of the skilful did ever doubt, but that the Pope was subject to the Judgment of a *General Council,* in things that concern Faith, *&c.*] And others saying the clean contrary: As also in divers other things.

XI. It was for above forty years, sometimes two, sometimes three *Churches,* instead of one: For the Head being an essential part, two or three Heads make as many Churches.

XII. It is at this day divers Churches really, as to the Form, that are by the ignorant supposed to be one: Two or three Forms and *Partes Imperantes,* being essential, make as many Churches, though the subjects live mixed. The *summa Potestas* is a constitutive essential part. Some called Papists take the Pope for the *summa Potestas,* and some a *Council,* and some both conjunct, and some the Church real or diffused through the World.

XIII. It is a Church made up of a tolerated hodgepodge of many Sects, some utterly uncapable Members, so they do but serve the Pope.

I have showed out of many Doctors cited by *Sancta Clara* that many that believe not in Christ are of their Church. He saith

himself pag. 113. (*Deus, Nat. Grat.*) [What is clearer than that at this Day, the Gospel bindeth not, where it is not authentically preached; that is, that at this Day men may be saved without an explicit belief of Christ? For in that sense speaks the Doctor concerning the Jews: And verily what ever my illustrious Master hold, with his learned Master *Herera,* I think that this was the Opinion of *Scotus,* and the COMMON one, *citing* many that follow it.

And that men that hold all the different Opinions in the *Jesuits' Morals,* and the Schoolmen, besides many various Religious Sects, make up their Church, is not denied.

XIV. It is a *Church* that pretendeth to have a Judge and end of Controversies; but indeed hath a Judge that for the most part dare not decide them, and that can make no end of them when decided.

For instance, the Controversy of the Virgins immaculate conception decided at *Basil,* is never the nearer an end. Images were decreed up by some *Councils,* and down by others. Even S. *Thomas* stood not to the second *Council* of *Nice* about Image Worship. The various *Councils* that decreed variously for and against a *Council's Supremacy,* never the more ended the strife.

And indeed it is so hard to know *approved* from *reprobate Councils,* and *what parts* of them the Pope meant to approve, and what not, (as by Pope *Martin* 5. his *Conciliariter* appeareth) that there is no certainty, and no end.

XV. It is a *Church* that hath almost laid by the ancient Discipline of Christ's appointment, and instead of it hath set up partly Auricular Confession, when it should be Public, and partly a tyrannical sort of hostile proclaiming their Adversaries excommunicate without hearing them, and forbidding God's Word and Worship to whole Kingdoms.

Saith Learned *Albaspineus* a Bishop, *Observ.* 1. *pag.* 1. [*If ever any one in this Age was deprived of Communion* (*which I know not whether it ever fell out*) *it was only from the receiving of the Eucharist: In the other parts of his life he retained the same familiarity*

and converse with other Believers, which he had before he was excommunicated.

XVI. It is a *Church* that is upheld by Flames and Blood, distrusting the ancient Discipline, and the mere Protection of the Magistrate, and the proper work of his Office.

The foresaid 12. General Council at *Laterane* proveth it, besides Inquisitions and bloody Executions.

XVII. It is a *Church* that cherisheth ignorance in the matters of Salvation.

Proved, 1. By forbidding the reading of the Scriptures translated, without Licence. 2. Their Prayers in an unknown Tongue. 3. The quality of their commonest Members.

XVIII. It is a *Church* that militateth against Christian Love. 1. By their foresaid condemning the most of Christians. 2. By the foresaid bloody Religion and Execution.

XIX. It is a *Church* which hath often damned itself, one Pope and Council damning others. *As is proved.*

XX. It is a *Church* which indeed is no *Church,* according to their own Rules; the Pope indeed being no Pope, and the General Councils no General Councils, (*as is proved*.) And if it were one, it could not possibly be certainly known to be so; because the Pope, who is an essentiating part, cannot be certainly known. As is proved both as to Election, Ordination, and all that is necessary to a Right and Title.

As to the Doctrines which they hold contrary to the Scriptures, I have named many of them elsewhere, (in my *Key, pag.* 39. 142, 143, *&c.*) And others more largely.

And thus I have told you what I take a *Pope,* a *Papist* and the *Papal Church to be.* But you must remember that as the same man may be a visible Christian or Member of the true Universal Church as headed by Christ, and a visible Papist or Member of the Sectarian Church as headed by the Pope, so I judge none of you as in the first respect, but allow you the same Charity proportionably as I do other erring Sects: And especially to those many thousands who adhere to a Church which they understand not, and profess that in gross which

in particulars they themselves abhor: Of which number I am not hopeless yourself (*W. H.*) to be one.

CHAP. IX. *How our Religion differeth from the Papists.*

AND now out of all this it is easy for you to gather how our Religion differeth from the Papists: I shall recite but a few of the Differences, leaving you to collect the rest from what is said of theirs.

I. *Our Religion is wholly Divine, or made by God:* For so is the holy Scripture, which is all ours. *But the Papists' super additions are made by men:* Even Popes and Councils, under pretence of Declaring, Expounding, Governing, Judging, *&c.*

II. The Religion of Protestants is no bigger, nor no other in the Essentials, than the Sacramental Covenant with God the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost, expounded in the Creed, Lord's Prayer, and Decalogue: And in the Integrals no bigger, nor other, than the holy Canonical Scriptures. But the Papists is as big as all the Decrees of all General Councils, added to all the Bible; if not the Pope's Decretals also, and uncertain Traditions.

Tell us not of our 39 Articles, and other Church Confessions, as contrary to this: For those Confessions all profess what I here say: And you may as well tell us of our other Books and Sermons. Our question is not of men's *Subjective Religion;* For so each person hath one of his own; And it cannot be known but by knowing what is in each man's mind! And our Books and Confessions are (as is aforesaid) but the Expression of our sense of that which is our *Regular Objective Religion:* And we are ready to confess and amend any misconception: but our *Objective Religion* which is the *Rule* and *Law* of our *Faith* is only Divine.

III. Our Religion is known, even the Sacred Bible. But yours is unknown: what are approved Councils, and what decrees are intended to be *de fide,* and what temporal, and what perpetual, and how far the Pope's Decretals bind, and whether all *Isidore Mercator*'s Decretals be the Popes, with abundance of the like.

IV. Our Religion is owned by you, and every word confessed to be Divine and Infallible: But your added Popery is disowned by us as sinful, presumptuous and false.

V. Our Religion is fixed and unchangeable; (for so you confess the holy Scriptures to be:) But yours is still swelling bigger and bigger while Councils will increase it, and hath no certain bounds.

VI. Our Religion is only that ancient one delivered by the Holy Ghost in the Apostles, and so is certainly Apostolical, your additions are Novelties since brought in.

VII. Our Religion is Infallible, Holy, Pure, your additions are fallible, contradictory, sinful, oft contrary to plain Scripture, condemning one another.

VIII. Our Religion is Universal, owned by all the Christian World in the Essentials, and in the Main in the Integrals, that is, the Scripture: Greeks, Papists, Armenians, Abassines, and all other parties that are Christians own it. But your additions are some disowned by one part of Christians, and some by another, and some by all save yourselves.

IX. Our Religion therefore is the true terms of Catholic concord, according to *Vincent. Lerinens. Doctrine, quod ab omnibus, semper, ubique receptum est.* But your additions are the very Engine of the dividing Enemy, by which he hath long kept the Christian World, distracted by discord, with all the calamitous effects and consequents.

X. Our Religion hath a certain Rule for the ending of all controversies, so far as there is hope of ending them in this world: All men will rest in the Judgment of God; and his word in all such necessary things is plainer than all your General Councils: But your Human Authority is such as fighteth with itself and all the world, and which the Universal Church never yet received nor will ever rest in.

XI. Our Religion owneth a certain lawful Government appointed by God, which well used may keep just order in the world: That is, Parents in Families, Pastors in such particular Churches as Christ hath instituted, (as join for personal Communion in holy Doctrine, Worship and Conversation;) which they are indeed capable of Overseeing and Governing by Sacred Doctrine in Christ's way: And Associations or Correspondences of these Pastors for concord; And Princes and

Magistrates to keep peace and order among them all; Governing Glergie-men as they do Philosophers, Physicians, *&c.* But yours hath an *Utopian* pretended Government of men on the other side the world, whose Countries you scarce ever heard or dreamed of; and an Usurpation of an impossible confounding kind and degree of Rule.

XII. Our Religion is fitted to give Glory to Christ, and his Grace and Kingdom. But yours to set up Proud Usurpers over Princes and People, in such an impossible Government making Subjection to him, necessary to salvation. As if a man unacquainted with Cosmography that never heard that there was such a Town as *Rome* in the world, must be no Christian and be damned: when yet the Pope's name was never mentioned in our Baptism.

XIII. Our Religion is Faith working by Love. Christ's Ministers that are truly of our Religion, take only convincing evidence of Truth, and unfeigned love, and works of love, to be their means of winning Souls: And they take not Christ's Discipline, which worketh only on the conscience, to be a leaden Sword, or vain. But yours is a hanging killing Religion; Jails, Strappado's, Exterminating, and Burning men are your means and works of love. You take a Bonfire, or the Ashes of the Bodies of such as will not believe in the Pope, to be a great Medicine to save the people's Souls. Such Murders as were done on the *Albigenses, Waldenses,* in the Inquisitions, the *French* and *Irish* Massacres, *Smithfield* Flames, *Piedmont, &c.* are your proof that you love God and Man, and some of your *good works.*

XIV. Our Religion tendeth to holy consolation, and a heavenly mind and life: For it teacheth us how to be certain of God's love by its effects on our Souls, and to know that we are justified by Christ, and to trust the sufficiency of his Sacrifice, Merits, and Intercession; and to believe, that when we are absent from the body we shall be present with the Lord, 2 *Cor.* 5. 1. 7, 8. and to desire to depart and be with Christ, *Phil.* 1. 23. But yours leaveth a man uncertain of his Justification: For you mostly deride such distinguished Fundamentals, as (re-

ceived) essentiate a justified Christian: And your Doctors lay all men's necessary Religion, and so their Peace, upon their *receipt of so much truth as hath been authentically proposed to them;* whereas no man living is certain that he hath received so much as hath been so proposed: All men are guilty of neglecting some such Proposal at one time or other: And gradual neglects the best are guilty of. And you cannot ascertain men what is an authentic Proposal. You also tell men of the necessity of their own *satisfactions* for the sin that Christ forgiveth, and that in the Fire of Purgatory; so that (as is said before) none such can dye comfortably, that look to go hence into such a Fire, where torment may make it hard to you to love God that tormenteth you. It is a spirit of bondage that seemeth to actuate your very austerities, and to turn your Religion into superstitious tasks of self-made Services; Ceremonies, and expectations of the expiating Flames in Purgatory: But you show too little of the *Spirit of adoption, of power, love and a sound mind,* 2 *Tim.* 1. 7. of *righteousness, peace and joy in the Holy Ghost, Rom.* 14. *Terror* and *Torments* are temptations to you to desire the miserablest life on Earth (much more a life of pleasure) rather than to dye, when such Flames must next follow.

XV. We offer God such Worship as we can prove by his Word that he commandeth and accepteth; and such reasonable service in spirit and truth, which is not unsuitable to the Father of Spirits, and God of wisdom; yet using all reverent and decent behaviour of the body as well as of the mind. But it would be hard to number over all the Human inventions of *Formalities,* and *Rites,* and *Ceremonies,* and *Images,* and other arbitrary external things, by which you have corrupted the Worship of God, and hid the body in your new fashioned Clothing, which you pretended to adorn; And as worldly minds do cumber themselves, as *Martha,* with many unnecessary things, and then say, [*Is it not lawful to do this and that?*] while they hereby alienate the *thoughts, affections, and time,* which should be laid out on the *one thing needful;* so do you in God's Worship make such abundance of work with your Ceremonies, for *thoughts, affections*, and *time,* as maketh

it very difficult to give the great and spiritual part of Worship its proportion, (far beyond what *Augustine Epist. ad Januar.* so much complained of in his time:) and then think you justify all, if you can say, *How prove you this or that unlawful?* As if your Servant should instead of his work play at Cards most of the day, and ask you [*How you prove it unlawful?*] You never well studied 2 *Cor.* 11. 3. [*I fear lest by any means as the Serpent beguiled Eve through his subtlety, so your minds should be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Christ,*] nor *Col.* 2. 18, 19, 20. 22, 23. nor *Act.* 15. 28. nor *Rom.* 14 and 15. nor *Joh.* 4. 20, 21. An ignorant Woman set upon Christ, just as you pervert all holy discourse, with turning all to [*Which is the true Church?*] *Our Fathers Worshipped in this Mountain, and ye say that in Jerusalem is the place where men should Worship:* But Christ answereth you in her, *The true Worshippers shall Worship the Father in spirit and in truth: For the Father seeketh such to worship him: God is a Spirit, &c.*] Those that by Custom be not engaged in your way of numerous Formalities and bodily actions, can hardly think that you are spiritually and seriously worshipping God, or can believe that Infinite Wisdom would be pleased with such things as—I am loth to denominate or describe.

XVI. Our Religion teacheth us that without Holiness none shall see God, and none but the Pure in Heart and Life are blessed, and if any man have not the sanctifying spirit of Christ he is none of his: and that God must be loved above all, and our treasure, heart and conversation must be in Heaven, and none but Saints are saved. I think you deny none of this; And yet you Canonize a Saint as if he were a wonder or rarity, and you call a few sequestered Votaries *Religious,* as if all that will be saved must not be *religious.* And your Doctors are permitted to teach all that's cited in the *Jesuits' Morals,* and Mr. *Clarkson* fore-cited: Even that it is not *commanded,* that *God be intensively loved above all. Tolet. li.* 4. *de Instruct. Sacerdot. c.* 9. see our *Morton Apolog. part* 1. *l.* 2. *c.* 13. *Stapleton l.* 6. *de Justif. c.* 10. *& Valent. l. de Votis c.* 3. [*This Precept of loving God with all the mind, is doctrinal, not obligatory,*] see my *Key, chap.* 33, 34. 38.

And yet you have the Fronts to persuade men that we are for only *Imputative Holiness,* and against *good works.*

XVII. Our Religion is for increasing true practical knowledge in all men, by all our industry, as knowing the Father of Lights saveth us by illumination; and therefore we are for all men's reading or hearing the holy Scriptures, and worshipping God in a known tongue: But yet with the help of the skilfullest Teachers. The Prince of darkness leadeth men in the dark to do the works of darkness, that they may be cast into outer darkness. How the case is with yours I have before showed.

XVIII. Our Religion is for so much fasting and austerities as is truly necessary to the subduing of Pride, Worldliness, or fleshly lusts, or to express our self-abasement in due times of humiliation, (*prescribed by Authority on public occasions, or discerned by ourselves in private;*) and so much as is truly helpful to us in God's service, or our preparations for death. But how much you have turned these into unreasonable Ceremony, and how much into a pretended satisfaction to God's Justice by punishing ourselves, as if our hurt delighted God when it tends not to our healing, I shall not now stay to open. See *Dallaeus de Poenis, Indulgentis, & de Jejuniis,* of it at large.

XIX. Our Religion teacheth us that all that truly believe in, and are heartily devoted to God the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost, as their God, and Saviour, and Sanctifier, forsaking the Devil, the World, and the Flesh, should be taken by Baptismal profession hereof into the Church, and shall be saved, if they prove not Hypocrites or Apostates: And that we must judge men by this their Profession, till they plainly or provedly nullify it, supposing every man, under God, to be the best Judge of his own heart.

But your Religion teacheth you to hold and say, that if men are never so fully persuaded in themselves that they truly love God and holiness, and are thus devoted to him, yea and if their lives express it, yet if they be not Papists, they are all deceived, and none but Papists so love God: And every Papist

thus knoweth the hearts of others, better than we can know our own.

XX. Our Religion leaveth us room for Repentance, and hope of Pardon, if we mistake. For we take not ourselves to be impeccable or infallible in all that we hold; though we are sure that our *Rule* and *Objective* Religion is infallible. But your Church being founded in the false conceit of the Popes and Councils' Infallibility, you shut the door against repentance and amendment; and when once a false Decree is past, you take yourselves obliged to defend it, lest by Reformation you pluck up your Foundation, and all should fall. Were it not for this I am persuaded your Church would recant at least the Doctrine of Transubstantiation, if not that of deposing Princes, and some others.

And now I humbly present what I have written to *W. H.* and not without hope (if he will but impartially read it) of his reduction: For the man seemeth to me to sin through Ignorance, and to have an honester zeal than many others. For my own part, 1. I profess to him I write as I think; and that after forty years reading I think as many of the Papists' Books as of the Protestants. 2. And that I would joyfully recant, whatever it cost me, if I could find that I do err. But I have showed him that I differ not from them, without that which to me appeareth to be constraining Reason. 3. And that if he will prove to me that I have in one word of this Book unjustly accused, either their POPE, PAPISTS, RELIGION, or CHURCH, I shall thankfully receive his conviction, and repent.

And I agree with him wholly in professing my Religion to be, The APOSTOLICAL CHRISTIANITY, and whatever he proveth to be truly such I will receive. The Name of [*The Protestant Religion*] I like not, because mere *Christianity* is all our *Religion,* and our *Protestation* against Popery denominateth not our Religion itself, but our Rejection of their Corruptions of it. But the Name of [*The Protestants' Religion*] I approve and own, that is, APOSTOLIC CHRISTIANITY CLEANSED FROM POPERY.

Aug. 9. 1676.

FINIS.

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ROMAN TRADITION EXAMINED,

As it is urged as INFALLIBLE

AGAINST

All Men's SENSES, REASON, the Holy SCRIPTURE, the TRADITION and Present JUDGMENT of the far greatest part of the Universal Church,

IN THE POINT OF

TRANSUBSTANTIATION.

In Answer to a Book called

A Rational Discourse of Transubstantiation.

Printed in the Year, 1676.

ROMAN TRADITION EXAMINED, *&c.*

Among many Books that lately came forth, of somewhat the like tendency, there is one called [*A Rational Discourse concerning Transubstantiation, in a Letter to a Person of Honour, from a Master of Arts of the University of* Cambridge.] Alas, for the unhappiness of those Persons of Honour that have such Teachers and Counsellors as this! *Could* they have no better? or *would* they not? If they chose them their misery is just.

The Title Paraphrased is [*A Rational Discourse against Sense.*] But the strain of this, and abundance Written, by Men of the like ingeny, tell us convincingly, that while they distrust all their Senses, and would have all the World distrust them, and deny them, they are so confident of their *Thinking, Inventing,* and *Talking Faculties,* that they dare set them in Battle against the Senses of all Mankind, and cherish some hopes to get the Victory. And verily, it is a wonderful victory that such Men's Tongues have got already, if all the Princes, Lords, Doctors, and all other People that go for Papists, do really believe Transubstantiation; and if some be not in the right, who think that there is not one hearty and complete Papist in the World, unless implicit Believers may be called such, who believe as the Church doth, though they know not what; but that the Masters of the Game are but the Makers or Predicants of a Faith for others, which never was their own, and that they generate but their like, even worldly dissemblers, and convert only Men's Tongues by the power of the Sword, and not their Hearts by all their Oratory. And I must confess, that when I have heard a profane Swearer, Curser, Railer, Drunkard, Whoremonger, plead for Transubstantiation, I have thought of peaceable *Melancthon*'s words [*You* Italians *maintain that Christ is in the Sacrament, when you believe not that he is in Heaven.*]

But the devout words and confidence of this *Master* of *Arts* maketh me think that he believeth himself, and that dissem-

bling is not the Art that he is Master of; but though he be as he saith [*Non ignara mali*] yet he may be *Ignarus mali,* ignorant of his Error and of the Mischief which he would do. Indeed if Men will needs believe that Night is Day, and Day is Night, we might satisfy ourselves with our compassion for their weakness, without any importunate public contradiction; but our case with such Men as this, is such as prohibiteth such patient silence: For, the same Religion which teacheth them to deny the *Senses* of Mankind, doth teach them to *Exterminate, Burn, Excommunicate,* and *Damn* all those that will not do as they do, but will believe their Senses; and also to depose those Temporal Lords that will not exterminate such from their Dominions.

Two things yet I must note, that make me doubt whether the Author be so honest in his dealing as I could wish him, and as a Man that talketh of *God* and *Jesus Christ* should be. 1. That he so *blindly,* or *fraudulently* stateth the Question. 2. That he taketh so little notice of the Books and Arguments that are Written against his Cause, as if they needed no Answer, when we suppose that they have put the Error of Transubstantiation so far past all rational doubt, that it is scarce possible for a Man that hath understandingly, and seriously read them, to believe it: It is but lately that a small Book, on that Subject, was published by *R. Baxter,* Dedicated to the Duke of *Lauderdale,* called, [*Full and easy satisfaction, which is the true Religion,*] which all the Papists in the World can never give a rational Answer to; and therefore this Man dare scarce take notice of such, lest it should bring them to the notice of his Reader. But doth he think that we must not know that his Book is Answered before it was Written, because he will take no notice of it? or must we therefore repeat the same things again?

The *Roman* Article of Faith is, that [*There* is a *change made of the whole substance of the Bread into the Body of Christ, and of the whole substance of Wine into his Blood*] so that our Controversy with them hath two parts. 1. Whether after Consecration there be no longer *Bread* or *Wine?* 2. Whether that which was *Bread and Wine* is *then turned into the very Flesh and Blood of Christ?*

Now this *Rational Discourser* confoundeth these together, and in his progress dealeth so little with the first part, as if he were afraid that it should be taken notice of.

The Reader must farther note. 1. That it is none of our Controversy [*Whether the whole substance of the Bread and Wine be Relatively changed into the Representative Flesh and Blood of Christ Which he once had, and offered in Sacrifice for us on the Cross, as the Lamb of God that taketh away the sins of the World;* For, this is our Doctrine:] But it is, *Whether there be a physical change of the substance of the Bread and Wine into the natural substance of the Flesh and Blood of Christ which is now glorified.*

2. That the Controversy is not at all of the *Real Presence of Christ's glorified Body,* whether it be in this or that *place,* or not? but whether the *Bread* and *Wine* be *changed into it?* For, many Protestants (Lutherans, and others) do profess that we have no certain clear Conception of the nature of a glorified Body; and consequently as they cannot judge of the Locality and Presence of a Spirit, so neither of the Locality and Presence of a *Spiritual Body:* They know not whether the now prevailing Philosophy be not true, that Light is a Body, and Solar Light is the emanant substance of the Sun itself, whose Center is in the Heavens: And if its very substance be so extensive as to fill all the Air betwixt Heaven and Earth, (and more,) and if the Light of an hundred Candles can be all together in one Room, they are uncertain what are the Limits of Christ's Spiritual Body, or whether it be either of a more ignoble nature than the Sun, or of less extent: And most of the *Greek* Fathers thought Spiritual Bodies (if not Spirits themselves) were *Fire.* And as our *Sense* or *Reason* cannot tell us whether or no there be now an Angel in this Room, so neither can either of them tell us whether Christ's Spiritual Body be here: This therefore they leave to God that knoweth it, and will have to be no no part of the Controversy.

1. For the first part, *Whether there be true Bread and Wine after Consecration,* as many others have fully proved the affirmative, so particularly the foresaid Author briefly hath proved it past all rational denial. 1. From the *Senses of all Mankind;*

an Argument fortified by twenty subordinate convincing Arguments against the deniers of Sense; where the Papists' Answers are refuted. 2. He hath proved the *Contradictions* of the Doctrine of Transubstantiation. 3. He hath showed that the Doctrine of Transubstantiation asserteth *one and thirty Miracles,* with *twenty miraculous aggravations;* and hath fully proved from Scripture that these Miracles are fictitious. 4. He hath proved from many express Texts of Scripture, that *it is Bread after the Consecration.* 5. And also that the Scripture itself doth fully teach us to expound *This is my Body,* as we do, and not as the Papists do. 6. He proveth that the very nature of a *Sacrament,* even as *Aquinas* defineth it, is inconsistent with Transubstantiation. 7. And Lastly, he proveth the *Novelty* of your Doctrine, and that the ancient Writers were against it; which *Albertinus, Pet. Molinaeus de Novit. Papismi,* the late *Morning Lectures* of the *Nonconformists* against *Popery,* and many others have proved at large. But these things our *Discourser Rationally dissembleth,* lest if he should answer them it would appear to be no *Rational Discourse.* But let us hear what the Rationality is which he pretendeth to.

His Discourse consisteth of three Assertions, and their pretended Proof, and a short Answer to some Scraps of Objection.

His first Assertion is, that [*It is possible to the Omnipotent Power of God, to change the substance of Bread and Wine into the substance of our blessed Saviour's Body and Blood.*] And he saith, that [*This his Adversaries generally grant.*] And yet, if he know what they say, he knoweth that they maintain that Transubstantiation is a Doctrine of *Contradictions,* and that God cannot make *two Contradictories true.* They easily grant him that God can do everything which belongeth to *Power* to do: Though we are not fond of his phrase [*Omnipotent Powers*] no more than of [*wise Wisdom*] or [*strong Strength*] or *great Greatness,*] yet taking his *meaning,* we grant that *Omnipotency* is never stalled with difficulties: Though God cannot *lie,* nor *cannot hate goodness,* nor *love sin*, nor *make Contradictions true,* that is not for *want of Power,* but because he is perfect: He *cannot* be *ignorant,* or *evil;* and he cannot choose but be God.

I suppose that he taketh not Christ's Body, though spiritual, to be merely, or properly *Spirit,* or (as they speak) *immaterial;* and so that it is none of his meaning, that God can turn Bread into *immaterial Spirit;* which yet I would not have said that he *cannot* do: But it is turning one *Body* into another which he calleth *Possible.* And that God can do this by *Apposition,* or *Union,* adding one Body to another, I cannot deny: But these following Contradictions we take not for Possibilities.

1. For *one Body* to be turned into *another pre-existent,* by *apposition,* (the *Form* of the changed Body ceasing, but not the Matter;) and yet that the *pre-existent Body* should not be *increased* by the apposition, this is a Contradiction. As in Numbers, for two to be added to ten, and yet the Number be still but ten, is a Contradiction: So for all the Bread that is Consecrated to lose only its *Form,* and the *Matter* to be changed into the *Body of Christ,* by apposition, and yet Christ's Body to be *no bigger,* is a Contradiction; unless some pre-existent part of Christ's Body vanish, and it be diminished by loss, as much as it receiveth by apposition.

You say, that *by Concoction we ourselves turn Bread and Wine into Flesh and Blood daily:* But note, that the *Form* only of the *Bread and Wine* ceaseth, and the *Matter* receiveth a new *Form* in us, and by apposition increaseth our Flesh and Blood; and that our bulk increaseth not always, is because some parts vanish, as others are added; and being in a continual Flux or Mutation, we have little, if any, of the same Flesh and Blood this Year, that we had the last, or a few Years ago. And doth Christ's Body thus change, and receive addition and diminution? or, doth it grow bigger at the pleasure of the Priest?

2. If you say that this is not your ordinary belief, but that the *very Matter,* as well as *Form* of the *Bread and Wine* ceaseth; I add, that it is a *Contradiction,* that the very *Matter* should *cease to be,* and yet be *changed into another Body.* The *ceasing* of *Matter* is *Annihilation:* And to say that it is *annihilated,* and yet *changed into another thing,* is a Contradiction: As *Matter* is denominated from the *Form,* when the *Form* ceaseth, the *Matter ceaseth* to be the *Matter* of that Form; but unless annihilated it is still the

Matter of *another* Form. For one *Body* to be *annihilated,* and *another* to take its place, is not for the one to be changed into the other. Annihilating and Transubstantiating are Contradictory.

3. It is a Contradiction for Bread and Wine to be turned into Christ's Flesh and Blood, and made his Body, whose Body is not *Flesh,* or *Blood;* unless he have two Bodies, or one consisting of marvellous dissimilar and heterogeneal parts. That Christ's Body in Heaven is not Flesh and Blood at all, must be confessed by all true Expositors of 1 Cor. 15. 50. *Flesh and Blood cannot enter into the Kingdom of God.* The Context showeth that it is not *Sin,* but natural proper *Flesh and Blood* that is there meant: And who will believe that glorified Bodies are *Flesh and Blood,* whoever well considered, 1. *What Flesh and Blood is,* and for what use? 2. In what *Region* glorified Bodies dwell; and that the Inhabitants are every where Connatural to their Region. 3. That the Text saith *They are Spiritual Bodies.*

And if Christ's Body in Heaven be no *Flesh or Blood,* and his Body on Earth *be both;* then either he hath two Bodies, or very heterogeneous parts of one.

4. It is a Contradiction to say that there are *Accidents,* which are not the Accidents of any Substance, (either of Bread, Christ's Body, or anything else:) For, *Accidentis esse est in esse,* it is relative: The foresaid Author *p.* 96. hath told you, 1. For *Quantity,* a Pound, or Inch of *nothing;* a long, or broad, or thick *nothing;* a Pint, or Quart of *nothing,* are Contradictions. 2. For the Number of Wafers, or Cups of Wine, to put twenty, or forty, or an hundred *nothings,* is a Contradiction. 3. For Figure, a *round,* or *square nothing,* is a Contradiction. 4. A sweet *nothing;* a *sharp,* or *austere nothing,* instead of Wine, is a Contradiction. So an *odoriferous nothing;* a *rough,* or *smooth nothing;* a *red,* or a *white nothing;* a *nothing* seated on the *Altar* more than another place, *&c.* all these are Contradictions.

5. And he hath there showed you that it is a Contradiction for *nothing* to have *real effects:* for *nothing* really to *nourish,* and become *Flesh and Blood* in him that eateth it: yea, for *nothing* to be eaten; for *nothing* to turn to real *excrements;* for *nothing* to make a Man drunk, as Wine doth: God can do all that are

works of Power, but to verify these Contradictories, is no work of Power.

6. God cannot *lie,* saith the Apostle, and Nature itself; else Faith had no certainty at all, the formal Object failing. To *lie,* is to give *false* deceiving *signs* of the *Matter,* and of the *Author's mind:* And if God's *Natural Revelation* to Sense itself be *false,* yea to *all Men's Senses;* doth not that make a lie as well as a false Word, Prophecy, or Vision? God's *Natural* Revelations are known by all Men certainly to be his own, and so are not the Prophetical: All know that God *made* Man's *Sense* to be the *Natural perceiver* of *sensible Objects,* that as sensed, they might be perceived naturally by the Intellect: And supposing the *Object, Sense, Intellect, and Medium* duly qualified, if now we be deceived, *Natural Revelation* faileth, or is false, and we have no remedy: So that to make God's Natural Revelation to Sense, and by Sense to the Intellect, to be false to all the sound Senses in the World, is to make God, blasphemously, the greatest Liar in the World; and this God cannot be, because he is God.

And now, I pray you what doth the *Doctrine* of *Rarefaction* and *Condensation* make against any of this that I have said? Apply it to any one of these Contradictions, and try whether it will prove them no Contradictions? Though your definitions of them are ridiculous, (*viz.* that *Rarefaction* is a *little Matter* under a *great Quantity,* and *Condensation* is a *great deal of Matter* under a *little Quantity;* and this you say is *the ancient and commonly received Definition*) yet this, were it so, is nothing to our business. Rarefaction maketh the Quantity of Matter *no more,* but only more *diffused,* or *extensive* as to *Space;* and *Space* and *Quantity* are not all one: And *Condensation* maketh not the Matter to be of *less Quantity,* but only to possess *less Space:* You show how great a Philosopher you are. But doth Rarefaction make *Accidents without a Subject,* or *Effects without a real Cause;* or *Matter* to be added to *Matter* without *augmenting* it; or the same Matter to be changed into other Matter, and yet cease to be the same Matter it was; or any of the rest.

And what if a Spirit, which is circumscriptively in no place, may be said to be *definitively,* or *operatively,* in many places at

once? Will you say the same of a Body, and so make *Body* and *Spirit* to be the same? A Spirit is *indivisible,* and so is not *Matter;* but yet I make not this the Controversy. I know not how near Christ's Body is to a Spirit, which is called spiritual; but if it be material, and yet in many places at once, it must be by Parts; one Part in one place, and another part in another place. For a material Body not to possess its proper place according to its Quantity and Parts, is a Contradiction: And whatever you will say of Christ's *Heavenly Body,* sure you will not say that his supposed *Flesh and Blood* is not material, or a true Body: And therefore either Christ hath as *many Bodies,* or else as many *Pieces,* or *Parts* of *one Body,* as there are Consecrated pieces of Bread, perhaps many Thousand Miles distant from each other. Yet I will confess to you, that as if a Thousand visible Apples could grow on one spiritual, or invisible Tree, they would be all Parts of that one Tree; so if you could prove, that a Thousand material visible Hosts are united by apposition to one spiritual invisible Body of Christ as *Parts,* they would all be *Parts* of that *one Body;* but marvelously heterogeneal. But what's all this to the foresaid *Contradictions?*

But you have recourse to the Miracle of Christ's *Incarnation,* to salve the Objection fetched from *Sense:* But what mean you by that? Did you think that it is *Miracles* that we object against? or that every *Miracle* is a *Contradiction,* or contrary to well-qualified Sense? What is there in Christ's Incarnation, Conception, or Birth, which is a *Contradiction,* or against *Sense,* or *Reason?* There is *indeed* much that is *above* the reach of Reason without Revelation; but nothing that is *against Sense,* or *informed Reason:* For, what should it be? Is it impossible for God to impregnate a Virgin, any more than to make *Eve?* Or is it impossible for God to take a human Nature into Union with the Divine; when as all things are so nearly dependant on him, that he is, as they say, *intimior intimo nostro?* and it is harder to confute that Platonist, who taketh God to be the Soul of the Universe, and all things to be as it were his Body and Accidents, than to prove it impossible for him to be united to *one.* What else meant your Fanatics, *Friar Benedict. Angl. in*

Regula perfect. to make it Man's perfection to believe that *there is nothing* but God?

And for the Doctrine of the Trinity, it is no more a Contradiction, than to hold that the *Mental Nature* or *Spirit* is informed by a *Virtue* or *Faculty,* which is *One essentially,* and *Three respectively,* as to the *Acts* and *Objects, viz.* The *Facultas-vitalis-activa, Intellectiva & Volitiva;* or, that the *sensitive* Soul hath a formal Faculty, which is *One and Three, viz. Activa, Perceptiva, Appetitiva;* or, that Fire hath a Trin-une power, *Motive, Illuminative, & Calefactive.* When *Trinity in Unity* is imprinted on all Active Natures, will you find out a Contradiction in it? If it were *Three Essences,* and yet *but One Essence;* or *Three Persons,* and yet *but One Person,* in the same sense and respect, it were a Contradiction. And is here any deception of our well disposed *Senses,* or any Lie? Because God hath many Works which surpass the power of natural second Causes, in their ordinary way of working; and because he hath many which we cannot know without supernatural Revelation, will you thence infer that he may be the great Deceiver of the World, and may deliver Contradictions as his Truth? As if *Miracles* were all *Lies* and *Contradictions.*

You say that *Christ appeared to S.* Mary *in the shape of a Gardner.* And what of that? Either *distance,* or want of *light,* or *observation* did hinder her from discerning his proper Visage, and then its nothing to our Case; or else he really *assumed a Visage* different from that which she had formerly seen: And if so, here was no deception of Sense, any more than in the apparition of an Angel; nor no more than a Masked person doth deceive another's Sense, because he would not be known; nor any more than when one knoweth not his old Friend, when Age or Sickness hath changed him.

Pag. 4. You did with a necessary craft pass over your *Doctors' Explications* of the Mystery, as knowing that they do but detect the Contradictions.

You here tell us of [*some of the learnedest of the English Clergy* (or *Church*) *that confess the holy Eucharist, after Consecration, to be really and truly our Saviour's Body, and therefore fall down*

before it, and adore it; and for this cause disown the New Rubric of the Common-Prayer Book, which saith, our Lord's Body is in Heaven, and not on the Altar. These Doctors will tell you that they acknowledge the thing, only they dare not be so bold as the Romanists to determine the manner. And one of the learnedest of them, Mr. Thorndike, *asks, why cannot our Saviour appear to us in what shape he pleaseth, in the shape of a Gardner, or if it so please him, in the shape of Bread and Wine?*]

To which I answer, 1. That *New Rubric* is but the *Old* restored: So you call our *Religion New.* 2. Those may well pass with you for the *most learned,* who please you best, while you confer Degrees. 3. Such as you teach men to refuse Kneeling at the Receiving of the Sacrament, (as one of you that is mentioned in the Life of Bishop *Hall*) by thus persuading men, that the English Clergy believe Transubstantiation, and adore accordingly. 4. Either you speak *true* or *false* of the *learnedest of the English Clergy:* If *false,* it is an ill shelter for your other Falsehoods: If *true,* what regard should we have of the judgment of such Clergy-men, as declare their *Assent and Consent* to all things *contained* in and *prescribed* by the *Book of Common-Prayer,* and *Articles of Religion,* and yet *disown the Rubric,* and *believe Transubstantiation,* and *adore the Eucharist as Christ's Body?* Why do you not call such the *Roman Clergy,* rather than the *English Clergy,* if they differ from you but only in a want of *boldness to determine the manner, while they acknowledge the thing?* What if a Bishop *Bramhall* will have the Pope to be *Principium Unitatis,* and take *Grotius* to be of the mind of the Church of *England,* (who would have *Rome* to be the Mistress Church, and the Pope the Universal Governor, according to the Canons of Councils, even the Council of *Trent*;) must we therefore stoop to such men's judgment? Or might you not as well tell us, that *Cassander,* or *Mileterius,* yea or *Bellarmine,* were of your mind? And whats that to us?

Your second Assertion is [*If our Saviour would have left us his sacred Body and Blood, instead of all the Sacrifices of Sheep and Oxen, under the Mosaical Dispensations, to be offered up by Christian Priests, and to be fed upon by the Christian People, it would*

have been a favour worthy of his excessive love to mankind, by reason of the innumerable benefits, &c.

Answ. 1. If he had only *left us his Body and Blood,* he had not deceived all men's Senses, nor imposed any Contradictions on our Faith.

2. If he had done so, his choice would have taught us to take it for a benefit, because his Wisdom is fittest to discern, and to denominate it.

3. To leave us that Body which was *true Flesh and Blood,* capable of *breaking, shedding, pain,* and *death,* is one thing; and to give us his *glorified Body,* is another thing: This is not capable of *breaking, shedding, pain,* or *death,* being a *spiritual, immortal, incorruptible Body.* Therefore indeed, the Eucharist is *Christ's Body and Blood* representative, but not of such a Body as he hath now glorified, but such as was truly Flesh and Blood, which he once offered; the benefits of which Sacrifice are really given us in and by the Eucharist. But to have left us a Body to be broken and slain, which cannot be slain, and *Flesh and Blood* which is not Flesh and Blood, but spiritual, is a Contradiction. But if Christ have two Bodies, or one consisting of parts spiritual, glorified, and of real Flesh and Blood, then indeed one part of this may be still a Sacrifice.

4. But taking it (as you here do) abstractedly from God's Will, and as in itself considered; what reason can you give us, why *Christ*'s true offering of himself in Sacrifice once for all, should not be as great a Benefit and Love-Token, as our offering him daily? The holy Scripture (*Heb.* 10. 14. telleth us, that [*by one offering he hath perfected for ever them that are sanctified*] and v. 10, 11, 12. that by the *Will of God we are sanctified through the once offering of the Body of Jesus Christ: and every Priest standeth daily ministering, and offering oftentimes the same Sacrifices, which can never take away sins; but this Man after he had offered one Sacrifice for sins, for ever sate down on the right-hand of God.*] But you will tell us what a benefit it would be to offer Christ often? Do you really break, wound, hurt, and kill him in your offering, or do you not? If not, how is it a *Sacrifice?* and how is he the slain Lamb of God that taketh away the

sins of the World? And what Sacrificing, or satisfactory use can it have, to be offered without breaking, hurt, or death? Is it a *living,* or *dead* Body of Christ that you offer? If a *living Body unhurt,* it is none of the Sacrifice the Scripture mentioneth of Christ: And how is it propitiatory for sin? If it be a *dead Body,* was it ever alive? If not, 'tis not Christ's: If yea, who *killeth him?* And if it be his living, glorified, impassible Body that you offer, how unlike is that to Christ's offering? And why calleth he the *Bread and Wine, his Body and Blood,* which a glorified Body is not? It's most evident that Christ speaketh of his *suffering Body,* and not of his *glorified Body* that cannot suffer: And if so, shall we tell God what a benefit it would be to *us,* if every Priest may become as the *Jews,* the killer of Jesus Christ; that he may break his real Flesh, and let out his real Blood? Christ did not this himself. He consented to be killed, but he killed not himself. And what Man of Sense can doubt but he speaketh of a Representative *Body, and Blood* at his last Supper, when his real Body was not broken, nor slain, nor his Blood, till after; unless Christ had two Bodies, one first killed by himself, and eaten by his Disciples; and the other killed after by the *Jews.*

I marvel whether any Papist believe in his Conscience, that *Peter,* and *John,* and the rest, did believe at that Supper, that they did eat Christ's real Flesh, and drink his Blood? What, they that did not understand before his Resurrection that he was to dye as a Sacrifice for sin, and rise again, though he oft told it them? For so expressly saith the Text, *John* 12. 16. *Luke* 18. 31, 32, 33, 34. and 24. 20, 21. If it had been believed by them, why is there no mention of any of their wonder at such a Mystery, as that their Saviour should at once be in their Belly, and in their sight? I can scarce believe that Man that saith he believeth that they believed that then they did eat Christ's very Flesh and Blood. But perhaps some of you will take up a late start Conceit, that Christ at his last Supper did not *celebrate,* but only *institute* that Sacrament: which I am ashamed to stay to answer.

For our parts, we take it for a greater mercy that Christ doth reconcile us to God, and put away our sins, by once offering himself in Sacrifice, instead of the old Sacrifices that must be often repeated, than if he had bid us kill, or break, or offer his real Body and Blood often. And we take it for a greater mercy that we may daily offer this *Representative* Body and Blood, and *Commemorative* Sacramental Sacrifice, than to have broken the real Body of Christ ourselves daily, and shed his Blood. But I wonder not that they that can *believe,* or take on them to do it in spite of all *Men's Senses,* can do it also in spite of *Scripture, Reason, and Conscience.*

I confess there is something in what you say, *p.* 7. It would have been *an incentive to munificence in adorning Churches with the richest Gold and precious Stones, and whatever else that's rare and splendid;* and also to enrich and magnify the *Priest,* that can instrumentally make God of Bread, and Sacrifice him when he hath done; or set him on the Altar, or keep him in a Box. But to the entertaining of Christ into the heart by Faith and Love, a Representative Sacrifice seemeth more meet for us to exercise: And Christ said to *Thomas, blessed are they that have not seen, and have believed.*

Your third Assertion is, that [*The Bread and Wine in the holy Eucharist, are by the Omnipotent Power of God actually, and indeed changed into the Body and Blood of our blessed Saviour Jesus Christ.*

Answ. This is to the purpose if it be but proved. But, alas, where is the Proof? Why you give us such as you have, and we can expect no better from you. You say [*This was the Universal Belief of the Christian World in the ninth Century.*] How prove you that? Very easily in your own conceit; *ziz.* say you [*It is evident by the Testimony of all the Writings of that Age, and by the Universal Testimony of the tenth Age; nor do our Adversaries deny it.*]

Answ. 1. All these three are false: Neither all the Writings of the ninth Age, nor the Universal Testimony of the tenth, saith it; and your Adversaries do deny it.

2. But was there not some sorry necessity that put you to begin your Proof so low as nine, or ten hundred Years af-

ter Christ? Methinks you should have feared, lest this have opened all the deceit.

3. Your Adversaries challenge you to name one Book that ever so much as named Transubstantiation, before one *Stephanus Aeduensis* after the Year 1100, which was neither in the ninth, nor tenth Century, and yet you have not done it to this day; and yet go on to talk at this rate. And they challenge you to name one General Council that ever determined for either *Name* or *Thing,* (that the Bread and Wine are changed into the very Body and Blood of Christ, and are no longer true Bread and Wine) before the Council at the *Laterane* in *Rome,* under *Innoc.* 3. *Anno,* 1215. which sure was neither the ninth, nor tenth Century. Can you give us no earlier proof that ever any Council mentioned it (when Councils are your Religion) and yet deceitfully talk with confidence as you do?

4. But suppose the twelfth Century, or thirteenth, had been the tenth; let us hear your Inference. You say, [*Then it must necessarily be taught in the first Age by the Apostles, to their first Converts over all the World; and consequently be most certainly true: For it cannot be doubted but that the first Converts did understand what was taught them, believe and esteem it as highly necessary to them and their Children.*]—*Then none can doubt but that they could and would and did teach the very same Doctrine which they so highly esteemed, &c.*

Answ. Thus some over-wise Persons can sit in their Closets, and tell from Moral Causes, what, *no doubt,* was done in all Ages of the World: And why can you not as infallibly prophecy from such Causes, what will be done, and so get the reputation of a *wise Man* indeed? As one that would infallibly foretell that his Party should conquer in a certain Battle, because they were Men that loved themselves and their Country, and therefore would not wilfully destroy, or desert both; and therefore would not run away: For they know that more are killed when they fly, than when they stand to it; and if they do not run, the Enemy will, as ordinary Experience showeth; *ergo* they must needs conquer. But when he was asked why all the same things might not be said of the Ene-

mies, and when he shortly heard, *de facto,* that the Enemy had got the day, his great Argument was unanswerably confuted. But let us come to the trial.

1. I will better argue from your Medium, against you: The far greatest part of Christians in the World are against Transubstantiation at this day; therefore so were their Fore-fathers, and their Fore-fathers, till you come up to the Apostles.

That it is so at this day requireth no better Proof than to have more knowledge in the state of the World, or more honesty in reporting it than you have. *Pag.* 16. you say [*The whole World formerly, in a manner, Pagan, except a handful of* Jews *is now become Christian.*] Reader, Is this Man like to tell you what all the Christian World held, in former Ages, from such a Medium as their latter Belief, that can no better tell what the Christian World is? Look over the Globe, or Map of the World, and let this Man tell you which be the Countries that are Christian; and then take the Measure there of their Proportion yourself. Or to save you the labour, read any credible Author that reporteth it. *Brierwood* in his *Enquiries,* one of the best, tells us, after the naming of the several Countries of each Religion, that if you divide the Known World into *Thirty Parts,* nineteen are Pagan Idolaters, six are Mahometans, and sive are Christians of all sorts: But this Man is not ashamed to say, that, *except a handful of* Jews, *the whole World in a manner Pagan, is now become Christian.* All the Pagans of *Africa,* and *America,* and *Asia,* and all the *Mahometans* are nothing to him; even five sixth parts of the Known World. And, alas, how little probability is there that the *terrae incognitae,* the vast unknown Regions, should be Christian: sure if they were governed by the Pope, he would know them. He that can Transubstantiate all the Pagans, and Mahometans on Earth, into Christians; and make Men believe that five parts of six of Mankind are now of a Religion which they partly know not, and partly abhor, may not despair hence to prove Transubstantiation. But how many of this *sixth part* of the World *are Papists?* A Bishop *Bromhall* saith, that about the fifth part of the Christians of the World are Papists: Others think about a fourth part, not measuring by the large-

ness of their Dominions (for few in the King of *Spain*'s *West-Indies* are Christians) but by the Number of Professors. But the most that ever I knew any understanding impartial reckoner allow them, is to be the third part of Christians; comparing them with the *Abasines, Copties, Syrians, Armenians, Georgians,* the *Greek-Church,* and *Muscovites,* and all the *Protestants, &c.* And when the Empire of *Abastia* was greater by many Kingdoms, and the Kingdom of *Nubia* was not revolted, and many great Countries of the *Greek* Religion were not yet turned Mahometans, the Papists were proportionably much less a part than now. And though most of these will say, as we do, that the Bread and Wine are Christ's Flesh & Blood (not which is *in Glory,* but which *was* Sacrificed for us on Earth) yet few, if any, of all these do hold real Transubstantiation. If he say the contrary of them, Travellers, and Authors enow of their own can confute him: (How shamefully they have changed the *Ethiopic* Liturgy, as to their sense, by the altering of one word Bishop *Usher* hath showed from the true Copies; and by such tricks they can, by a Printer, make all the World Papists: and I would the Pope had no other sort of Subjects to uphold his Monarchy, than such as are so made.)

I appeal now to any impartial reason, whether I may not better argue against Transubstantiation, because two or three parts of the Christian World are against it, than he can argue for it, because a third or fourth part are now for it, or were so in the twelfth, or the tenth Century.

But perhaps he will say, that *they are of the same Religion that they ever were, but so are not the Protestants.* I answer, 1. The Protestants will not undertake that none of their Ancestors from the beginning were in this, or other points, erroneous: If the Papists will, it is suitable to their other undertakings: But that we are of the same Religion which all true Christians were of from the beginning, the *same Baptism,* the *same Creed,* the *same Lord's-Prayer* and *Decalogue,* and the same Scriptures, owned, show: and the Lord's-Supper Administered in the same words as Christ and his Apostles and the ancient Churches did. 2. But if the Protestants had not been of the

same Faith with their Ancestors, what's that to the rest that are more than all the Papists? It's notable to read in their *Godignus de rebus Abassinorum,* how an old Woman (the Emperor's Mother) confuted, or baffled the Learned papist that came with *Oviedo* to pervert them to the Pope, by pleading the Tradition of their Fore-fathers, that had delivered them their Religion, and never told them of the Pope. And how tenacious the *Greeks* are of their Religion as received from their Fathers, their very stiffness against the *Roman* Insertion of [*Filioque*] into the Creed, sufficiently showeth. 3. But that really the Papists are Innovators, and have changed the old Religion in this Point, as we have oft fully proved out of Antiquity, so we need no other Proof than the express words of Scripture; which (to pass by the rest) in one Chapter in the three next Verses 1 *Cor.* 11. 26, 27, 28.) doth three times call it [*Bread*] after Consecration. And I never met with a Writer so impudent as dare deny but their leaving out the Cup to the Laity in the Lord's-Supper is a change from the ancient Practice of the Church. And yet will this Medium serve our *Rational Discourser; The present Church leaveth out the Cup,* ergo so did *their Fore-fathers,* and so did the Apostles? And let him tell me, with the Face of a Man, if he can, whether he think in his Conscience that our Ancestors, or the first Converts of the Apostles, were not more likely to *understand* and *remember whether the Bread* and *Cup* were both delivered by the Apostles, or the Bread alone, than to *understand* and *remember* in what sense it was that the Bread and Wine was called Christ's *Body* and *Blood.*

In sum, 1. We believe that all true Christians have the same Religion which was first received from the Apostles. 2. We are sure that they kept not all the same Purity, and Integrity of that Religion; As some fell quite away to Paganism, and Mahumatanism, and some to Arianism, and other Heresies; so some that fell not so far, fell to lesser Errors. 3. And we do undertake to prove, contrary to this Discourser, that the generality of the Churches for many Ages, and the most of the Christian World to this day, held not, and hold not Transubstantiation.

II. I farther use his own Argument against him; At this day, the greatest part of the Church, by far, and in the fourth Century, that which they themselves call the *Universal Church,* denied the *Pope's Primacy* (much more his *Sovereignty*) to be of *Divine Institution:* Therefore so did the first Converts of the Apostles. If the Consequence be good in your Case, it is much more in this. 1. You falsely feign all the Church to have been for Transubstantiation, but I shall undeniably prove what I urge them for, as being against the Divine Institution of the *Roman* Primacy. 2. And this is a Point likelier to be commonly understood and remembered, than the meaning of the words [Body and Blood.] I prove the Antecedent.

1. That most Christians now are against it, is a matter of Fact commonly known: Two or three parts of the Christian World being no Subjects of the Pope at all, *viz.* Those before mentioned. 2. That in the fourth and fifth Century the Church was of this judgment, appeareth by the most express words of one of the four Great General Councils, even that at *Calcedon,* which saith, [*Definitiones sanctorum Patrum sequentes ubique & Regulam, & que nunc relecta sunt* 150 *Deo amantissimorum Episcoporum, qui Congregati sunt sub piae memoriae Imperatore majore Theodosio in Regia Civitate Constantinop. nova Roma, Cognoscentes & nos eadem definivimus de privilegio ejusdem sanctiss. Constantinop. Ecclesiae, novae Romae: Etenim sedi senioris Romae, propter Imperium Civitatis illius, Patres consequenter privilegia reddiderunt: & eadem intentione promoti* 150 *Deo amantiss. Episcopi aequa sanctissimae sedi novae Romae privilegia tribuerunt, rationabiliter judicantes Imperio & senatu urbem ornatam aequis senioris Regiae Romae privilegiis frui.*] that is [We following always the definitions of the holy Fathers and the Canon, and knowing those things which now have been read of the 150 Bishops most beloved of God, that were Congregated under the Emperor, of pious memory, *Theodosius,* the greater, in the Royal City, *Constantinople,* New *Rome,* have ourselves also defined the same things concerning the Privileges of the same most holy Church of *Constantinople,* New *Rome:* For, to the Seat of Old *Rome,* because of the Empire of

that City, the Fathers consequently gave the Privileges: And the 150 Bishops most beloved of God, being moved with the same intention, have given equal Privileges to the most holy Seat of New *Rome;* reasonably judging that the City, adorned with the Empire and Senate, shall enjoy equal Privileges with Old Regal *Rome.*]

Here you see, 1. That two of the four greatest General Councils concur. 2. That they profess herein to follow the old Definitions, and Rule. 3. That they conclude that *Rome's* Privileges were given it by the Fathers. 4. And that because of the Imperial Seat. 5. And therefore they give equal privileges to *Constantinople.*

The Testimony is such as nothing but impudent violence can put by: either they speak true, or not: If not, then how come two of the greatest General Councils so quickly to falsify the Tradition of the Apostles? Did they not understand what their Fathers had delivered to them? or did they disesteem it, or forget it?

If they spake truth, (as they did) you see that *Rome* hath no privileges, or primacy, from God's Institution, but (like *Canterbury*) in our Empire by the Princes and Fathers' Gift.

Which is so sure, that he must put off common Ingenuity, that considerately will deny it; having not only this Testimony of two Grand Councils, but the continued opinion of all the *Greek-Church,* even before their division from the *Roman:* For, let any Man rationally Answer me this Argument. [*The whole* Greek-Church *knew that a Divine Institution was to be preferred before a Human: The whole* Greek-Church *knew that* Constantinople *was not by Divine, but by Human Institution, made Patriarchal or equal with* Rome, *and yet were for its Patriarchate and equality, if not priority: Therefore the whole* Greek-Church *judged* Rome's *Patriarchate and Primacy to be of Human, and not of Divine Institution.* I have largelier proved this elsewhere.

III. I give you another Argument with your own Medium. [*The Universal Church in the time of the Councils of* Constance *and* Basil, *judged that a Pope might be a wicked Heretic, and as such be deposed; and that it is* de fide, *that Councils have power so to*

do: Ergo, *this was the Doctrine of the Apostles to their Converts.*] And yet the Councils at the *Laterane* under *Leo* the Tenth, and *Florence,* determine that the Pope is above a Council. What Self-contradictors now do you make the Apostles to be? How could the Councils of *Basil* and *Constance* believe that Councils are above the Pope, and that he may be a fallible wicked Heretic, unless they had received it down from the Apostles? And how could the Councils at the *Laterane,* and *Florence,* judge the contrary, unless they had received it down from the Apostles? Will neither Reason nor Experience make you ashamed of cheating the World by such silly Inferences?

IV. But yet I will come nearer you: The same General Council at the *Laterane, sub Innoc.* 3. which first decreed for the Belief of Transubstantiation, did in the very next Canon and words, decree, That all Temporal Lords should exterminate from their Dominions all such, as Heretics, that denied this Transubstantiation; and if they did not exterminate them, should be excommunicate by the Pope; and if yet they did it not, the Pope should depose them,, and absolve their Vassals from their Allegiance, and give their Dominions to another. Now either they had this by Tradition from their Ancestors, and so from the Apostles, or not: If not, why should you dream that the Council had the *second* Canon from the Apostles, and not the *third?* If yea: Then, 1. We see what we must expect from your Religion: The King must exterminate all Protestants (and other Decrees say, *Burn them*) or else be deposed himself. To exterminate us all, will be almost to depose himself. Kind Sir, whither shall we all go? or who shall burn so many? It will be a greater *Incendium* than that of *London,* or *Southwark:* And who shall be the King's Subjects? Who shall Plant *England* anew? The *French, Spaniards,* or *Italians?* But what if in this fortunate Island *they also* should awaken and turn Protestants; must the King be to seek for new Planters to be his Subjects?

As *Benedictus Spinosa,* who assaulted the Scripture, did at once also assault all Civil Government; and taught men, that he that could get the Crown had best right to it; and that a Man

may kill any that stand in the way of his desires, and break any Vows when they are against those desires (which are his Interest,) God mercifully so ordering it, that he that will depose Christ, shall with him be permitted to depose all Kings and Governors; Even so God in mercy to preserve Princes, in their wits, from turning Papists, hath permitted the same Men that first by Council condemned common Sense, and made God the deceiver of Sense, and of the World, and new brought Transubstantiation into the Faith, to make a Decree also (such as never Turks, or Cannibals made) That all Men that will not renounce all their Senses (that is, their animality, and their humanity) shall be exterminated; and all Princes deposed that will have such (as renounce not humanity) for their Subjects.

Several things are said to this, by Men that think that if they do but open their Mouths, and speak, though it be to prove that Murder is Mercy and Piety, they have conquered.

1. Say some, *You see the King of* France, *and others, do not so. Answ.* 1. If *they* may be *good Catholics* that *rebell* against the Pope and a General Council, why may not we? 2. I speak not of what any of *you do,* but what your very *Religion bindeth you to do:* Are not *Councils* your *objective Religion?* By the same *Law and Religion* then that Transubstantiation was first decreed, if it rule in *England,* we are all in Law exterminated, or dead Men (except the Papists) or else the King must be no King. Can you say in Conscience that your Ancestors had this from the Apostles? If you will, let Kings, that love your Tradition, take it.

2. But some say, that these were no Decrees of the Council, because they were but proposed in haste by Pope *Innoc.* and not passed by the Council. This help Bishop *Taylor,* Bishop *Gunning,* and Bishop *Pierson,* in kindness, would give the Papists; but unthankful Men will not accept it: And therefore the Answerers to Bishop *Gunning* and Bishop *Pierson* prove the contrary, as Mr. *Dodwell* hath unanswerably done lately at large: And what ever it was in itself, it was a General Council to the Papists, and is part of their Religion, who number it with the approved ones. And *Math. Paris* saith but this, that [*many Decrees were proposed,* or *brought in* by the Pope, which

some liked, and some disliked] and yet the Major Vote might pass them: See also *Naucler, Gen.* 41. *an.* 1215. *Godefrid ad an.* 1215. *Platin. in Vit. Innoc.* 3.

3. Others say, that these were but Decrees of Practice and Discipline, and not *de fide;* and therefore the Pope is not here Infallible, nor his Council neither. But Men that will not take a sound of Words for their Estates, Lives, and Souls, may soon answer this. 1. That though there be many things to be believed, that are not to be *done;* yet there is nothing to be *done* but what we must first believe that it *may,* or *must* be done. When it is said, Thou shalt love God and thy Neighbour; it is included, that, Thou must believe it thy Duty to love God and thy Neighbour: So he that saith [Heretics shall be exterminated, and Temporal Lords that will not do it shall be deposed, and their Dominions given to others] doth include, that [*To do so is a Duty, or Lawful at least.*] Sure it is not confessedly decreed that the Pope shall sin, or that Temporal Lords shall be deposed by him for anything but sin, in their Assertion.

2. If you grant that a Pope and General Council are Fallible about Duty and Sin, even in deposing Princes, and dissolving their Subjects' Oaths of fidelity, how shall we know that they are Infallible in matters of Faith? He that is deceived in saying, Thou must obey the Ten Commandments, may be deceived in saying, Thou shalt believe the Creed: If we cannot be sure by the Church's Proposal that *God is to be loved;* how shall we that way be sure that *he is to be believed, and that the Scripture is his Word.* And if the Pope may excommunicate and depose Princes, and change Dominions by error; how can I be sure that he may not say by error, that this Bread is no Bread, and this Wine is no Wine.

3. Is it only matter of *Faith,* and not matter of *Fact* that you have by sure Tradition? Is not matter of *Fact* (as Christ's Birth, Death, Resurrection, and Ascension) also matter of Faith? And is not this in question a matter of Fact, *viz.* Whether, *de facto, the Apostles told the first Converts,* that Bread after Consecration was no Bread, and that this was the meaning of Christ's words [*This is my Body*] which you assert? And

it's matter of *Practice* that Men must receive it in this sense. But if the Council may be deceived in this, and make such Laws for ruining Princes and Nations, which yet they were never taught by their Fore-fathers; why may not the same Men say [*Bread is no Bread*] without being taught it by their Fore-fathers.

4. Will you give it us under your hand, that this Council and Pope did err in this, and are not to be obeyed, that Princes may have so much notice of your trustiness? But what Council hath ever since *declared* that this Pope and Council erred in this; name it me if you can? No, they will be guilty of no such Contradictions as shall signify repentance and amendment.

5. In the mean time, is not the Pope and his Council by this Decree, *declared Enemies* to all Protestant Princes, and People? What can any proclaimed Hostility do more, than thus by your highest power to Decree Extermination of all the People, and Deposition of their Lords? And is not he to be taken and used as a Public Professed Enemy, who so professeth himself? Are you not all virtually in continual Arms against us, who make the Decrees of such Councils your Religion?

V. And why might not an *Arian* have argued as you do, when they had their General Councils, and the *World groaned to find itself turned Arian,* faith a Father? Might they not at *Ariminum* and *Sirmium* have said, *How can we believe it, unless our Fathers had it from the Apostles?* And I suppose you know (else *Sondius* will tell you) that the *Arians* pretend as confidently to *Tradition* as the Papists do. And your own *Dionys. Petavius* hath cited so great a Number of the ancientest Fathers and Writers, who speak words too plainly savouring of, or favouring Arianism, as will tell any Man that their pretence is not without such a colour of proof, as is as plausible as any you can bring for the Tradition of Transubstantiation at the least.

VI. I pray you tell us which way was Transubstantiation delivered down from the Apostles? By *Writing,* or *without-book, by Word alone?* If by *Writing,* are not those *Writings* yet extant? And cannot we read them as well as you? You tell us that all the Writings of the ninth, or tenth Age show it (which is false.)

But if the Writings of the first eight hundred years showed not the same thing *to them,* how *did they* know it? If by *bare words,* can you make yourself believe that *bare words,* and *Memory,* will as surely convey down from Age to Age, the Mysteries of Faith, as *Written Records* will do? Do you not daily find, that if Men are but to repeat a Sermon, yea a few *Sentences,* how apt they are to alter, or omit, or add some words which alter the whole sense? I seldom hear a Sermon reported, but somewhat of it is mis-reported! yea, we can scarce have a matter of Fact reported without great diversity and mis-reports; which makes the common reports of Persons, and Things, in City and Country, to be so full of falsehood, and uncertainty. Men's Memories are slippery, and the alteration of a word, may make the matter another thing. Send but your Servant to do a message, or business for you, by bare *word* and *memory;* and at another time Write him down all that he shall say, or do; and try which way will occasion more mistake! Why do you keep your Bonds, Bills, Covenants, Leases, Deeds, and Testaments in Writing else, and do not trust them to Men's Memories? Why are our Laws Written, and Court Records kept, if Memory will keep them better? Had we no Books, or Records, one Lawyer would say one thing, and another, another thing; and there would be nothing but uncertainty and confusion. Why do so many Preachers use Sermon Notes? Why do you cause all your Mass, even the *Hoc est Corpus meum* to be read out of a Book, and trust not your Mass-Priests to repeat them by Memory? Besides, that Men Write more deliberately, and accurately, than usually they speak; and their sense is easilier tried, and reviewed. Where Men's Life and Death lyeth on it, Physicians will hardly trust their Memories with all their Remedies, nor send one to the Apothecaries without a written Bill, lest the mistake of a *Word,* or *Dose,* prove Death.

VII. And I ask you farther, Is all the *rest of your Religion delivered only, or most certainly, by word of Mouth and Memory,* or rather by Books? Are not the *Decrees* of all your approved *General Councils* for *Faith* and *Practice* your *Religion?* And are not these *written* in Books? Have *Caranza, Crab, Surius, Nicol-*

inus, Binius, the great and many Volumes of the *French* Edition, and all the rest, been all written in vain? Do all your Lay-Papists, or all your Priests, or any of them carry all these in their Memories to a word? Or are they there as sure as in your Books? Doth Verbal Tradition now deliver down your Religion? Nay, do you not Write your very *Confessions* and *Creeds?* If all your Books were burnt, would not your Religion be greatly changed, while much of the Decrees of Councils would be forgotten? and O what contention and confusion about them would there be?

VIII. But if all your Religion was so currantly delivered by word of Mouth by Fathers to their Children, what made the ancient Doctors pass by the same things in *their Writings?* when their *Writings* were purposely to tell their Readers what was the Christian Religion, and the reasons of it; would they leave out that in their deliberate Writings, which every Child was taught by his Parents?

IX. But what mean you to talk of *all Parents delivering it to their Children?* Do you mean *all Priests,* or *all Laymen?* If *Priests had Children,* it's like they were Married; And had you then the Celibate of Priests by Tradition from the Apostles? If you mean *Lay-men,* would you make Men believe any Story you tell them, contrary to the experienc of their daily Converse? Do we not see that the far greatest part of Men, both among Papists, Greeks, and Protestants, have too little sense, or understanding of Religion, to be accurate keepers of the sense of Scripture? Try your own followers in *Ireland, Spain, Italy,* yea, or *France,* whether the generality of the Common People teach their Children, or understand themselves, what a Sacrament is; though your Industry may teach them to Cant out such words as you would have them say in opposition to the Protestants. When we have much ado to get most of the Vulgar to endure to be Catechised themselves, and to understand the very Creed, and Principles of Christianity; do you suppose them competent preservers of the mysterious sense of such words as we are Controverting?

X. And if Tradition without Writing be so sure, how cometh Tradition to be so contrary? The Millenaries pretended to Tradition from St. *John?* Most of the Writers of the first 300 Years seem for them. Yet I think you will scarce confess that this was indeed the Doctrine of any Apostles.

XI. How long did the Opinion and Practice of Infants Communion prevail in the Church? Doth it follow therefore that they had it from the Apostles? Why then do you disuse it?

XII. The Practice of not adoring, kneeling on any Lord's-day in the Year, or any Week-day between *Easter* and *Whitsuntide,* was indeed called the Practice of the Universal Church, and an Apostolical Tradition; and was Decreed in the first General Council at *Nice, Can.* 20. If they had not this from the Apostles, how prove you that your Transubstantiation is from them? If they had, why have you changed an Apostolical Universal Practice?

XIII. And if it was the Common Belief of the Church, why did never General Council mention it till 1215 Years after Christ's Birth? Was it because it was commonly known? So were the Articles of Faith which they do mention: And sure it is the Common Faith which they are to preserve and deliver. Unless they were negligent or forgetful, it was because no such thing was then believed.

XIV. The ancient Churches professed that their Creed contained all the necessary Articles of the Christian Faith: And when Heretics obscured some of them, they put the Exposition of them into their after Creeds. If Transubstantiation then was a necessary Article of Faith, how came it to be left out of all the Creeds?

XV. The second Council at *Nice* held Angels to be Corporeal, and that Images were not to be worshipped with *Latria:* Yet *Aquinas,* and many others of you, as to the *Image of Christ* and the *Cross,* dissent from them in the latter; and the generality in the former: Had they these then from the Apostles, or not?

XVI. Doth one of your General Councils, (*e. g.* that at *Trent,*) signify all the Christian World? 1. When they are oft but a few Men (not fifty sometimes) and when one County or Diocess

with us hath more Learned Men. 2. When they are a Faction packed by the Pope, and his Agents. 3. When we know that it is usually the Pope, Prince, or Arch-Bishop, or Men of Power, that choose the Members, though most of the Clergy be oft for others, or have no choice. 4. When all the Papists that send to your Councils are not past the third part of Christians, and the far greatest part have no Delegates there. 5. When we know that a few Men's Interest, and Speeches in such Assemblies use to carry away the most. 6. When we know that they use to differ among themselves, and sometime carry a Cause but by a few Votes: And how shall we be sure that if ninety say one thing, and one hundred say the contrary, that the ninety did not as well understand the Tradition of their Forefathers as the hundred? 7. And when we know that Men are oft in Council born down by fears, or hopes, or fair words, and repent when they come home, as the *Greeks* did after the Council at *Florence.* 8. Yea, when we know that they sometime fall into inhumane Feuds, yea, and fight it out to Blood; as the Case of *Dioscorus* against *Flavianus* proveth. And is this a certain Tradition of what was delivered by the Apostles?

Indeed Baptism, the Creed, Lord's-Prayer, Decalogue, and the Eucharist have been delivered down by certain Tradition; But so hath not every Controversy about them, nor in particular, the Doctrine of Transubstantiation.

XVII. Read but *Pet. Molineus de Novitate Papismi,* or but the *Non-conformists* late *Morning Lectures* on that Point; and you will see how the Papists have *innovated in Religion,* and all their Errors proved *Novelties:* And shall we think that such *changers* have kept Transubstantiation as from the Apostles, that could not keep *one half the Sacrament itself* which they delivered them?

XVIII. How shall the ignorant know whether this Man *say true?* that most Books, and most Men were for Transubstantiation in the ninth and tenth Centuries? The time is past, and the Men are dead: Must he know it by the Books of those Ages, or by the Testimony of this Age? If by their Books, 1. How shall he that hath read their *Index expurgatorius*, and known their

corrupting of Authors, be sure that those are not corrupted? or many of them as very Forgeries, as *Mercators Decretals,* and abundance of Spurious Writings? so proved by *Cook, Blondell, Rivet, Usher,* and many more. Is it necessary to Salvation that the Vulgar (yea, or the Priests) have so much skill in History as to know which way most Men went for so many Ages past in the Exposition of such a Text of Scripture? What Man can tell now what mind most of the World are of in several Mysteries and controversies between you and us? Who can tell how to take their Votes? Much less can every illiterate Man know what mind most Men were of in former Ages; and least of all to be able critically to judge of the Evidence, and what Authors are spurious and corrupted, and what sound. 2. Nay, who ever put so much Cosmography into the Creed before you, or made it necessary to Salvation, to know that there is such a Place as *Rome* in the World? 3. If Books must decide that Case for the ninth and tenth century, why not for the former also? And have not we all those Books as well as you? And yet we are confident that they are against you. 4. But if it must be by the Testimony of the present Generation, whose Testimony must it be that must tell us what our Fore-Fathers held? Must it be by the Testimony of a *Council?* 1. There is no General to enquire of, nor hath been long; nor know we whether ever there will be? 2. If it must be by the *last Council,* 1. How shall the Vulgar know that it was a true General Council, any more than that of *Ephes.* 2. *Basil, Constance, &c.* 2. How know they what they did Decree? They never saw, or heard them. If it must be by the Printed Books, 1. They cannot read them. 2. They know not whether they are forged, or falsified. 3. They know not the meaning of them. If it must be by *Reports,* by *whose* Report? Father *Paul Servita* maketh them a pack of Fellows that abuse the World, under the show of a General Council: He was a Papist. We cannot look for another Council to tell us what *this* Council said. Must men take the word of *particular men?* Some accuse that Council; some own it: Whom shall we believe? must it be every *single Priest?* Then Father *Paul* must be believed against them: And some

that turn from the Pope say more against them than he: And how shall the People know that the Priest saith true? Perhaps he knoweth the Priest to be a common Liar, or perjured; at least, he knoweth him not to be infallible. If the *Pope* be infallible, none of you saith that *each Priest* is so: And we never saw or heard the Pope. If you say that we must believe the Priests where they all consent: How shall ordinary men know that, who never see a Council, nor *many* of them? If the major Vote must be believed: who shall gather the Votes, and how shall the People know them? In a word, I see no way that you have to give men any assurance what to believe to salvation, (for the generality that cannot travel over the World, nor get skill in History and Cosmography) but only to believe that Priest that speaketh to him; when perhaps he knoweth him to be a man that hath forfeited belief; or at least is neither the Pope, Council, Church, nor pretendeth to infallibility.

But suppose that the person be so learned, as to be versed in the Councils, How shall he know by them what the former Ages held? 1. What Councils be they that he must believe, and how shall he be sure of it? Is it the Councils aforesaid of *Ephes.* 2. *Basil, Constance,* and such other? These you reject, and many more. 2. Do any Councils tell him by Decrees, which *former Councils* were current, and which not? Sure they do not; no, not the last at *Trent:* So that it is not, *de fide,* with yourselves, which are the true Councils, and which not. 3. How doth a later Council know which former Councils were true? Not because they said so themselves; for then all would be true: If it be by any Characters, what be they, and why may we not know them? 4. How do Councils know which way most Writers went, or what they wrote? As it cannot be expected that the Bishops that met at *Trent* should remember by Tradition what all the Christians in the world *said or thought* in every Age; so neither were all *Writers' words* known to them without Book, by verbal Tradition. I pray you tell me truly, whether ever any General Council took that way to prove what *Justin, Tertullian, Cyprian, Basil, Gregories, Hierom, Augustine, Chrysostom, &c.* said and held, by showing

that they had it by Tradition from other Councils' Decrees, or their Fathers' telling them so, rather than by looking into the Writings of the Authors themselves? And your own Doctors commonly tell us *what the Fathers held,* by citing the *Fathers' words,* and not by telling us, that either Councils, or their Fathers, or Mothers, or Nurses told them what they said or held, [except in the common Essentials of Christianity, the Sacramental Covenant, Creed, Lord's-Prayer, Decalogue, and that the Scripture is God's Word] which all Christians acknowledge are delivered to us, as by two hands, *viz.* by verbal and practical Tradition, and by the Scripture itself.

But if it be the *Present Church* real, (that is, the consent of Christians) which must tell us what was held in the former Ages (which for ought I find is it that you fly to;) though the ignorant cannot try this, all knowing men can tell that this way you are utterly condemned: For at this day, as is said before, at least two third parts of the Christian World are against your very Papacy itself; and believe the ancient Churches to have been against it: So that Tradition doth depose the Pope. So that you have no way left, but to say, *It is our own judgment or Tradition alone that we will stand to.*

So much to your dull cheat, about your pretended Universal Tradition.

Pag. 11. You notably say, [*Suppose a Book fully written as to all points to be believed by Christians, by the first Teachers of Christianity: Let them together with this Book give charge to their first Converts, not to add to it, or diminish it, and to believe as in their Consciences they shall think that Book shall teach them. Though Generation after Generation be never so faithful to such a Charge, yet they may in after Ages come to lose or change their Faith, because the Book may seem to one Generation to bear one sense, and to another Generation to bear another*—As these words, *This is my Body, may seem to one Age to bear this sense, This is the Sign of my Body, &c.*]

1. But you must suppose also, that they that will learn *this Book* must have *Teachers:* Else how will they so much as read it? We are for *Teachers* as well as you, though not for *Judges* that may judge *in partem utramlibet.* The Pastors may teach the

People that there is a God, a Christ, a Life to come; but cannot judge that there is *none.* And Teachers make known that same Evidence of Truth to the Learner, by which they received it themselves; but do not say, you must believe that there is a God, a Christ, a Heaven, merely because we say so.

2. And you must put into your Supposition, that (as is said) the *Essentials* are delivered both ways, by *Writing* and by *word of mouth.*

3. And now suppose, that the Apostles had put the same expository words of [*This is my Body*] into a *Book,* which they spake by word of mouth? Had that been the less *intelligible* because they were in the Book? Or the harder to be remembered? Or could that Age have delivered to the next any more, as from the Apostles, than what they received? And if that be the same written as spoken, sure writing maketh it not the less or worse? If it do, all your Religion is in danger, now it is written in your Volumes of Councils. Have you *more* yet thats necessary, besides all those Volumes, which you whisper or deliver by word of mouth? If not, you profess your Religion unsafe, because you have written it.

4. And indeed you here profess, that the fidelity of successive Generation cannot preserve Religion, by preserving and delivering any Books. And if so, then your preservation of Fathers, and written Councils, and Decretals, is no sufficient Tradition of the sense of [*This is my Body.*] Could you show us your sense in them, it is an insufficient Tradition; for one may take your Councils in one sense, and another in another.

5. But do you indeed think that any Person or Country is secured from changing their Religion by your verbal way? Why then did the Reformers when they were of your way forsake it? Why did the *Greek Churches* disown you? Nay, why did so many ancient Churches apostatize to Mahometanism? Was it for want of Verbal Tradition? Had they not the same as you? Sure no Law will secure itself from being broken by sinners, and no Tradition is enough to prevent Apostasy. But why the same words should be less sufficient *written* by the Apostles, than *spoken* by them; or why God's Writings should not be as

sure and clear in things of necessity, as your Councils; or why your Councils should be insufficient, because written, no impartial man can tell.

But you say further, [*But no ten Families who have been taught by their Parents, either to believe that our Saviour's Body is in the Eucharist, or that it is not there,* (you should have said, *in what sense it is there*) *can possibly mistake, &c.*]

Dreams may seem something to men that are asleep: If God had written the same words that my Mother spake to me, why could not I have as well understood them? Doth my Mother, or Father, or Priest speak so much more wisely than God? Sure not, if the words were the same. But alas, can you keep us from knowing, that you and we have ten thousand and ten thousand Families near together, where the Parents never talk much to their Children about any such matters, nor catechize them, nor themselves understand them: When we ask many of the ignorant Papists, whether they believe that there is no true *Bread and Wine* at all after consecration, they tell us that they do hold that there is, though yet Christ's Body and Blood be there; which is but the *Lutherans* Consubstantiation: And do you not know what *Durandus* taught in this? and yet they that chide him excuse him from Heresy. And had *Durandus* never heard what ten Parents teach their Children?

You presently stab your Papacy to the heart, when you say [*Seeing God Almighty is resolved not to teach every Age by immediate infallible Missionants from himself, but to send inspired Ambassadors to one particular generation only, and to leave that generation to teach their Children successively till the day of judgement, what they learnt, &c.* Thus much is just the Protestant Religion. But then what's become of the inspired Infallibility of your Church? who though they understood not the matter when they came to the Council, (or though the Pope were an unlearned Lad) yet presently can infallibly expound *Scripture,* and decide Controversies. As you praise Mr. *Thorndike,* you might have accepted of the kindness of one Mr. *Warley* of *Cambridge,* in a Book lately dedicated to the Lord Chancellor, called, *The Natural Fanatic,* who will allow the Church and

Councils a higher way of certain determination, than by *Reason;* and will tell you how doubtful its left to Reason, whether there be a *God,* or the *Soul be immortal,* and will curb men that will set their Reason against Councils or the Church. But to remember and rehearse only the words that the Apostles delivered, is a work that Reason may perform, without any inspired *infallibility.*

But if Tradition by immediate Parents, yea and Pastors be so sure, the *Abassines,* the *Greeks,* and many others, are sure that the Papacy is an Usurpation: And so were the old *Britains,* and the *Scots,* a little before *Beda*'s time, who would neither conform to the Church of *Rome,* nor so much as eat with them.

Pag. 42. You say [*If God Almighty will oblige me to believe what was taught* 1600 *years before I was born, how should he expect I should come to the knowledge of this, but by such Books as were written in those times, and near those times, and by the testimony of all Christian Countries, what hath been immemorially believed by them, ever since they were Christians.*]

Answ. Well contradicted: This is our very Religion: We stand to *Vincent. Lerniens.* Rule, *Quod semper, ubique, ab omnibus.* But, 1. Here then Books be not made so unserviceable as before. 2. God Almighty obligeth us first to believe his *own Book* before any *others:* And how shall we more certainly know what Christ did and commanded, than by those that purposely Wrote so many Gospels, or Histories of it, that we might believe and have Life by his Name. Sure the four Evangelists and the Apostles Wrote what they Wrote (even to the ignorant) to be understood and read. 3. We also know by the Books written near *those times* what then was received by the Churches. And your Councils cannot know it (nor your Pope neither) by any other means than are known to others: for their extraordinary Inspiration we never saw cause to believe. 4. And I remember no one thing at all, which I do not receive, *which hath the Testimony of all Christian Countries that it hath immemorially been believed by them ever since they were Christians;* nor shall I reject such when you prove it. But that is, because, *de facto,* I think there is no error that hath such a

kind of Testimony; and not because I think it *impossible:* For as your part of the World is deceived, *e. g.* to think that the *Roman Supremacy* was instituted by God, contrary to the judgment of all the *Greek Church,* and of the two forementioned General Councils at *Constantinople* and *Calcedon;* so I know not but it had been possible to have brought all Countries to the same deceit, or to have believed that Christ's Blood might be denied the People in the Sacrament, as a thing received by Tradition.

We believe that the true Church infallibly believeth what ever it believeth upon true Divine Revelation, and that it can never fall from the Essentials of Christianity; that is, that Christ will still have a true Church in the World till the end. But we know that in many things we offend all, and if every Man's *Will* and *Life* is imperfect and culpable, then so is every Man's judgment; and there is no Man living without many errors, who hath the Exercise of Reason; and the Church is Composed of such erring Individuals: And why it is not possible for them all to have thought that some of their errors came down from the Apostles (as the *Millinaries* thought) I cannot tell. But whatever is truly proved to be delivered by the Apostles as the Will of Christ, by *Writing,* or *Word,* we will readily receive: And the Essentials of Christianity we believe, and can prove to have been both ways so delivered; and some things more, (as the Lord's-day, *&c*).

But you say, *pag.* 15. *Can any imagine that they who exposed their Lives for their Religion, would, if they could, agree together, so notoriously to change it, as to make themselves most gross Idolaters, by adoring Bread and Wine, as the true Body and Blood of their Creator, and God?*] *Answ.* No, but we may well imagine that good Fathers may have bad Children, and that Children are not born with a Church-history, or Councils written in their minds; and that worldly Clergymen may deceive, and be deceived; and that even pious Men might concur in the deceit: that is, That the name of *Christ's Body and Blood* being justly from the beginning applied to the Eucharist, as the Clergy grew formal, ceremonious, selfish, and worldly, they

neglected the explication of the sense and spiritual part of the Sacrament; and grew to over-magnify the external signs in a way that tended to that advantage and honour to themselves, which for want of Learning and Grace they could not by their worth attain: That the ninth and tenth Ages which you choose for instance were as a Night of darkness, having few Learned Men, in which he that was but skilled in *Greek* and *Hebrew* was taken for a Conjurer, or a Heretic, other of your own Writers besides *Bellarmine* do acquaint you. That the Popes were some Boys, many Murderers, Simonists, and most horrid, wicked, and ignorant Men, many by one Woman brought in, and poisoned after; and that for forty Years there were divers Popes at once contending for their several Titles, almost all Histories agree; That hence the World was filled with Treasons, Rebellions, Perjuries, and all wickedness, how many Historians testify; when the Pope hath been judged by a Council for a Heretic, and Adulterer, deflowering Women at his Doors. And is it incredible that such Men should degenerate from their Fore-fathers? Or shall a Friar now come out of a Cell, and tell the World, that because, the first Bishops of *Rome* were holy Martyrs, it was not possible for Pope *John* to be such a blasphemous filthy Villain; nor for Pope *Eugenius* to be damned as a Heretic and wicked Man by a General Council, and yet continue Pope after deposition: or for *Sergius* to use *Formosus* as he did? I speak not of rarities, or doubtful things: The Pope's greatest flatterers lament them. *Baronius ad an.* 912 saith [What then was the Face of the holy *Roman* Church? How exceeding filthy, when the most potent, and yet the most sordid Whores did Rule at *Rome?* by whose pleasure Sees were changed, Bishops were given, and which is a thing horrid to be heard, and not to be spoken, their Lovers (or Mates) were thrust into *Peter's* Chair, being false Popes, who are not to be written in the Catalogue of the *Roman* Popes, but only for the marking out of such times: And what kind of Cardinals, Priests and Deacons think you we must imagine these Monsters did choose, when nothing is so rooted in Nature, as for everything to beget his like?] 1. Is not here a Succes-

sion fit to prove the Church of *Rome* to be the true Church? O happy Succession! 2. And is it impossible that such Men as these should err? and such Bishops, Priests, and Deacons should change one word that was delivered orally from their Fathers? Is not here a sure Foundation for a Man to build his Faith and Salvation on?

Genebrard another furious Papist (*li.* 4. *Sect.* 10.) saith [*In this one thing this Age was unhappy, that for near an hundred and fifty Years, about fifty Popes did wholly fall away from the virtue of their Ancestors, being rather irregular and Apostatical, than Apostolical.*] Apostates make an Apostolical Succession of Infallible wicked Men. Reader, did not our *Rational Discourser* wisely choose the ninth and tenth Ages for his ground-work? These are the very Ages whose Testimony he appealeth to.

Pope *Adrian* (after) himself, (*de Sacram. Confirm. Art.* 4. saith, that there have many Popes of *Rome* been Heretics. And as I said, Pope *John* 13 *alias* 12 was in Council *Convict of Ravishing Maids, Wives, and Widows, at the Apostolic Doors, and of committing many Murders, and he drank a health to the Devil; and at Dice called for help to* Jupiter *and* Venus, *and at last was killed in the Act of Adultery.*

Saith their *Platina* [*He was from his Youth a Man contaminated with all dishonesty, and filthiness; and if he had any time to spare from his Lusts, he spent it in hunting, and not in praying.*—He saith, *he was a most wicked man, or rather a Monster.*—And saith, [*that the Life of this wicked Man being judged in a Council of* Italian *Bishops, for fear of them he fled, and lived like a wild Beast in the Woods.*]

Pope *John* 23 was accused and deposed by the General Council at *Constance,* upon about seventy Articles, which you may see in *Binnius* in about thirteen Columns, *viz.* of Murders, Adulteries, Witchcraft, Simony, a Heretic, obstinately maintained that there is no Life after this; called commonly, *The Devil incarnate; said the Soul was extinct with the Body, as a Beasts; denied the Resurrection,* &c. And for these the Council deposed him.

So the great Council at *Basil* deposed *Eugenius* the 4*th* as [*a Rebel against the holy Canons, a notorious disturber and scandalizer of the Peace and Unity of the Church; a Simonist; a perjured wretch; incorrigible; a Schismatic, and an obstinate Heretic*] Yet is their Church's Succession continued from this condemned Heretic, who staid in spite of the Council that deposed him.

But you'll say, Though the Pope may so err, yet General Councils cannot. *Answ.* These very Councils that condemned him, are now rejected by you, as is *Ephes.* 2. and many others: yea accused as being another Church; saith the Learned Cardinal *Cajetan* in his Oration at the Council at the *Laterane sub. Leon.* 10. (*Bin. p.* 552.) [*This Novelty of* Pisa (Mark Councils are Novelists) *sprung up at* Constance, *and vanished: At* Basil *it sprung up again, and is exploded. And if you be Men it will now also be repressed as it was under* Eugen. 4. *for it cometh not from Heaven, nor doth it embrace the Principality of that One who is in the Church-Triumphant, and preserveth the Church-Militant; and which the Synod of* Pisa *ought to embrace if it came from Heaven, and not as it doth to rely on the Government of a Multitude. The Church of the* Pisans *therefore doth far differ from this Church of Christ: For one is the Church of Believers, the other of Cavillers; One of the Household of God, the other of the Erroneous: One of Christian-men, the other of such as fear not to tear the Coat of Christ; and divide the Mystical Members of Christ from his Mystical Body.*

See here to what Novelty and Apostasy, even to be *another Church:* You think that General Councils have fallen, as those Councils say the Pope hath done. O but *these Men* can corrupt nothing, because the Martyrs would not have corrupted it! And yet even good Men's pious credulity, believing ignorant Men's Dreams and Visions (such as *Gregories* Dialogues and *Beda* show to any rational Man) may do much to introduce Changes.

But if Changes be so impossible, because Fore-fathers were pious Men and of another mind, how come the *Greek-Churches* to be Apostatized so far to Mahometanism? and why do you accuse the Protestants, or *Greeks* of changing, if it was impossible (for ten Families) to do it? Sure then the *Abassines, Syrians,*

Armenians, Greeks, &c. have their old Faith still unchanged, if it be impossible. Sure never such Villainy was charged on their Bishops as on your Popes. If they may change, notwithstanding their Fore-fathers Piety, why not you?

In the last place I should speak to your Testimonies out of some Ancients. But 1. Why should we put it to the trial of Fathers, when you dare not stand to it, but fly to the Authority and Judgment of your present Church; that is, your Pope. 2. Can any Fathers speak plainer than St. *Paul* himself doth, who calleth it *Bread* after Consecration thrice in the three next Verses? Or did the Fathers contradict him? If they delivered what they received, we see what that was. Is oral Tradition contrary to the Scripture? Is not this a certain Argument? *Paul* in 1 *Cor.* 11. saith oft that it is *Bread after* Consecration; *ergo,* that Speaker, or Writer is deceived, or a Deceiver, who saith, that he or any other Apostle delivered the contrary by word of Mouth.

3. Doth this Discourser mean sincerly in talking of Tradition and the Fathers' Testimonies, and yet never once attempt any answer to all those Testimonies to the contrary, out of their plain words, which our Writers have copiously and often cited. How many, and many more, plain Testimonies of the Fathers against Transubstantiation doth one *Edmundus Albertinus* give you? to which, instead of answers, a few mere words, or cavils are returned: But all these are overlooked by this Discourser.

But come, let us briefly try all his great proof of the Tradition of the Fathers.

I. He begins with excellent *Augustine* (who in a *Carthage* Council did help to quell the Pope's Usurpation) And out of many great Volumes he hath found, 1. That *Austin* said, that [*now it is no longer called Bread, but the Body of Christ:*] The same will the Presbyterians say: Do they not in their Directory say, [*Take, eat, this is the Body of Christ*] when they deliver the Sacrament? Are they therefore for Transubstantiation? Is it all one to say, [*It is not called Bread, and, It is not Bread?*] *If the King's*

Statue be made in Marble or Brass, you may well say, This is not now to be called *Marble* and *Brass,* but *the King.*

2. That *Austin* said [*that Christ gave us his very Flesh to be eaten to our Salvation; but nobody eateth that Flesh, unless he have first adored it.*] *Answ.* Any Protestant will say the same. For Christ himself hath said, *Except ye eat the Flesh of the Son of Man, and drink his Blood, ye have no life in you.* Do not your own sacrilegious Popes and Clergy expound this of something else than the Eucharist? when they deny the *Cup* to the People? If it be that *Wine* Consecrated that is here meant, what bloody wretches are you to damn all your People's Souls, by denying them all that Blood of Christ, without drinking which they *have no life?* But it's certain by 1 *Cor.* 15. that Christ hath not Flesh and Blood in Heaven, and therefore it is not the Heavenly Body, that, as such, is here meant; but the true sense of Christ and *Austin* is, that as the Sacrifices are eaten by such, by, and for whom they are offered; so his Flesh and Blood offered on the Cross is the true Sacrifice for Sin, which must be eaten in its Commemorative Representation orally in the Sacrament, and really in itself by Faith, that the benefits of that Sacrifice may be ours. And who doth not adore that Christ whom we thus eat and live upon? This is the sum of all that the Fathers say.

But let the Reader judge of *Austin's* mind by plainer words, *De Doctr. Christ. cap.* 7. [*Let no Man look to what they are* (mentioning the *Bread* and *Wine*) *but to what they signify: For our Lord was pleased to say, This is my Body when he gave the sign of his Body.*]

And *Cont. Max. l.* 3. *cap.* 22. [*We note in the Sacraments, not what they are, but what they show: For they are signs, which are one thing, and signify another.*]

And *Epist.* 23. *ad Bonif.* [*If Sacraments had not some likeness* (or resemblance) *to those things whereof they are Sacraments, they could not be Sacraments at all. From this likeness* (or resemblance) *they often take the names of what they represent: Therefore as the Sacrament of Christ's Body is in some sort his Body, so the Sacrament of Faith is Faith also.*]

You need no more than this of *Austin* to Interpret other Fathers, that call the Sacrament *Christ's Body.*

II. His next is *Ambrose,* who saith that [*That when Consecration hath been made of Bread, it is made the Flesh of Christ*] and [*Christ makes this Sacrament*] and [*the Body of Christ was not before Consecration, but after,* &c.] *Answ.* 1. All this the Presbyterians say. Even as we say, It is not a Law till the King give the *fiat,* or it is not his *Coin* till his Authority and Stamp so make it; And are they therefore of your mind? 2. *Ambrose* expressly expounds his negation of *ordinary Bread;* no doubt it is not *ordinary Bread.* 3. You would deceive the Reader by hiding *Ambrose,* who saith there, *de Sacram. l.* 4. *c.* 4. [*This we assert, how that which is Bread* (mark that) *can yet be the Body of Christ*]—[*And if Christ's Speech had so much that it made that to begin to be which was not; how much more is it operative that the things that were, both Be, and be changed into something else*—] And [*As thou hast drunk the similitude of Death, so thou drinkest the similitude of precious Blood.*] So *Ambrose,* and so the Protestants.

III. His next is *Hierome;* out of many Volumes he hath gathered thus much, that Priests [*make the Body of Christ with their sacred Mouth and Prayers.*] *Answ.* And any Protestant will say the like: He that saith [*This is the Body of Christ*] that is, Sacramentally, will say that, under Christ, his Minister maketh it such. And is this the Tradition?

2. Let *Hierome* speak for himself, *Contr. Jovin. l.* 2. [*The Lord as a Type* (*or Figure*) *of his Blood, offered not Water, but Wine.*] Are not these words plain, till the Pope expound them?

IV. His next is *Cyprian, de Coena Dom.* And, 1. Let the Reader note, that even *Bellarmine de script. Eccl. in Cyprian* saith, that the Book which this Man citeth as St. *Cyprian's,* [was neither *Cyprian's, nor any Learned Man's; and had neither Words nor Sentences worthy a Learned Man, but foolish and ridiculous Narrations, and Fables.*]

2. The words cited out of it are [*Panis iste quem Dominus discipulis porrigebat, non effigie sed natura mutatus, omnipotentia verbi factus est Caro*] But by [*Natura*] the Author plainly meaneth [*the Relative Nature*] and not the *Substance.* And it

was not for nothing that *Bellarmine* contemneth him, who ever he was; for he is downright against Transubstantiation. *Cap* 2. He maketh the difference between this and common Meat to be, that, *Corporalis substantiae retinens speciem, sed virtutis divinae invisibili efficientia probans ad esse praesentiam:* It is but the presence of *Divine Virtue* that he affirms to be with the *Species of corporeal substance.* And plainer, *cap.* 3. [*When the Lord had said, Do this in my remembrance, This is my Body, and this my Blood*] *as oft as by these words and this faith it is done, that supersubstantial Bread and Cup, by solemn blessing hallowed, profiteth to the life and health of the whole Man; being both a Medicine and a Sacrifice, to heal our infirmities and purge our iniquities.* And showing the difference between the Common part of Christ's last Supper, and this Spiritual Food, he addeth, that, [*when the perfidious mind of* Judas *touched this holy Meat, and the sanctified Bread entered his wicked Mouth, &c.*] So that he calleth it *sanctified Bread* after the Consecration.

And *Cap.*—telling why Christ calleth the same both *Bread, Blood, Flesh, and his Body,* he saith, [*Panis est esca,* &c. *Bread is Meat, Blood is Life, Flesh is Substance, his Body the Church.* And *cap.* 4. *This Sacrament Christ calleth sometime his Body, sometime Flesh and Blood, sometime Bread; a Portion of Life eternally, which he Communicateth according to these visible things to corporal Nature. That common Bread being turned into Flesh and Blood, procureth Life and increase to bodies* (that is, our common Concoction turneth common *Bread* into our *Flesh and Blood;*) *Therefore the Infirmity of our Faith being helped by the usual effect of things, by a sensible Argument is taught, that the effect of Life eternal is in Visible Sacraments; and that we are united to Christ, non tam Corporali quam spirituali transitione, not so much by a Corporal as by a Spiritual Transition.* And *cap.* 6. *His Conjunction and ours neither mingleth Person, nor uniteth Substances; but Consociateth Affections, and Confederateth Wills.*

And the same Author, or another, in *Cyprian's* Works, *de Unctione Chrism. cap.* 7. Saith [*Our Lord at the Table where he last feasted with his Disciples, gave them with his own hands, Bread and Wine; but on the Cross he gave his Body to be wounded by the hands*

of Soldiers, that the sincere truth, and true sincerity, secretly imprinted in the Apostles, might expound to the Nations how the Wine and Bread was Flesh and Blood; and by what Reasons the Causes agreed to the Effects, and divers Names and Species were reduced to one Essence; and the Things signifying, and the things signified were called by the same Names, (or known by the same Words) *By these Privileges of supernatural Grace, by the eating of sanctified Bread, being refreshed, washed, and anointed, &c.*] Reader, here you see what Tradition saith.

Next out of *Cyprian de Lapsis,* he citeth words against them, that [*with defiled hands and mouths receive the Body, and drink the Blood of the Lord.*] Words which Protestants have more frequently than *Cyprian;* and are they on your side too?

But shall *Cyprian* have leave to speak indeed? *Epist. ad Magn. cap.* 4. [*When our Lord calleth his Body Bread, congested by the adunation of many Grains, he showeth the Union of the People whom he bare: and when he called his blood wine, expressed out of many bunches of Grapes and Kernels, and made up into one, he signified one Flock united,* &c.]

And *Epist.* 63. *Ad Caecilium de Sacram.* Proving that the Sacrament should not have *Water alone without Wine,* he saith *cap.* 2. [*That the Cup which is offered in commemoration of him be offered mixed with Wine. For when Christ saith, I am the true Vine, his blood is not water, but wine.* Nor *can his blood, by which we are redeemed and sanctified, be seen to be in the cup, if wine be not in the cup, by which Christ's blood is showed,* &c.

And *c.* 6. *We find the cup mixed which Christ offered, and that it was wine which he called his blood. Whence it is apparent that the blood of Christ is not offered, if wine be wanting to the cup; nor is the Lord's Sacrifice celebrated by due sanctification, unless our Oblation and Sacrifice answer his Passion.*

And *cap.* 9. *In the wine is showed the blood of Christ, as in the water is understood the People.* (Is the water turned into the People?)

And *cap.* 10. *So the cup of the Lord is not water alone, nor wine alone, but must both be mixed; even as the body of the Lord cannot*

be meal (*or flower*) *alone, or water alone, but both must be united, conjoined, and be bread by composition solidated.*

And *cap.* 12. [*As oft as we offer the cup in commemoration of the Lord and his Passion, let us do that which is manifest the Lord did.*] So much of *Cyprian.*

V. The next cited by him is *Tertullian,* saying, [*The flesh is fed with the body and blood of Christ, that the Soul may be made fat with God.*]

Answ. 1. The same we all say, even when we Administer the Sacrament: See the like in the *English* Liturgy, and the Directory: Are we therefore for Transubstantiation? 2. It is the *Representative body of Christ,* and not real flesh and blood: For he saith, that *he that eateth his flesh, and drinketh his blood, hath eternal life; and dwelleth in Christ, and Christ in him, John* 6. 54, 56. But the wicked, that eat the body of Christ Representative, have not eternal life, nor dwell in Christ.

Another citation from *Tertullian* is *lib. de Idololat.* [*To touch the body of our Lord with those hands which give bodies to Devils,* &c.]

Answ. Here is no more than we commonly say: This Man sure would prove that the Liturgy and Directory are both for his opinion. Is this the Proof of Universal Tradition?

Reader, *Tertullian* calls it *The body of Christ,* and so do we. Will you hear him speaking his own Sense, which this Man concealeth?

Cont. Marcion, l. 3. *c.* 19. [*Sic enim Deus in Evangelio quoque vestro revelavit, panem corpus suum appellans, ut & hinc jam eum intelligas corporis sui figuram pani dedisse, cujus retro corpus in panem Prophetes figuravit, ipso Domino hic sacramentum postea interpretaturo.*] That is [*For so God even in your Gospel revealed, calling bread his body, that so hence you may understand, that he gave to bread the figure of his body; whose body the Prophet formerly figured into bread, the Lord himself being afterward to interpret this Sacrament.*] Here it is oft called *bread,* and this *bread* is called Christ's body, and the figure of the body given to *bread* itself, as was prefigured by the Prophets before Christ had a body.

And *Cont. Marc. l.* 1. 14. [*Nec panem* (*reprobavit*) *quo ipsum*

corpus suum representat,] [*He reprobated not bread, by which he represented his own very body.*] *Pamelius* hath no shift, but to say, that by *representing* he meaneth *making present,* such deceit will seem to prove to them *Universal Tradition:* And he citeth many other places, as for him, out of *Tertullian*, which have no more but his naming the Sacrament *Christ's body and blood,* as we all do.

Cont. Marc. l. 4. *c.* 40. He is yet plainer, saying [*The bread which he took and distributed to his Disciples, that he made his body, saying, This is my body; that is, the* FIGURE *of my body: But it had not been the Figure of it, if he had not had a true Body. For an empty thing which is a phantasm, can have no Figure; or if he therefore feigned* (or made) *bread to be his body, because he wanted* (or had not) *a true body, then it was bread that he must deliver up for us: It made for* Marcion*'s Vanity that bread should be Crucified.* (All this is to prove against *Marcion* that Christ had a true body.) *But why doth he call bread his body, and not a Pumpion, which* Marcion *hath instead of a heart, not understanding that this was the old figure of Christ's body,* (*N. B.* had Christ flesh then?) *who said by* Jeremy [*They have devised a Device against me, saying, Come, let us cast wood upon his bread; that is, the Cross upon his body—so also making his Testament in the mention of the Cup,* &c. *And that you may know the old figure of his blood in wine,* Esaias saith, &c. *so now he consecrated his blood in wine, who then figured wine in blood.*]

Let anything but ignorance and impudence judge, whether here be not over and over, *bread and wine* after Consecration, being the *representative and figurative body and blood* of Christ, or *representing and figuring* them fuller, as the Prophets had partly, or darkly done before. But nothing will convince some that *rage, and are confident.*

I repeat *Tertullian*'s reproof of the deniers of the certainty of Sense, *Lib de Annim. c.* 17. [*Therefore if Causes are freed from the infamy* (of fallacy) *how much more Sense, which Causes freely go before,* &c. *What dost thou procacious Academic? Thou overturnest the whole State of Life; thou troublest the whole Order of Nature; thou blindest the Providence of God himself, as if he had made de-*

ceitful and lying Senses the Lords of all his works, as they are to be known, inhabited, dispersed, and enjoyed.—It is not lawful for us to call those senses into doubt, lest in Christ we deliberate of the belief of them; Lest perhaps it be said that he falsely saw Satan cast down from Heaven, or falsely heard his Father's Voice testifying of him; or was deceived when he touched Peter*'s Mother-in-Law; or after felt some other Spirit of the Ointment, which he received as to his Burial; and some other relish of the Wine which he* CONSECRATED *for the* MEMORIAL (or to be the Memorial) *of his blood.*] So much for *Tertullian.*

VI. He next citeth *Chrysostome,* saying that Christ [*makes us his Body, not only in belief, but in very deed;* and that *we eat and touch his Body.*] *Answ.* And doth he not see how in citing these, he confuteth himself. 1. Christ doth really make *Us* his Body; that is, his Political and Mystical Body: But *is it We* that this Man would prove Transubstantiate into Christ's Body? I thought it had been the *Bread,* and not *Us.*

2. If we *touch Christ's Body* it must be his *Representative Body;* for the Papists hold that we *touch* not the *real Flesh and Blood of Christ,* but only certain *Accidents,* which now are not the Accidents of Christ's Body, nor of any other Substance.

It would be tedious to cite out of *Chrysostome* all that makes against them. Let these plain words serve to notify his mind [*Epist. ad Cesar. The Bread is made worthy to be honoured with the Name of the Flesh of Christ, by the Priest's Consecration; yet the Flesh retains the properties of its incorruptible Nature, as the Bread doth its Natural Substance. Before the Bread is sanctified we call it Bread; but when it is Consecrated by the Divine Grace, it deserveth to be called the Lord's Body, though the Substance of the Bread still remaineth.*]

Reader, This is the Tradition of the Church.

As to some Men's Cavil, that this Epistle is Spurious, it is fully confuted by Learned Men from sufficient Testimony.

VII. The next cited is a word that seemeth, in sound, to be for them, in *Cyril* (or some think *John*) of *Jerusalem's* Catechism. Read the words Translated by himself; It is that Sentence which above all in the Ancients they most boast of, [*viz. Do*

not look on it as bare bread, and bare wine; for it is the body and blood of Christ:—For though thy Sense suggest this to thee, yet let Faith confirm thee: Do not judge of the thing by the taste, but rather from Faith hold for certain, so that thou hast no doubt that the body and blood are given thee; knowing and accounting for certain, that this bread which is seen by us, is not bread, though our taste judge it to be bread; but that it is the body of Christ: And the wine which is seen by us is not wine, but the blood of Christ.]

Answ. Here I desire the Reader to note, 1. That this one Sentence is all that hath any *Words that sound like* his Sentence (that there is no true *bread and wine*) of all that he bringeth to prove Universal Tradition. 2. That this Book called *Cyril's Cat. Mystagog.* is questioned. 3. That the Author plainly declareth himself against Transubstantiation.

Which I prove, 1. The Assertion which he stateth is, that the *bread and wine* (for so he calleth them) are not [*bare, or mere bread and wine*] but Christ's *body* and *blood;* which we all assert: As the King's Statue in Brass is not bare Brass. 2. He next bids us not *judge by our taste,* that it is *bare bread.* And after when he saith *it is not bread and wine,* and appealeth to Faith from Sense, it is but his repeating of what he before asserted; meaning that though Sense perceives nothing but *bare bread and wine,* yet Faith perceiveth Christ's *body and blood;* and so it is not to be called *bread and wine,* for all proper denomination is from the *Form;* and the Form of a Sacrament is *Relative,* (as of a *Statue, Image, Symbol, Sign, &c.*) and it is *Relatively* Christ's *body and blood:* So that it is but, that it's *bare bread,* that he denieth; as we do.

3, Most fully, he tells us his mind, *Cat.* 3. *p.* 235. [*For as the bread of the Eucharist after the Invocation of the Holy Ghost, is no more* COMMON *bread, but is the body of Christ; so also this holy Ointment is no more mere Ointment, nor* (*if any one had rather so speak*) *Common, now it is Consecrated; but it is a Grace* (*or Gift*) *which causeth the presence of Christ, and the Holy Ghost; that is, of his Divinity:*] So that if you take him to assert the Transubstantiation of *bread,* you must say that he takes *Oil* also to be *Transubstantiate* into *Grace,* or the Holy Ghost. For he saith, that

one is so as the *other is changed.* That is, they are no more *mere or common bread, or Oil.*

VIII. His last is out of *Justin Martyr,* who saith [*We do not take these things as Common and ordinary bread,* &c.

Answ. 1. There is not one word in *Justin Martyr* here that we do not own, and say; (nor do we desire to worship God by any other Liturgy, or Order of Worship, than that which he describeth as then the Practice of the Christian Church. O that we might all unite in that described Order!

2. And if any may be yet unsatisfied what Tradition saith, hear *Justin* farther, *Apol.* 2. (Truly the first) [*When the President hath given thanks, and all the People acclaimed, those that with us are called Deacons, distribute to every one present* BREAD *and* WINE *and Water, and bring them to those that are absent.*] It is *bread and wine* when distributed.

And *Dial. Cum Tryph.* [*The Offering of Flower delivered to be offered for them that were cleansed of the Leprosy, was a Type of the* BREAD *of the Eucharist, which our Lord Jesus Christ commanded us to make in remembrance of his Passion.*]

Thus you see to what his boast of Universal Tradition is come.

Read but *Dallaeus de Cultu Latinorum,* and you will see that there *Universal Tradition* was against them.

The foresaid Author of the Dialogue, called, [*Full and easy satisfaction which is the true Religion,*] to these forementioned addeth more, which you may read, *pag.* 140, *&c. viz. Irenaeus* saying, [*For as the bread which is of the Earth, receiving the Divine Invocation, is not now common bread, but the Eucharist, consisting of two things, the Terrene and the Celestial, &c. Lib.* 4. *c.* 34.

Origen in *Mat.* 25. calling it [*Bread, and a typical and symbolical body, which profiteth none but the worthy Receivers, and that according to the proportion of their Faith; which no wicked man eateth, &c.*

Euseb. Caesar. Demonstr. Evang. l. 1. c. 10. [*Celebrating duly the Memorial of the body and blood of Christ—Seeing we receive the Memorial of this Sacrifice, to be perfected on the Table, by the*

Symbols of his body and most precious blood—Lib. 8. *He delivered us to use bread as the Symbol of his own body.*

Ephr. (in Biblioth Photii, p. 415. Ed. August.) *The body of Christ which Believers receive, loseth not his sensible substance, and is not separated from the intelligible grace.*

And *ad eos qui filii Dei, &c.* [*Take notice diligently, how taking bread in his hands he blessed it, and brake it, for a* FIGURE *of his immaculate Body; and he blessed the Cup, and gave it to his Disciples, as a* Figure *of his precious blood.*

Theodoret in *Dialog. de Immutab.* against an *Eutychian,* who pleaded, that Bread in the Eucharist was turned into Christ's Body, saith, [*The Lord who called that meat and bread, which naturally was his body, and who again called himself a Vine, did honour the Visible Signs with the Names of his Body and Blood; not having changed their Nature, but added Grace to Nature.*] Can any Protestant speak plainer than this?

And Dial. 2. [*The Divine Mysteries are Signs of the true Body.*

And further, answering the *Eutychian,* he saith, [*By the Net which thou hast made art thou taken: For even after the Consecration the mystical Signs change not their Nature, for they remain in all their first* SUBSTANCE, *Figure, and Form, and are visible, and to be handled as before.*] This is not plain enough for a Papist.

Nor *Gelasius cont. Nestor. & Eutych.* [*Verily the Sacrament of the body and blood of Christ which we take is a Divine thing, for which and by which we are made partakers of the Divine Nature; and yet it ceaseth not to be the* SUBSTANCE *and* NATURE *of bread and wine: And certainly the Image and similitude of the Body and Blood of Christ are celebrated in the action of the Mysteries.*] O dark sayings!

[*Cyril, Alex.* in *John* 4. *c.* 14. [*He gave to his believing Disciples fragments of bread, saying, Take, eat, this is my body.*]

Facundus is there cited as from *Molinaeus* (*l.* 9. *c.* 5. *p.* 404. though I have not the Author) saying [*We call that the body and blood of Christ, which is the Sacrament of his body in the Consecrated bread and cup. Not that the bread is properly his body, and the cup his blood, but because they contain the Mystery of his body and blood.*]

To these I might add plain Testimonies out of most of the Ancients, who write on this subject: Such, *e. g.* as these words of *Gregor. Nyssen Orat. de Baptis. As the Altar naturally is but common Stone, but being consecrated becometh a holy Table, an unspotted Altar; so the bread of the Eucharist is at first ordinary, but being mysteriously sacrificed, it is, and is called, The body of Christ, and is effectual to great things: And as the Priest who was yesterday a Lay-man, by the blessing of Ordination is made a Teacher of Godliness, and a Steward of the Mysteries, and though not changed in body or shape, yet is changed and made better as to his soul, by an invisible power and grace; so also by the same consequence Water, being nothing but Water of itself, yet blest by the heavenly grace, reneweth man by working in him the spiritual regeneration.*

Is *Stone* in the *Altar,* or the *Priest ordained,* or *Water in Baptism* transubstantiated?

If *Charles* the Great was a Heretic, the Pope is greatly beholden to a Heretic. In his Epist. to *Alcunius* he saith, [*Christ at his Supper did break the Bread to his Disciples, and likewise gave them the Cup, in Figure of his body and blood; and so left to us this great Sacrament for our benefit.*] This was his Tradition.

Amalarius Praef. de Offic. Eccles. [*I am swayed in all that I write by the judgment of holy men and godly Fathers; yet what I judge myself I speak: Those things which are done in the celebration of Divine Service, are done in the Sacrament of the Passion of our Lord, as he himself commanded. Therefore the Priest offering the bread with the wine and water in the Sacrament, doth it in the stead of Christ; and the bread and wine and water in the Sacrament represent the flesh and blood of Christ. For Sacraments are somewhat to resemble those things whereof they are Sacraments. Therefore let the Priest be like to Christ, as the bread and liquors are like the body and blood of Christ.*]

[*The Sacrament of the body of Christ is in some manner the body of Christ: For Sacraments should not be Sacraments, if in some things they had not the likeness of that whereof they are Sacraments. Now by reason of this mutual likeness, they are often called by that which*

they represent,—Sacraments have the virtue to bring us to those things, of which they are Sacraments.]

Walafridus Strabo de reb. Eccl. cap. 16., saith, [*Christ gave to his Disciples the Sacrament of his body and blood in the substance of bread and wine.*]

Bernard an. 1120. *Serm. de Purific. Mar.* saith, [*The Body of Christ in the Sacrament is the food of the Soul, not of the Belly; therefore we eat him not corporally, but in the manner that Christ is meat, in that same manner we understand that he is eaten.* And *Serm. de S. Martin. The same Flesh is given us to this day, but Spiritually not Corporally.*]

To conclude, If the words *This is my Body* are to be taken literally, then so are the rest; [*This Cup is the New Testament in my Blood.*] And then the Cup is Transubstantiated into the New Testament.

And he that at once doth believe that Christ hath a Glorified Spiritual Body, that Flesh and Blood doth not enter into the Kingdom of Heaven, that the Bread and Wine cease to be *Bread and Wine,* and are turned substantially into the very *Flesh and Blood* of Christ, and yet that the Pope and his Clergy are not Enemies of Christ and Souls, who deny this *Blood* to the People, and give them but a half Christ and a half Sacrifice, when he is praised by all Saints for washing them from their sins in his Blood; this Man and his Leaders seem to be Educated in such an Academy, as *Festus* thought *Paul* had been, and to be made by Satan the Stumbling-block of the unbelieving World, to persuade them to laugh at Christianity as we do at the Fopperies of *Mahomet*'s Alcoran; and to make all the Nations of Heathens and Infidels believe that they cannot be Christians, unless they will be mad and senseless too: While Senses, Reason, Scripture, the History of the Church, and Writings of the Ancients, the Tradition and Judgement of the far greatest part of the Church, together with Charity, Humanity, and Peace, are all denied in obedience to *one Man,* that, because one Prince and his Clergy made him the first Bishop in his Empire and Councils, feigneth himself to be the Universal Monarch of the World; and undertaketh an Apos-

tleship and Government at the Antipodes (when his zealousest Bishops formerly some of them thought there was no such place;) and obligeth himself to the care of Souls farther than *Drake* and *Candish* Sailed, even in abundance of unknown Lands; and (as his Agents confessed to the *Abassines*) where his Missioners have no access.

The sum of all the History of this Matter is, The Fathers called it as we do, sometime Christ's Body, and sometime the *Figure,* or representation of his Body, and often Bread: And from the *Name,* in the dark Age, the Thing grew controvated, and *France* was the chief Seat of the Contention: *Bellarmine* himself saith, that *an.* 820. [Paschasius Ratbertus, *an Abbot. was the first Man that seriously and copiously Wrote of the truth of the Body and Blood of the Lord in the Eucharist against, Bertram,*] who he thinks was one of the first that Wrote against it. *Bell. de script. Eccl. Johan. Parisiensis* and the Sorbonists concluded that neither Opinion was *de fide:* But the Pope chanced to be on the other, and the Council of *Trent* hath now made it *de fide. Qu.* Whether the Sorbonists knew not that Tradition which Parents teach their Children? nor any of those that were against *Ratbertus?*

But the Discourser pretendeth in the end to Answer Objections: But he first made them himself so thin, that he might not despair of saying something, which a Man deep in his Cups, or one that is little used to the Exercise of his Brain, might possibly take for a Rational Answer. But if the Reader be a Man that will be at so much pains to escape delusion, as to Read over the Arguments against Transubstantiation in the forementioned (little) Book of *R. B.* and then try whether he can here find them Answered; I may conjecture that he will not boast of the Discourser's performances.

He begins the Objection with a [*Why doth not this marvellous Change appear to our Senses, as well as other marvellous works: as the Water turned into Wine,* &c.]

I confess it is strange *Flesh* and *Blood, that no sense can perceive:* But a *spiritual Body* may be out of the perception of our Sense. But did not the Discourser know, that it is another kind

of Objection that we make? Not [*Why doth not God show us the Miracle to our Sense?*] but [*whether God deceive all our Senses and Intellect, which there perceive Bread and Wine, when there is none?*] It is not, whether Sense *perceive Christ?* but, [*whether Sense perceive Bread and Wine?*] It is not, whether Sense do *privatively not perceive;* but, whether it *here positively err,* and the first *Intellective* perception of the sensate Object be an Error?

But under the Coats of this first part, he brings in a little of the true Objection at last, [*It would follow, that we might call in question the whole Mystery of Christianity, &c.*]

His Answer to all is, *By a distinction of Miracles; some are to convince Unbelievers; some to sanctify and save Believers: And these are not to be the Object of our Senses.* He instanceth in *Baptism, by which, as an outward and visible Sign, is wrought an invisible Grace in the Soul of the baptized; though view the Child as much as you will, you can by none of your Senses perceive any mutation wrought.*

Answ. As your *Transubstantiation* seemeth devised to *make Infidels,* so doth your Doctrine of *Baptism* seem made to make *Anabaptists.* Is it by a *Miracle* that Baptism giveth Grace to the *Adult,* or not? If not, will not Men rather turn Anabaptists, than believe that Infants can have no Grace by Baptism, but by Miracle; when that Sacrament was instituted to give Grace to the Adult without a Miracle, and Scripture mentioneth no such difference of the Effects? But if it be by Miracle to the Adult, is it not also by Miracle, that Men receive Grace by Reading, Preaching, or other means? You'll never prove one a Miracle, and not the other. And before we come to the Dispute between the Jesuits and some Friars, the *Arminians* against some *Calvinists, Whether all Grace infused be a Miracle,* we must bestow more time to agree of the *definition* of a *Miracle,* than is congruous to our present business. Overdoing is undoing: They that will make Men believe, that all Grace and Christianity is a Miracle, I doubt, do but drive men from the belief of all.

But this Discourser tells us, that *you see no change on a Child. Answ.* And is all a Miracle that is unseen? Is *God* a Miracle?

Are Angels and all Spirits Miracles? Is the Soul of a Man, or of a Beast, or the Life of a Plant a Miracle, because unseen? Then all Grace however wrought is a Miracle; yea, and every thought of a man's heart both good and evil.

Is all a Miracle that is done by God alone, without second Causes? Then his moving the first created Motor were a Miracle. And yet who can say, that no second Cause is used in the conveyance of Grace?

But if you could prove that Word and Sacraments work Grace by miracle, you would make us less wonder that it is no more common: And here the Priest cannot do this Miracle when he will, for it must be on a disposed Subject: But your Priests can make *Bread* to be no *Bread,* by miracle, when they will. But S. *Paul* saith, *Are all works of miracles?* But how much greater Miracles your Priests are feigned to work, than the raising of *Lazarus,* or any such like; and how your feigned Miracles are confused, is showed fully by the foresaid Author.

But the Question, whether the Sacrament work by miracle, is one; and that, whether it be *itself a miracle,* is another. God's *workings* are secret to us, as the wind whose course we cannot describe, *Joh.* 3. But is the Sacrament itself a Miracle? The Word is not so: Baptism is not so: You feign not your Confirmation to be so: (though *Cyril* aforesaid make the change of the *Bread* and of the *Oil* to be alike.) And is only this one Ordinance a Miracle?

But if it were, what's that to the positive deception of all our Senses?

He tells us of the Hypostatical Union, answered before: What Senses are deceived by that? Doth Sense judge that Christ was not God? Or that there is no Trinity? Or that a Virgin may not conceive? Not at all: Sense neither tells us that it is so, or that it is not. Therefore to tell us of things *hidden from Sense,* is impertinent. All the spiritual and noblest parts of Nature are out of the reach of our bodily Senses: But Sense is our only first perceiver of all its own proper Objects, and the Intellects first perception of them, is only as they are sensate.

But the only pertinent Answer given, is, [*We may always trust our Senses about their own Objects, and in due circumstances, and when we have not positive grounds to think, either God Almighty by himself, or by an Angel, or permissively by a Devil, represents things otherwise than they are.*]

Answ. When things are *represented otherwise than they are,* it is either in *other sensible qualities than they have,* or else something else is under those qualities, than what they naturally signify; or else it is by altering the Sense, Organ, or Medium. The first is a mere contradiction: To *make* an Object to be what it *was not,* is usual; but to make it at the same instant to *be what it is not,* is a contradiction. Therefore by *representing* you cannot rationally mean this; *e. g.* To represent a rough thing as smooth, a *little* thing as *great,* a white thing as black, by real alterations of those qualities making them to be so.

But to make them *seem* so, when really they are not so, must be by the failing of the *Medium, Organ, Sense, Fantasy,* or *Intellect.*

1. And for the *Medium,* no doubt but God can so alter it easily, as to deceive all men's Senses: And in our present case, where all the five Senses of all the sound men in the World, that try, are pretended to be deceived, God is *able* to do it, by altering the *Medium* of *every Sense* that hath a *Medium:* (For whether *tactus* have *any* distinct from the Organ is undetermined.)

2. And the same is to be said of the *Organ, Sense, Fantasy,* and *Intellect: Quoad potentiam,* no doubt but that God that can annihilate them can *deprave* them when he please, and make a man senseless, deceived, doting, melancholy, or mad; either *privatively,* by withholding his necessary natural aids; or *positively,* by overcoming contraries.

But the Question is not, Whether God *can* do this *per potentiam;* but, Whether he *will* do it, or *can will to do it* in such case as ours, in consistence with his *Governing Wisdom* and *Goodness,* and that *Truth* and *Constancy* which he manifesteth in the Government of the World. That he may and doth penally make men senseless, mad, and dead, we doubt not; and

that those that would not receive the love of the Truth, that they might be saved, may permissively be given up to strong delusions to believe a Lie: *That all they might be damned that believed not the truth, but had pleasure in unrighteousness,* 2 *Thess.* 2. 11, 12.

But that God doth thus (not penally, but) as a *blessing,* and not upon men's forsaking him and his Truth, but while he is communicating *Himself* and *his Truth* to them, and to make a *Deceit* or *Lie* the *ordinary Means* of *Truth* and *Holiness,* and that he should do this ordinarily as the *Governor, Benefactor,* and *Saviour* of Mankind, and so make Falsehood (not of his *permitting,* but of his own *effecting*) to be the ordinary way of *saving men;* all this is contradiction; contrary to his Will revealed in *Nature* and *Scripture,* and contrary to his Perfection, who needed not to Govern the World by Deceit or Lies, as wanting neither *Power, Wisdom,* or *Goodness* to do otherwise. Grace consisteth in the *illumination* of the *Mind,* which revealeth Truth, and not in the Error or Deception of the Mind, by deceiving the Senses. God's Works of Nature discerned or perceived by our Natural Sense and Fantasy, and so by Natural Apprehension of the Intellect, are his *first-way* of Revelation, in which he is most *clear* and *constant.* And we are *Men* and *Animals* before we are *Believers,* and *Faith* is graffed into the Stock of *Nature,* and *rectifieth, illuminateth, elevateth, perfecteth it,* but doth not destroy it, deprave it, deceive men, and make them mad or senseless.

But you tell us of many excepted Cases, in which God may deceive our Senses, or we may not trust them: No doubt, we may never trust them for that which belongs not to them, but is beyond them, (as to know whether God can assume Flesh, whether he can impregnate a Virgin; whether there be *Trinity* in *Unity:* There be many things that Sense is no Judge of, one way or other. But when there is an *Object near us, duly situate,* which *Sense* was made to perceive, (as a *quantitative, sapid, odoriferous, &c. substance*) and there is [no natural defect in Medium, Organ, Sense, Fantasy, or Natural Intellect, to tell us of such excepted Cases, is, 1. To deface or slander the Provi-

dence of God, who Governeth by truth and order: 2. To make *Mercy* to consist in the subversion of Nature, and *Penal Acts* to be *gracious.* 3. To leave man utterly uncertain of every Article of Faith, yea, to bring in Scepticism, and leave us no certainty in the world. For if God may and do, in so many Cases as you name, deceive all the Senses and Perceptions of all men, even his faithfullest Servants in the World, by *Himself,* by *Angels,* by *Devils permitted,* how shall any man know when he doth otherwise? You say, [*'till we have positive grounds to think these.*] But, if God *can do thus,* how can you tell that he doth it not without *telling us,* or giving us *positive grounds?* And who knoweth what those positive grounds are? Or that ever he read or heard a word, or saw a thing which you may call a *ground?* For if you know not *first* that the perception of Sense, and things sensate is true, you know not that ever you *heard any*thing to suspend your belief of them: Or that what you hear is true. And how will you prove against the Infidels, that God cannot Lie, or deceive us by a Prophet, an Angel, or a Voice from Heaven, or a Writing, if he can and do daily deceive all our Senses, about such Objects as they are made to perceive?

And what a War do you raise against the life of Faith, as if it had not difficulties enough without such? If you should set a Candle before Infidels or doubting persons, and say, [*If this be Light, the Gospel is false,*] would you be a Preacher of Christ or Satan? And if you set the Consecrated *Bread and Wine* before them, and say, [*See them, smell, taste, feel them; if this be Bread and Wine the Gospel is false;*] would you not be the Preachers of Infidelity?

But I must consider, that so much being said already in the foresaid *Dialogue,* which you give no Answer to, I must rather stay till that be answered, than repeat it here.

But, at the least, you satisfy us, when you grant, that *we must trust our Senses 'till we have positive grounds for the contrary;* and so the Case before us is this: You say, [*They that will be saved, must believe that God in mercy to illuminate men's minds, deceiveth all the sound men's Senses in the world* (that try) *about those things which naturally are the proper Objects of Sense, and duly qualified;*

and they must believe that there is no Bread or Wine, when all their Senses present them as such to the Intellect, which necessarily perceiveth them is such as sensate; and they must believe, that to govern, illuminate, and sanctify us by such deceit, God enableth every Priest, how ignorant and wicked soever, to verify all the Contradictions before opened, and to work, as oft as he pleaseth, in every Mass above thirty Miracles, with many miraculous aggravations.] And the proof of all this is, 1. That the same Christ that said [*I am the Door, the true Vine, the Shepherd, a Sower, a Husbandman, the Bridegroom, and spake ordinarily by Parables, and said in this same Sacrifice or Sacrament* [*This Cup is the New Testament in my Blood;*] *and in all these is to be understood parabolically; yet saying at the same time* [*This is my Body*] *is to be understood literally, though S.* Paul *over and over call it Bread.*] 2. *And this Exposition is delivered to us by the Roman Pope and his Clergy, and by some Priests in the Ninth and Tenth Ages, when their own Writers say, that their Popes were Monsters not to be named, and the Ages were for horrid Ignorance the shame of the Church. And after that,* 1215. *a General Council Decreed it first, which also Decreed the extermination of all Christians as Heretics, that will believe man's Senses herein, and the Excommunication and Deposition of all Temporal Lords, that will not exterminate all such Subjects, and the disobliging their Vassals from their Allegiance, and giving their Dominions to others: While yet the Judgment and Tradition of the far greatest part of the Christian World is against them, and the Writings of the ancient Doctors of the Church; and the Pope and his Clergy dare not pretend to have received by Memory and Tradition an Exposition of the Bible, nor do give us any proof of their pretended Tradition of this one Text, that is considerable, besides their own bare word.* This is the true Case.

POSTSCRIPT.

Since the Writing of this I first saw *Larrogues* French Discourse, and therein the Citation of *Joh. Parisiensis* Opinion about Transubstantiation, and the *Sorbonists* determination, that neither Opinion was *de fide,* and determined: And did they not then know Tradition?

Since that I have seen Bishop *Cousin*'s History of Transubstantiation, which so fully proveth the Novelty of it, as against the Tradition and Judgment of the Church, and that by Fathers and many Councils, in all Ages till *Innoc.* 3. and even after *Petrus Blesensis,* and *Steph. Aedunensis* (who first name it) and *Innoc.* 3. who first established it, few believed it in most Countries, as their own Authors confess; that I repented that I had needlessly meddled with the Citation of Authors, which is done by him so much better: And indeed such unanswerable Testimony is produced by him, (and that briefly in a small Volume) to prove that the constant Judgment of the Church hath been against Transubstantiation, that I need not refer the doubting Reader to any other Book, nor provoke the Papists to try their strength upon any other: (Though *Hospinian, Usher, Chamier, Spalatensis, Albertinus,* and abundance more, have done it beyond all reasonable contradiction.)

FINIS.